



Shadow Accord

2026 Core Rulebook

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Shadow Accord Mission Statement

Shadow Accord is a dark fantasy boffer LARP with an alternate-history medieval setting inspired by World of Darkness: Dark Ages. Our mission is to provide an immersive roleplay experience with an emphasis on character-driven stories and conflicts, with themes of horror, intrigue, internal character struggle, and faction politics at the heart of every event. Shadow Accord is committed to treating all players equally and equitably in order to provide a safe environment that actively welcomes players of all backgrounds, identities, and abilities.

In order to achieve this, our community expects everyone in the community to contribute toward these values:

Fun, Immersion, Accessibility, Fairness, Safety, Inclusion, Diversity and Community

Shadow Accord strives to be a **Fun** game; this means everyone attempts to create opportunities for others to engage in a way that they find satisfying, and leave looking forward to the next event.

Shadow Accord strives to be an **Immersive** game; this means everyone works together to create and maintain an in-game space that allows for the suspension of disbelief, creative agency, emotional expression, and social interaction.

Shadow Accord attempts to be an **Accessible** game; everyone makes and respects reasonable accommodations that allow people of varying abilities to enjoy the game.

Shadow Accord strives to be a **Fair** game; this means that the staff of this game enforces rules and policies without favoritism, and everyone interacts with each other in-game in a way that avoids exclusion based on out-of-game relationships.

Shadow Accord strives to be a **Safe** game; safety includes physical, mental, and emotional safety. Every member of the community is responsible for contributing to and upholding a safe environment for participants.

Shadow Accord strives to be an **Inclusive** game with a **Diverse** playerbase; everyone stands against discrimination and actively welcomes participants from all backgrounds, identities, and abilities, especially from groups who have been marginalized in the past and present, to join this community as players and staff. Staff strives to create policies that support the goals of creating a safer and more empowering environment for our playership.

Shadow Accord is a **Community** game; this means that everyone deals with each other respectfully and charitably, and contributes to creating a positive and welcoming experience for others, in both in-game and out-of-game spaces.

Everyone is asked to use their good-faith best judgment to uphold these values in a way that works toward the overall good of the game. Where these values come into conflict, the wellbeing of players is the priority.

Shadow Accord Code of Conduct

The Code of Conduct is our expectations for the behavior of everyone who plays Shadow Accord. Participating in Shadow Accord is a privilege, not a right; being a member of our community is contingent on following this Code of Conduct. Failing to follow this Code of Conduct may result in losing the privilege to play Shadow Accord or participate in other game-related activities.

All players are empowered and encouraged to report incidents of a player or staff member doing something which the reporter believes violates the Player Code of Conduct or the Staff Code of Conduct or otherwise makes them feel unwelcome or unsafe in the community.

The main principles of the Code of Conduct are outlined here:

No Harassment - We do not tolerate any form of harassment at any time.

Interact Respectfully - We expect all players to be good sports and interact respectfully with everyone.

Be Kind to Staff - Staff are players who work hard to make game happen, and they ask for your understanding and patience.

Manage Character Bleed - We expect players to clearly distinguish between IG and OOG actions.

Uphold the Community Values - Fun, Immersion, Accessibility, Fairness, Safety, Inclusion, Diversity and Community.

Make Everyone Feel Welcome - We welcome everyone who upholds this Code of Conduct.

Follow the Rules - Mistakes are forgivable, but persistent cheating is not.

Prioritize Player Well-Being - Player well-being always supersedes any game rules.

Pause Scenes Only When Needed - Call a hold to protect wellbeing, but attempt to minimize disruption.

Avoid Metagaming - Don't draw on OOG information unless it's positive metagaming to improve another players' experience.

Respect Others' Experiences - This is a collaborative effort, and the actions of an individual affect the whole community.

Physical Roleplay - Ask for consent every time.

Portrayals of Prejudice, Sexual Content, Religion and Other Sensitive Topics - Make game-space inclusive for everyone.

Avoid Cultural Appropriation - LARP is not an excuse to misuse others' culture.

Play Within Your (and Others') Limits - Don't push yourself or others to the point of injury or exhaustion.

No Roughness - Do not engage in roughhousing or grappling with other players.

Use Boffer Weapons Safely - The point is to hurt characters, not players.

Abide by Stand Downs - Stop or modify play when conditions are unsafe and listen to the Safety Team for guidance.

Practice Fire Safety - You must be approved by XO's and Safety team to have fires. No combat is allowed around fires.

Follow Site Rules - The rules of the site we play at supersede most other rules.

Follow the Law - No illegal activity is tolerated at game.

Respect People's Stuff - Taking things that do not belong to you without permission is not allowed.

Leave Substances at Home - Don't bring to game anything that could impair your judgment.

Behave Appropriately at Site - There is no space on site where you are guaranteed privacy.

Use Kitchens and Bathrooms Respectfully - Keep the kitchens and bathrooms usable for other players.

Read the full [Code of Conduct](#) on our website or Discord server.

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Introduction

Tales of Shadow

It is a cold autumn day with the smell of wet and decaying leaves in the air. Deric is busy shopping in Ploermel. The smell and sights of the city can be a little overwhelming for the young man growing up in a small village in the woods. However, Deric, in his excitement, is not paying attention to the time, and it is starting to get dark. Going into the woods at night is dangerous, but he spent his whole life in the woods and knows the dangers – or so he thought.

Deric puts on his pack of supplies to return to his mother and little sister. It is a long walk back to their home near Arthorne. "I

should only take an hour or two as long as I stay on the main roads; this should be fine," he says to himself.

The walk is fine as he gets on the path going north along the lake. A fog starts rolling off the lake, snaking its way around the trunk of the tall Oak and Ash that make up the Brocéliande forest. As he gets into the woods, what light is left from the sun is snuffed out, and darkness overtakes the path ahead. The hair on Deric's neck starts to rise, and he feels uneasy in his gut. He hears footsteps behind him, and

a sense of dread grows within; then he stops and listens to the footsteps, which also stop. Deric slowly turns around and only sees the fog wisping behind him. Deric heard of bandits on this road, and the Blue Sash Gang has been getting violent of late.

"Shit, I'm going to get robbed." He mumbles, "Ok, come out, might as well get this over with!" Deric

shouts. He looks around; nothing has changed, just a light breeze dancing within the treetops.

He takes a deep breath and continues into the dark foggy path. Soon he gets the feeling he is being watched, and out of the corner of his eye, he sees

a silhouette of a man watching him as he walks by. Overwhelming dread sinks in as he picks up his pace.

Then he hears it again – the footsteps behind him. Looking into the woods with the corners of his eyes, he sees silhouetted figures, all staring at him. The feeling of dread quickly transforms into terror as he checks over his shoulder. This time he sees a hooded figure standing in the fog. Deric bolts, running as fast as he can almost blindly through the dark and winding road. After what seems like forever, he comes to a stop



and catches his breath. Only a distant owl is heard in the dark, empty forest.

Deric starts to laugh. "Is it just the shadows in the dark? The Watching Men aren't real," he says as he regains his composure, only a few minutes away from home. Then, he hears the footsteps again. He looks up to see a silhouetted figure breaching through the fog. He peers up and tries to get a good look at the face. The darkness, fog, and hood obscure the face, but he swears he sees a smile.

The next day is bright and sunny. The air is cold and crisp, and the frost melts and streams in the sun's warm rays. An older woman is at her bread bowl kneading dough and is about to wake her children once the bread goes into the oven. She is interrupted by a knock on the door. "Who could that be this early in the morning?" She thinks to herself. She gets up and opens the door to see the Constable at her door.

"Oh my, Constable, I did not expect you or anyone this early. How can I be of help, sir?" she says, a little bewildered.

The Constable nods, "Morning to you, ma'am. I am here on business; When was the last time you saw your son Deric?"

The woman, a bit shocked, shakes her head and says, "I had not seen him since last morning when he went into the city for some things. I figured he got in late... Oh no, did something happen?"

The Constable lowers his head, "I am afraid so, ma'am; we found him this morning on the road. He seemed to have succumbed to the elements last night, but his face was twisted as if he died scared. It was foggy last night, and several people claim they saw them."

The older woman, now in tears, is trying to piece together everything in her head. "Saw who? The people who murdered my son?" she asks.

"No, ma'am, worse. The Watchers."

—Tales of Shadow, 1222

The Very Basics

Shadow Accord is a multi-faction live action role play (LARP) adaptation of the World of Darkness: Dark Ages tabletop roleplaying system.

What the Heck Is a LARP?

Do you remember when you were a kid how you'd spend afternoons building imaginary worlds in the woods near your house? You and your friends agreed on what you could and couldn't do in your games; which tree stumps were castles, who had laser eyes, and so on.

As LARPers, we're basically doing the same kind of make-believe, just with a little more formality. Instead of sticks, we have fancy foam swords, and nice garb instead of bedsheets (but the running around in the woods part hasn't changed at all). Our rules and lore are written down so everyone's on the same page, but it's all just as "made up" as they were when we were kids.

You're coming into a story that's already underway, but one which we're excited to have you join. As a newcomer, it's your job to fit the tone of what's already been created, but everyone's job to make space for your new additions to the story!

Our game is set 800 years before the present day in a small town in the Duchy of Brittany, a region in the northwestern corner of what will eventually become France. While much of the setting closely resembles real life history, there are a few key differences – most importantly this is a world in which Vampires, Werewolves, Ghosts, Mages, and other beings of supernatural power have blended in with the human populace and have been subtly shaping their culture for generations. This is a world that is ever-so-slightly darker, angstier, and more dangerous than the one we know.

While most "normal" people have no idea that Monsters live among them, fragments of the truth seep out in the form of myths, legends, and superstitions. Tales of swords in the stones, succubi that steal children in the night, dragons sleeping in the hills, elixirs of eternal life, wolf-men transformed

at the full moon, and souls of the dead left to wander the earth all have a crumb of truth to them. And as long as it's just a crumb, the real monsters don't mind.



On the mundane side, this is the height of the Medieval period in Europe. Nobles rule absolutely, and alliances shift as frequently as the wind. Brittany has fiercely defended its independence from the neighboring powers of England and France – maintaining its own language, culture and even its own saints. Common people eke out subsistence however they can, some driven to desperate acts by

hunger, jealousy, greed, or the lure of forces they cannot understand. When lives hang in a precarious balance, no action is without consequences.

Arthorne is a small town between Rennes and Nantes, a minor stop along a busy trade route. For arcane reasons yet to be fully explained, it's also a haven for the weird and mysterious of the world. Its residents understand the importance of secret-keeping because almost everyone in town has something they would rather others not know. Although the townsfolk each pursue their own aims – sometimes at deadly odds with each other – all know the dangers that would befall them if the truth was fully revealed...

If this sounds intriguing, you've found the right place! We are dedicated to creating an immersive, dramatic LARPing experience that provides the opportunity to step out of everyday life and experience rich, fantastic stories in a safe environment. These stories can be grand conflicts or simple tales. With attention to detail and dedication to roleplay, even the smallest interactions can be surprisingly intense and deeply moving.

How to Use this Rulebook

If you've never LARPed before, start with the [Introduction](#) and [Appendix A - How to Prepare for Game](#). Then move on to the rest of the rules, starting with [Game Rules](#).

If you're familiar with LARPing but new to **Shadow Accord**, you should at least skim the Introduction before reading the Game Rules, Character Creation, the Faction(s) you're interested in, and Merits, Skills, and Powers.

What's in this Rulebook

This book contains the mechanical rules for playing Shadow Accord.

What's Not in this Rulebook

Details of the game's setting and the lore for each faction can be found in the **Shadow Accord Player's Guides**. Additional info can be found in official World of Darkness source books.

Shadow Accord's organizational policies, including the full Code of Conduct and reporting process can be found on our website. You can also find resources like boffer making guides and ideas for garb.

Shadow Accord Website

All of the reference materials mentioned in this rulebook are available on the Shadow Accord website:
sites.google.com/nwlarpers.org/shadowaccordwiki

Updates

There may be periodic updates and clarifications to the player rules that come out between releases of the rulebook. These will be published in an **Errata** document available wherever Shadow Accord links are hosted.

Mostly, You Don't Need Rules

This is a live-action roleplay (LARP), so most interactions in-game are not governed by rules. To convince someone to help you, you need to make a compelling argument. To eavesdrop on a conversation, you have to be sneaky. Certain game effects can certainly help you with these things, but generally your real-life abilities are just as important as what's on your character sheet.

This rulebook provides rules for doing the types of actions that would be impossible or dangerous to do in real life, such as throwing fireballs or drinking someone's blood. Everything else is up to you!

Specific Supersedes General

If there's something that says "do X" and another effect that says "you can't do X", what happens? The more specific situation supersedes the general one. For example, if your faction usually can't Frenzy, but you cast a ritual that says you can Frenzy, the ritual is more specific and supersedes the general rule.

Things Only Do What They Say They Do

When it comes to game mechanics, the rulebook is a collection of things you *can* do. If the rules don't say you can do something, you should assume that you can't, even if we didn't explicitly say so. As an example, there are no rules about making flaming arrows in this rulebook – which means that's not something you can do.

Likewise, you can assume that the plain meanings of this rules text are the real meanings. No part of this book is trying to trick you. If you think there's genuine ambiguity, let us know! But we're not here playing word games about the meaning of "is" (save that for the Fae).

Roleplay Flavor

You're always welcome (and encouraged!) to put your own individual roleplay flair on these rules! Generally you have free reign when it comes to flavor, as long as you meet the minimum requirements of what the rules say you have to do. Get weird!

Flavor Text

Throughout the rulebook, you'll see some text in this font.

This is flavor text – not rules per se, but indications of how this concept is usually roleplayed. You're free to roleplay differently, but you should be aware that you're playing against a stereotype. See the [Player's Guides](#) for more information.

Time Durations

When there are time durations in this rulebook, they are almost always 10 seconds, 60 seconds, or 10 minutes.

Unless you're in a situation where you can count seconds or discreetly peek at a watch, it's acceptable to make your best guess at how long 10 minutes lasts, as long as you're not bending time to your favor. Generally, "10 minutes" means at least the duration of a scene or interaction. If in doubt, go long. You may also choose to count out the last 60 seconds to avoid having complete control over when it ends.

Conflicting Interactions

Shadow Accord has been around since 2010, and its predecessor Mortal Tears started in 2005. Like the Wyld, the Weaver, and the Wyrms, various forces have acted on this ruleset to add features, remove features, and generally try to keep things organized. *However*, you are sure to encounter some strange interactions of mechanics for which there are no defined rules. When these situations arise, please use your best judgment.

The Most Important Rule:

Player safety and well-being supersedes anything else in this rulebook. Period.

If a rules-based circumstance prevents you from doing something important for your well-being, such as eating, drinking, resting, or tending to a medical issue, you may temporarily and discreetly disregard the rule to take care of that need. Please return to following the normal rules as soon as you can and minimize disruption to other players. If a player finds that they frequently need to disregard a rule or that they cannot resolve the issue quickly and without disruption, they should contact Safety or the XO's to discuss a longer-term accommodation. (A player exploiting this leniency to give themselves an in-game advantage is considered to be cheating)

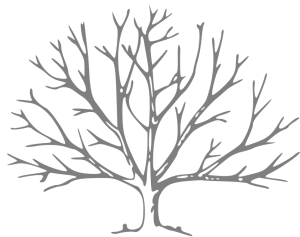


Roleplaying Principles

Immersion

Shadow Accord strives to be an immersive experience. We believe that a detailed atmosphere is important to creating a strong roleplay environment. For this reason at every event you will find a fully decorated tavern complete with tapestries on the walls, electric flame lanterns, a wooden bar with medieval style mugs, pitchers, food, and drink. The players contribute to this atmosphere by decorating (deco-ing) their own area as befits their character.

Both the remote wooded environment and the decorated buildings and cabins help support the medieval town setting.



Immersion extends to the garb you wear and the props you use as your character. The small details sometimes make the experience!

Staying In Character

At a Shadow Accord event, you're encouraged to stay in character the whole weekend. The players roleplay to such depths that you will find them staying in character even when they are alone in a room. If this sounds intimidating, don't worry! It's actually way easier than you'd think because everyone around you is doing the same thing.

We ask that you refrain from making out-of-game references or jokes during the event (save it for afters!).

Additionally, there is no difference between player characters and Storyteller characters (NPCs). All characters interact with everyone on the same intense roleplay level. The result is an atmosphere where anything can happen to anyone by anyone at any time, including character death.

No Rewinds

Once something happens in game space, it cannot be taken back. There are no rewinds or "retcons". If you make a mistake, try to find a way to roll with it. You'll be surprised how easily things get smoothed over and worked into the fabric of a story.

What You See is What You Get (WYSIWYG)

What you see, smell, hear and touch in game space is meant to be taken literally. This means that as much as humanly possible we represent what is going on with props, costumes, makeup, or sets. With very few exceptions, this LARP doesn't use OOG commentary or counting to portray actions. Don't describe to other players what they are seeing, show it to them! The reactions are longer lasting if you represent what you are supposed to be seeing. That said, your imagination is sometimes needed to help fill in the gaps: a person wearing a wolf mask is a Garou in Crinos, the person with their hand over their face is invisible, etc. There is more information on this available in [Appendix F - What Do You See?](#)

Find Out In-Game (FOIG)

Shadow Accord is a game where much of the plot (and the fun!) comes from keeping, learning, and trading secrets. Some players find that learning in-game secrets during out-of-game conversations wrecks the surprise and diminishes the reward of finding out in-game. It's polite not to share in-game information with other players between games (especially if it involves someone else's character). If you're talking to someone and they tell you to "FOIG", they're likely not being rude; rather they're inviting you to interact with them in-game to learn the knowledge in a more satisfying way.

FOIG can also be a boon to new players. As a brand new character, you're not expected to arrive in town with encyclopedic knowledge of everything in this rulebook or WoD lore. Very few characters in-game have a full understanding of how all the other factions work. Learning and earning information IG can be an interesting way to start generating connections with other characters.

(That being said, FOIG is never an excuse to not know the rules. While your character may be ignorant, you as a player must not be.)

Rules Support Story

Most interactions between characters aren't governed by mechanics. In order for your character to do something, you must do it. You move, speak, believe, perceive, feel, and sleep as your character sees fit, provided that your character uses knowledge and supplies available in early thirteenth-century Europe.

We believe that rules should facilitate roleplay, but should not become the focus of a roleplaying event. As much as possible, we have tried to make the rules simple and easy to follow. Generally, things should work as you expect them to, with any exceptions explicitly called out. Players are expected to become familiar with the rules and use them as they are written, fair for everyone.

Leave it In-Game

We are a community of players that meet for fun pretend games. No one is really a Vampire, Werewolf, or Ghost. But you knew that, right? This also means that you are not really your character and other people aren't really their characters. What happens in the game, stays in the game (*with the obvious exception of reporting Code of Conduct violations*).

Avoid Metagaming

Metagaming is when a character acts on information that was learned by the player out-of-game, rather than by their character

in-game. For example, in between events, players often chat about their characters and what they did. If your character was not involved with what happened, then you can not bring that information to the game as your character. Also, even if you know all there is to know about the lore of the game, that doesn't mean your character does. Metagaming to give yourself an in-game advantage is considered cheating.

Players cannot pass any tagged items, in-game money, or information between their own characters. This includes characters who are being cameo'ed; their actions should not directly impact the actions of the player's other characters.

In some instances, positive metagaming is acceptable. Positive metagaming is using information from outside of the game to make a better experience for others. Examples might include spending extra time interacting with a new player's character to help them get involved in plots right away, or giving players opportunities to show off something really cool about their character.



Character Death at Shadow Accord

The "lethality" of the plot in Shadow Accord waxes and wanes over time, but it isn't unusual to have a few character deaths each event. Sometimes you can sense your character's death coming as they rack up enemies; other times death appears by surprise as a pack of Black Spiral Dancers or Tentacle Monsters.

It's a bit of a mind trip to face your character's mortality each time you play. We find this feeling of vulnerability heightens each moment you stay alive. The thrill of victory is sweeter when you know that the consequences were "real". Still, it can be difficult to let go when a character faces their end. Most longer term players have had a character die – you can seek out a veteran player to ask how they coped.

Shoot for Success, but Accept Failure!

No plan ever goes the way you want it to. Allies betray you, important items get stolen, secrets reach the wrong ears, etc. Other characters can *and will* throw wrenches into your plans.

At a LARP, you are part of a collaborative storytelling experience. You do not have complete control over what happens to your character when you play them. Anything can happen to you at any time (within the bounds of the rules, of course). This includes character death. Dying is not the only permanent change that can happen to you: another character can choose to Embrace you, cast you out of your cabal, shatter your prized possessions, or turn you into all manner of monstrous beings.

When plans fail or your character goes a direction you weren't planning, it's okay to grieve. But it's important to recognize that you didn't "lose" - you've been handed an opportunity to tell a more interesting story for yourself and others. What's the point of a tale where the hero always gets exactly what they want on the first try? The better you can roll with it and adapt, the happier you'll be. There's nothing wrong with losing uphill

Definitions

Armor Points

The amount of damage your armor can absorb before damage starts decreasing your Health. Armor Points are lost from damage taken until the armor is repaired.

Attack

Any weapon attack or power used on a target with hostile intent or against their will. It is up to each character whether they consider themselves to be using a power with hostile intent, and it is up to each character whether they consider themselves an unwilling target of a power. Condition, Damage, Mental, and Status powers nearly always have unwilling targets, as do many Touch powers. As a notable exception, Counted Touch powers *never* count as attacks. Note that there must be at least one second between each attack.

Carrying

Keeping something on your person, whether it's in a bag, on your belt, or being held in your hands. If something specifically needs to be carried in your hands, it will be specified.

CGs

Short for Character Guides, this team is composed of volunteer staff members who are tasked with helping you design your PC. CGs also help with the overall new player experience - helping with prepping for game, giving a pre-game rules talk, etc. They can also be tapped after creation for questions or guidance in things like transitioning paths, factions, general background development, etc.

Character Knowledge

The sum of everything your character knows – knowledge, memories, false impressions, their own backstory, etc. This is contrasted from “Player Knowledge” which is everything *you* as the player knows (e.g. game rules, stats on your character sheet, email addresses of staff, etc.).

Conscious

This means that your character is not Incapacitated, Dying, Dead or asleep (whether asleep in-game or if you the player are actually asleep OOG).

Game Space

The official physical boundaries of the game where you're expected to be roleplaying as your character - typically the in-game areas of the site during the time the game is happening. Since we're a LARP, we strongly value having as much of the story as possible take place in game space, rather than “off screen”. Things can happen with your character outside of this game space, such as unofficial RP, interactions at ST camp, and downtime reports between events, but typically “important” things like death, Embrace, and permanent changes to your character *must* happen in game space.

Garb

Refers to what you wear as your character. Garb is slightly different from a “costume” because it also needs to be practical clothing that will keep you comfortable for a weekend in the woods.

IG

Short for “in-game”, this indicates anything that happens in the game world.

Immobilized

An Immobilized character cannot speak, move, or perform any action except use Regeneration (if they aren't Interrupted). Characters can be Immobilized by Counted Touches such as Paralyzing Bite or Paralyzing Touch and are automatically Immobilized if they are Incapacitated or Dying.

Immunity/Immune

This means certain types of effects can't impact you, even if they carry the “Unresistible” meta call. If you are immune to a power, respond “No Effect” to its calls.

Interruption

This causes a character to lose concentration while they're trying to do something. Characters are Interrupted if they move their feet, get attacked, are targeted with a power (other than a Sensory power) or ritual, use a different power, speak more than a few simple words (other than speech required for the roleplay they're doing), use Regeneration, or take any action other than focusing on the action they were originally trying to do.

Living

A trait that beings have which signifies that they are alive. They have not died and transitioned to another state of existence.

Makeup Requirements

These are included as a requirement to play certain factions/subfactions or use certain powers, often as a drawback.

Max Health

Short for "Maximum Health", this is the most your character is currently able to be healed to. Most characters start each event with a Max Health of 10, but that amount can get reduced by taking [Aggravated Damage](#).

NPC

Short for "Non-Player Character", NPCs are characters who are designed by the STs to help further the story and add depth to the world we play in. Please see the section on [NPCs](#) for more details.

OOG

Short for "out-of-game", this indicates anything that happens outside of the game world.

Packets

A delivery method for some types of damage or powers. Packets are a small fabric pouch about the size of a walnut filled with millet or other rounded grain (biodegradable and no sharp edges) that can be thrown at a target without hurting them.

Permatainted

Short for "permanently tainted", this means that you are [Tainted](#) and can never be Cleansed. You are not able to resist the power [Subjugate](#).

Phys-Rep

Short for "Physical Representation", this is the prop that you attach a tag to. A free-floating tag without a phys-rep isn't anything and can't be used in-game except by abilities that specifically allow you to attach that type of tag to a prop. The source of the tag will describe what an appropriate prop is. You may swap phys-reps for an item for practical reasons (e.g. the old one breaks, or you get a nicer prop) but not for the purposes of being deceptive. See "Cheesing" in the [Cheating](#) section for more information.

Player

Anyone involved in this game, either as a PC, NPC, or some other role. Players are differentiated from their Characters. You may see the [Roleplaying Principles](#) section for more information.

PC

Short for "Player-Character", PCs are characters whose motives, actions, desires, backstories, etc. are in the hands of their player to determine, with the help of the Character Guides.

Regen

Short for "Regeneration Rate", this indicates how efficiently your character can use their Energy to heal their own wounds after spending 60 seconds concentrating. A Regen rate of 1 means that 1 Energy spent on healing becomes 1 regained Health; Regen 2 means that 1 Energy spent becomes 2 Health, and so on. Humans by default have Regen 0, meaning they can't regain Health this way. You may read the [Regaining Health](#) section for more information.

RP

Short for “Roleplay”, this encompasses any and all actions you take while acting as your character.

Scene

This indicates an intuitive unit of time, lasting roughly 10 minutes (or longer if appropriate). If an instruction in this rulebook says to wait until the end of a scene, it means to wait for a natural breaking point in the action before doing something that could disrupt the roleplay happening around you.

Scorched

This is a trait that means your character takes both [Aggravated](#) damage and [Exposure](#) damage from contact with a certain substance.

Sig Call

Short for “Signature Call”, this is the OOG verbal signal you use to let other players know you’re doing something, whether it’s using a power, moving between realms, or dealing damage with a sword.

ST

Short for “Storyteller”, this team is a volunteer staff who control the NPCs and represent the wider game world. You may read [Appendix D - ST and Me](#) for more information.

Sunrise

Just like it sounds, sunrise indicates the time it gets light out again in the morning. For most people, it’s when they wake up, but if you’re actually up around sunrise the official time is always 6:00am. Sunrise is the rest time for any effect that is “once per day” unless otherwise noted.

Taint

Also called Soul Sickness, Taint is a supernatural sickness that can be spread and detected in-game and has various mechanical effects. You may read the section on [Being Tainted](#) for more information.

Transformation Mask

This is a mask used to indicate that your character has radically altered their appearance, usually to something monstrous or inhuman. This is contrasted from other masks, like masquerade masks or disguise masks, which are perceived in-game as regular masks. Most transformation masks should alter your silhouette or profile, while other masks should not.

Unliving

A trait that beings have which signifies that they are not alive. They may have been alive in the past or may have never possessed life. Unliving characters cannot be healed by Medicine, and call “No Effect” when the skill is used on them.

Unresistable

If a sig call includes Unresistable, it means that no other power or effect lets you call “Resist” to that effect. You may still call “No Effect” if applicable.

Weapon Attack

This indicates any attempt to hit a target with a boffer weapon for 1 or more Damage. You may only attack once per second.

Willing

A “willing” character can be influenced to make the decision through seduction, bribery, blood bond, etc., and can be lied to about the results of the action, but the action itself must be fully described accurately. Any ability that forces a character to do something, rather than making them choose, such as obedience or possession, does not count as willing.

Chapter 1 : Game Rules

Life & Death

Health

Characters typically start each event with 10 Health (which can be increased with powers like Toughness or the Healthy Merit). Lots of things can reduce a character's Health in-game, including getting struck with weapons, being drained, or spilling one's own blood for nefarious magical purposes. Regular damage reduces the target character's Current Health. For example, a hit from a sword for 3 damage would bring a character's Health from 10/10 to 7/10.

Aggravated (Agg) Damage

Aggravated Damage, also called **Agg Damage**, represents especially grievous injuries that are much harder to heal from.

Whereas regular damage reduces a character's Current Health, Aggravated Damage also reduces a character's Maximum Health – in other words, the actual size of their Health pool. A character can never have Health that exceeds their Max Health.

Aggravated Damage most frequently appears as a modifier on top of regular damage calls from weapons. A character's Max Health is reduced by 1 for each instance of a hit with the "Agg" meta-call attached that damages the character.

For example, if you're hit with a call of "<Agg> 3", you lose 3 regular Health and your Maximum Health decreases by 1. If you started with 10/10 Health, you would now have only 7/9 Health. To restore this health, please see the section on [Regaining Maximum Health](#).

Universal Agg	Does Agg to?
Agg	Everyone
Common Agg	Does Agg to?
Blood	Humans, Wraith (in the Realm)
Dark	Humans, Wraith
Fire	Humans, Shifters, Vampires, Wraith (in the Realm), Fae
Light	Vampires
Silver	Werewolves, Bastet, Ratkin
Uncommon Agg	Does Agg to?
Gold	Corax
Holy	Baali, Demons
Iron	Fae, Ceilican
Wolfsbane	Shifters

This list is not exhaustive, and other damage types may appear in game.

Scorched

Most characters have specific substances that they are particularly vulnerable to; mechanically, they are **Scorched** by that thing. Being hit with damage of a <type> you are Scorched by causes you to take Aggravated damage. For example, most characters take Aggravated damage from <Fire>, so a damage call of "<Fire> 3" would cause them to lose 3 Health and 1 max Health (bringing a Health of 10/10 down to 7/9, like in the example above).

In rare cases, it's possible to acquire magic or items that protect a character from a scorch. This is denoted as <type> Armor, and causes a character to no longer take Aggravated damage from that <type>.

If a character is doubly-vulnerable to a particular substance (i.e. if they have two or more sources of Scorch), they're Double Scorched. In this rare circumstance, the character takes double the amount of regular damage, and still loses 1 max Health per instance of damage.

Exposure Damage

Exposure damage is caused by being in contact with a substance that you are Scorched by. For every 10 seconds you're in contact with the source, you take 1 point of Aggravated damage (if the exposure is less than 10 seconds, you're safe!).



Some situations simply do <Agg> Exposure damage. You don't have to be specifically Scorched by <Agg> – you take Exposure damage as though you're Scorched by whatever it is you're being exposed to.

Multiple sources of Exposure damage don't stack with each other (e.g. carrying 5 Fetters in the Umbra does the same damage to you as carrying just 1 Fetter).

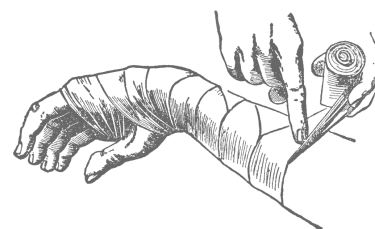
A list of common sources for Exposure damage is below; you're also invited to roleplay additional sources as appropriate to your character.

Scorch	Exposure Damage Source
Agg	Carrying a Fetter in the Umbra
Dark	Contact with a dark fire in tagged Fireplaces
Fire	Contact with fire in tagged Fireplaces
Holy	Standing in a Church or holy building; touching a holy symbol
Light	None; causes Sunsickness instead.
Silver	Contact with items tagged as Silver (Silver coins sting but don't cause Agg)

Regaining Health

Health can be regained in a variety of ways, such as Healing Potions, powers, Regeneration, and other abilities. The

[Medicine](#) skill also restores Health up to certain levels, but is only effective on "living" characters (such as most Humans and Shifters), not on the undead (such as Vampires and Wraiths).



Regeneration

Many characters can restore their Health by spending their own Energy. How efficiently they can do this is based on a character's Regeneration Rate, usually based on their faction and subfaction. For example, a Regeneration Rate of 2 means a character regenerates Health at a ratio of 2:1 – they get 2 Health for every 1 Energy they spend on Regeneration. A Regeneration Rate of 0 means that a character cannot use Energy to Regenerate Health and must restore it through other means..

To Regenerate, spend 60 seconds without Interruption and then convert as much Energy as you like into Health, up to your Max Health.

If you become Incapacitated, your 60 second Regeneration count begins automatically. Regenerating while Incapacitated is an instinctual process and doesn't require any concentration – therefore Regenerating while Incapacitated cannot be Interrupted. However, exactly 60 seconds after you become Incapacitated is your **only** opportunity to Regenerate; if you choose not to or can't Regenerate (e.g. you have no Energy or have been Disabled), you will continue being Incapacitated until you reach Dying or are healed by someone else.

Regaining Max Health

All characters may choose to spend 1 Willpower to regain 1 Max Health, after spending 60 seconds without Interruption. Unlike Regeneration, you must spend a full 60 seconds without being Interrupted for each point of Max Health you wish to regain. You can regain Max Health this way anytime you are conscious (e.g. not Incapacitated, Dying or asleep) as long as you're not concentrating on doing something else. You can regain Max Health any time you can Regenerate, including when Paralyzed. Any Max Health that was not regained in these ways is regained between games.

Character States

Incapacitated

A character is Incapacitated when they are at 0 Health, but still have Max Health greater than 0.

When you reach 0 Health, you may take a moment to utter a few final words or gasp for breath (no soliloquies or yelling for help), and then fall to the ground. If you're not in a safe place to go to the ground (such as the center of a battlefield) you can put a hand on your head briefly and move to somewhere nearby. If going fully prone is physically challenging for you, you can take a knee instead (just be sure to clarify to people around you what they're seeing; calling "I'm down" is usually sufficient).

If you're Umbrabound you return to the Umbra, and if you're Realmbound you return to the Realm.

Incapacitated characters can't move or speak, and aren't aware of anything going on around them. When you are Incapacitated, you cannot resist any powers used on you. Passive and Mask powers you were using remain active, as do any powers you used on other characters, but any power that requires a hand signal, such as Cloak or Avert, ends.

If you are able to Regenerate (see above), you may choose to regenerate your Health on your own after exactly 60 seconds.

If you are Incapacitated for 10 minutes, your Maximum Health drops to 0 and you progress to the Dying state, except for Wraiths who follow special rules - please see the [Harrowing](#) section for more information.

Dying

Characters are sent to the **Dying** state when their Max Health reaches 0. This is typically from taking Aggravated Damage or from having been Incapacitated for more than 10 minutes.

Once in the Dying state, a character can only be affected by Sensory Powers and any powers that explicitly target Dying characters, such as Insight or Revive. Any short-term powers that were active on them end, but effects like Conditions, Blood Bonds, Fae Oaths, Demon Pacts and Taint remain even when a character is Dying.



At this point, very few things can save a Dying character. If 10 minutes pass without some kind of intervention, you become Dead.

Accelerating Incapacitated and Dying Timers

NPCs sometimes are meant to exist as an antagonist which is going to “respawn” or represent new antagonists. To support this, NPCs are allowed to shorten their timers to 1 minute. If the player is informed that a character is going to use a power which can only target someone in the Incapacitated or Dying states, then the timer cannot be shortened. ST will inform NPCs who should use this rule.

Players who are left alone without anyone around may choose to lower their Incapacitated or Dying timers to 1 minute if they would like. If there are other characters interacting with the scene, the timer cannot be accelerated. This cannot be used to gain any advantage such as avoiding powers like Insight. Doing so is a violation of the Code of Conduct.

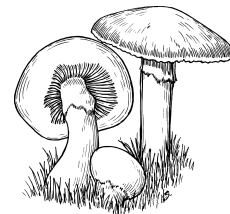
Dead

After being in the Dying state for 10 minutes, a character is **Dead**.

When dead, Vampires turn to ash, Wraiths go to Oblivion, and Spirits simply fade away. Otherwise, you may choose to stick around in-game as long as you want to represent your Dead character's corpse. This is encouraged if there's still roleplay happening around you.

When it's time to go, leave all your in-game items behind, put on an orange headband or put a fist on your head, and go to ST camp (if there's no one around you when you die and you think your items might get damaged being outside, you can bring them to ST instead).

Death may not be the end of your character's story! Some characters may be eligible to return as Wraiths at the next game, or as a Specter immediately. Talk to a Character Guide about this!



OOG Clarifications and Timers

If an Incapacitated or Dying timer is in effect, it does not stop, even during OOG related needs like consulting a rule. The timer can pause if the choice is made to move the scene to a safer place (temperature, deep brush, etc) or if the Rules Team is needed for a ruling.

Combat

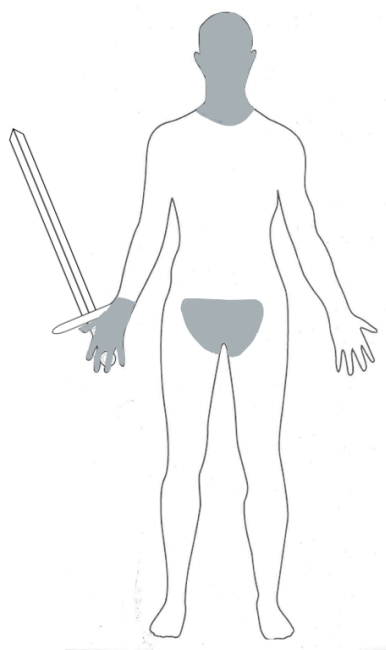
Combat Safety

Shadow Accord uses Boffer weapon props only. “Boffer” is a term that means the weapon is specifically designed to **not** injure someone when swung at them. Boffer weapons are made from foam, latex, or other soft materials with a rigid core.

All weapons and shields must be checked by Safety Team at Check-In before each event (with the exception of packets), to make sure the weapon is in good condition, that it’s sufficiently padded, and that there aren’t any sharp spots that could poke or scratch someone. Safety team determines what weapons are acceptable to use at Shadow Accord; any weapons that don’t pass their check cannot be used at game, even as decoration.

Valid hit areas are the entire body **except the head, groin, and hands holding weapons**. Do not count any hits to these areas.

Valid hit areas (white) and invalid hit areas (gray)



You should never swing hard enough to hurt the player. It is up to the target to decide how hard that is – if someone tells you you’re hitting too hard, you must immediately lighten your blows or disengage. Call a Hold if needed. Please read our [Safety Rules](#), for more information.

Combat can be exciting and chaotic. It is up to you to maintain spatial awareness and avoid collisions or roughhousing. Be extra aware of running around with weapons or shields so they don’t clip other players. **Failure to play safely can result in loss of privilege to participate in boffer combat.**

Combat Roleplay

Making Boffer Attacks

Shadow Accord uses a “lightest touch” combat system that relies on (OOG) cooperation between the opponents. A successful hit meets the following requirements:

- The hit is to a valid target area, which is anywhere on a person’s body, except for their face, groin, or hand holding a weapon. Hits to just garb (e.g. cloaks) count at the discretion of the target.
- The hit touches the target before it makes contact with a melee weapon or a shield. Any attack that hits a melee weapon or a shield first counts as blocked, even if it touches the target afterwards.
- There is at least one second between each attack - attacking any faster is called “machine-gunning” and is not allowed.
- If you’re using Melee weapons, you must pull your arm back at least 45 degrees between swings.
- If you’re using Melee weapons, you must attack with a slashing or swinging motion, rather than a stabbing or poking motion.

When you make an attack, it must be accompanied by an audible sig call. The typical sig call for an attack is simply the number of damage the swing is for. The sig call must occur before or at the same time as the hit – you can't wait to see if the hit is successful, then make the call.

The default amount of damage per hit is 1, which can be raised by having relevant Skills or Augment. However, **you can choose to deal less than your maximum damage**, down to a minimum of 0 damage. Anyone witnessing an attack can tell approximately how powerful it is - calls for "2" and above look like incredibly powerful blows, while calls for "0" look like sparring more than fighting. No matter how many levels of Augment or magical items you have, the most damage you can ever swing with a weapon is 10.

Attacks can also have a damage <type> which must accompany the sig call. For example, if you have a power that lets you deal <Fire> damage and you can deal 2 damage with an attack, you call "Fire 2" when attacking. If you're using a martial weapon and don't make a sig call, it is assumed that damage type is <Iron> or <Wood>, as appropriate. If your attack has any other <type>, you don't have the option to leave it off. Attacks can also have rider effects, which must accompany the sig call. For example, using Disarm with a 1 damage attack sounds like "Disarm 1".

You may choose to attack yourself with a Melee weapon using the normal rules.

There are [special rules](#) for using weapons in the Umbra.

One Second Rule

You can only make one attack per second. This is one attack of *any kind*, whether you're using a weapon or a power. It is still one second per attack if you are holding multiple weapons or have multiple opponents.

During boffer combat, you're welcome to block and feint as much as you like. However, once you've made a sig call indicating a "real" attack, you must wait one second to make another attack.

The purpose of this rule is to make sure sig calls stay distinct and give your target time to process what they hear. Attacking any faster is called [machine-gunning](#), which is considered cheating.

Being Attacked

It is up to each player to determine when they are attacked (with the exception of Counted Touches, which are not considered attacks). You judge for yourself which hits were successful and keep track of your own Health. If combat is too chaotic and you find yourself unable to process being attacked, it is better to guess that you've been hit more often rather than less often. Intentionally ignoring damage from valid attacks is called "Rhino Hiding" - you may read the section on [Cheating](#) for more information.



If an attack hits you but is invalid, e.g. because it hit an invalid target, caused actual pain, or attacks are being delivered more than once per second, treat it as if it had missed and ignore all its effects. It is also a good idea to let the attacker know OOG what they did. Simply crossing your fingers and saying “You’re hitting too hard” is good enough. In the heat of a fight, particularly at night, a player might not realize that they’re swinging too wildly, too hard, or too fast. If they continue hitting too hard or playing in an unsafe manner, call “Hold!” to stop the fight and let a member of staff know. You may read our [Safety Rules](#) for more information.

Do not intentionally use an illegal target, such as your hand or head, to block an attack. Doing so is dangerous and cheating.

Confused about Combat?

Players frequently organize fight practices, especially in the weeks leading up to an event; the times and locations are posted in the Discord. Attending a fight practice is a great opportunity to learn how combat works in a low-stakes environment. You can also speak with a member of Safety Team before game for a demonstration of how it all works.

Weapon Types

Melee Weapons

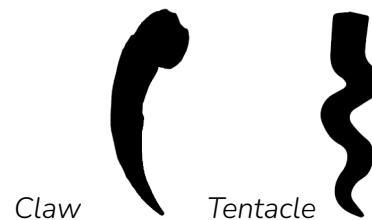
Melee weapons are Boffers that deal damage by striking a target while being held by the attacker.

Martial Weapons are Melee weapons designed to look like real-life melee weapons: swords, staffs, axes, daggers, etc. They always require tags. There are three types of Martial weapons: One-Handed, Versatile, and Two-Handed weapons. The type of a Martial weapon is determined by its size. Please see the [Melee weapons](#) table for more information.

Anyone can wield a single Martial weapon to deal 1 damage per hit. You must hold a Two-Handed

weapon in both hands to deal any damage with it, though you can still block with it held in only one hand. Having the [Melee](#) skill can increase the amount of damage you do per hit, and lets you wield two martial weapons at once.

In addition to conventional weapons, some characters can also use **Natural Weapons** – melee weapons that are part of their bodies, such as sharp claws, long tentacles, or just their fists. These are represented by black boffers marked with the symbols below in white or silver (brawl boffers do not need symbols). Natural weapons aren’t considered items. They’re OOG unless they’re being wielded, and they can’t be disarmed, stolen, or shattered.



Brawl boffers, also called fist boffers, are the shortest type of Natural weapons and simulate any unarmed attack like a punch or slap. Anyone can use a single Brawl boffer to deal 1 damage per hit. If you have the **Brawl skill**, you can wield a Brawl boffer in each hand, and can increase the amount of damage you do per hit. Unlike all other Melee weapons, Brawl boffers cannot normally be used to block attacks; a weapon attack that hits a Brawl boffer counts as hitting the person wielding it.

The other types of Natural weapons are claw and tentacle boffers. They can only be used by characters with special access to them, such as from a power, item, or ritual. Anyone with access can use one or two of these boffers to deal 1 + their Augment damage with each hit.

When buying or making weapons, make sure they fit the following specifications for the type of weapon they are.

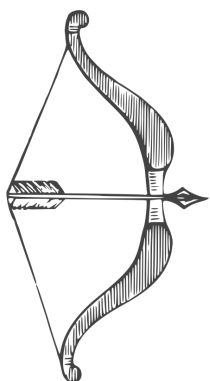
Required specifications for Melee weapons (all lengths in inches)

	Weapon type	Appearance requirements	Minimum overall length	Maximum overall length	Minimum Striking Surface*	Minimum Handle + Pommel**
Martial Weapons	Dagger	Must look like knife or small sword	12	18	6	6
	One-Handed		18	36	12	6
	Versatile		36	48	18	9
	Two-Handed		48	72	24	12
Natural Weapons	Brawl (Fist)	Must be black	12	18	6	6
	Claw	Must be black and marked with the "claw" symbol	18	32	12	6
	Tentacle	Must be black and marked with the "tentacle" symbol	32	48	24	6

***Minimum striking surface** refers to the minimum length that must be safely padded for LARP-safe combat, regardless of the aesthetics of your weapon prop (e.g. a One-Handed hammer might have a 4 inch foam head at the end, but it still needs at least 12 inches of safe striking surface overall).

****Minimum handle and pommel length** refers to the minimum length of the weapon that is NOT used to strike, though it can still be padded. Doesn't apply to staves.

Bows and Arrows



Using a bow requires the **Archery skill**. Bows require tags, but arrows do not. You may shoot one arrow at a time at your target, no faster than once per second. Arrows do base 3 damage, plus your Augment.

Ranged weapons have a maximum limit of 35 pounds; only store-bought LARP-safe arrows are accepted for use.

Thrown Weapons

Thrown weapons are coreless and softer than Melee weapons, and can appear as typical weapons such as throwing knives, or as other objects such as rocks or sticks. You cannot use packets to represent thrown weapons. Thrown weapons do not require item tags. Anyone can use a Thrown weapon to deal 1 + their Augment damage with each hit.

Packets

Packet attacks represent inherently magical attacks, such as a fireball, ear-piercing shriek, or spheres of darkness. Packets are bundles of seeds or grains (millet is preferred) wrapped in cloth, which do not require item tags, and are not visible in-game until they are used as part of a power or attack. Unlike all other weapons, Packets do not need to be individually approved by Safety for use. They can only be used by characters with special access to them, such as from a power, item, or ritual.

Packets used for Damage attacks can be blocked by shields, but **Packets used for Status powers go through shields**. You can differentiate between a Damage packet or a Status packet from the sig call: Damage packet sig calls contain a number, whereas Status attacks do not.

Packets **must** leave a player's hand to be valid.

Defenses

Shields

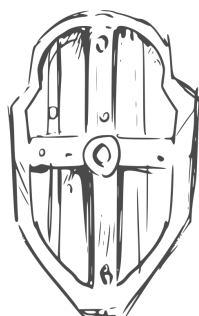
Anyone can use a shield to block damage attacks. However, the **Shields skill** is required to wield a shield at the same time as a Melee weapon.

Shields can be used to block damage from weapons and packets, but they do not block Status effects (which are also delivered by packet).

Shields may not exceed 30 inches wide and 36 inches tall – knees to shoulders on an average person. While you can crouch while using a shield, you cannot completely hide behind a shield so that only your head or other illegal hit areas are exposed.

Shields must be boffer safe, meaning that they're thoroughly padded and won't hurt someone if someone gets smacked with it accidentally. All shields must be inspected by a member of Safety Team before each event.

Shield bashing (deliberately hitting or pushing someone with your shield), rushing at someone with your shield, or using your shield to obstruct someone's view during a fight are strictly not allowed at this LARP.



Armor

Armor lets your character soak a few blows in a fight before their Health is impacted. Armor can only protect a character from damage dealt by weapons and packets (not damage from draining, exposure, or bleeding, etc.). When wearing armor, the weapon damage that hits you always subtracts from your armor first - you don't get to choose when your armor takes the hits vs your character's flesh. Aggravated Damage that is totally absorbed by armor doesn't affect your

character's Maximum Health, but other effects like Taint do go through armor. Armor Points are reduced by damage much like Health; e.g. if you have 4 Armor Points and take 3 Damage, you now only have 1 Armor Point.

Once the armor points are used up, armor must be repaired using the [Armory](#) skill before it provides any protection again. If you find armor laying around somewhere, assume it's broken and needs to be repaired before use.



There are various grades of armor that provide different levels of protection. These armors have to be represented by an appropriate prop made from the materials below, and that covers most of your torso, or

some of your torso plus your arms (Check-In, Crew, or Rules team can tell you if you're covered enough). You can wear two types of armor at one time, but you can only wear one of each type (e.g. chainmail with plate on top gives you 10 armor points, the non-magical maximum).

Type	Armor Points	Phys-rep Requirements
Light Armor	2	Garment-weight leather, leather, quilted fabrics, or furs
Medium Armor	4	Chain, chainmail, brigandine, or layered mixed materials
Heavy Armor	6	Plate, foam/plastic painted to represent metal, metal scale, or hardened/boiled leather

Supernatural Abilities

Characters often gain and wield supernatural abilities, or Powers. Most powers come from a character's faction or subfaction, but sometimes characters acquire power from other sources.

Powers usually have a caster (the one wielding the power) and a target (the one who the power is used on). The target must be visible to the caster in-game. The target must usually be in the same Realm as the caster, unless a power explicitly says otherwise (i.e. it can Breach). The caster cannot be the target of their own power, unless it is a Self type power, or the power text explicitly states so.

To use a power, the caster must pay the cost and make the sig call, if any. The cost of the power is expended as soon as the caster makes the sig call, regardless of whether the power hits or is effective. If the caster is interrupted between beginning to activate the power and activating it, no energy is spent.

Some powers have a roleplay requirement (such as staring, meditating, or sniffing) that must be performed before the power can be used. Roleplay requirements for all powers should be obvious on an in-game level, but you're free to put your own spin on the flavor of this role play. If the power has a range requirement, the roleplay must also be performed within range of the target.

When a power requires activation by touch, lightly touch your target on the arm or shoulder only (any other physical touch requires OOG consent, please see our [Safety Rules](#) for more information).

A target must be aware of an attack OOG and be given a chance to respond in order for it to affect them. Unless otherwise written into the power, a target who is asleep (in real life) only takes effects from attacks they are aware of, and should be woken up before targeting them.

Many of the abilities and powers available are marked with one of the following types: Mental, Status, Touch, Sensory, Self, Passive, Mask, Damage, and Conditions. These designations contain information about the requirements to activate the power and what kind of effect the power has. When a power is Resisted, its effects end.

The full list of powers and their costs, sig calls and effects can be found in the [Powers](#) section.

Using and Resisting Supernatural Powers

Summary Table

You can click on the Example powers to be taken to their write-up

Type	Delivery / Activation	Duration	Can the Target Resist?	Examples
Condition*	Various, often from Touch powers, rituals or potions	Until end of event or specifically cured	No , must be removed through a power, ritual, or other effect	Craving , Despair , Dreamshape
Counted Touch	Must touch target and count the sig call slowly without Interruption	As long as the touch lasts	No , though may be stopped by Interrupting the caster or breaking contact	Paralyzing Bite , Paralyzing Touch
Damage	Must hit target with weapon or packet	Instantaneous one time effect	Yes , with the Avoidance power or other ability	Ranged 2 <Type> , Stonehand Punch
Mask	Put on mask or otherwise change appearance	Indefinite	N/A	Imitate , Mask of a Thousand Faces , Powerful Form
Mental	Must be within 10 feet of the target	10 minutes, or until the caster touches the target and says "release [name of Mental]", or until hit with another Mental	Yes , with Willpower	Entrancement , Hypnotism , Sanctuary , Serenity
Other	Various, often resources collected at Check-In or requiring touch	One time effects once roleplay requirements are met	No , though potentially can be Interrupted; see power for details	Fabricate Armor , Pence from Heaven , Shatter , Telepathy
Passive	N/A - always active on user	Perpetual	N/A	Cognizance , Hidden Taint , Toughness
Self	Various	Typically one time effect	N/A	Realm Grasp , Resilience
Sensory	As described in the power source; usually must stare at or touch target for 10 seconds	Instantaneous	No	Detect Taint , Sense Health
Status	Must hit target with packet	60 seconds, or until hit with another Status	Yes , with the Resilience power or other ability	Disable , Root , Paralyze
Touch*	Must touch target (on hand, arm or shoulder) with your hand	Instantaneous one-time effect	Yes , with Willpower	Daze , Forgetful Mind , Healing Touch , Induce Catharsis

*"Touch <Conditions>" are a type of Touch power where the result is that the target takes a Condition if they don't resist the Touch.

Mental Powers

Mental powers represent a character directly trying to influence another's mind. An adept caster can subtly manipulate their target's emotions or desires, wildly impact their perception of reality, or even cause them to lose their sense of self.

Mental powers can be cast when the caster is within **10 feet** of a **target they can see** in-game. Unless explicitly stated in the power's text, the target must be in the **same Realm** as the caster. The caster should make sure OOG that the target knows the attack is directed at them.

Mental Roleplay Tips

For the most part, Mental powers are **not** true mind control. A particular Mental power may affect what your character thinks, feels or perceives in a certain situation, but the power itself doesn't determine what your character *does*. It's up to you as the player to determine what your character does next – what impact will your character's altered mental state have on their actions? Even a power like "Control Body - walk" has room for your interpretation.

To resist a Mental, spend 1 Willpower and call "Resist". When you resist, you become aware that someone attempted to influence your mind, but you don't know specifically who, or what they were trying to do to you. The exception is the power **Meditate**, which allows you to know in-game the identity of the caster.

You must have an in-character reason to resist a Mental. The reason might be obvious immediately – someone trying to use Entrancement on you while also brandishing a sword – causing you to Resist right when the power is used. Or, the reason for resisting the Mental might arise at some point during the power's duration. For example, you're perfectly content to carouse with a friendly stranger in the tavern, but when they convince you to walk out into the dark forest alone with them, you balk and Resist.

When in doubt, you should roleplay the effect of the Mental until you understand why your character would resist.

Reasons for Resisting a Mental (or Not)

These examples are not meant to be exhaustive, but ideas to help players think ahead of time about what would make their character resist or not so they are prepared to act in the moment.

Why you might NOT resist a Mental:

- Your character is generally trusting or open-minded
- Your character is exhausted, which means their guard is lowered
- The caster is doing RP that supports the power, making it harder for your character to recognize what's happening
- The atmosphere or mood of the scene matches the power's effects
- Your character feels overwhelmed in a tense situation and can't defend themselves
- Your character is drunk and has lost their inhibitions

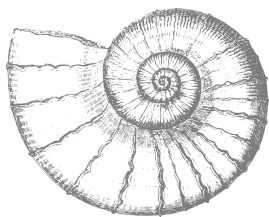
Why you might resist a Mental:

- You are under the effect of the power **Meditate**
- You're with a character you already distrust
- Your character feels overwhelmed; they have become mentally shut down or closed off
- You are in a tense situation or feel threatened; your character's focus is on protecting themselves
- Your character realizes they're doing something strange or against their personal values, or is pushed to a breaking point
- There's a sudden change or shift in the scene that makes you "snap out of it"

If in doubt, consider the Shadow Accord Mission and Values statement. Ask yourself - what can I do to collaborate and tell a compelling story in this scene? What would make this interaction most fun for the players around me? Would my actions be metagaming?

Only one Mental power can be active on a character at a time - if a character is successfully hit by another Mental power while the previous one is still active, the second one overwrites the first one.

The caster can end a Mental early by touching the target and calling "Release [name of Mental]".



Otherwise, Mentals end after **10 minutes**. As your character recovers, they may gradually become aware that something affected their actions, but they have no in-character knowledge of who or what it was.

Touch Powers

Touch powers produce a single instantaneous effect on the target of the power, such as inducing them to Frenzy, enter Catharsis, gain a Condition, etc.

Touch powers are delivered by a single touch to the target (on the arm or shoulder - always ask permission before touching a player anywhere else).

You **cannot** use Touch powers on yourself unless explicitly allowed in the power's text.

Targets can resist Touch powers immediately after the sig call by spending a Willpower and saying "Resist." They cannot be resisted after the fact.

If you resist a Touch, you know that someone has tried to use a power on you. You do not know what power it was, or who used it on you (although the fact that they're touching you may give them away).

Status Powers

Status powers are physical maladies of the body. Casters can use Status powers to bind a victim in place, make them experience debilitating pain or

nausea, or even cut off their access to their magical abilities for a time.

Status powers are delivered by a thrown packet. The packet must leave the caster's hand to be valid. This use of a power (the thrown packet) is visible in-game, and the nature of the attack is clear to everyone who sees it as long as they're familiar with the power (e.g. you can recognize someone is using Paralyze if you've seen it before; <Fire 4> looks like a massive fireball).

You are hit if the packet touches you or anything you're carrying - weapons and shields can't be used to deflect Status powers.

Status powers cannot normally be resisted. Only certain powers or abilities allow a target to resist a Status power.

Status powers last for 60 seconds. Only one Status power can be active on a character at a time - if a character is successfully hit by another Status while the previous one is still active, the second one overwrites the first one and the 60 seconds restart. The Statuses Root and Paralyze also break when the target takes damage.

Sensory Powers

The user of Sensory powers has an uncanny knack for detecting hidden information about those they come in contact with.



You can determine the roleplay requirement to use a Sensory power from the name of the power. A Sensory power with "Sense" in the name requires the caster to stand within 10 feet of the target and stare at them for 10 seconds. Sensory powers with "Detect" in the name require the caster to touch (or in some cases, smell) the target. Sensory powers with "Test" in the name of the power require tasting the target's blood in-game.

Sensory powers that require staring at the target (i.e. the ones with “Sense” in their names) may be used across the Gauntlet for no additional cost as long as you can see the target in-game. “Detect” Sensory powers require you to be touching the target, which can’t be done across the Gauntlet.

Once you’ve satisfied the requirement to use a Sensory power, you can use any others of the same type (e.g. once you’ve stared at a target for 10 seconds, you can use “Sense Emotion” followed immediately by “Sense Vitae”).

Answers to Sensory powers can only be taken in-game by the character who used the Sensory power, even if other characters in range have the same power (this is because there are certain rare effects that might allow a target to modify their answer based on who uses the power).

Sensory Powers and Unconscious Characters

Some Sensory powers, like Sense Emotion or Sense Desire, don’t make sense when used on unconscious characters (asleep, Incapacitated, Dying or Dead). In these cases, it’s fair to respond “no effect”.

Self Powers

Self powers only affect you. You may have as many self powers active at the same time as you wish.

Passive Powers

Passive powers only affect you and are always active, even when you’re Incapacitated or Dying. The effect of Passive powers cannot normally be removed by other powers.

Mask Powers

A Mask power is any power that requires wearing a Transformation mask to indicate that your character’s appearance has radically changed. The type of mask you must wear is described in the power text or by the tree that grants the power.

Some mask powers, such as Powerful Form, work in concert with other Mask powers and apply whenever you activate any other mask power; otherwise, only one mask may be worn at a time.

You need to provide your own mask to use Mask powers. Avoid masks that could be confused with masks from other powers.

Damage Powers

Damage attacks are all those that result in the loss of Health to the target. These types of attacks are typically issued by boffers and packets, and perceivable in-game (for instance "Fire 2" might look like a flaming sword or a ball of fire, depending whether it's delivered by a boffer hit or a packet throw). Damage packets **can** be blocked with shields.

Condition Powers

Conditions are long-term effects such as poisons or illnesses that remain until treated or the end of the event. They can be caused by powers, potions, rituals, or other effects. A character affected by a Condition will need to follow the rules for that Condition (usually stated on a tag or ritual), as well as roleplay in the suggested manner.

You can be affected by multiple different Conditions at the same time, but different Conditions do **not** stack (e.g. a character can be afflicted by both a Craving and a Dreamshape, but a second Dreamshape command will end the first.). If they conflict, you should RP the conflict as you see fit.

Characters cannot normally rid themselves of Conditions on their own - typically another character must assist with a power or a ritual. A player may decide to have their Condition continue from event to event if they were not healed in game space.

Counted Touch Powers

Counted Touch powers represent a character trying to initiate a time-consuming action that puts your character in a vulnerable position - typically trying to drain your blood or life force.

Counted Touch powers are delivered by a touch to the target that must be maintained during a slow count of the sig call, typically to 3 (e.g. "Biting 1, Biting 2, Biting 3"). Some powers have an effect only when the count ends, while others have an effect for each count.

Counted Touch powers do *not* count as attacks, nor can characters Resist them. However, they usually end when Interrupted, and the count always has a maximum number that, when reached, ends the power.

After a Counted Touch on you concludes, you do not necessarily know what just happened to you - you are encouraged to roleplay feeling disoriented, especially if you just had your blood or life force drained. However, before the call concludes you are aware that someone is trying to do *something* to you, and if you are suspicious have every right to try and wriggle away from their grasp.

"Other" Powers

Some powers have a type of "Other." These powers generally affect objects or have effects outside of the game's normal bounds. Each of these powers will explain clearly how they work in their descriptions.

Mass Powers

Some powers have a Mass effect, indicated by the "Mass" sig call and the caster extending their hands out to the side. Mass powers affect everyone within a 10 foot radius of the caster who is in the same Realm as the caster, including those the caster can't see (e.g. characters using Cloak). They are resisted as per their power type.

Umbra and the Realm

The Realm and the Umbra are two sides of the same coin. While the Realm is the “normal” world, the Umbra is the shadowy place that contains everything which usually goes unperceived by mortal eyes. Ghosts, spirits, fae, and all manner of other creatures dwell in the Umbra.

The part of the Umbra represented at Shadow Accord is a parallel to the Realm. The same buildings, trees, and ground exist in the Umbra as in the Realm, although there are occasionally features which can only be seen in the Umbra. The Umbra also contains a myriad of places that have no analogy in the Realm, but they require traveling out of town to reach. See the Player's Guides for [Wraith](#) and Shifter for more information about the Umbra.

Representing the Umbra

The Umbra is represented in Shadow Accord by characters wearing **white headbands**, and occasionally with **blue light**. Unless you have a specific power or ability, you can't see, hear or interact with characters in the Umbra, and they usually can't interact with you.

If you don't know whether something you're hearing (e.g. a distant scream, a conversation around a corner) is in the Realm or the Umbra you can assume it is in the Realm until shown otherwise. Sometimes the voices of the dead carry over — this town is just weird like that.

If it's ever unclear whether someone is in the Realm or the Umbra, you should do a quick clarification OOG.

Objects In The Umbra

Characters in the Umbra can't interact with objects unless they are in the Umbra already, or are marked with **Relic** tags. When a character in the Umbra picks up an object, it seems to vanish in the

Realm, and reappears when it's dropped or set down.

Food and Drink in the Umbra

For player wellbeing, you're always allowed to pick up food and drinks in the Umbra. This is an exception to the regular rules about objects in the Umbra, because we want you to stay fed and hydrated! Player wellbeing always comes first.

Umbra Conduct

When in the Umbra, please be aware of your surroundings and keep in mind that your character doesn't exist for characters in the Realm. You can see characters in the Realm, but they probably can't see you, so you should move out of the way for them. **Characters in the Umbra must speak softly**, because players who can't see the source of the sound will assume it's in the Realm.

Doors in the Umbra

Characters in the Umbra may pass through unlocked doors (by opening and then immediately closing the door behind them). You still need to meet the same requirements to pass through locked or Warded doors in the Umbra as in the Realm.

Combat in the Umbra

Martial weapons can't be used in the Umbra, unless they are specifically marked as a [Relic](#) or are magic. Keep these weapons sheathed and don't try to use them. Natural weapons, shields, armor, and all other items still work as usual in the Umbra.

The Gauntlet

The Gauntlet is the permeable membrane that separates the Realm and the Umbra. As a general rule, most powers and effects don't cross the

Gauntlet unless it is specifically stated that they do (e.g. “Breach” effects).

The Gauntlet works as a one-way mirror, allowing those in the Umbra to observe the Realm, but not the other way around.

Interacting Across the Gauntlet

Some characters are able to use their powers from the Realm to the Umbra, or vice versa.

Sensory powers that require staring at the target (i.e. the ones with “Sense” in their names) may be used across the Gauntlet at no additional cost as long as you can see the target in-game. “Detect” Sensory powers require you to be touching the target, which can’t be done across the Gauntlet.

The “**Breach**” sig call is used to let you know that a power is being used on you from across the Gauntlet. You must be able to see the target in-game to target them with a “Breach” effect.

Game Items

General Notes

For an item to be something that can be interacted with using game mechanics, it needs to have both a prop (also called a **phys-rep**) and a **tag** that describes what the item is or does. With a few exceptions, tags must be signed by a member of the Check-In or Storytellers team to be valid. A prop may only have a single item tag to represent it, though it may have any number of other tags that specify they may be “attached to” or “placed on” an existing item (such as Foci, Fetters, or Relics).

Props should have tags if it’s okay for other players to mess with them. You can bring as many random goblets, bones, cabbages, decor, trinkets, and



Travel Across the Gauntlet

Some factions or subfactions have methods of crossing the Gauntlet to access either the Realm or the Umbra. These include Wraiths using the Embodiment tree, Shifter’s Fundamental Power of Stepping Sideways, Vampires when they consume the blood of the Umbrabound, and the power Shunt. These methods are described in full detail elsewhere in the rulebook.

Characters who can enter the Umbra or can force others into the Umbra should carry a white headband.

Umbrabound and Realmbound

Characters are either **Umbrabound** or **Realmbound**, referring to which side of the Gauntlet they exist in innately. A character returns to their side when they become Incapacitated or fall asleep (either for real or from a power like Daze). Most characters are Realmbound - Umbrabound characters will be specially noted.

tchotchkes as you’d like with you to game, but unless you tag it as an item, other players aren’t allowed to interact with these items - no stealing, borrowing, shattering, cursing, or trapping a demon inside them. Of course if you’d like this to happen to the props you bring, you’re always welcome to affix a generic item tag. Generic item tags are your way to communicate to other players that they can interact with your stuff. You may take as many generic item tags as you wish at Check-In, and they do not need to be signed.

Tags need to be reasonably visible, so that other players know what they’re allowed to interact with.

Item
Prop: _____
This item can be stolen and shattered. The Prop must be appropriate to the provided name and does not carry additional rules-based properties beyond being a tagged item.
Tainted ☐

That doesn't mean tags need to be in direct sight at all times, but they can't be deliberately hidden. A good rule of thumb is making sure a person interacting with the object normally is able to see the tag. So the inside surface of the armor you're always wearing – that's a no. But the inside cover of a book – probably fine.

Unattached Tags

Tags which have not been attached to an object do not exist within the game. A character may look at tags they have available but should be interpreted as innocuous methods of counting or remembering resources at their disposal. They do not count as in-game documents. Unattached Tags cannot be stolen unless they are with a ritual which is stolen (see Tags Created by Rituals).

If a character wishes to give an unattached tag to another character, the actual exchange must occur in an OOG space to preserve WYSIWYG. This represents going to a place such as a workshop outside of the game space where the actual goods exist and exchanging them. The person with the tag may attach it to a prop OOG between games without needing the crafter present. This represents the object being created or picked up between events.

If an NPC is being given the tags, the character handing them off will need to go with that NPC to ST camp to pass the tags off. This may require the player to NPC or assist at ST Camp per their rules.

If a player acquires a tag from ST at ST Camp, if ST cannot provide a prop (example: it is a potion but there are no more bottle props) they can give the tag to the player who can attach it to a prop when able without the required skill. This only applies to tags gained at ST Camp. The tag cannot be used until it is attached to a prop.

Reading Tags

Anyone can read a tag on an OOG level, but your character can only know that information IG if they have the power or skill to do so. Items appear as

what they are at surface level: *that's a sword, that's a bottle of liquid, that looks like blood*. The power Sense Item and other abilities allow characters to read what is on tags and take the information as character knowledge. Additionally, if your character has the ability to make a certain type of tag (e.g. through a skill, power or ritual), then they can also read tags of that type and take the information as character knowledge.

Destroying Items

Tagged items can be destroyed in-game using the power Shatter, or by placing it into a tagged Fireplace for 10 minutes. Rip off and destroy the tag to mark something as destroyed.

Don't actually damage the prop when you destroy items!

Ritual scrolls can be ripped up to destroy them, but other in-game documents should be "ripped up" in mime and then returned to the OOG owners.

Note that in-game documents and ritual scrolls can be destroyed *without* the shatter power, even if they have a tag.

Out-of-Game Storage Locations

The following are OOG storage locations: Off-site locations (areas outside the in-game play area, including player homes, vehicles in the parking area, ST Camp, Kitchens, Bathrooms), OOG sleeping accommodations, and any space clearly marked "OOG" with the color orange (e.g. orange tape, orange paper signs, orange ribbons). Areas without this marking are in-game by default.

All spaces, including sleeping spaces, are considered in-game unless clearly marked OOG using the color orange. Players are required to mark their own OOG spaces. All spaces under beds and bottom bunks are always considered OOG.

Tagged Items in OOG storage cannot be stolen, searched, or affected by in-game mechanics.

When Tagged Items can be Out-of-Game

Tagged Items can only be in OOG storage when your character is not in-game. Some examples of this are: being melded, sleeping in OOG accommodations, leaving site, NPCing, and any time OOG safety or hygiene is involved.

When your character returns to game, their tagged items must return with them. You cannot intentionally leave items in OOG storage while your character is in-game to retrieve them later.

Tagged Items in OOG storage provide no mechanical benefits. Magic items that are still attuned still confer their flaws even if the item leaves game space.

Character Death and Items in OOG storage

When a character dies with items in OOG storage, those items are destroyed. The same is true of all unattached tags they own, except those tied to in-game rituals. The player may inform ST about shared ownership or other arrangements, but ST is not required to honor these requests. Physical props belonging to the player are returned to the player.

The following are exceptions to the above rules:

- Fetters are taken by ST who will notify the Wraith player when convenient and allow the player to return it to game in the way most appropriate.
- ST can ask to be given items they originally created for story reasons.

Character Retirement and Item Destruction

Before a character retires, the player may distribute items in-game any way they see fit. Items not distributed before retirement are destroyed.

The following are exceptions to the above rules:

- Fetters should be returned to the Wraith player when convenient and allow the player to return it to game in the way most appropriate.
- ST can ask to be given items they originally created for story reasons.

Player Storage Responsibility

Players manage their own OOG storage marked with orange “OOG”. ST does not provide storage except for ST Camp bins during NPC shifts.

Tainted Items

Depending on where they came from or what they’ve been used for, some objects pick up an aura of corruption and evil. These objects then spread Taint to those who carry or use them later.

Items are marked as Tainted on their tags. Players can make generic items which are Tainted, but should have a good explanation for how that item got that way.

If your character has carried a Tainted item with them between events (especially if it’s stored on their person), they begin the next event Tainted. However, they can still be Cleansed as normal.

If you attune to an item that is Tainted, you become Tainted (see Attunement, below). You cannot be Cleansed of Taint while the object is on you, but you are not considered Permatainted. If the object is removed from you and you're cleansed, you must re-attune to it before you can use it again.

How do I get items?

Other than the items you get at character creation, where do all these things come from? Some items are created through Skills, so you can either make them yourself or reliably buy them from other PCs. Some items are made through rituals. NPC merchants pass through town periodically to buy or trade for more uncommon goods. Very rare or powerful items usually need the help of NPCs to acquire (See the [ST and Me](#) Guide for information about getting Magic Items). Of course, theft is always an option... (please see the [stealing](#) rules for more information).

Recipes

Recipes are item tags representing formulae for crafting objects that require specialized materials or techniques. See the Innovator merit in the Merits chapter for information on how to acquire Recipe tags.

Reading a Recipe

- With **Academics 1**, you may read the Item Title and Pre-Requisites of any Recipe.
- With **Academics 1** and all listed **pre-requisites**, you may read the full Recipe, including Cost and Effect.

Anyone may read a Recipe on an OOG level to clarify what it does, if needed.

Using a Recipe

To use a Recipe, bring the Recipe and the appropriate prop to ST. Show the Recipe and demonstrate that you meet the Pre-Requisites. You may be asked to NPC or support ST, as per the normal design use rules. Once complete, gain and attach the item tag to the prop.

Item	Skill	Pre- Requisites	Cost	Effect
Iron Weapon	Armory	Armory 2	5 Silver	Create a Melee Weapon that does <Iron> Damage for 5 silver. The melee weapon deals 2 less damage (to a minimum of 1) than a normal weapon.
Gold Weapon	Armory	Armory 3, Adept	30 Silver	Create a Melee Weapon that does <Gold> Damage for 30 silver. The melee weapon deals 2 less damage (to a minimum of 1) than a normal weapon.
Silver Weapon	Armory	Armory 3, Adept	15 Silver	Create a Melee Weapon that does <Silver> Damage for 15 silver. The melee weapon deals 2 less damage (to a minimum of 1) than a normal weapon.

Rituals

The [Rituals Skill](#) grants access to powerful scripted magic unavailable through spontaneous powers. Rituals are represented in-game by Ritual Scrolls — physical documents that can be stolen or destroyed. All Rituals are Relics even though they do not have a tag. You must have the Rituals skill to read or cast Rituals.

Getting Started

When you first gain this skill, you must create a **Sigil** and draw it on your character sheet. This is a visible in-game symbol used in certain rituals, and which other characters may use to identify your handiwork.

Ritual Abilities

Ritual Casting: You may use rituals you meet all other requirements for. The maximum Potency of rituals you can cast is defined by your Rituals level. See the Potency description for the needed ranks.

Ritual Identification: You may recognize and identify ritualistic symbols with which you are familiar, and can read rituals in-game as per the [Reading Rituals](#) rules.

Ritual Ratings

Rituals are rated by **Potency** (Simple, Complex, Expert) and **Knowledge** (Public, Guarded, Secret).

Potency

Each potency is listed with an in-game term to verbally describe the power of the Ritual. Then in parentheses, the needed rank in the Rituals skill is listed numerically. They are always the below pairings of description to rank.

Simple (1): Easy to perform (brand-new PCs); casting produces simple effects

Complex (2): Moderately difficult to perform; casting produces powerful one-time effects or simple longer-lasting effects

Expert (3): Quite difficult to perform; casting can produce powerful long-term or permanent effects

Legendary (NPC Only): Impossible for PCs to perform; used to create plots

Knowledge

Public

Public rituals are well known. They are not specific to any subfaction and as such are accessible to all in the faction.

Faction Lore lets take the knowledge of the mechanics as in character knowledge.

Guarded

Guarded rituals are well known but access is often controlled by the relevant subfaction. The ritual is likely considered dangerous, important, or a hallmark of an organization. Subfactions would be disappointed if it were to get in the hands of non-subfaction. One can expect:

- Members of the subfaction(s) who control this ritual will view you with suspicion if you are not of the same subfaction
- If you have this, you may be pestered by NPCs of other subfactions who control this ritual if they find out

Faction Lore lets you know it exists and take its summary as in character knowledge. Meanwhile the relevant Subfaction Lore lets you take the knowledge of the mechanics as in character knowledge.

Secret

Knowledge of Secret rituals are not normally shared widely beyond subfaction members. One should not be caught spreading information about said ritual. Those who do learn of it are expected

to say nothing about it. The subfaction may take drastic and extreme action against those who spread it. If it got into the hands of a non-subfaction member, the holder should expect to be targeted. One can expect:

- Members of the subfaction(s) who control this ritual will view you as a transgressor if you are not of the same subfaction
- If you have this, you may be targeted by NPCs of other subfactions who control this ritual if they find out

The relevant Subfaction Lore lets you take the knowledge of the ritual existence and its summary as in character knowledge. Meanwhile being a member of the subfaction lets you take the knowledge of the mechanics as in character knowledge.

Cryptic

These are rarely known even among subfactions. If one owns a copy it is seen as being "in the know". If a non-faction or subfaction member is caught with the ritual, one should expect drastic action and reprisal. Acquisition of Cryptic rituals are impossible without ST interaction. One can expect:

- If you have this, expect to be targeted
- Only hearing about the ritual in-game lets you know it exists
- Only seeing the ritual in-game lets you know the mechanics

Lore and Rituals

Being a member of a subfaction gives one access to the knowledge and proper magic for creation of Public, Guarded, and Secret rituals, though players should consider whether their character would be considered trusted by their subfaction when acquiring Secret rituals at Check-In.

Lore is used to represent knowing about rituals and being able to acquire them in a social context. With the proper subfaction Lore, one can obtain

Public and Guarded rituals they can cast outside of their Subfaction. This represents using the connections one has made in their backstory to trade, steal, or otherwise recreate that subfaction's rituals.

While characters cannot gain Lore after character creation, they can only learn the secrets of other subfactions in-game from in-game sources: other characters. Thus, a character can pull on those in-game connections to obtain their rituals in-game. Using Lore to get a ritual at Check-In represents pulling on backstory connections that cannot be represented in-game.

Ritual Information

Title: The in-game name of the ritual

Type: Mystical Rite (Essence) / Blood Rite (Vitae) / Glyph Rite (Gnosis) / Arcanos Rite (Pathos) / Other (any Energy Type)

Potency: Simple (1) / Complex (2) / Expert (3) / Legendary

Knowledge: Public / Guarded / Secret / Cryptic

Lore: The Subfaction Lore needed

Casting Requirements: Any prerequisites the caster must have to perform this ritual - any power trees and dots listed must be exactly on your sheet

Faction Locked: If Yes, then no rule can allow this ritual to be cast by those who are not part of the relevant faction.

Check-In Instructions: Tells Check-In what is needed and how many tags to issue if relevant

Storyteller Instructions: Tells Storytellers what they need to do

Summary: A short summary of what the ritual does

Cost: The cost that must be paid by the caster, target, or participants

Components: Any items that must be present IG or OOG in order to perform the ritual

Drawback: The negative effect that the caster or participants incur for casting the ritual, if relevant.

Instructions: Step-by-step instructions to perform the ritual

Effects: What happens if the ritual is successfully performed

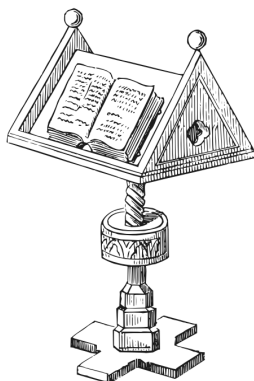
Duration: How long the ritual effect lasts

Notes: Additional consideration

Tag Generated: The name of the tag which the ritual generates if it is relevant

Reading Rituals

- If you have Rituals 1, you can identify the Type of the ritual.
- Then, if your faction or subfaction can cast such rituals, you may read the title and casting requirements.
- Then, if you meet all its casting requirements, you may read the entire ritual.



(...But anyone can read the whole thing OOG to clarify what's going on, if needed). A character does not need the Academics skill to read rituals.

Acquiring Rituals at Check-In

At each Check-In, you may receive **one** ritual scroll using any single **Scribe** option available to your

Rituals level. You cannot combine options across levels, and a ritual received this way cannot immediately be converted into another via Research or Thesis.

Access to rituals at Check-In always requires that you can cast the ritual you are receiving. **Public** rituals require faction Lore, though some may require subfaction Lore — this will be noted on the ritual itself. **Guarded** rituals require the appropriate subfaction Lore. **Secret** rituals require subfaction membership — Lore alone is not sufficient. Legendary and Cryptic rituals are distributed by Storytellers only.

Research and **Thesis** require you to physically turn in the ritual scrolls at Check-In. The rituals turned in must be ones you can read in-game, but do not need to be ones you can cast. Refer to the table below for rituals access at Check-in.

You can find a full list of Rituals [here](#).

	Public FACTION LORE REQUIRED*	Guarded SUBFACTION LORE REQUIRED	Secret SUBFACTION REQUIRED
Simple	Level 1+ • Scribe at Check-in	Level 2+ • Journey Level Scribe at Check-in	Level 3 • Expert Level Scribe at Check-in
Complex	Level 2+ • Research: Turn in 3 Simple or higher Potency rituals	Level 2+ • Research: Turn in 3 Simple or higher Potency rituals	Level 3 • Research: Turn in 3 Simple or higher Potency rituals
Expert	Level 3 • Thesis: Turn in 3 Complex or higher Potency rituals	Level 3 • Thesis: Turn in 3 Complex or higher Potency rituals	Level 3 • Thesis: Turn in 3 Complex or higher Potency rituals

*some Public rituals require subfaction lore

Note: The "+" after a level number includes all higher levels in the Rituals Skill

Casting Rituals

To cast a Ritual, follow the instructions printed on the Ritual scroll. You must have the scroll with you in view the entire time you cast it. A Ritual may require specific elements (drawing your Sigil, making a circle, pouring a glass of water, etc.), or a requirement of open-ended "ritual roleplay" for a certain amount of time, which can be chanting, praying, drawing symbols, or anything else you feel is appropriate for your character. You're encouraged to be creative with this part!

Typical Items

Armor

Armor can protect a character from damage dealt by weapons and packets. Armor points are used before Health points, and are reduced by damage much like Health. Once the armor points are used up, armor must be repaired using the [Armory](#) skill before it provides any protection again.

For more information on how to use armor, please read the [Armor](#) section under Combat for more information.

Coins and Currency

There are several official currencies used by different factions in-game. In practice though, almost anything is fair game to barter with. You will see characters exchanging weapons, potions, secrets, favors, their own blood, other people's blood... and so on. Mortal coin is also used for mundane transactions. Vampires, Shifters and Wraith have their own social currencies that are discussed in the [Player's Guides](#).

Because of the potential for OOG confusion, we don't allow counterfeit currency props. This rulebook uses the terms "Silvers" and "Coppers" to denote mortal coin, with 12 Coppers being worth 1 Silver. In-game, characters will use different terms, such as Shillings and Pence, Sols or Dinners, etc.

Rituals can be **interrupted** midway though casting. If this happens, the caster must start over and repay the casting cost if relevant.

Some rituals allow you to claim tags at Check-In that are used later when casting the ritual. The tags can only be claimed once per copy of the ritual, though the total number may vary. These tags can only be attached to a prop after the ritual is performed in-game.

Documents

Any in-game document counts as a game item for the purposes of stealing and destroying them. This could include letters, diaries, notices, deeds, writs, sketches, maps, ancient tomes of dangerous knowledge, etc.

Fetters

Fetters are items (or sometimes people) of great significance to certain Wraiths. Only characters with Sense Item or Fetter Creation can recognize this connection to the Wraith.

Anyone carrying a Fetter in the Umbra takes Aggravated exposure damage until the Fetter is dropped.

If you are holding a Fetter, the Wraith that Fetter belongs to can't attack you, except with boffer attacks from the same realm.

See [Fetters](#) in the Wraith section for more information.

Imbued Curios

Some items provide short-term or a single use of a power. These items must be destroyed or consumed to use. Instructions for these items are

included on their tags. These items are *not* detected by the power Sense Item.

Locks and Keys

Locks may be used to secure a door or an IG container (such as a chest) so that other characters cannot open it unless they have a Key corresponding to the Lock.

Lock and Key tags are matched with corresponding numbers, and a Lock may have any number of Keys corresponding to it. Keys for an existing Lock can be created by someone with the Locksmith skill, provided they bring a matching Lock or Key with them when they claim their item tag at Check-In.

To use a Lock, hang an appropriate prop with the tag on the doorknob of a door you wish to lock, or affix the Lock to the outside of a container. The door or container may no longer be opened without holding a corresponding Key in your hand. If the prop is functional, do not actually lock it - players must be able to physically bypass it if their characters have the appropriate abilities.

A door is only locked from the side of the door with a Lock. You may place a Lock on both sides of a door. A Lock can be removed from a door or container by someone holding a corresponding Key. A Lock can also be broken open using the power Shatter.

Potions and Poisons

There are a variety of bottled concoctions with potent effects on the drinker— restoring their strength, causing them embarrassment, or even grievous harm. These elixirs can be consumed directly from their bottles, or slipped into a victim's food or drink. Potions and poisons are



represented in-game with small vials or containers containing the item tag.

The following table contains a non-exhaustive list of potions and poisons.

For information on how to roleplay poisoning, please read the section on [Poisoning Someone](#).

Potion/ Poison	Effect
Antidote	Removes all Poison Conditions.
Belladonna (Poison)	You cannot use Willpower. Roleplay confusion, hallucinations, dry mouth, and slurred speech.
<i>Bottled Energy</i>	<i>Bottled Energy is an umbrella term for Blood Vials, Bottled Essence, Bottled Pathos, and Spirit Brew – potions that restore 4 Energy of the type listed on the tag.</i>
Foxglove (Poison)	You cannot speak in character but you may mumble. Roleplay dryness and swelling of the mouth as well as headaches.
Golden Chain (Poison)	Your attacks with boffers deal -1 damage to a minimum of 1 damage and you cannot run. Roleplay being physically weak, intensely sleepy and uncoordinated.
Healing Potion	Restores 4 Health.
Hemlock (Poison)	You can't read, preventing you from using the Academics skill and reading item tags or rituals. Roleplay having blurry vision and nausea.
Holy Water	Non-human characters are affected as per the power Body Wrack.
Potion of Mind	Restores 1 Willpower. It can also replace any Potion component in a ritual.
Spite Potion	You hate the next person you see per the power Passion.
Vitae Poison	You must spend an extra Energy each time you activate a power. Roleplay internal aches and pains.

Relics

Characters in the Umbra can't interact with objects unless they are in the Umbra already, or are marked with **Relic** tags. When a character in the Umbra picks up an object, it appears to vanish in the Realm, and reappears when it's dropped or set down.

Items can be made into Relics at character creation, or later through a **ritual**. A set of items, such as a deck of cards, counts as a single item, and therefore only needs to have a single Relic tag.

All rituals are Relics even though they do not have a tag.

Shields

Shields can be used to block damage from weapons and packets, but they do not block Status effects (which are also delivered by packet).

Please read the [Shields](#) section for more information.

Weapons

You will find Melee weapons, Bows & Arrows, Thrown weapons, and Packets at Shadow Accord. Please see [Weapon Types](#) for more information.

Weapons can be **Silvered** by adding a Silvered Weapon tag to them in-game with the appropriate skill or ability. This causes the weapon to deal <Silver> damage, and lasts the entire event.

Unusual Items

Certain objects are so far outside the ordinary that their power radiates off them as a detectable aura. These items are marked with special tags explaining the power or effect you get from them.

Attuning to Items

Some items must be Attuned to before they can be used. Items can only be attuned to by characters with the Energy type listed on the tag. These items are detected by the power Sense Item.

All characters start with 10 Attunement Points in their Attunement Pool. This represents a character's capacity to bond to magic items. You may choose to enter game already attuned to any magic items you have, spending Attunement Points as normal. Being attuned at the start of game allows you to use powers that take effect at Check-In (for example, Pence From Heaven).

To attune to an item, meditate with it for 60 seconds. The item's Attunement Value is deducted from your Attunement Pool for the rest of the event. If you do not have enough Attunement Points, the attempt to attune fails. Multiple characters may be attuned to an item at the same time, but only one character holding it may benefit from it. Items that provide benefits at Check-In can only benefit one player per event.

To un-attune to an item, meditate with it for 60 seconds. Attunement Points you have previously spent to attune to the item are not restored to your Attunement Pool. You must spend Attunement Points equal to the item's Attunement Value again if you choose to reattune to it.

While attuned, you can benefit from the item as long as you keep it on you. You are also affected by all flaws on an attuned item even if it is not on your person. You remain attuned to the item for the rest of the event, even if the item is stolen, destroyed, or leaves game space. At the end of the event, you are automatically unattuned to any and all items you were attuned to, and your Attunement Pool goes back up to full.

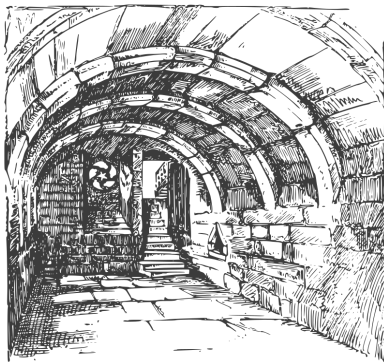
Type	Energy	Factions
Artifact	Pathos	Wraith
Curio	Any	Any
Fetish	Gnosis	Shifter and Gifted Kin
Heirloom	Vitality	Commoner and Faithful
Talisman	No Attunement Needed	Any
Vestige	Vitae	Vampire and Ghoul
Wonder	Essence	Mage and Sorcerer

Talismans

Talismans are Magic Items that do not require Attunement to use. Simply holding the item gives you the effect. They are, however, detected by the

Landmarks

Some areas IG have special rules or properties. They are called Landmarks, and are marked OOG with instructions that explain what they do. They can only be made, moved, or destroyed by specific powers, rituals, or abilities that explicitly do so. Even Landmarks represented by an item follow these rules so long as the Landmark exists, rather than following general item rules.



Some Landmarks are in the Realm, while others are in the Umbra. Landmarks in the Umbra can be seen by anyone in the Umbra or anyone in the Realm with Umbra Sight. Anyone with Read Magic

power Sense Item. Talismans usually have unique effects that aren't granted by any other power.

Enchanted Weapons

Some weapons are empowered to do especially deadly damage for a short period of time. Enchanted Weapons have an additional tag on them which says what kind of damage they do. You must attune to an Enchanted Weapon before you can use it, and they are detected by the power Sense Item. The Enchantment expires at the end of the event written on the tag, and after that event you must remove the tag.

Other Magic Items

There are some other classes of Magic Items that you may encounter in your adventures. Instructions for interacting with these rare objects will be clearly explained on the tags.

can read the information on any Landmark they can see and take it IG.

A Landmark tag will be made for: Fireplaces, Forge, Holy Ground, and Spectral Fireplaces.

Blood Fountains

Blood Fountains are Vitae Nodes for Vampires. They are located in the Realm. They are fixed locations marked by a laminated card visible to all creatures with Vitae or who can see in the Realm. They can only exist at the location of Crays and Gaian Nodes, and are Tainted while the other Node is.

Crays

Crays are Essence Nodes for Sorcerers and Mages. They are located in the Umbra. They are places of intense magical significance. They are fixed locations marked by a laminated card that is visible

to all creatures with Essence or who can see into the Umbra.

Sorcerers can regain the amount of Essence listed on the Cray's card by meditating within 10 feet of the Cray for at least 60 seconds. A character may receive this benefit from a given Cray once a day.

Dwellings

Dwellings represent a character making a deep mystical connection with a space they inhabit, are prerequisites for some rituals, and can provide other benefits.

Dwellings are created by certain rituals. Your Dwelling must be the space your character slept in, overnight, the previous night (Saturday night at the previous event is sufficient for a Friday night placement). Only "private" spaces, such as bedrooms, small cabins, tents, etc. can be Dwellings. Only one Dwelling banner may be hung up in a room at a time. A ritualist may only have one Dwelling tag active at a time.

Dwellings are marked with a tagged banner at least 2-feet by 2.6-feet. Banners are in-game objects that can be stolen and destroyed like any other tagged item.

Fireplaces

Fireplaces are tagged, prop fireplaces (NOT real fireplaces). Fireplaces provide a source of fire damage and item destruction. Any character who is <Fire> Scorched (which is almost everyone) and touches or is held against a Fireplace will start taking <Fire> exposure damage. Any item that is held within a Fireplace for 10 minutes is destroyed in-game, and its item tag must be removed and destroyed. A Dead character's corpse that is in contact with a Fireplace for 10 minutes is destroyed and turned to ash (its player goes OOG). These Fireplaces have no effect on creatures, items, or corpses in the Umbra.

Some tagged Fireplaces might have a blue flame rather than a typical red or orange flame. These

Fireplaces are only visibly burning in the Umbra. Characters in the Umbra who touch or are held against a blue Fireplace take <Dark> exposure damage every 10 seconds. Dead characters in the Umbra can be destroyed as per normal Fireplaces. These Fireplaces have no effect on creatures, items, or corpses in the Realm.

Building a Fireplace

- Prop Requirements: Fireplace tags will be available at check in for anyone to pick up. The prop must resemble in some way a wood fire or fireplace, and be at least 10 inches in at least one dimension. Any light given off by the prop must be Yellow to Red in color. Fireplace tags will be available at check in for anyone to pick up.
- Important: Absolutely no real fire should be used at any point in this RP, nor be a component of the prop in any way.
- Directions:
 1. Roleplay at least 60 seconds "lighting" the fire with the prop. The prop must remain dry for the entire process.
 2. Someone must remain within 10ft of the prop for at least 10 minutes, occasionally tending it while the fire "grows". If you have a power that deals <Fire> Damage, you may use that power to skip steps 1 and 2.
 3. Attach your Fireplace tag to the prop if not already attached.
- Special: If the prop is moved, or is left unattended outside for any amount of time, the fire goes out, and you must start the process over to use the Fireplace. The last person to leave should remove the tag. A Fireplace inside a building does not go out if unattended.
- Effects: The prop now functions as a Fireplace, with all associated mechanics

Building a Spectral Fireplace

- Prop Requirements: Fireplace tags will be available at check in for anyone to pick up. The prop must resemble in some way a wood fire or

fireplace, and be at least 10 inches in at least one dimension. Any light given off by the prop must be Blue in color.

- Important: Absolutely no real fire should be used at any point in this RP, nor be a component of the prop in any way.
- Directions:
 1. Roleplay at least 60 seconds "lighting" the fire with the prop. The prop must remain dry for the entire process, and you must be in the Umbra the entire time.
 2. Someone must remain within 10ft of the prop for at least 10 minutes, occasionally tending it while the fire "grows". If you have a power that deals <Dark> Damage, you may use that power to skip steps 1 and 2.
 3. Attach your Spectral Fireplace tag to the prop if not already attached.
- Special: If the prop is moved, or is left unattended outside for any amount of time, the fire goes out, and you must start the process over to use the Fireplace. The last person to leave should remove the tag. A Fireplace inside a building does not go out if unattended.
- Effects: The prop now functions as a Spectral Fireplace, with all associated mechanics

Gaian Nodes

Gaian Nodes are Gnosis Nodes for Shifters. They are located in the Umbra. They are places of intense spiritual significance for Shifters and their Kinfolk.

They are fixed locations marked by a laminated card visible to all creatures with Gnosis or who can see into the Umbra.

Typically, they are called Glades; Tainted Glades are called Blights. Incredibly powerful, unique Gaian Nodes are called Caerns; Tainted Caerns are called Hives.



Shifters can regain the amount of Gnosis listed on the Glade's card by meditating within 10 feet of the Glade for at least 60 seconds. A character may only receive this benefit from a given Glade once per event. If you gain Energy from a Tainted Node, you become Tainted.

Gifted Kin may gain up to 5 Gnosis each day by meditating at a single Gaian Node regardless of the value printed on the card. This limit of 5 Gnosis can be drawn over multiple meditations or all at once. If you gain Energy from a Tainted Node, you become Tainted.

Shifters who can Step Sideways can move from the Realm to the Umbra or from the Umbra to the Realm instantly if they do so within 10 feet of a Glade, rather than spending the typical 60 seconds of meditation.

Haunts

Haunts are Pathos Nodes for Wraiths. They are located in the Umbra. They are fixed locations marked by a laminated card visible to all creatures with Pathos or who can see into the Umbra.

Holy Ground

Holy ground is a location that is of religious significance to a particular group. It will not be tagged, but should be obvious both in and out-of-game. Certain characters may have limitations that restrict them from entering Holy Ground or cause them to take [Exposure](#) damage from it.

Nodes

Nodes are any type of Landmark that can provide a certain Energy type to characters who share that Energy type. Blood Fountains, Crays, Gaian Nodes, and Haunts are all Nodes. Any character who shares an Energy type with a Node can see the Landmark and can read and take IG any information on it. This is true regardless of which side of the Gauntlet the Node is and whether or not the character has Read Magic.

If a character can see but not read the laminated card representing the IG Node, they can tell there is something special about that location, but not exactly what.

Blood Fountains and Gaian Nodes can become Tainted, at which point drawing Energy from them will cause the drawer to become Tainted. Refer to your faction's Energy rules to determine how you can draw Energy from a Node.

Not all kinds of Nodes are active all the time, and are usually introduced and removed as part of a plot.

The Shallowing

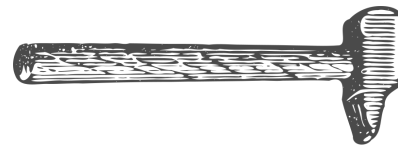
The Shallowing is a storytelling device that explains why characters at Shadow Accord appear to be able to behave differently than characters in the wider World of Darkness. The Shallowing allows Vampires to be active during the day and Wraiths to pick up and eat food. It causes the many layers of the Umbra to collapse into a single Umbra. It draws together diverse types of beings who would otherwise be unlikely to rub elbows. It attracts weirdness to it with astonishing regularity each festival weekend (etc. etc.). In short, it's the justification we use to explain the changes that needed to be made to take this from a table-top system to a LARP.

In story terms, the Shallowing is a concentration of magical forces that interact to create an unusual environment. Other characters in the world are aware of the Shallowing and may come to study it

or experience its effects. The Storytellers determine just how far the Shallowing extends, but it's generally understood to reach just to the outskirts of town and not quite as far as the surrounding villages. See the Player's Guide for more information.

Spectral Smelter

Smelters are represented with an anvil prop that is usable from the Umbra. These count as a Spectral [Fireplace](#), and also are used for certain Wraith Rituals.



Wards

Wards can be cast on doorways to prevent specific types of characters on the tag from passing through. Such characters cannot even partially pass through (e.g. with a claw or weapon) or open the door, but may make ranged attacks if the door is already open. The tags are placed on either side of large banners hung from the door frame with all relevant symbols viewable. Anyone can (and should!) read the Ward tag OOG, but Wards can only be detected IG with specific powers. Wards are not items and can only be removed by specific effects that target Wards.

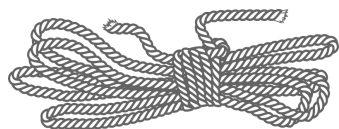
A single character can only have one Ward active at a time. A single doorway can only have one Ward on it at a time.

Roleplaying Specific Actions

For most things you do as your character, you simply *do them* (e.g. sneak behind a bush, carouse in the tavern, convince someone to turn on their ally, etc.). However, because this is a LARP, some actions have special rules because it could be dangerous or inappropriate to actually do them.

Restraining Someone's Hands

Restraining a character's hands represents physically capturing and restraining them. To restrain a character, loosely wrap their wrists with rope, chain, or another suitable prop for at least 10 seconds, then hand them the ends of the bindings (do not actually tie it).



If another character holds you by the shoulder or the restraints while you are restrained, then you must move in any way that they direct. Restrained characters cannot run. Restrained characters also can't do anything that requires their hands (making OOG hand signals for powers is acceptable, but throwing packets or swinging a sword is not).

Be aware that certain skills and abilities let restrained characters break free of their restraints or otherwise escape.

Brawling

Attacking with a fist boffer (12 inches long) represents trying to hit someone with your closed fist. Any character may make attacks for 1 damage using a single fist boffer. To attack with a fist boffer in each hand, or to swing for more than 1 damage, you must purchase the Brawl skill. Fist boffers cannot be used to block; anything that hits your fist boffer has hit *you* and you take the damage. You may read more on Natural Weapons in the [Melee Weapons](#) section.

Carrying a Person

Typically two characters have to work together to carry someone, unless one of them has at least Augment 1, in which case they can carry them solo.

To roleplay carrying, put your hand on the other person's shoulder (or arm if they'd prefer) and call "lifting 1, lifting 2, lifting 3, carrying". Then, you can move together at walking speed wherever the characters doing the carrying want to go. You cannot run.

While carrying or being carried, characters can't wield a weapon or do anything that requires their hands (OOG hand signals for powers are alright).

Cutting, Bleeding, and Drinking Blood

Spilling blood or drinking the blood of another character sometimes has a mechanical effect in-game.

Use a boffer prop with a blade (or mime using your teeth, if appropriate for your character) to roleplay cutting your hand by calling "cutting 1, cutting 2, cutting 3". This counts as an attack for the purpose of Interrupting other effects.

To bleed, use a call of "Bleeding 1, bleeding 2, bleeding 3... etc." with at least a second per count.

You can also use this process to drain another character of their blood. Note that Vampires cannot be forced to bleed. The only way to forcibly remove Vitae from their veins is to drink it.

To feed someone else your blood, hold your hand near their mouth and call "Giving blood 1, giving blood 2, giving blood 3... etc." They can refuse blood given to them this way by turning away if able to. If you are giving blood while Tainted, the person you give blood to also becomes Tainted.

You lose 1 Health per “Bleeding” or “Giving my blood” completed count. At the end of either call, if you lost any Health you also lose 1 Maximum Health. If you caused this Health loss to another character, make sure to remind them of this.

If you are a Vampire, instead you lose 1 Energy per “Giving my blood” completed count and don’t lose any Maximum Health. You are immune to the Bleeding call.

There are special rules about consuming a Vampire’s blood, and for Vampires consuming others’ blood. See the [Vampire](#) section for more info.

Some characters have the ability to drain a target of blood by biting them. See [Draining](#) for those instructions.

Destroying Items

Tagged items can be destroyed in-game using the power Shatter, or by placing it into a tagged Fireplace for 10 minutes. Rip off and destroy the tag to mark something as destroyed.

Don’t actually damage the prop when you destroy items!

Ritual scrolls can be ripped up to destroy them, but other in-game documents should be “ripped up” in mime and then returned to the OOG owners.

Disguising

It’s common to see players playing multiple characters across even a single game (e.g. through NPC shifts), so it can be hard to tell if someone is in Disguise or is playing an entirely different character.

To roleplay a character who is in Disguise, you need to make it obvious in-game that you’re wearing a Disguise. This style of Disguise is a mundane approach. There are two components to a mundane Disguise which must be followed.

First, you must cover your face with a big hood, scarf, or a mask that isn’t a Transformation mask.

Second, you must obscure your garb by wearing a cloak, putting some extra layers on, hiding any signature accessories. Articles of clothing (shirt, dress, pants, etc.) need to still be worn underneath this new layer. When Disguised, you still need to be “discoverable”: if someone unmasks you, they must be able to tell it’s “you”.

If at any point it is unclear from garb if someone is playing a specific character, a player is encouraged to ask OOG “Would I recognize you as <character name>?”

Draining

Some characters (Vampires and Ananasi) have the ability to bite and drain blood from another character against their will. Unlike with simple cutting and bleeding, the target is Immobilized during this process.

To bite and drain another character, you must use the following three powers in the specified sequence: Paralyzing Bite, Test Faction, Draining

These are given to you as Fundamental Powers if your faction/subfaction is able to do this.

You can see the write ups below.

PARALYZING BITE (COUNTED TOUCH)

Cost:	None	Call:	“Biting 1, Biting 2, Biting 3, Paralyzing Bite”
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Place your hand on the target’s shoulder and begin the count, making no more than one call per second. The call can be Interrupted, including by the target moving away from you, attacking you, or using another power on you. This power does **not** count as an attack.

If you successfully complete the count, the target is now Paralyzed per the power. This ends unless you proceed with draining (i.e. Test Faction and Draining).

TEST FACTION (SENSORY)

Cost: None Call: "Test Faction"

This power can only be activated on a target affected by your Paralyzing Bite or that you are touching and have completed a cutting call against.

The target must answer with their Faction as it appears on their character sheet. You may then use Draining on them.

Blood Effects

Faction / Subfaction	Energy Value	Additional Blood Effects
Human	1 Health: 1 Energy	None
Vampire	1 Energy: 1 Energy	Blood bond may apply (see Blood Bond section)
Shifter	1 Health: 2 Energy	Vampire affected by Passion: Anger
Ananasi		Vampire affected by Venom
Wraith	1 Health: 1 Energy	Vampire is shunted to the Umbra (if not already in the Umbra). <i>Vampire players should carry white headbands</i>
Anything Umbra-bound		
Demon	1 Health: 2 Energy	Vampire affected by Tainted Induce Sin <Demonic Vice>

DRAINING (COUNTED TOUCH)

Cost: None Call: "Draining 1, Draining 2, Draining 3, etc." and "Aggravated End Drain"

This power may only be activated after successfully using **Test Faction** on the target you are draining from. During the Draining, the target remains paralyzed per the power Paralyze if you initiated the drain with Paralyzing Bite.

For every call of "Draining", the target loses 1 Health (or 1 Energy if the target is a Vampire) and you gain 1 or 2 Energy as per the **blood effects** table. The target should inform you when the pool you are draining from becomes empty, and may roleplay slumping over, if appropriate. "Draining" doesn't count as an attack for the purpose of ending other effects.

Draining ends if you or the target are Interrupted, your Energy pool becomes full, or if you take your hand off of the target. At the end of the Draining, state "Aggravated End Drain" if you drained any Health from the target. They lose 1 Maximum Health if they are not a Vampire, and this counts as an attack.

Your target becomes Tainted if you are, and you become Tainted if they are (cross your fingers and ask them). You also take effects as per the **blood effects** table.



Escaping

Certain powers and abilities allow characters to break free of restraints or escape locked rooms.

However, if you get imprisoned without guards or stuck in a locked room for an hour, you can “find a loose bar in the jail” or “manage to work your restraints loose” and escape. This escape rule also applies to other situations in which a character is somehow trapped by rules-based circumstances (for example, a Wraith with no Fetters is trapped behind a closed door, or a staked Vampire is left alone). The point is to have fun at this game, so this is a place we’re willing to sacrifice immersion.

If you’re forced by a power to put on a Transformation Mask, grow claws or tentacles, or sport any other kind of prosthetic, you may remove it after 10 minutes (or at a natural break in scenes).

Players can always go OOG briefly to tend to real-world issues as needed, but then should return to being in-game as quickly as possible with minimal disruption. You may read our [Safety Rules](#) for more information.

Frenzying

In a Frenzy your character’s mind retreats from all influence and pain and is replaced by a bestial psyche that only fights or flees.

The beast’s grip on the psyche lasts for a full 60 seconds (or until you become Incapacitated or are the target of an effect that ends the Frenzy). After the beast relinquishes your character’s mind, your character has no recollection of any events that transpired during the Frenzy.

When in a Frenzy, all Mental and Status powers active on you end, and you call “No Effect” to further attempts to use Mentals and Statuses on you. Other powers still affect you as usual. The Mental power Disquiet can still affect you and will end your Frenzy early if not resisted, as will the Touch power Serenity.

While in Frenzy, you can only use Passive and Mask powers. All other powers are beyond your comprehension. The exception is that you can use Natural weapons if you have them, or use Counted Touch powers to drain targets.

At the start of the Frenzy, you must make a split-second decision whether to flee - entering a Fear Frenzy, or to fight - entering an Attack Frenzy.

If you choose for your character to enter a Fear Frenzy, your only goal is to dash for safety in isolation, incapable of higher thought like operating doors. You will cower in a corner or claw at walls if trapped. Abilities that bypass Locks without dedicated RP allow escape from doors as usual.

If armed or capable of striking out with Natural weapons (or Counted Touches) you may instead choose for your character to enter an Attack Frenzy. This is an all-out offense, without any thought of tactics or stealth; just unbridled rage and a need to kill. The beast attacks the nearest person until they are downed, then causes you to immediately attack the closest target, or run to find a target if one is not convenient. Some abilities allow you to choose your first victim present regardless of distance, but once they drop to the ground the distinction of friend and foe is lost again unless a new Frenzy is initiated.

Vampires and Shifters possess innately bestial psyches. As such they may spend a point of their Virtue to enter a Frenzy any time they are threatened, enraged, ashamed, or experiencing any other overwhelming emotion. Other effects can cause any character to enter a Frenzy.

Burdens

To be Burdened is to suffer a magical compulsion which influences your behavior towards the source of the effect. Many variations on the Burden exist with unique mechanics explained elsewhere, for example Blood Bonds and the power Entrancement.

While Burdened to another character (referred to as the source of the burden):

- You cannot resist any power used on you by the source
- You cannot willingly harm the source
- You must complete direct commands from the source to the best of your ability
- You cannot willingly tell anyone that you are Burdened

Burden Roleplay Tips

While being Burdened creates a powerful emotional hold over your character, it is **not** mind control. You are still free to think and act as your character would act, with the additional motivation that you now have another character who you care deeply about. You must follow their word, how you understand their commands may differ from how they understand them.

If you come under an effect that forces you to behave contrary to a Burden, the effect takes priority over the Burden. Please read the [Specific Supersedes General](#) entry for more information. If multiple Burdens or commands conflict with one another, resolve the conflict using this priority order: avoiding causing harm to the source character(s) first, followed by following direct commands, followed by keeping the Burden secret.

When the Burden expires, you are aware that you were unusually compliant with the source character for a time, but you do not recall the specific reason why — unless you have learned this through some other means. You will naturally assume that any actions you took were your own free choice. It would take considerable evidence for you or others to recognize your behavior as anything other than your own free will.

If you are unsure whether your Burden is to a character OOG (e.g. your source character's player is Disguised), you should ask OOG before roleplaying being Burdened.

If either player is uncomfortable with close roleplay with the other person for OOG reasons, they may

request an exemption from Safety Team or XO. If the request is granted the XOs will make sure both parties are aware.

Bindings

A Binding is a specific type of Burden used most often on Spirits, Wraith, and other strange creatures. They are delivered via Rituals, which outline their specifics.

While Bound to another character you are affected by all the rules of the Burden, except:

- You **can** speak about being Bound (unlike a normal Burden)
- You must follow any additional rules specific to this type of Binding.

When a character ceases to be Bound, they may choose to spend 1 Willpower and enter an attack Frenzy directed at the source character.

Bound Roleplay Tips

While Bound you must follow the will of another, and are conscious of your acts. You may feel anger or hatred towards the Binding's creator, or simply see their orders as necessities to complete to end the Binding.

Bindings are dangerous business and run the risk of infuriating the character affected. Sometimes a Ritualist can negotiate with their targets to escape their vengeance.

Hierarchy of Burdens

If someone is under the effect of multiple Burdens, use the following hierarchy when they conflict:

Precedence Order for Burdens

	Powers
	Bindings
	Blood Bond
	Any Other Burden (Basic Mechanic)

Poisoning Someone

To attempt to poison another character, attach the tag from the potion vial to the dish, cup, or food item you want to poison. Do not actually put anything in someone's food or drink. Characters with the Sense Item power or the ability to create the potion/poison can notice the specifics on the tag before consuming it. Otherwise, the poison affects the first (and only the first) character to eat or drink the poison. Once consumed, they destroy the tag and take the effects from the poison.

Conditions caused by poisons can be cured with an Antidote potion, or by any other effect that removes Conditions. Otherwise the Condition remains in effect the rest of the event. You can be affected by multiple different Conditions at once, but instances of the same Condition overwrite each other.

[Blood Bonds](#) can also be delivered via the poisoning mechanic.

Reading and Writing

In order to read or write in-game, you must purchase the [Academics](#) skill.

Searching a Person

You can search other characters when they're detained, Incapacitated, or otherwise unable to stop you, and take any stealable items they have on them. Please read the entry on [Stealing](#) for more information.

If you're carrying something that could be stolen, you need to have it in an area that would be okay for someone to search through, like a pouch or a bag. If you're being searched and you'd rather not have other players touch you at all, you can opt instead to just hand over anything steal-able that you have on you (likewise– if someone doesn't want to touch you, they can ask the same courtesy).

Stealing

Any character can steal in-game items from another character without any skills or abilities. The **ONLY** items that can be stolen are **tagged items, in-game money, and in-game documents** like rituals, letters, diaries, etc. If you have a prop that you're okay with other characters pilfering, you're welcome to put a generic item tag on that object, marking it as stealable (see [Game Items](#)). You may search bags for in-game items, but untagged bags should be left alone or returned. **You cannot take stolen props home.** By the end of the game, stolen props must have their tags removed and be returned to their real-life owner. You may steal unattended objects from in-game areas, which excludes areas being used for OOG storage like under beds, bathrooms and cars. If you're unsure – leave it be! If an object has an orange OOG marker on it, that item is not in game space and cannot be stolen (e.g. it belongs to a character not currently in play, Melded, etc.). You **cannot** search out-of-game bags for stealable items, nor can you store stealable items OOG to keep them safe.

You may steal items that are worn or carried only if the victim cannot mechanically stop you. A character cannot stop you if they are Bound, Dazed, Immobilized, Paralyzed, Incapacitated, Dying, or Dead. You may call "Removing <item>" to let the player know you are taking something from them.

You cannot steal from a character's person without their player's awareness.

Tagged items on one's person should be worn, or stored in accessible locations (belt pouches, bags, outer pockets, etc.). **Do not use physical force to take things from anyone.**

Once you've stolen something, make sure anything that can't be stolen is returned to the player **as soon as possible**. If you cannot find them, return it to ST Logistics. If this fails to happen, it may be considered a Code of Conduct violation. This includes untagged containers, packets, headbands,

power masks, character sheets, and personal items such as medication. Before the game ends, make sure stolen items have their tags removed and the prop returned to the player. You can freely attach the tag to an appropriate prop you own. **You cannot take stolen props home.** Doing so is against the Code of Conduct. While you have a stolen prop in your possession at game, treat it with the utmost care and respect. Do not damage it, and do not neglect it (don't leave it outside to be damaged by the elements, don't lose track of it, etc.).

Items can be returned to players directly, through an intermediary such as a member of staff, or to ST Logistics via the lost and found bin at ST camp. If not returning it directly, tell the intermediary/ST who and where you stole the items from.

Being Tainted

Taint, also called **Soul Sickness**, is a spiritual malady that causes your character to grow subtly darker in personality the longer they remain Tainted. There are various mechanical impacts from your character being Tainted, but it's primarily a roleplay effect that encourages you to lean into the horrific themes of the game.

You're encouraged to think about what being Tainted brings out in your character. However Taint manifests, it is always a smart and subversive force that tries to protect itself and spread.

Being Tainted affects each character differently. Some characters find that their negative traits like being pessimistic, irritable, thoughtless, sarcastic, selfish, nihilistic, melancholic, depressed, distractible, or other foibles worsen while Tainted. Some may find it more difficult to focus, empathize, or connect with the source of their magic when Tainted. Perversely, other characters even relish being Tainted for the feelings of power or passion it brings; some may become addicted and seek it out.

There are a variety of mechanical consequences of being Tainted. **Corrupt** power trees require you to be Tainted to use them. The power Sanctuary forces all Tainted characters to move more than 10 feet away from the caster. Subjugate only works on Tainted characters.

Subjugate

While Tainted, you can be Targeted with the power **Subjugate**. This is one of the most potent effects in the game, causing the target to be entirely bent to the will of the caster. However, if you are **not** Tainted, you are immune and call "No Effect". If your character is Permatainted, you cannot resist Subjugate.

While Tainted, you may spend your Virtue (Humanity, Rage, etc.) as Willpower. Be advised: Virtue does not refresh at sunrise, so spending Virtue this way can have a devastating effect on your character.

There are lots of ways to become Tainted:

- Being targeted with powers with the "Tainted" meta call (Characters avoid becoming Tainted only if they have an ability that lets them *immediately* call Resist or No Effect).
- Drinking the blood of, draining Energy, or draining Health from a character who is Tainted
- Attuning to a [Tainted item](#).
- Starting an event with 3 or less Virtue (7 or more for a Wraith)

Characters may choose to begin an event Tainted if they weren't Tainted at the previous event to represent something they were doing between games.

Tainted characters can be Cleansed of Taint by powers or rituals. However, some characters are Permatainted and cannot be cleansed.

Targeting a Sleeping Character

Players typically sleep in character. If you need out-of-game sleeping accommodations, contact the Safety team. When sleeping, you can be the target of attacks or effects. However, the person targeting you must wake you up and confirm with you OOG that you're aware of what's going on before you take the effect.

Teaching and Learning

Learning new Powers and Skills often requires the guidance of an expert. There are no specific roleplay requirements for Teaching powers or skills; however, you must spend at least 10 minutes roleplaying the lesson in-game. The lesson may include, but is not limited to, spending the time demonstrating the powers of the tree, having your student practice related skills, or discussing the theoretical underpinnings of your particular type of magic. Your imagination is your only boundary in terms of RP - just be sure it has to do with what is being taught.

There are restrictions and limitations on what can be taught to other characters. Please read the Character Progression: [Teaching and Learning](#) section for more information.

Characters should be aware that there are potentially political consequences for sharing certain kinds of knowledge. Teachers are well within their rights to ask favors in exchange, extract promises, or otherwise require payment for their instruction. Some teachers refuse to teach certain trees at all unless the student has proven themselves to be worthy of it.

You must report the Teaching to Check-In via the [Teaching Form](#) after game for your student to be eligible to learn the skill or power. Check-In keeps one learned power and one learned skill recorded for you at a time. Missed opportunities to learn must be retaught.

Traveling Out of Town

Characters may decide that they want to travel outside of the town during a game. To leave town, go to the edge of game space in any direction; if you are being pursued, you have to have shaken off your pursuer for at least 10 minutes. Then, go OOG and head to ST camp.

STs decide how fast a character can travel, taking into account their special abilities (e.g. some characters run supernaturally fast or have wings) and therefore how long the player has to stay OOG.

STs will likely request that the player do an NPC shift during the time that they're away from town for. Characters are in the hands of the STs to decide what they find when they leave town and whether their trip is successful or not.

You may read [Appendix D - ST and Me](#) for more information.

Vampires aren't able to travel outside of town during daylight hours without falling into a deep, death-like sleep, and so often send thralls and Ghouls instead.



Safety Rules

General Safety Guidance

LARPing is a dynamic activity with lots of potential hazards, not all of which we can account for in advance. It's your job as a player to be aware of your surroundings and other players to make sure you're doing your part to contribute to the safety of the game. The most important rule is that player wellbeing always comes first.

Calling a Hold

If during combat or some other situation where things are moving fast you feel unsafe on an OOG level, or you spot a situation that looks unsafe, you may pause the game by calling **"HOLD"**. If you hear someone yell "HOLD" you can repeat the call so that everyone in the area hears it. Everyone must cease what they're doing until the situation has been resolved and the original person who called the hold ends it by calling **"Lay on"**.

Occasionally, inclement weather or other situations means we either have to suspend the event, or suspend parts of the game like combat or being outside. Please listen and follow the instructions of staff if these situations occur.

Getting Consent for Physical Roleplay

You must ask for OOG permission before you touch anyone (beyond a brief touch on the hand, arm or shoulder required for some powers). You must be specific about what you'd like to do.

Examples of Asking For Consent

"OOG, do you accept physical roleplay? I'd like to grab you by your shirt and push you against this wall"

"OOG, would it be alright to hug you in character?"

The other player is free to say yes or no and the scene proceeds from there.

Fade to Black

If a scene is going in a direction that would be inappropriate or uncomfortable to actually act out, you should stop and call a "Fade to Black". This can be used for anything from kissing to a graphic torture scene. A Fade to Black must be used when roleplaying sexual activities.

Anyone can ask for a Fade to Black at any time (except during combat) by crossing their fingers and giving a brief description of why. Anyone who wants to stay in the scene can stay, anyone who wants to leave can leave (making up an in-game excuse if needed). If another player walks in on a Fade to Black scene, inform them what's happening. The new player can then decide to join or to leave.

Once there are no other players around, you can stop physically roleplaying and instead switch to talking out what is happening in the scene. This description can be very general (e.g. "now our characters have sex", "my character tortures yours until they give up the information"), more specific ("we fumble around like teenagers", "I slowly remove your toenails one by one"), or entirely talked out in explicit detail, depending on the players' comfort level. Always check in with the other players and reign it in if it's getting too intense for anyone.

If a player wishes to call a Fade to Black in a situation that will last more than a single scene - for example a character's death or illness or an ongoing torturous situation - then that player should report to ST immediately after the Fade to Black is called. Any other players involved in the scene should accompany them. ST will oversee the verbal narration of what happens, and determine what happens next. ST may advise any players involved to self nerf using the normal rules at this time. Additionally, a player may choose for their character to die during a Fade to Black, and should

narrate the death to those involved. At the end of the scene, they must report to ST camp as per the usual rules for [dying](#) (leaving all their in-game items behind and putting on an orange OOG headband or a fist on their head).

Using Fade to Black as outlined above allows players to narrate their own death without requiring ST. If Fade to Black details become a dispute between players, it should go to ST.

Be Aware of Physical Space

While the story may happen in our imaginations, the game takes place in physical space. Be alert and careful moving around in the dark. Don't move furniture in a way that causes safety hazards like blocking doors or being trip hazards. Follow Site's rules for where you can sleep. Certain areas may be designated "no combat zones" if fighting there could cause a hazard; pay attention to any announcements or signage placed by Safety Team.

Non-Combative Players

Shadow Accord is a physical combat LARP. That being said, some players may find themselves in a position where they cannot be struck by a weapon due to injury, recent surgery, etc. These players can choose to be a non-combative, or a "non-com", player. Non-com players will be given a fluorescent pink-colored headband or sash if they prefer that they must wear prominently; at nighttime, non-com players should hold or wear a pink light or glow stick so as to be identified by other players.

Non-com players cannot be targeted with packet or boffer weapons, but may still be targeted by other powers (Mentals, Touches, etc.). Hitting or attempting to hit a non-com player with boffers or packets is a violation of our Code of Conduct. Non-com players cannot make attacks that use either boffers or packets, but may still use Mentals, Touches, and other powers.

While it's every player's responsibility to look after the safety of others, non-com players should be aware that accidents or confusion may happen during the heat of combat that can result in a non-com player being struck. Non-com players should take steps to ensure their own safety. If combat starts, non-com players must remove themselves from the area and move far enough away that it is clear they are not a participant. As always, any player can call "Hold!" to pause a scene until non-com players are out of the area.

To "attack" a non-com player, the attacker must point a weapon or packet at the non-com player from within 10 feet and make the sig call, "Attacking 1, attacking 2, attacking 3." The count is interrupted and must be restarted if:

- Something hits the attacker's weapon or the attacker,
- If someone steps between the attacker and the non-com player, or
- If the non-com player gets further than 10 feet away from the attacker.

The non-com player may only respond to the attacker using Mentals or touch attacks. If the call is completed, the non-com player's character is dropped to 0 Health and enters the unconscious state; the player may move themselves to a safe location before representing unconsciousness.

For best results, contact the Safety team before any event you plan to make use of the non-com policy to ensure they can accommodate you.

RP Only Spaces

For player safety, there are some spaces which will be designated as RP only spaces. They will vary by site, and which spaces are RP only spaces will be announced before game on Discord, as

As an example of what these areas will be, when we play at Camp Edwards the RP only spaces are: The fort structure, the second floor of the tavern, the tower of stairs in the field, and the lofts in the cabins.

Spaces may become RP only spaces if a space is unsafe to fight in for impermanent reasons, such as if someone is cooking in a space that is not separated from the main RP area (e.g. someone cooking in the tavern's kitchen would not make the whole tavern an RP only space because there is a clear divide, while someone cooking in the Healer's Guild Hall would make that area of the building RP only).

Physical combat, damage powers, counted attacks such as draining, and status powers cannot be used by or against characters in RP only spaces. If you want to initiate fighting in an RP only space, you may go OOG to invite the other players who are in that space to "teleport" with you to the nearest space where fighting is allowed and resume the scene from there. If you are in an RP-only space when combat breaks out nearby, you must choose to stay until combat has subsided or leave to join the combat. If you choose to exit and join combat, you cannot return to the RP only space until the combat is over. Don't enter these spaces as a means to avoid combat.

Out-of-Game Spaces

Story Teller's camp, the parking lot, the bathrooms, the main kitchen and the Check-In area on Friday night are considered OOG areas. Other spaces may be OOG and will be announced before an event. If you're in these spaces when combat breaks out nearby, you must choose whether to stay until combat has subsided or leave to join the combat. If you choose to exit and join combat, you cannot return to the RP only space until the combat is over. Don't enter these spaces as a means to avoid combat.

Fires

No combat is allowed near (real life) fires. If combat breaks out, call "Hold!" and move everyone to a safe distance away to restart the fight. You can't enter an area with a fire as a way to avoid a fight. You must have permission from the Safety team to light fires.

Cheating

Shadow Accord is a game, but there's really no such thing as "winning". The point is to tell a good story. When you cheat, you're really robbing yourself of the opportunity to add conflict and struggle to your story.

We have rules so that characters can interact with each other and so that the consistency of the world is preserved. So that everyone is on the same page, here are some things that would constitute cheating:

Bending/Breaking & Deliberate Misuse of Rules

– by participating in this game, you are agreeing to play by the rules of the game to the best of your ability. Bending and breaking these rules to gain an advantage is not tolerated.

Blocking with an Illegal Zone – intentionally using an illegal hit zone such as your head, the hand holding your weapon, or groin to block an attack is not only dangerous, but also cheating.

Cheesing – this refers to doing things that aren't *technically* cheating per the "letter of the rules", but are clearly not the "spirit of the rules" (for example, responding to "Obedience: drop your weapon!" by "dropping" it from one hand to the other). It's also cheesing to exploit meta aspects of the rules for an in-game purpose (for example, taping a bunch of white paper squares that look like tags but aren't tags to your items, in an effort to confuse in-game thieves)

Exploiting Accommodations - safety and health come first, and rules may be temporarily disregarded to tend to a health or safety need as seen [here](#). However, exploiting this leniency to give yourself an in-game advantage is cheating.

Gibbering – many aspects of the rules require a sig call that must be spoken clearly enough for other players to hear and slowly enough for them to respond to. Making your sig calls inaudible to give yourself an advantage is cheating.

Lying to Character Guides - lying about your concept or trying to play a concept after you've been told no is a form of cheating.

Machine-gunning – making more than one attack per second. This is one attack of any kind, whether you're using a weapon or a power. It is still one second per attack if you are holding multiple weapons or have multiple opponents.

Metagaming – this means acting on information that you as a player know, but your character does not. It is considered cheating when it is done to give yourself an advantage. Please read the entry on [Avoiding Metagaming](#) for more information on this.

Rhino Hiding – not going down and continuing to fight after you have lost all your Health is cheating. The same logic applies to any of your character's stats.

Roughhousing – physically tackling or grappling players who have not consented to physical roleplay is against the rules. This also includes Charging (rushing someone so they are forced to move out of your way) and blocking doorways or tight trails so players cannot move past you without physically pushing you.

Shield Bashing - deliberately hitting or pushing someone with your shield, rushing at someone with your shield, or using your shield to obstruct someone's view during a fight.

Chapter 2: Character Creation

Building New Character

Character Guides and You

The role of the Character Guides (CGs) is to help you craft a character that will give you the best chance of having a fun experience at Shadow Accord. We have an entire team for this because the lore for the setting inherits from a franchise that has been running for 25+ years and can be daunting to pick through by yourself. Even if you already know WoD, we use a selection of WoD materials, so the CGs can help get you up to speed with what's available.

You can contact the CGs at any point during your character creation process, from "I have no idea, please help" to "here's my entire character sheet, does it look alright?". All characters must be approved by the CGs before they can be played. See the full CG policies on the Shadow Accord Website.

Names

Characters can have many names: first names, last names, bynames, nicknames, aliases, and more. For mechanical purposes, the name on your character sheet is your character's name. If a power, tag, ritual, or other rules mechanic requires you to write, speak, or otherwise use a character's name, it must be the name on that character's sheet.

Any time a character's sheet name changes (see the Retraining policy), the new name counts as their name for the purposes of any mechanic that interacts with the character's name. If a mechanic specifically interacts with a previous sheet name of a character, treat that mechanic as if it was referencing the new name.

Before anything, think about your concept...

Starting with some inspiration will help you figure out what stats you want for your character, and will guide the rest of your process. You don't need all the details just yet - perhaps just a shadowy outline. Do you enjoy playing characters who are loud and boisterous, or sneaky and subtle? Do you want to start out on a hell-bent mission, or be adrift in the world? Do you know your family, or are you an orphan, or do you have a new found family? Do you have a tragic past, a dark secret, illicit desires, dangerous enemies, or an impossible goal?

Then, choose a Faction and Subfaction...

The most fundamental choice to make when building a new character is what Faction and Subfaction(s) you want to have. Each has different advantages and disadvantages and its own unique flavor, plot elements and themes. Depending on what concept inspires you, you may steer more toward one faction than another, although it's totally possible that several factions might work with your concept. Read the chapter for each of the four main factions, below. See the [Player's Guides](#) for a better sense of what each faction is like, or talk to a Character Guide.

Your Faction and Subfaction determines your base stats, including some features that you get automatically for being part of the faction. **Follow the templates in the next section.**

Faction and Subfaction Options

Faction	Subfaction
Human	Commoner
	Faithful
	Ghoul - Choice of Clan
	Gifted Kinfolk - Choice of Garou or Fera Tribe
	Sorcerer - Optional choice of Fellowship
Shifter	Choice of Breed ; choice of Auspice ; choice of Garou or Fera Tribe
Vampire	Choice of Clan
Wraith	Choice of Legion , Heretic, or Renegade; optional choice of Guild ; choose if Specter (Advanced) or not

Next, spend some XP...

In addition to the base stats that you get automatically, you get 27 “freebie” XP for your new character that can be spent on beefing up the rest of their sheet (extra stats, powers, skills, etc.). These freebies are lost if unspent. You can also spend additional XP that you have earned at previous events. The templates in the next section tell you the restrictions on what you can purchase for your character. The menu of what you can purchase with XP is found in the section on [Character Progression](#).

Choose your starting gear...

Each new character gets 5 Silvers worth of coin to spend toward starting equipment and gear for your character. Please note this is the only time you may purchase tags this way at Check-In. Each Silver is worth 12 Coppers. Anything you don't spend you get to keep as starting coin (Wraiths may claim this coin as Oboli and Bits instead of Silvers and Coppers).

Wraith characters may choose to receive a Relic tag at no additional cost. This may be affixed to one of their starting weapons, and must remain attached to the same prop it was purchased for.

Characters may purchase Public rituals from any faction, provided they have the **requisite Lore** or are **members** of the subfaction.

Characters may purchase Guarded rituals from their faction provided they have the **requisite Lore** or are **members** of the subfaction.

Characters may purchase Secret rituals from their faction provided they are **members** of the subfaction and meet the **casting requirements**.

Mundane Item Table

Mundane Item	Cost
Light Armor	8 Copper
Medium Armor	1 Silver
Heavy Armor	1 Silver, 9 Copper
Ranged Weapon	1 Silver
Martial Weapon	1 Silver
Shield	1 Silver, 6 Copper
Silver Dagger	15 Silver
Key	2 Copper
Lock	1 Silver

Supernatural Item Table

Supernatural Items	Cost
Antidote	4 Copper
Bit (Wraith Only)	6 Copper
Healing Potion	5 Copper
Relic (Generic)	6 Silver
Simple Ritual	1 Silver
Complex Ritual	3 Silver
Expert Ritual	10 Silver
Obulus (Wraith Only)	2 Silver
Melee Weapon – Iron	5 Silver
Melee Weapon – Silver	15 Silver
Melee Weapon – Gold	30 Silver

Finally, finishing touches!

This is where you flesh out the bones! Figure out your backstory, your motivations and goals, your problems and deepest fears. You should probably pick a name, too. Once you've got these basic details, you can also reach out to other players to see if they'd like to establish backstory connections between their character and your character.

Once you have the approval of the Character Guides, Check-In your character and bring them into game!

Your character isn't "real" until you check them in for the first time at Check-In. That's when any XP is spent and you can pick up all their starting tags and money.

Character Sheets

Shadow Accord									
PLAYER:		CHARACTER:			FACTION:				
SUBFACTIONS: (TRIBE, BREED, CLAN, AURICE, LEGION, GUILD, GHOU, KINFOLK, PATH)									
PATRON:		GEN / RANK:			PASSION:				
HEALTH		WP	ENERGY	VIRTUE	DEVoured	SHADOW - DEED NAME - SIRE			
- Sigil -									
Learned - Innates	SOURCE / TREE		LEVEL						
			0 0 0						
			0 0 0						
			0 0 0						
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			0 0 0						
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			0 0 0						
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Learned - Skills	SOURCE / TREE		LEVEL						
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Learned - XP	SOURCE / TREE		LEVEL						
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Learned - Lore	SOURCE / TREE		LEVEL						
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Learned - Merits	SOURCE / TREE		LEVEL						
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Learned - Adv/Weakness	SOURCE / TREE		LEVEL						
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Learned - Notes	SOURCE / TREE		LEVEL						
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Character Name – This is your character's name (the name they call themselves in their head, the name their god knows them by, etc.). It's fine to have a nickname, use an alias, or have titles, but the name on your character sheet is the one you write on tags, use in rituals, etc.

Faction / Subfactions – List your factions and subfactions (and note whether any of your subfactions are Dormant, if relevant). Your faction and subfaction determine how the rest of your sheet is filled out.

Patron, Generation, Rank, Passion, Shadow, Deed Name, Sire, etc. – This is where you record details that are important to your character. They may or not be relevant to you.

Sigil – If you have the Rituals skill, you'll be asked to pick a Sigil for your character.

Health – Represents how much of a battering you can take. All characters default to 10 Health, but powers like Toughness or Merits like Healthy can increase it. Your Health begins full each event, but you must be healed in-game if you get hurt.

Willpower – Represents your grit, tenacity, and ability to resist the forces of the world trying to act on you. All characters have at least 1 Willpower. Your Willpower refreshes to its full amount each day at sunrise. You can spend XP to increase your maximum amount, up to 10.

Energy – Your primal spark, the thing that allows you to work your influence upon the world. This number represents the size of the Energy pool you have to spend. You can regain Energy in-game, but you can never have more than the size of your pool. You can spend XP to increase your pool, with a limit determined by your faction.

Energy Type – Is determined by your faction (and sometimes subfaction). Your Energy type determines how you regain Energy.

Virtue – Represents how well you're doing at holding yourself back from becoming a true monster. Your faction determines how much Virtue you start with. Virtue can be spent, but the only way to regain Virtue is to purchase more at Check-In.

Devour count – For Wraiths and Vampires, this is the number of other souls you have consumed. See their respective sections for more information.

Powers – These represent the gifts and abilities you have through your connection to the supernatural. There are both Innate and Learned powers (see Character Progression). Each tree has 3 levels or dots worth of powers. If a level of a tree has multiple powers, you get all of those powers when you gain that dot. You can use the back side of the sheet to record which powers go with which levels of the trees you've purchased.

Skills – These represent knowledge that isn't necessarily supernatural in origin. Skills represent trades or crafts you're knowledgeable about.

Merits – These represent additional perks that give unique flavor to your character.

Other character stats you may want to track:

Regeneration Rate – Some characters can spend Energy to heal themselves. Your Regeneration Rate is how many points of Health you get back for each point of Energy spent on Healing. Sources of Regeneration stack (e.g. having Regeneration from your faction and from the power Fast Healing). A Regeneration Rate of 0 means you can't regenerate.

Augment – This stat represents how much stronger your character is than a standard mortal. Augment starts at Augment 0 for most characters (except Shifters in their War Form) and can be increased by various powers and abilities. You can use your Augment to do more damage with a weapon (if trained with the appropriate skill). A character with at least Augment 1 can lift and carry a body by themselves. All **different** sources of Augment stack (e.g. you can't get Augment 2 by having Might twice).

Advantages and Weaknesses – Some subfactions grant your character inherent Advantages or Weaknesses. These are listed in your subfaction's description and are recorded on your sheet.

Fundamental Powers – These are things that you can just *do* by virtue of what your faction or subfaction is. These Powers are described in the Power section of this book and are recorded on your sheet. They are unconnected to any power tree and cannot be taught or self-nerfed. Fundamental powers are lost or go dormant if that faction or subfaction is lost or goes dormant.

Attunement – All characters start with 10 Attunement points, which can be filled by attuning to magic items. See [Attuning to Items](#) to read more on this.

Other Character Details

Restrictions

Subfactions and concepts are organized by a system to help determine the amount of information and knowledge a player must have to play them. The system has three levels: Basic, Intermediate, and Advanced. Each of these levels is available to any player both new and returning and acts to set expectations of what the Character Guides will be asking for in terms of background information and player understanding before granting approval for any character type.

Level	Subfaction/Concept
Common	Black Fury, Bone Gnawer, Brujah, Cappadocian, Ceilican, Corax, Child of Gaia, Commoner, Faithful, Fenrir, Fianna, Gangrel, Lasombra, Messianic Voices, Nosferatu, Old Faith, Sorcerer, Silent Strider, Shadow Lord, Silver Fang, Spirit Talker, Toreador, Valdaerman, Ventrue, Warder of Men
Intermediate	Ahl-i-Batin, Ananasi, Assamite, Bagheera, Bubasti, Caitiff, Giovanni, Lamia, Malkavian, Ravnos, Ratkin, Red Talon, Salubri, Swara, Tremere, Tzimisce, Order of Hermes, Craftmason, Wraiths
Advanced	Baali, Black Spiral Dancer, Dark Thaumaturgy, Fallen Fera, Fallen Sorcerers, Wyrms Gifts, Dark Arcanoi, Specter, Veneficti, Merit: Mortwright

Anything not listed above is not available during PC creation.

Ghouls, Kinfolk, and Gifted Kinfolk are based on the subfaction they are a part of.

Any character faction can be raised to the level of game antagonist if the player desires. Such a desire moves scrutiny up to Advanced.

Patrons

A Patron is a powerful NPC who you are in a formal relationship with, typically including an oath to serve them. Talk to the Character Guides about your options for starting with a Patron already established.

You don't need Demon Lore (see below) to have a Demon Patron, but you need Demon Lore to buy any of the Fallen Paths of Dark Thaumaturgy.

Derangements

Derangements are serious alterations to your thought pattern brought on by some interaction of supernatural forces. While some of these traits share names with real world conditions, we acknowledge that these roleplay requirements do not represent real-world experiences.

Amnesia	You have trouble remembering past events.
Aphasia	You are unable to speak coherently.
Melancholia	You are extremely depressed and difficult to motivate.
Delusional	You believe in a reality that simply doesn't exist.
Masochism	You drive others to cause you pain.
Megalomania	You must seek to control things.
Dissociative Identity Disorder	You have several distinct personalities, only one of which manifests at any given time.
Obsessive Compulsion	You have a specific order that things must be kept in. If it is out of place, you will replace it.
Paranoia	You consider everything a threat.
Regression	Your mind has reverted to a childlike state to protect itself from the world.
Schizophrenia	You hear voices and follow their instructions.
Synesthesia	You are in a permanent hallucinatory state.

Mutations

Mutations are very obvious visible physical features that mark your character as not being fully human. Examples include: horns, a tail, scaly skin across your whole face, claws or tentacles you cannot retract, inhuman colored eyes or snakelike pupils, sharp teeth, or an animal head growing out of your face. You may choose other options, but you must choose something that doesn't overlap with any normal human variation that exists in the real world. Mutations are a makeup requirement for certain subfactions, but you may also choose to have a Mutation (if it's appropriate for your character).

Flaws

Flaws are like physical Derangements; alterations to your body that are caused by supernatural forces. Once again, we acknowledge that these roleplay requirements do not represent real-world experiences of conditions with similar names. You cannot pick a Flaw that will not impact your character (e.g. "No Claws" on a character without any mechanical access to claws anyways).

Lore

Lore is the amount of clandestine or arcane knowledge about other groups your character knows. As your character makes allies, eavesdrops, or interrogates enemies, you'll naturally gain more information (or misinformation!) in-game. Lore learned this way isn't formally tracked – it's just part of your character knowledge.

You begin with Lore from your faction and subfaction for free. But because this is a game largely about intrigue and secrets, knowing the lore of other factions right from the start can be a major advantage. When you have the Lore, you can read any information provided in the World of Darkness source material and treat the relevant parts as character knowledge (e.g. the information about the faction/subfaction you're purchased, during the Middle Ages time period). See available lores below.

Faction Lore: Broad information about a group of supernatural beings, such as their social organization, typical abilities, major weaknesses, major customs, and habits. May include an awareness of subfactions within the groups, but not their details.

Subfaction Lore: Specific practices, knowledge, and history of a smaller group within a faction. You know this group's allies, enemies, their opinions of others, and how their views deviate from the views of the faction overall. Subfaction Lore is generally anything you'd need to blend in or pass as a member of the group.

Learned Powers During Character Creation:

When purchasing non-Innate powers during character creation, you are required to have the appropriate subfaction Lore for that power tree.

Subfaction Lore or membership in the relevant subfaction is required for [Fellowship](#) trees, [Tribe](#) trees, and [Clan](#) disciplines at character creation.

Deranged	Select a Derangement
Fragile	All damage is considered Aggravated.
Hemophilia	Your Regeneration Rate is always 0.
Horns	You must wear horns.
Lame	You cannot run.
Mute	You cannot speak.
No Claws	You cannot use claws or purchase the Merit Mix Morph.
Puny	Your base Maximum Health is 8 instead of 10.
Restricted Form (Shifter Only)	You must always wear your War Form mask.
Tail	You must wear a tail.
Withered Arm	You cannot use one arm to hold any items during game (including packets).
Weak Musculature (Shifter Only)	You do not get the Augment 1 bonus usually granted through War Form.

Available Lore

Type	Available Options	XP Cost
Faction Lore	Mage, Shifter, Vampire, Wraith, Spirit, Demon, Fae	6
Subfaction Lore - Common <i>In Faction: These groups are quick to make friends with the right kind of people. One could more easily explain how they gained access to the secrets of these Subfactions as a well trusted outsider.</i> <i>Out of Faction: Your character may have had direct and prolonged interactions with this Subfaction. They are relatively common, easy to bump into, and are known to interact with a wide variety of outside groups.</i>	Messianic Voices, Old Faith, Order of Hermes, Spirit Talkers Bone Gnawers, Child of Gaia, Warder of Man Fomori Brujah, Cappadocian, Gangrel, Malkavian, Ravnos, Toreador, Ventrue Grim Legion, Skeletal Legion, Iron Legion, Emerald Legion, Legion of Paupers, Harbinger, Chanteur, Proctor, Lifeline, Sandmen, Puppeteers, Usurers	3
Subfaction Lore - Uncommon <i>In Faction: These groups are sensitive to who they are seen with. They can even be hostile to outside groups, your character must have been trusted deeply by a member of these Subfactions to have gained access to their secrets.</i> <i>Out of Faction: Your character may have had a very unique experience with this Subfaction; it may have been friendly or antagonistic, but involved enough to gain access to their inner-workings. If others of these Subfactions know what you know, you may be in danger for knowing too much.</i>	Valdearmen, Craftmason Black Fury, Silver Fang, Red Talon, Silent Strider Corax, Ratkin Lasombra, Nosferatu, Tremere, Assamite, Lamia, Tzmisce Penitent Legion, Silent Legion, Pardoner, Artificer, Alchemist, Mnemioi, Oracles, Haunter, Heretics	6
Subfaction Lore - Rare <i>There is no reasonable excuse why you have access to this information. These groups are as secretive as it gets and information only gets out against their wishes. If you let slip you know this information you would certainly be hunted down by both these groups, and also by others who want to get their hands on this information.</i>	Veneficti, Ahl-I-Batin Shadow Lords Ananasi, Bagheera, Bubasti, Celican, Swara Drone, Gorgon Giovanni, Salubri, Bali, The Senate Legion of Fate, Masquer, Monitors, Specters, Renegade	9

Character Templates

Follow these templates to create a new character. You must pick a valid combination of base stats from the first section box before you choose your Additional Options (e.g. your free dots of a tree have to be valid on their own before you choose to purchase more).

If you're creating a Human with more than one subfaction, complete the template for one of the subfactions, then add anything from the template for the second that wasn't on the first (and so on for additional subfactions). For example, a Faithful with a Dormant Ghoul subfaction gets one Bounty tree for being a AND three innate trees for being a Ghoul, but doesn't get an additional three free skills or a second free Merit.

I'm making a new:

Commoner

- Your **Faction** is [Human](#). Your **Subfaction** is [Commoner](#).
- Your starting **Energy** is 10. Your **Energy Type** is Vitality.
- Choose a [talent tree](#) as an **Innate Tree**. Gain the first dot of that tree for free.
- Your **Virtue** is Humanity. Begin with 7 Humanity.
- Choose 3 free dots in [Skills](#).
- Choose 1 free [Merit](#).

Additional Options:

- You may [purchase](#) additional **Willpower, Virtue, Merits, Skills, or Lore**.
- You may purchase additional Energy, up to 15 Energy.
- You may choose to take the [Delirium merit](#) for free. It will not increase the cost of your future merits.
- You may purchase talents from your Innate Tree at the Innate price

Bringing the Character to Life

The Character Guides may ask you some of these questions, or you can work on them yourself:

- What are the greatest problems you're trying to overcome?
- Do you hold any beliefs that are controversial in your community?
- What is your knowledge of the supernatural? How much of it is accurate?

See the [Human Lore Packet](#) for more info.

Faithful

- Your **Faction** is [Human](#). Your **Subfaction** is [Faithful](#).
- Your starting **Energy** is 10. Your **Energy Type** is Vitality.
- Choose 1 [Bounty tree](#) to be your **Innate Tree**. Gain the first dot of that tree for free.
- Your **Virtue** is Humanity. You begin with 7 Humanity and **must** purchase up to the maximum of 10 Humanity.
- Choose 3 free dots in [Skills](#).
- Choose 1 free [Merit](#).

Additional Options:

- You may [purchase](#) additional **Willpower, Merits, Skills, or Lore**. You **must** purchase Virtue to 10.
- You may [purchase](#) additional Energy, up to 15 Energy.
- You may [purchase](#) more powers from your Innate Tree at the Innate price.

Bringing the Character to Life

The Character Guides may ask you some of these questions, or you can work on them yourself:

- What is the strong belief or conviction that motivates you?
- Has your faith ever been tested? What was the outcome?
- Are you trying to recruit to your cause?

Ghoul

- Your **Faction** is [Human](#). Your **Subfaction** is [Ghoul](#).
- Your starting **Energy** is 10. Your **Energy Type** is Vitae.
- You have [Celerity](#), [Fortitude](#), and [Potence](#) as **Innate Trees**. Gain the first dot of Potence for free.
- Your **Virtue** is Humanity. Begin with 7 Humanity.
- Choose 3 free dots in [Skills](#).
- Choose 1 free [Merit](#).
- You have a Regeneration Rate of 1 and [Test Vitae](#) as a Fundamental Power.

Additional Options:

- You may gain Vampire **Lore** for free. You may also choose a **Clan**, and gain Lore for this Clan for free. You can choose whether taking this Lore is appropriate for your character based on their backstory.
- You may [purchase](#) additional **Willpower**, **Virtue**, **Merits**, **Skills**, or **Lore**.
- You may [purchase](#) additional Energy, up to 15 Energy.
- You may [purchase](#) more powers from your Innate Trees at the Innate price.
- You may [purchase](#) powers from [Animalism](#), [Auspex](#), [Dominate](#), [Obfuscate](#), and [Presence](#) at the Learned price. These trees never require a Lore purchase.
- You may [purchase](#) from other Vampire power trees at the Learned price, but you must also purchase the subfaction Lore for that power tree. You must have a [Demon Patron](#) to learn powers from [Dark Thaumaturgy trees](#), which you may purchase at the Corrupt power price. You must purchase Demon Lore to begin with a Demon Patron.

Bringing the Character to Life

The Character Guides may ask you some of these questions, or you can work on them yourself:

- When did you first become a Ghoul? Who made you a Ghoul?
- What Vampire do you serve now, or are you rogue?
- How much do you understand about Cainite culture, or have you been kept mostly in the dark?
- Other than serving your Domitor, what are your greatest goals and ambitions? Do you desire to become a Vampire yourself?
- What are you like when you become Tainted?

Gifted Kinfolk

- Your **Faction** is [Human](#). Your **Subfaction** is [Gifted Kinfolk](#).
- Your starting **Energy** is 10. Your **Energy Type** is Gnosis.
- You have the [Homid tree](#) as an **Innate Tree**.
- Choose a [Garou](#) or [Fera](#) Tribe. This is the group of Shifters you are part of. You do **not** gain the Advantages or Weaknesses of your Tribe. You gain that Tribe's power tree as an **Innate Tree**.
- You gain **Lore** for both Shifter and your Tribe for free.
- Gain the first dot of one of your **Innate Trees** for free.
- Your **Virtue** is Humanity. Begin with 7 Humanity.
- Choose 3 free dots in [Skills](#).
- Choose 1 free [Merit](#).

Additional Options:

- You may [purchase](#) additional **Willpower**, **Virtue**, **Merits**, **Skills**, or **Lore**.
- You may [purchase](#) additional **Energy**, up to 15 Energy.
- You may [purchase](#) more powers from your Innate Trees at the Innate price*.
- You may [purchase](#) powers from [Lupus](#), [Natus](#), or any of the [Auspice trees](#) at the Learned price. These trees never require a Lore purchase.*
- You may [purchase](#) powers from other [Shifter trees](#) at the Learned price, but you must also purchase the subfaction Lore for that power tree. You may purchase [Wyrm Gifts](#) at the Corrupt power price.

**Gifted Kinfolk do not need to learn powers in order within a tree, but they must not have more level 3 powers than level 2, and no more level 2 powers than level 1.*

Bringing the Character to Life

The Character Guides may ask you some of these questions, or you can work on them yourself:

- How did your character discover they were a gifted kinfolk?
- How much does your character know about Shifter society?
- What is your role within your Tribe?
- What are you like when you become Tainted?
- Why do you believe you were chosen to be a Human with these Gifts, rather than Shifting?

Shifter

- Your **Faction** is [Shifter](#). Your **Subfaction** is your Tribe.
- Your starting **Energy** is 10. Your **Energy Type** is Gnosis.
- Choose a [Breed](#). Gain this power tree as an **Innate Tree**. If you choose Natus as your Breed, choose a [Flaw](#).
- Choose an [Auspice](#). Gain this power tree as an **Innate Tree**.
- Choose a [Garou](#) or [Fera](#) Tribe as your subfaction. Gain any Advantages or Weaknesses of your Tribe. Gain the Tribe's power tree as an Innate Tree.
- You gain **Lore** for both Shifter and your Tribe for free.
- Choose 3 free dots of powers from your Innate Trees*.
- Choose a starting [Rank](#). You must have a number of level 3 Powers at least equal to that Rank. You cannot start at the highest Rank.
- Your **Virtue** is Rage. Begin with 7 Rage.
- Choose 3 free dots in [Skills](#).
- You have a Regeneration Rate of 2 and have [Bestial Frenzy](#), [Bestial Healing](#), [Step Sideways](#), and [War Form](#) as Fundamental Powers.

Additional Options:

- You may [purchase Merits](#).
- You may [purchase](#) additional **Willpower, Rage, Skills, or Lore**.
- You may [purchase](#) additional Energy, up to 20 Energy.
- You may [purchase](#) more powers from your Innate Trees at the Innate price*.
- You may [purchase](#) powers from other [Breed](#) or [Auspice](#) trees at the **Learned** price. Breed and Auspice trees never require a Lore purchase.*
- You may [purchase](#) powers from other [Shifter trees](#) at the **Learned** price, but you must also purchase the subfaction Lore for that power tree. You may purchase [Wyrms Gifts](#) at the **Corrupt** power price.*

*Shifters do not need to learn powers in order within a tree, but they must not have more level 3 powers than level 2, and no more level 2 powers than level 1.

Bringing the Character to Life

The Character Guides may ask you some of these questions, or you can work on them yourself:

- What was it like when you had your First Change? Did you know about Shifters beforehand?
- What is your Deed Name? How did you earn it?
- Who do you look up to or aspire to be like?
- Do you have a pack? Why or why not?
- Who is your totem and why did you choose them? Or did they choose you?
- What would it take to make you **Frenzy**?
- What are you like when you become **Tainted**?



Sorcerer

- Your **Faction** is [Human](#). Your **Subfaction** is [Sorcerer](#).
- Your starting **Energy** is 10. Your **Energy Type** is Essence.
- Choose 2 [Sorcerer trees](#) to be your **Innate Tree**.
- Gain the first dot of one of your Innate Trees for free.
- Your **Virtue** is Humanity. Begin with 7 Humanity.
- Choose 3 dots in [Skills](#) for free.
- Choose 1 free [Merit](#).
- You receive 2 [Focus](#) tags at your first Check-In.

Additional Options:

- You may [purchase](#) additional **Willpower, Virtue, Merits, Skills, or Lore**.
- You may [purchase](#) additional **Energy**, up to 15 Energy.
- You may choose a [Fellowship](#). The [Fellowship tree](#) becomes your third **Innate** tree. Your Fellowship has a profound impact on how your character understands their place in the world. Fellowships are Restricted.
- If you choose a Fellowship, you gain **Lore** for both your Fellowship and Mage Lore for free.
- You may [purchase](#) more powers from your Innate Trees at the Innate price, or powers from other Sorcerer trees at the Learned price. You cannot learn powers from Fellowship trees that aren't yours.
- If you have a [Demon Patron](#), you may learn powers from the [Fallen Paths](#) at the Corrupt power price or choose them as Innates. You must have Demon Lore to begin with a Demon Patron.

Bringing the Character to Life

The Character Guides may ask you some of these questions, or you can work on them yourself:

- How do you understand your magic? Where does it come from? (Sorcerers call this their Paradigm).
- Did/does your family know about your magical talents? What do they think?
- What are your Foci? What do they mean to you?
- How much do you know about the supernatural? Is your knowledge mainly from folk stories or do you have direct experience?
- What are you like when you become Tainted?
- What is your occupation? How do you feed yourself and make a living?



Vampire

- Your **Faction** is [Vampire](#). Your **Subfaction** is your Clan.
- Your starting **Energy** is 15. Your **Energy Type** is Vitae.
- Choose a [Clan](#) as your Subfaction. Gain these power trees as Innate Trees. Gain the Curse for your Clan.
- You gain **Lore** for both Vampire and for your Clan.
- Choose 3 free dots of **Powers** from your Innate Trees.
- Choose a **Generation**. Your Generation determines the size of your Energy pool. You **must** purchase additional Energy to start below the 10th Generation. See Vampire rules for more info.
- Choose a **Road**. Begin with 6 Road.
- Choose 3 free dots in [Skills](#).
- You have a Regeneration Rate of 1 and [Amaranth](#), [Bestial Frenzy](#), [Blood Buff](#), [Draining](#), [Paralyzing Bite](#), [Test Faction](#), and [Test Vitae](#) as **Fundamental Powers**.

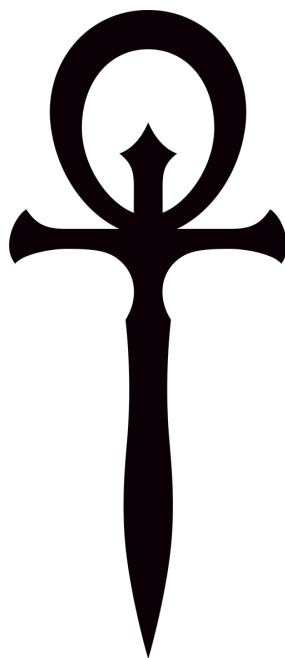
Additional Options:

- You may [purchase Merits](#).
- You may [purchase](#) additional **Willpower**, **Road**, **Skills**, or **Lore**.
- You may [purchase](#) more powers from your **Innate Trees** at the Innate price.
- You may [purchase](#) powers from the [Common Discipline](#) trees at the **Learned** price. Common Discipline trees never require a Lore purchase.
- You may purchase from other [Clan Discipline](#) trees at the **Learned** price, but you must also purchase the subfaction Lore for that power tree. You must have a [Demon Patron](#) to learn powers from the [Fallen Paths](#), which you may purchase at the Corrupt power price. You must have Demon Lore to begin with a Demon Patron.
- You may begin with an Amaranth count greater than 0.

Bringing the Character to Life

The Character Guides may ask you some of these questions, or you can work on them yourself:

- Who is your Sire? What is your relationship with them like?
- What would it take to make you **Frenzy**?
- What is your greatest ambition for this decade? For this century? Millennium?
- What is your Clan's view of the other Clans? Do you share those views?
- What do you think of humans? Do you keep (or want to keep) Ghouls or thralls?
- How do you keep the Masquerade of being Human? Or do you not bother?
- What are you like when you become **Tainted**?



Wraith

- Your **Faction** is [Wraith](#). Your **Subfaction** is your [Legion or Guild](#) (or both) if you choose to start with either.
- Your starting **Energy** is 10. Your **Energy Type** is Pathos.
- Choose 3 [Arcanoi](#) power trees to be your **Innate Trees**.
- Choose 3 free dots of powers from your Innate trees.
- Choose 2 [Passions](#).
- Choose a [Shadow Archetype](#) and a Thorn.
- A Wraith's **Virtue** is Angst. Begin with 4 Angst.
- Choose 3 free dots in [Skills](#).
- You receive 2 [Fetter](#) tags at your first Check-In.
- Wraiths have a Regeneration Rate of 1 and have [Fetter Healing](#), [Portal Walk](#), [Sense Emotion](#), [Temporary Angst](#), and [Umbra Sight](#) as Fundamental Powers.

Additional Options:

- You may purchase [Merits](#).
- You may purchase additional **Willpower**, **Skills**, **Lore**, or purchase down (reduce) your **Angst**.
- You may purchase additional **Energy**, up to 20 Energy.
- You may choose a [Guild](#) and a [Legion](#). These have an important roleplay impact.
- You may choose [Death Marks](#) as makeup requirements.
- You may [purchase](#) more Powers from your Innate Trees at the Innate price.
- You may [purchase](#) powers from other Wraith power trees at the Learned price, or from Dark Arcanoi Trees at the Corrupt price.

Bringing the Character to Life

The Character Guides may ask you some of these questions, or you can work on them yourself:

- How did you die? Did several Legions fight over you, or was it clear-cut?
- What's your current relationship with your **Shadow**? Is it stable or in flux?
- What would cause you to go into **Catharsis**?
- How involved are you with Stygian politics?
- What are your views on the Quick? Do you associate with them or stay away?
- What are your Fetters? Why are they important to you? How do you protect them?
- How does being **Tainted** affect you? Your Shadow?



There are a couple more character concepts that exist in the Shadow Accord rules system. However they are not available at character creation, so they aren't shown here. See [Appendix B - Things that Go Bump in the Night](#), for information about what these are and how a player character might become one.

Character Progression

Check-In

To play or progress a character at an event, you must check them in at Check-In. This is also the time when you can spend XP to advance your character.

At Check-In, you also collect any resources your character gains from their abilities. You can also check in rituals that your character owns to collect the tags for them, if relevant.

You may check in a primary character and any number of backup or cameo characters; however, you can only collect resources (e.g. tags, coins, rituals) for one character. You do not have to play every character you check in.

If you won't be on site by the end of the usual Check-In hours (announced before each game), please let Check-In know beforehand so they can coordinate a late Check-In for you.

Cameo Rules

Players typically can't change characters part way through an event. The exception is if your character is killed, forced to leave town by NPCs or other PCs, or if you Cameo a character. To Cameo, you must Check-In both characters you wish to play. The cameo character may be played from 9PM Friday to no later than 6AM Saturday, after which point you must either switch to your main character or choose to continue playing the Cameo for the duration of the event.

Teaching and Learning

You are able to purchase dots in order from your Innate Trees without being taught. However, to purchase skills and powers from trees you don't know yet, you need another character to teach you that tree in-game. This is expanded on in the RP Specific actions: [Teaching and Learning](#) section. Once you've purchased the first dot of a skill or

power tree, you may keep purchasing dots in order from that tree without having to have it taught to you again.

The exception to this is Shifters and Gifted Kinfolk, who have special rules for Teaching and Learning:

each *power dot* must be taught and learned individually, but can be taught in any order. Specifics and restrictions regarding this may be read in the [Shifter](#) section.

You can only teach your Innate Trees, Corrupt Trees, Dark Arcanoi, or Skills to other characters who are eligible to learn them (i.e. a Vampire may not teach a power tree to a Shifter), and you must have yourself learned all three levels of a tree before you can teach it. The tree has to be Active at the time it was taught, and the learner also must have the appropriate subfaction Active (in the case of Dormant subfactions).

Dark Arcanoi cannot be taught or learned by Wraiths with less than 10 Angst unless they're in Catharsis. See the [Dark Arcanoi](#) section for more information

Any character can teach one power tree rank and one skill tree rank each game. There are ways, like the [Academics](#) skill, which allow a character to teach more.

The Teaching must be reported to Check-In via the [Teaching Form](#) after game. Check-In keeps one learned power and one learned skill recorded for you at a time. Missed opportunities to learn must be retaught.



Earning XP

XP is the meta-currency you use to advance your character over time. XP is earned through contributions to the game such as attending events, helping with setup/teardown, playing NPCs, and other services to the organization. XP is banked *per player* and can be spent on any of your characters. XP never expires. You earn a minimum of 3 XP each game just for attending.

Keep an eye out for regular announcements about how to earn XP, or talk to any member of staff!

Advancement

At each Check-In, you can spend XP to gain new Skills, Powers, or Merits, or raise your character's Energy, Willpower, or Virtue (up to the limits for their faction and subfaction). Apart from the first Check-In for a new character, players can only advance each stat by one dot per character at each Check-In. You don't have to intend to play a character at an event to advance them when you Check-In.

If you're purchasing something that goes with a particular faction or subfaction (e.g. Powers), that faction or subfaction has to be active when you purchase that thing



XP Costs Table

Item/Trait	XP Cost
Virtue	2
Energy*	3
Willpower	6
Merit	3 + 3 per Merit
Changing Road	1
Level 1 Innate/ Corrupt Power	3
Level 2 Innate/ Corrupt Power	6
Level 3 Innate/ Corrupt Power	9
Level 1 Learned Power	6
Level 2 Learned Power	9
Level 3 Learned Power	12
Level 1 Skill	2
Level 2 Skill	4
Level 3 Skill	6
Faction/Demon Lore†	6
Common Subfaction Lore†	3
Uncommon Subfaction Lore†	6
Rare Subfaction Lore†	9
4 Copper‡	1
1 Silver‡	3

*Humans are capped at 15 Energy, while Shifters and Wraiths are capped at 20 Energy. Vampires Energy cap is determined by their [Generation](#).

† May only be purchased at character creation.

‡ May only be purchased with starting freebie points.

Redundant Powers

Some powers offer what may seem to be the same magic as others. If you already possess all the powers granted by a certain level in a given power tree, those powers are Redundant to you and you may take that dot for free, provided you meet all other prerequisites (e.g. Teaching). Taking a power in this manner still counts toward your one-power-level limit when advancing at Check-In. Fundamental Powers do not count toward making a tree level Redundant.

You can count a power as Redundant if you have it in a faction or subfaction that's currently Dormant. (e.g. a former Sorcerer with Might from the Body tree can gain Might from the Potence tree as a Ghoul or Vampire for free as their one-per-game power dot. The Vampire must still be taught Potence if it isn't Innate.)

Corrupt or Dark Arcanoi versions of powers do not allow you to take non-Corrupt versions for free, but non-Corrupt versions will allow you to take Corrupt or Dark Arcanoi versions for free. Likewise, you may take the <Tainted> version of something for free if you already have the non-Tainted version, but not the other way around.

Dormancy

When a new Faction is added to your sheet, the old Faction becomes **Dormant**. For Humans, some subfactions also cause other subfactions to become Dormant (see the Subfactions section of the Human Faction chapter for more information).

All Powers, Skills, and Merits associated with a Faction or Subfaction on your sheet also become Dormant if that Faction or Subfaction becomes Dormant. Anything on a character sheet that is Dormant does not exist for any mechanical purpose.

Self-Nerfing

At Check-In, you may choose to remove or decrease character stats for roleplay reasons. Once you apply a self-nerf, you cannot change your mind. These drawbacks may be corrected only through IG means, such as relearning a lost power. You may self-nerf any of the following (and only the following) from your character if you wish:

- Permanent Willpower
- Virtue (may increase instead for Wraith)
- Energy (except for Vampires)
- Non-Corrupt powers
- Skills
- Merits

Additionally, you may add any of the following to your character:

- Devour count
- Derangement
- Flaw

You may also choose to enter game with any number of the following stats decreased, without changing your sheet or updating Check-In:

- Max Health (as if struck by [Agg damage](#))
- Current Health
- Current Energy
- Current Willpower

You may choose to begin an event Tainted even if you were not Tainted at the end of the previous event.

Character Sheet Changes Mid-Game

If during an event you experience something that causes a permanent change to your character sheet (e.g. changing factions or subfactions), go to ST camp once the scene is finished. An ST will update your sheet. This is not necessary for changes in Virtue only.

Character Death

Character death is a very real possibility at Shadow Accord, though death may not be the end of your character's story. If your character is a Human, they may return as a Wraith. Vampires and Shifters with the Lost Soul Merit also may return as Wraiths. If your character dies you must report to ST camp at the end of the scene. You may read the section on being [Dead](#) for more information.

Retirement

You may retire your character from play, either for a period of time or permanently. Characters who are permanently retired can **never** be played again. Retirement can occur through your own decision, or through an opportunity for permanent character retirement offered by ST. When your character

dies, you can permanently retire them (even if there is no way they could come back).

When your character is permanently retired, you can reclaim **half** (rounded down) of the XP on your current character sheet (excluding the initial freebie points and free dots), and put it toward advancing an existing character or creating a new character. You should notify Check-In to make sure the retirement is recorded.

Characters retired before their **3rd** game of being Checked-In can be refunded for **all** of the XP on your current character sheet (excluding initial freebie points and free dots). You may only receive this "early" retirement XP once per calendar year, except with approval from XO.

Retraining

You might find after creating a character that you don't enjoy one of their powers, never use one of their skills, or wish you had built them just a little bit differently. Instead of having to either retire the character or live with it, you can choose to retrain them. This choice must be made before their 3rd game of being played; once they have been Checked-In for a third time they are no longer eligible for retraining. A character can only be retrained once.

To Retrain a character, you must first email CG and Check-In before the character's **3rd** game of being Checked-In with the changes you would like to make and get their approval. At your next Check-In, you can refund any purchases of Virtue, Energy, Willpower, Merits, Powers, or Skills for the XP, freebie points, or free dots that were spent on them. You can then purchase any of these traits as if creating a new character. You do not keep any unspent freebie points. If you wish to change any other aspect of your character, that will require specific CG approval. If the changes are vast enough, you may be recommended to retire your character early and create a new one. (see above; all spent XP will be refunded). A player may only retrain a character once per calendar year, except with approval from XO.

Changing Factions

Characters might undergo a change to their faction as their story unfolds, especially if they begin their story as a Human. If your character's faction changes, work with Character Guides to convert your character sheet to your new faction. Unlike character creation, you don't get to make additional purchases at this time, but you can progress your character as usual at your next Check-In.

Unless otherwise noted, you keep your Health, Energy, Willpower and Virtue at the same number. You also keep your character's memories and identity. The faction becomes Dormant as well as faction-specific powers, skills, and merits from your old faction. This is not a new character, so you do not get an additional 27 freebie XP.

Wraiths - If you were Human or you had the Lost Soul Merit, you can return as a Wraith the event after you die (or you can wait longer, if you'd like). New Wraiths are called Enfants. You may choose whether to begin with your Caul still intact. You may read the **Wraith** section for more information. Choose 2 Fetters, 2 Passions, a Shadow Archetype, and a Thorn. Your Energy Type becomes Pathos but the number does not change (unless you were a Vampire with more than 20 Energy, in which case it becomes 20). Choose three Arcanoi as your Innate trees and gain 3 powers from those trees. Your Virtue becomes Angst, and the number changes to 4 Angst.

Vampires - A Dying Human can be Embraced as a Vampire. Being Embraced is the passing of life into death for a character, and the character is no longer considered 'alive' for relevant mechanics. A newly created Vampire is called a Childe and the Vampire who created them is called their Sire. You have the Clan of your Sire and your Generation is 1 greater than theirs. Your Energy Type becomes Vitae. If relevant, gain Energy to the level appropriate for your Generation. You gain your new Clan's trees as Innate Trees. As a newly embraced Vampire, if you have less than 3 dots in your new Innate Trees, you

may choose free power dots from your Clan's trees until you have 3 total dots in them. Your Virtue becomes Road. The default starting road is Road of Humanity, but you can choose another with CG permission.

Shifters - Humans with the Kinfolk Merit become Shifters when they experience their First Change. To do so, you must submit a First Change request to STs. At any point in the future, STs can choose for your character to have their First Change, and they will send an NPC to guide you through the process. New Shifters begin with the rank of Cub. Your Energy Type becomes Gnosis but the number does not change. Your new Innate Trees are Homid, your Tribe's tree, and an Auspice (you choose). You gain three dots in Powers from your Innate Trees. Your Virtue becomes Rage. Note that Gifted Kinfolk can never undergo a First Change.

Chapter 3: Humans



As a human, you are the basis of every monster in the World of Darkness and the most challenging to play in a world dominated by the supernatural. All factions abstractly rely on your kind in some way. Vampires drink your blood, werewolves are born from you, and your passions are the source of energy for Wraiths.

Most Humans have little to no awareness of the supernatural power struggles happening around them. Those who find themselves in the know and are brave (or foolish) enough to stick around are at risk of becoming a thrall, commodity, or pawn to the true monsters of the world.

If you are looking to play the Human faction, expect a game of survival and wits and a fight to maintain your autonomy and humanity among monsters.

Basics

Unless altered by their subfaction, all Humans have the same basics attributes:

Humans are Living.

Humans are Scorched by <Fire>, <Blood> and <Dark>.

Humans are Realmbound.

Humans have a Regeneration Rate of 0.

Humans have an Energy cap of 15.

Humans get one free [Merit](#) at character creation, which does not increase the cost of future merits.

Virtue: Humanity

At the core of each Human character is their innate sense of Humanity.

Losing Humanity

- While Tainted, you can spend Humanity as Willpower.
- Unlike some other factions, you cannot spend Humanity to enter a Frenzy

If you ever reach 0 Humanity, you have lost all sense of yourself as a person. You behave as nothing more than a wild beast, lashing out at anyone who comes near you. You have run wild, and this character cannot be played at future events.

Subfactions

Humans may have multiple subfactions, but there are restrictions on having multiple subfactions Active at any time. Only the subfaction with the highest precedence is active. A subfaction becomes Dormant if you acquire a subfaction that has precedence over it per the chart on the next page.

No matter how many subfactions you have, you can only have one Energy type at a time. Characters can only use powers associated with their current Energy type (regardless of whether the power itself costs Energy to use).

If you gain a new subfaction in-game, bring your character sheet to ST to update it. You may gain new subfactions between games, but should have a strong reason for doing so.

Precedence Order for Human Subfactions

	Ghoul (Vitae)
	Sorcerer (Essence) ** Gifted Kinfolk (Gnosis) **
	Faithful (Vitality)
	Commoner (Vitality) ***

** The one which you acquired later has precedence over the one you acquired earlier

*** Commoner may be active with any other subfaction which uses Vitality as its Energy type.

Human – Commoner

The vast majority of this world's inhabitants are just regular people, living out their lives as best they know how. Their stories can be just as dramatic, horrible, and tragic as any others, perhaps enhanced by their relative innocence.

Folktales aside, most Commoners remain blissfully oblivious of the dangers that lurk in the darkness. However, a rare few may be very aware that monsters live alongside them – perhaps due to a personal tragedy or inborn uncanny perceptiveness. Some Commoners are destined to become something else entirely, having their very natures altered by contact with the Supernatural.

Basics

Commoners are Living.

Commoners are Scorched by <Fire>, <Blood> and <Dark>.

Commoners are Realmbound.

Commoners have a Regeneration Rate of 0.

Commoners have an Energy cap of 15.

Being a Commoner

You may start as a Commoner. Otherwise, a human whose subfaction[s] go dormant will default back to a Commoner, as seen [above](#).

The Veil

The Veil is the collective agreement among most supernatural factions to maintain the secrecy of their existence from the Humans. More than just a political agreement, the Veil seems to be a force in

its own right: it nudges mortal eyes to slide away from the strange and their minds to steer clear of unanswerable questions.

The Veil is not perfect, and over the millennia pieces of the truth have slipped out in the form of legends, superstitions, and folktales. Religions have arisen to help Humans parse the manageable parts of the supernatural.

If you've already had significant interactions with the supernatural and have arrived at the realization that the world you knew is not wholly accurate, you are referred to as "Unveiled".



Delirium

An Unveiled human faces extraordinary danger just from the knowledge they hold. Over time, a potent survival instinct has developed among humans that helps humans keep their veil and remain in blissful ignorance. Commoners may take the [Delirium Merit](#) for free.

Energy: Vitality

Commoner's Energy is represented by Vitality, the natural energy of life. Your Vitality is regained completely each morning as the sun rises.

Dormancy

The Commoner subfaction becomes Dormant if you acquire another subfaction that does not use Vitality as its Energy type.

Teaching & Learning

Choose one talent tree as your Innate Tree, which you can teach. You may purchase powers from your Innate Tree at the Innate price, or powers from other talent trees at the Learned price.

Talents

Talents represent natural skills, attributes, and abilities acquired by unique individuals without being supernatural.

These trees go Dormant if your current Energy type is not Vitality. If you gain or change Subfactions without changing Energy types, you still have access to your talents.

Key

M	Mental	Ma	Mask
T	Touch	P	Passive
St	Status	D	Damage
Sn	Sensory	O	Other
Sf	Self	C	Condition

Click on a power to be taken to its writeup.

BRASH

1	Taunt (M)
2	Disarm (D)
3	Avoidance (Sf)

BRAWNY

1	Shatter (O)
2	Might (P)
3	Brutal Strike (D)

INQUISITIVE

1	Sense Emotion (Sn)
2	Sense Mental (Sn)
3	Sense Vitality (Sn)

STURDY

1	Endure (P), Withstand (Sf)
2	Resilience (Sf)
3	Toughness (P)

“Spicy” Commoners

A Commoner character doesn’t just need to be a simple cabbage farmer or merchant (although they certainly could be!). There are a multitude of ways in which a “normal human” may be touched by the supernatural. These are just a few examples of the many types of Commoners you can play at Shadow Accord.

Former Ghoul – Somehow, you escaped and “got clean”. You’ve managed to rid yourself of all traces of your former life, but the Vitae still calls. *Take the Ghoul subfaction and start with it Dormant.*

Secret Kinfolk – Your parents failed to mention a crucial piece of family lore, which may become very, very important later. *Take the Kinfolk Merit.*

Hunter – A hellish beast killed your family, and now you’re out to kill it and all its kind. *Take one or more Faction Lores.*

Demon Follower – It certainly didn’t tell you it was a Demon, but through your partnership you’ve been achieving things you could never dream of. *You can’t begin as a thrall, but you can begin with a Demon Patron ([Appendix B - Things that Go Bump in the Night](#)).*

Human – Faithful

Every religion, philosophy, creed, or worldview has a rare few adherents who are so firm in their conviction that their beliefs are the absolute right ones that their devotion manifests as actual power. Most Faithful respond to this blessing by dedicating themselves to sharing their bounties to improve the lives of those less fortunate or less strong in their convictions. Some fight to keep temptation of corruption away from the flock, others teach paths to fortify their neighbor's spirit to the end of seeking their own unique bounties, but nearly all defend their own integrity to preserve their cherished faith.

Basics

Faithful are Living.

Faithful are Scorched by <Fire>, <Blood>, and <Dark>.

Faithful are Realmbound.

Faithful have a Regeneration Rate of 0.

Faithful have an Energy cap of 15.

Becoming Faithful

Any Human Commoner with 10 Humanity can become Faithful at Check-In. Players should clearly define the tenants of their character's Faith and are encouraged to self-nerf Virtue for transgressions against those tenants.

Energy: Vitality

As a Faithful, your Energy type is Vitality, the natural energy of life. Your Vitality is regained completely each morning as the sun rises.

Dormancy

The Faithful subfaction becomes Dormant if you have less than 10 Humanity. You cannot use any of your Faithful powers if you are Tainted. The Faithful subfaction becomes Dormant if you become a Sorcerer, Gifted Kinfolk, or Ghoul.

Teaching and Learning

You have one Bounty tree as an Innate Tree. You cannot learn any other Bounty trees.

Please note that so long as your Energy type is Vitality, you may also pick an Innate tree from the [Commoner talent tree](#). Teaching and Learning per the respective rules.



Bounties

While the bounties of the Faithful are a marvel, they are but a dim flickering candle against the roaring winds in this dark world. One misdeed could result in having your light extinguished.

Key

M	Mental	Ma	Mask
T	Touch	P	Passive
St	Status	D	Damage
Sn	Sensory	O	Other
Sf	Self	C	Condition

Click on a power to be taken to its writeup.

AFFINITY

1	Pence from Heaven (O)
2	Taunt (M)
3	Hypnotism (M)

CHAMPION

1	Heal Self (Sf)
2	Resilience (Sf)
3	Avoidance (Sf), Disarm (D)

DISCERNMENT

1	Detect Taint (Sn)
2	Sense Amaranth (Sn), Sense Demon (Sn), Sense Rank (Sn)
3	Cloak Sight (P)

PURITY

1	Avert (M)
2	Serenity (T)
3	Cleanse (T)

SOLACE

1	Sense Angst (Sn), Sense Fetter (Sn), Sense Shadow (Sn)
2	Detect Fetter (T), Fetter Consumption (T)
3	Exorcism (M)

SPIRITUAL

1	Resist Gauntlet (Sf), Sense Spirit (Sn)
2	Umbra Sight (P)
3	Umbra Strike (Sf)

A Note on Faithful

Faithful are not necessarily the Hunter faction, although some members of the Faithful could see it as their duty to discover and put right that which doesn't mesh with their beliefs.

Just because a Faithful has the ability to do things other humans cannot, it does not mean that they understand anything of the supernatural world. In fact, many Faithful fight to keep their veil, because a true understanding of how their world actually works might shatter their beliefs from which they draw their powers. Supernatural factions would be wise to keep tabs on the Faithful in their areas and know that they are generally harder to control and more aware of things the veil would keep hidden.

Faithful are contrasted from Sorcerers in that they are not usually able to work their will directly on the world as a Sorcerer could (except perhaps in moments of true duress). Their range of powers is very limited and almost more like channeling miracles than consciously slinging magic. While Sorcerers grow their powers through learning and exposing themselves to other ideas, the Faithful cling to their convictions at the exclusion of others.

Human – Ghoul

Humans who consume the blood of Vampires themselves become a part of the Vampire world. Although they are still a living human, they are touched by the Curse of Cain infused in the Vitae that they now carry within their bodies.

Ghouls are almost always **Blood Bonded** servants of a Vampiric master, serving as bodyguards, retainers, courtesans, snacks, or simply companions to ease the loneliness of long nights. Some Vampires groom potential Childer by keeping them as ghouls while they instruct them with everything they need to know before the Embrace. Others treat ghouls as disposable peons. Rarely, rogue Ghouls manage to exist outside of the control of a Vampire and forge their own path.



Basics

Ghouls are Living.

Ghouls are Scorched by **<Fire>**, **<Blood>**, and **<Dark>**.

Faithful are Realmbound.

Ghouls have a Regeneration Rate of 1.

Ghouls have [Test Vitae](#) as a Fundamental Power.

Ghouls have an Energy cap of 15.

Becoming a Ghoul

Humans who drink at least 2 points of Vitae within a single 10 minute period become a Ghoul.

Energy: Vitae

As a Ghoul, your Energy type is Vitae. You typically only regain Vitae by drinking it from a Vampire.

Dormancy

You must continue regularly drinking Vitae to remain a Ghoul. If you go an entire event without consuming at least 2 points of Vitae within a 10 minute period, you will begin the next event with the Ghoul subfaction **Dormant**. The subfaction will become active again when you next consume 2 points of Vitae within a 10 minute period.

Rituals

You may cast Blood Rites (Vampire Rituals) that require at most the level 1 Rituals skill. You may still cast other rituals if you meet their requirements.

Teaching and Learning

You have [Celerity](#), [Fortitude](#), and [Potence](#) as Innate trees, which you can teach. You can be taught any Vampire power trees at the Learned price.

Human – Gifted Kinfolk

Fewer than 1 in 10 children of a Shifter parent become Shifters themselves. The rest live as regular Humans – or "regular Humans." Those who maintain a connection to Shifter society are Kinfolk; valued by Shifters, though their treatment varies by Tribe.

Among them is a rarer subset: the Gifted Kinfolk, chosen few who carry some of their brethren's power but will never Shift. Each carves out a unique identity between the worlds of Shifter and Human.

Basics

Gifted Kinfolk are Living.

Gifted Kinfolk are Scorched by <Fire>, <Blood>, and <Dark>.

Gifted Kinfolk are Realmbound.

Gifted Kinfolk have a Regeneration Rate of 0.

Gifted Kinfolk have an Energy cap of 15.

Becoming a Gifted Kin

You may begin as a Gifted Kinfolk from character creation. If you are a Human with the Kinfolk Merit, you can request to become a Gifted Kin at any Check-In. You cannot become a Gifted Kin while you have Ghoul as an active subfaction.

Energy: Gnosis

As a Gifted Kinfolk, your Energy type is Gnosis. Unlike Shifters, your Gnosis is regained completely each morning as the sun rises.

You may also gain up to 5 Gnosis each day by meditating at a single Gaian Node regardless of the value printed on the card (you can gain Gnosis

at multiple Nodes, and it does not need to be the same Node(s) each day, but you cannot gain more than 5 Gnosis total at Nodes per day).

First Change

As a Gifted Kinfolk, you are not eligible for **First Change** into a Shifter.

Dormancy

The Gifted Kinfolk subfaction becomes Dormant if you become a Sorcerer, or Ghoul, and stays Dormant while you have any of those subfactions active.

Rituals

You may cast Glyph Rites (Shifter Rituals) that require at most the level 1 Rituals skill. You may still cast other rituals if you meet their requirements.

Teaching and Learning

You have [Homid](#) and your [Tribe's tree](#) as Innate Trees, which you can teach.

You can be taught any Shifter power trees. Like Shifters, you must teach and learn each level of powers individually. However, you can purchase levels in trees out of order from each other, and may teach any level you have already purchased of an Innate tree regardless of if you have learned every level in that tree or not.

While you may purchase levels out of order, you must have one lower level power for every power of the next level. You may never have more level 2 powers than level 1 powers, and you may never have more level 3 powers than level 2 powers.

Example of valid Shifter Gift purchases

SOURCE / TREE	LEVEL
Homid	● ● ○
Galliard	● ● ○
Fianna	● ○ ●

Human – Sorcerer

As a Sorcerer you are one of a wide variety of Humans who can wield a limited amount of supernatural power derived from sources as diverse as the people who worship them. Perhaps you are a hedge mage, druid, zealot, alchemist, priest, witch, or a witch-hunter. Regardless of the source of your power, all Sorcerers can prove to be very helpful allies or minions or very problematic enemies or obstacles to any supernatural creature.

Basics

Sorcerers are Living.

Sorcerers are Scorched by <Fire>, <Blood>, and <Dark>.

Sorcerers are Realmbound.

Sorcerers have a Regeneration Rate of 0.

Sorcerers have an Energy cap of 15.

Becoming a Sorcerer

You may become a Sorcerer at any Check-In. You cannot become a Sorcerer if you currently have the Ghoul subfaction active. Becoming a Sorcerer causes the Gifted Kinfolk, Faithful, and Commoner subfactions to become Dormant.

There's no mechanical requirement for becoming a Sorcerer. However, discovering the ability to use Essence is a profound change in your understanding of yourself and the world you live in. You should do appropriate roleplay before and after gaining this subfaction to represent the change. Speak to Character Guides for ideas.



Energy: Essence

Essence is a fundamental force that stems from the life around you. Your Essence is regained completely each morning as the sun rises. Essence can also be gained at **Crays**, local points in the landscape with deep magical significance.

Dormancy

Your Sorcerer subfaction becomes Dormant if you become a Gifted Kinfolk, or Ghoul, and stays Dormant while you have any of those subfactions active.

Focus

Your collected essence is channeled through personalized magical tools called a Focus (plural: Foci), often used in fantastical, masterful, or insightful ways to coax the world to deviate from its usual path with rote powers generically called spells.

You must interact with or at the very least prominently display one of your Foci every time you use your powers, or the attempt fails. Even passive powers go dormant without a Focus available.

You can make a free Focus tag and apply it to a prop at least 3 inches long at Check-In each game.

Cabals

Unlike Mages, Sorcerers don't have a formal organized society. However, it's common for groups of like-minded Sorcerers, or Sorcerers who share a common purpose, to gather in collectives called **Cabals**. Cabal members gain the benefits and weaknesses of placing their full trust in others. See the Cabal ritual for mechanics.



Locus

Sorcerers can store some of their excess Essence in an extremely personal magical vessel called a Locus. Loci are made in-game by ritual out of a large container or resonant crystals. Loci are usually too big and unwieldy to carry around with you. Loci can be stolen or destroyed like any tagged item. Each Sorcerer can only have one Locus at a time, and it must be created in-game using the Create Locus ritual. A Sorcerer may start an event with their locus half full (5 essence).

Rituals

More so than other Humans, Sorcerers are capable of rituals that bind the will of like-minded Sorcerers (and in rare cases stronger beings) to bring reality to its knees.

Teaching and Learning

Choose two Sorcerer Trees as your Innate Trees, which you can teach. If you join a Fellowship, you gain that Fellowship's tree as a third Innate, which you can also teach. You can be taught any Sorcerer tree except for Fellowships you are not a member of.

Sorcerer Trees

Key

M	Mental	Ma	Mask
T	Touch	P	Passive
St	Status	D	Damage
Sn	Sensory	O	Other
Sf	Self	C	Condition

Click on a power to be taken to its writeup.

ANIMAL

1	Beast Mind (M)
2	Disquiet (M), Induce Frenzy (T)
3	Frenzy Control (Sf)

BODY

1	Endure (P), Withstand (Sf)
2	Resilience (Sf)
3	Resist Taint (Sf)

CURSE

1	Forgetful Mind (T)
2	Body Wrack (St)
3	Paralyze (St)

HEALER

1	Healing Touch (T)
2	Serenity (T)
3	Revive (T)

MIND

1	Confusion (M)
2	Telepathy (O)
3	Obedience (M)

PATTERNS

1	Shatter (O)
2	Fabricate Armor (O)
3	Disable (St)

PERCEPTION

1	Sense Essence (Sn), Sense Item (Sn)
2	Read Magic (Sn), Sense Spirit (Sn)
3	Detect Taint (Sn), Sense Confidence (Sn), Sense Desire (Sn)

PROTECTION

1	Avert (M)
2	Cloak (Sf)
3	Sanctuary (M)

SPIRIT

1	Resist Gauntlet (Sf)
2	Cleanse (T)
3	Exorcism (M)

WARRIOR

1	Taunt (M)
2	Might (P)
3	Avoidance (Sf), Disarm (D)

Fallen Paths

As taught to us by generous fallen angels, there is more possibility in the world than there is will. Those on the Fallen Paths actively shun the traditional boundaries of good and evil. In this shadow work there is power and self awareness, but society will find fault in the perceived corruption you invite. Fallen Paths are Corrupt Trees that require you to be Tainted to use. Purchasing these trees at character creation requires Demon Lore. These trees are dormant if you do not have a [Demon Patron](#).

Key

M	Mental	Ma	Mask
T	Touch	P	Passive
St	Status	D	Damage
Sn	Sensory	O	Other
Sf	Self	C	Condition

Click on a power to be taken to its writeup.

DEATH

Purchasing a power in this tree causes your character to become Permatainted.

1	<Tainted> Silence (S)
2	Insight (T)
3	<Tainted> Decay (D)

DEMONOLOGY

Gaining a power in this tree causes your character to become **Permatainted**.

1	Sense Demon (Sn), Scion of Evil (P)
2	Umbra Sight (P)
3	Subjugate (M)

MADNESS

Gaining a power from this tree causes your character to gain a [Derangement](#).

1	<Tainted> Monsters (M)
2	Derange (M)
3	Horrid Reality (M)

RUIN

Gaining a power from this tree causes your character to gain a [Derangement](#).

1	<Tainted> Wither (St)
2	Ranged 2 <Dark> (D)
3	Brittle Bones (St)

Fellowships

While some Sorcerers come to their techniques for reality manipulation naturally, others are trained by Mages or their disciples. This dedicated training highlights unique pillars of the world that once understood become avenues to mastering a new set of spells and even more powerful rituals.

As a member of a Fellowship you gain Mage Lores at no cost and are expected to understand your pillars intimately. You can read more about each Fellowship in the **Player's Guide**.

When you join a Fellowship (by purchasing the tree), the appropriate Fellowship Tree becomes your third Innate. You can only ever learn Fellowship powers from your own Fellowship Tree, and you can only ever be a member of one Fellowship.

Fellowship Trees

Key

M	Mental	Ma	Mask
T	Touch	P	Passive
St	Status	D	Damage
Sn	Sensory	O	Other
Sf	Self	C	Condition

Click on a power to be taken to its writeup.

AHL-I-BATIN

1	Visions (O)
2	Mask of a Thousand Faces (Ma)
3	Hasty Escape (Sf)



CRAFTMASON

Having this tree counts as having Order of Hermes for the purposes of ritual requirements

1	Pence from Heaven (O)
2	Meditate (T)
3	Daze (T)

MESSIANIC VOICES

1	Sense Demon (Sn), Silence (St)
2	Ranged 2 <Holy> (D)
3	Majesty (M)

OLD FAITH

1	Root (St)
2	Sense Fae (Sn), Wither (St)
3	Entrancement (M), Passion (M)

ORDER OF HERMES

1	Fire 2 (D)
2	True Form (M)
3	Daze (T)

SPIRIT TALKERS

1	Hallucination (M)
2	Dreamshape (TC)
3	Umbra Sight (P)

VALDAERMEN

When your character joins the Valdaermen, select a predatory animal mask for your mask powers. Once you make this selection, you cannot change it. The most common animal is a bear; other animals should be considered rare or unusual.

1	Snarl (M)
2	Clawed Form (Ma), Powerful Form (Ma)
3	Toughness (P)

VENEFICTI

1	Sense Demon (Sn), Venom (St)
2	Induce Sin (M)
3	Silver Tongue (P)

Chapter 4: Shifters



Howls echo from deep within the forests, interrupting the calls for curfew. Parents check twice to make certain that their doors are barred as watchmen take their posts, their swords turned towards the night. For myths and legends speak of great beasts of tooth and claw that prowl through the trees, though these stories do no justice to the truth.

As a Shifter you are born of Gaia, Mother of All, to protect the natural world that she created. Whether born as human or beast your duty to the spiritual and natural world is the same: maintain the balance of the Triat and fight corruption wherever it lives and breeds, careful to not succumb to the darker forces of nature or the beast that lives within them. Shifter society is one of found families, in the forms of Packs and Tribes, which are united under the common laws of their society known as the Litany.

Basics

Shifters have [Bestial Frenzy](#), [Bestial Healing](#), [Step Sideways](#), and [War Form](#) as Fundamental Powers.

Shifters are Living.

Shifters are Scorched by <Fire>, <Silver>, and <Wolfsbane>.

Shifters are Realmbound.

Shifters have a Regeneration Rate of 2.

Shifters have an Energy cap of 20.

Energy: Gnosis

Gaia is a great creator. This creative energy filters down through all her spirits, Shifters included. This Energy is called Gnosis, and signifies a character's connection to the Umbra and other spirits.

You may replenish Gnosis at [Gaian Nodes](#).

If you have 0 Gnosis, you are unable to Step Sideways or enter your War Form.

Teaching and Learning

You have your Breed, Auspice, and Tribe's tree as Innate trees, which you can teach. You can be taught any other Shifter tree, so long as you meet the requirements, at the Learned price.

Unlike other factions, Shifters must teach and learn each level of powers individually. However, they can purchase levels in trees out of order from each other, and may teach any level they have already purchased of an Innate tree regardless of if they have learned every level in that tree or not.

While they may purchase levels out of order, they must have one lower level power for every power of the next level. They may never have more level 2 powers than level 1 powers, and they may never have more level 3 powers than level 2 powers.

Example of valid Shifter Gift purchases

SOURCE / TREE	LEVEL
Homid	● ● ○
Galliard	● ● ○
Fianna	● ○ ●

Renown

Shifters use a social currency called Renown. Renown is tracked by ST. See the [Shifter Player's Guide](#) for more information.

Rank

Shifter society is organized into Ranks; your Rank determines your degree of responsibility for yourself and others. Higher ranks are cause for respect, but Rank can also be lost for missteps and blunders.

Each Tribe has their own method by which their members achieve Rank, but it usually comes in the form of challenges offered by those of higher rank,

or sometimes Spirits. See the [Shifter Player's Guide](#) for more information.

Rank is mostly a roleplay attribute at Shadow Accord, but it can be important for interactions with NPCs like Spirits.

The first three ranks (Cub, Cliath or Fostern), can be achieved from player character interaction without the involvement of ST. If you want to gain Rank to represent things you've done "off screen" (like not having played your character for a few years), talk to a Character Guide to get their approval.



Gaining higher Ranks (Adren and Athro) almost certainly requires the blessing of relevant Spirits, which will involve ST. STs must sign off that you have achieved these ranks. Let STs know if you have lost these ranks.

If you gain or lose Rank, have your sheet updated at ST camp, or at the next Check-In.

Rank	Name (among the Garou)	Level 3 gifts required to start at Rank
0	Cub	0
1	Cliath	1
2	Fostern	2
3	Adren	3
4	Athro	4
5	Elder	(not available at character creation)

Totems

Totems are powerful local spirits. Many Shifters have a specific Totem as their Patron. This relationship is typically one of mutual service; the Shifter honoring and working on behalf of their Totem and the Totem providing tools and connections that can help a Shifter advance.

Talk to Character Guides about what Totems are available as patrons at character creation and whether starting with a Patron would be appropriate for your character.

Virtue: Rage

Luna, the celestial spirit of our moon, gifted Shifters (except Ananasi) with a mystical wellspring of primal anger that carried a ban for silver that to this day burns their spiritual flesh.

If you ever reach 0 Rage, you have lost your sense of purpose in this world. You become Permatainted and enter into a [Frenzy](#) that never ends. You have run wild, and this character cannot be played at future events.

Losing Rage

- You can willingly expend 1 Rage at any time to enter a Frenzy per the [Beastial Frenzy](#) power.
- While Tainted, you can spend Rage as Willpower
- You can spend 1 Rage to use [Beastial Healing](#).

Bestial Healing

When you reach 0 Health, you may spend 1 Rage to instantaneously return to 1 Health and enter an uncontrollable Frenzy. See the [Bestial Healing](#) power for more details.

Crinos

As a Shifter you can change your body, melding the power of your spirit with the deadliest features of your human and animal forms. Garou call this war form Crinos, and players signify the change with a wolf mask. Fera have their own names for this form and players signify the shift with an animal mask representing their subfaction. See the [War Form](#) power for more information.

Stepping Sideways

Separating the Realm from the Umbra is a Weaver construct called the Gauntlet. As half spirit and half flesh, Shifters can all [Step Sideways](#) through the Gauntlet.

Stepping Sideways allows you to move between the Realm and the Umbra at no cost immediately at any Gaian Node or by meditating for 60 seconds at any other location. You must put on or take off a white headband as appropriate to show which side of the Gauntlet you are on.

You cannot Step Sideways if you have 0 Gnosis. See the **Stepping Sideways** power for more information.

Gaian Gifts

As a Shifter, you are blessed by Gaia with certain abilities that are yours by virtue of your birth – what form you were born in, the phase of the moon at your time of birth, and what breed of Shifter you come from. Fera understand the source of their gifts differently – See the [Shifter's players guide](#) for more information.

You have the trees for your Breed, Auspice and Tribe as your innates. You are also able to learn gifts from other trees.

Breeds

Breed represents the form in which a Shifter was born. Homids (born as Humans) tend to be more understanding of the human world, while Lupus (born as animals) generally have a greater connection to the Wyld. Natus are born of two Shifter parents and are frequently rejected by Shifter society.

Key

M	Mental	Ma	Mask
T	Touch	P	Passive
St	Status	D	Damage
Sn	Sensory	O	Other
Sf	Self	C	Condition

Click on a power to be taken to its writeup.

HOMID

Born as a Human

1	Avert (M)
2	Avoidance (Sf)
3	Paralyze (St)

LUPUS

Born as an animal

1	Snarl (M)
2	Resilience (Sf)
3	Frenzy Control (Sf)

NATUS

Born in Crinos to Shifter parents

Restriction: Cannot be Corax or Ananasi

Weakness: You have a [Flaw](#)

1	Wither (St)
2	Telepathy (O)
3	Passion (M), Terror (M)

Auspices

A Garou's Auspice is the phase of the moon they were born under, and defines some of their role within Shifter Society.

Fera have their own versions of Auspices. However, you must choose from the following options.

AHROUN

Full Moon: Warriors

1	Silver Claws (D)
2	Might (P)
3	Brutal Strike (D)

GALLIARD

Gibbous Moon: Bards

Restriction: Cannot be Ratkin

1	Taunt (M)
2	Dreamshape (TC)
3	Song of Rage (M)

PHILODOX

Half Moon: Judges

1	Sense Gnosis (Sn), Sense Item (Sn)
2	Meditate (T)
3	Toughness (P)

THEURGE

Crescent Moon: Seers

1	Release Spirit (T), Sense Spirit (Sn)
2	Umbra Sight (P)
3	Umbra Strike (Sf)

RAGABASH

New Moon: Tricksters

1	Confusion (M)
2	Disembodied (Sf), Realm Grasp (Sf)
3	Mimic <Gnosis> (T)

Garou Tribes

The Garou are a nation of interconnected werewolf Tribes. While some groups are traditionally associated with certain regions, they all have a presence across the world.

BLACK FURIES

Fierce, matriarchal warriors who pursue justice at all costs.

Note: While most Black Furies identify as female, CG can approve members of this Tribe of any gender

1	Detect Taint (Sn), Heal Self (Sf)
2	Body Wrack (St)
3	Aggravated 1 (D)

BLACK SPIRAL DANCER

Dark and demented servants of the Wyrms.

Weakness: You must follow a Wyrms totem. Additionally you have a [Derangement](#).

Innate Tree: Pick one tree from the [Wyrms Gifts](#).

BONE GNAWERS

Survivors and lurkers in human refuse

Advantage: Bone Gnawers have Poison Immunity as a Fundamental power

1	Forgetful Mind (T)
2	Ranged 2 <Stone> (D)
3	Resist Taint (Sf)

CHILD OF GAIA

The peacemakers and healers of the Garou

1	Healing Touch (T)
2	Serenity (T)
3	Silver Armor (P)

FENRIR

Fierce and heroic warriors with little room for mercy or compassion

1	Razor Claws (D)
2	Venom (St)
3	Hero's Stand (Sf)

FIANNA

Bards and revelers who preserve the stories and lore of the

Garou

1	Fast Healing (P)
2	Woadling (T)
3	Form of Vapor (Ma)

RED TALONS

Feral enemies of the Weaver in all its forms

Restriction: Cannot be Homid.

Note: Red Talon PCs should be somewhat tolerant of Humans to live in town.

1	Shatter (O)
2	Beast Mind (M), Root (St)
3	Fire 4 (D)

SHADOW LORDS

Scheming and manipulative politicians and assassins

1	Disarm (D)
2	Wounding Lies (M)
3	Disable (St)

SILENT STRIDERS

Travelers and messengers who are constantly on the move

1	Silence (St)
2	Horrid Reality (M)
3	Gauntlet Walk (Sf)

SILVER FANGS

The ruling Tribe of the Garou

1	Detect Taint (Sn), Sense Emotion (Sf)
2	True Form (M)
3	Obedience (M)

WARDERS OF MAN

City-dwellers encouraging human progress and trade

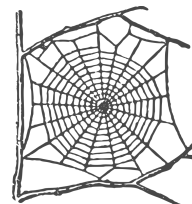
1	Pence from Heaven (O)
2	Fabricate Armor (O)
3	Cloak Sight (P)

Fera Tribes

The Garou (werewolves) and the Fera (every other shifting animal) have a fraught relationship since the time of the War of Rage. The rare Fera that remain pursue their aims separately (although sometimes allied) with the Garou.

Ananasi

The highly secretive and emotionless children of the Weaver's daughter, Queen Ananasa. These spider-Shifters strictly uphold their Queen's will, while working to free her by untangling the Corrupt Weaver's stagnant webs and in so doing return sanity to the Wyrms. If you plan to answer Ananasa's call, be prepared for a slow paced and subtle game of interwoven secrets building to stealthy but violent action from the shadows.



Advantage: All Ananasi have the Silver Armor and Venom Blood, as well as Paralyzing Bite, Test Faction, and Draining as Fundamental Powers.

Restriction: Cannot be Natus.

Weakness: Ananasi cannot use Gaian Nodes for stepping sideways or regaining Energy.

Energy: Ananasi use Gnosis to fuel their powers, but they must refill their pools by [draining Health](#) in the same manner as a Vampire.

ANANASI

1	Cloak (Sf)
2	Venom (St)
3	Meld <Darkness/Shadow> (O)

Bastet

The Bastet are the eyes of Gaia and tend to be secretive. The Bastet Tribes, made up of werecats and their kinfolk, do not make a whole and keep their own company most often. The Ceilican are most commonly, if at all, seen in the area.



BAGHEERA

The lawgivers of catkind with a keen sense of justice

- | | |
|---|---|
| 1 | Detect Taint (Sn) |
| 2 | <Fire> Weapon (D) |
| 3 | Daze (T) |

BUBASTI

Mystics and secret keepers of the Bastet

- | | |
|---|------------------------------------|
| 1 | Forgetful Mind (T) |
| 2 | Entrancement (M) |
| 3 | Form of Vapor (Ma) |

CEILICAN

Musicians, artists, and followers of the Old Ways with a connection to the Fae

Weakness: Ceilican are Scorched by <Iron>

- | | |
|---|---|
| 1 | Hallucination (M), Withstand (Sf) |
| 2 | <Fire> Weapon (D), Sense Fae (Sn) |
| 3 | Hasty Escape (Sf) |

SWARA

These solitary cheetahs serve as messengers for the Bastet.

- | | |
|---|---|
| 1 | Razor Claws (D) |
| 2 | Mask of a Thousand Faces (Ma) |
| 3 | Gauntlet Walk (Sf) |

Corax

Wereravens. Curious, gossiping collectors of knowledge and shiny objects.

Advantage: Corax have Silver Armor as a Fundamental Power.

Restriction: Cannot be Natus

Weakness: Corax are Scorched by <Gold>

CORAX

- | | |
|---|-----------------------------------|
| 1 | Insight (T) |
| 2 | Fire 2 (D) |
| 3 | Hasty Escape (Sf) |

Ratkin

The rat Shifters, born from delirious illness and driven to spread disease in many forms, are perhaps the most varied group of the Fera, each with their own bonds and duties. A common dedication of them all is survival, lending them to being a paranoid bunch.

While Ratkin aren't evil, they are often antagonistic. If you choose to play Ratkin you should be prepared to balance the drive for largely amoral violence and goals with the fun of other players. Talk to a Character Guide for more information.

Advantage: Ratkin have Poison Immunity as a Fundamental Power.

Restriction: Cannot be Galliards.

RATKIN

- | | |
|---|----------------------------------|
| 1 | Cloak (Sf) |
| 2 | Monsters (M) |
| 3 | Aggravated 1 (D) |

Fallen Fera

Unlike Black Spiral Dancers, which are a true Fallen Tribe, Fallen Fera are generally individuals who started as a normal Gaian member of their Tribe but later fell through various means to join the Wyrms' service. Fallen Fera use the normal rules for their original Fera Tribe, with the following changes:

Original Tribe: You have all the Advantages, Restrictions, Weaknesses, and Energy changes of your original Tribe.

Advantage: In addition to the Lore for your Fallen Tribe, you also receive the Lore of your original Tribe, and as such may purchase your original Tribe's gifts as learned gifts at character creation.

Weakness: Choose at least 1 [Derangement](#) in addition to any Weaknesses of your original Tribe.

Power Tree: Choose one of the Wyrms Gift trees as your Tribe innate instead of the normal Tribe gift tree.

Note: Your subfaction Tribe changes as per the following: Ananasi changes to Antara, Corax changes to Buzzard, Bastet (all types) changes to Histpah, and Ratkin changes to Vermin.

Wyrms Gifts

Wyrms Gifts are Corrupt Trees that require you to be Tainted to use.

CORRUPTION

Gaining any power in the Corruption tree causes your character to become Permatainted.

1	Taint (P)
2	Corrupted Powers (P)
3	Subjugate (M)

CUNNING

1	Smell Fear (P)
2	Cloak Gathering (T)
3	Hidden Taint (P)

DEFILING

1	Detect Taint (Sn), Scion of Evil (P)
2	Induce Sin (M)
3	<Tainted> Induce Frenzy (T), Terror (M)

FEAR

1	Sense Confidence (Sn)
2	Horrid Reality (M)
3	Disable (St)

MADNESS

Gaining any power in the Madness tree causes your character to become Permatainted. After gaining any power from this tree, you must select at least one [Derangement](#) if you do not already have one from another source.

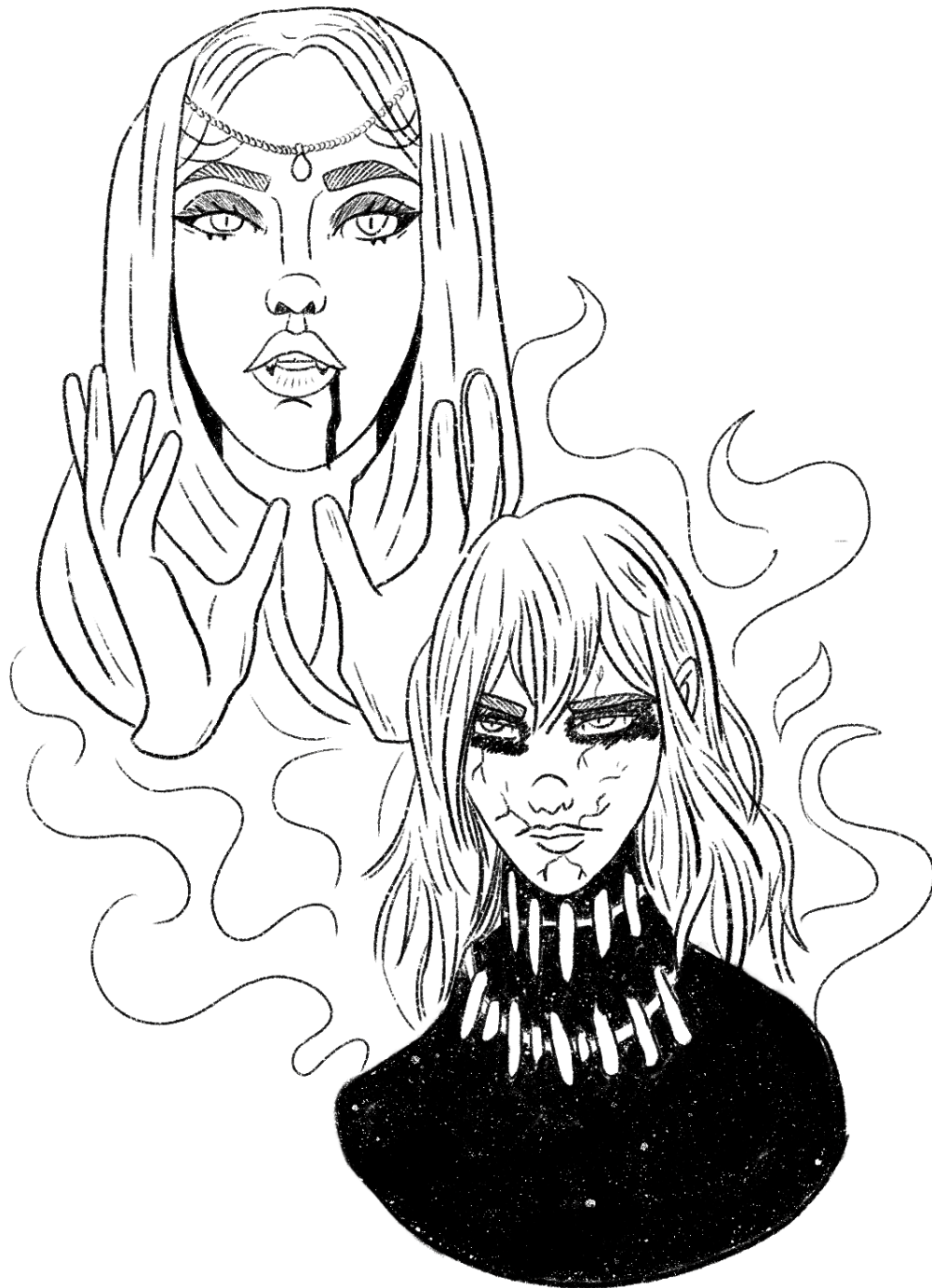
1	<Tainted> Confusion (M)
2	<Tainted> Derange (M)
3	<Tainted> Decay (D)

STRENGTH

Gaining any power in the Strength tree causes your character to become Permatainted.

1	Hide of the Wyrms (P)
2	Resilience (Sf), Totemic Form (Ma)
3	Balefire (D)

Chapter 5: Vampires



It all begins with blood. Abel's blood, spilled on the rocks by his brother. The curse placed on Cain's blood, passed down to his progeny. The blood that pools in your veins now, bringing you both power and torment.

Vampire Society is both complicated and cutthroat. Interactions are governed with traditional rules, but with the shared understanding that those rules can be broken by those with enough power to get away with it. Some lean into the intrigue and political mire while others remove themselves to become semi-feral creatures of the woods. Meanwhile, each and every Vampire experiences their own personal struggle to remain in control of themselves, lest they fall to the Beast...

Basics

Vampires have [Paralyzing Bite](#), [Test Faction](#), [Draining](#), [Amaranth](#), [Bestial Frenzy](#), [Blood Buff](#), and [Test Vitae](#) as Fundamental Powers.

Vampires are Unliving.

Vampires are Scorched by <Fire> and <Light>.

Vampires are Realmbound.

Vampires have a Regeneration Rate of 1.

Vampires Energy cap is determined by their [Generation](#).

Energy: Vitae

Vampire's Energy type is Vitae, aptly named for the life's blood that sustains them. Vampires get more Vitae by [Biting and Draining](#) targets, or you may replenish Vitae from [Blood Fountains](#).

Others can also [feed you their blood](#) to replenish your Vitae. If you are Incapacitated when they do this, you may reset your Incapacitated timer (i.e. Regenerate yourself after 60 seconds).

If you ever reach 0 Vitae, you lose 1 Road and take the condition Craving <Blood>. You also enter a Frenzy, unless you spend a Willpower to resist. If you're not able to get any Vitae within a minute, you fall unconscious for 10 minutes, after which you awaken still craving blood, but no longer in a Frenzy.

To Cainites, blood is the wellspring of all power – and certain blood carries more power than others. For beings who are cursed to prey on humans, consuming the blood of other supernatural creatures instead causes strange but potent effects:

Blood Effects

Faction / Subfaction	Energy Value	Additional Blood Effects
Human	1 Health: 1 Energy	None
Vampire	1 Energy : 1 Energy	Blood bond may apply (see Blood Bond section)
Shifter	1 Health: 2 Energy	Vampire affected by Passion: Anger
Ananasi		Vampire affected by Venom
Wraith	1 Health: 1 Energy	Vampire is shunted to the Umbra (if not already in the Umbra). <i>Vampire players should carry white headbands</i>
Anything Umbra-bound		
Demon	1 Health: 2 Energy	Vampire affected by Tainted Induce Sin <Demonic Vice>

Teaching and Learning

You have three Innate trees determined by your Clan, which you can teach. You can be taught any other Discipline so long as you meet the requirements at the Learned price.

Generation

A Vampire's Generation is the number of Vampires in their bloodline spanning from them to the first Vampire, Cain. Generation is traditionally regarded as a short-hand for a Vampire's power – although many enterprising neonates would beg to differ. The size of your Energy pool is determined by your Generation. Vampires cannot buy additional Energy after character creation; they may only increase their Energy pool though lowering their generation through Amaranth (see below). To begin lower than 10th Generation, players must spend XP to purchase Energy up to the required amount.

Generation	Energy
13th - 10th	15
9th	20
8th	25
7th	35
6th*	45

*Not available at character creation

Amaranth

Amaranth is simultaneously one of Cainite society's greatest taboos, its surest routes to power, and an addictive pleasure beyond description. It requires draining another Vampire so completely that you absorb their own power into yourself.

See the [Amaranth](#) power for more details.

For roleplay purposes, committing Amaranth involves consuming the target's soul. This is a horrific act that may leave you permanently

scarred. Your personality may warp over time to take on aspects of your victim, or in some cases their soul may fight with you for control of your own body. See the Vampire Player's Guide for more information.

Virtue: Road

Cainites adopt a Road, or a code of morals, which they cling to to keep themselves from falling to their base predatory instincts (referred to as one's Beast). These morals may or may not align well with human moral systems. See the [Vampire Player's Guide](#) for more information.

Choosing a Road

Most young Vampires begin on the Road of Humanity. This Road is the most similar to human morality, and therefore is something most former humans already understand. Other Roads are more alien to human thinking, and likely require study or a mentor to grasp.

Choosing a Road other than Humanity from the start (character creation or Embrace) should have a good backstory justification. Speak to the Character Guides for more information. If you change your Road later, you'll need another character to teach you the tenants of that Road and you must be below 5 on your current Road. Once you've satisfied these conditions, have your sheet updated at the next Check-In.

Losing Road

Road is lost through several ways:

- You can willingly expend 1 Road at any time to enter a Frenzy (see [Bestial Frenzy](#)).
- While Tainted, you can spend Road as Willpower.
- You automatically lose 1 Road after committing Amaranth on another Vampire.
- Vampire characters are encouraged and expected to self-nerf their Virtue for taking actions contrary to their Road. See Hierarchies of Sin below for more information.

Whenever Road is lost Vampires take the condition Craving <Blood>. Make sure to update your Virtue at your next Check-In.

If you ever reach 0 Road, your Beast has entirely taken over. You become Permatainted and enter into a [Frenzy](#) that never ends. You have run wild, and this character cannot be played at future events.

Hierarchies of Sin

All Roads have a Hierarchy of Sins dictating the actions that will cause you as a walker of the Road to lose Virtue. These actions become more restrictive the higher the rating a walker achieves on a Road. The hierarchies for the more common Roads are listed in the Vampire Player's Guide.

Players are encouraged to use the provided hierarchies. However, if you follow specific paths within a Road, or follow an obscure Road, the CGs invite you to create your own hierarchies based on the provided ones and on WoD material. These hierarchies must be discussed and approved by CG. You must also consult with CG when changing your Road.

Road Rewards

While it is difficult, there are benefits for adhering closely to your Road.

These rewards stack: you receive the benefits of both if you are eligible for both. These rewards become inactive if your Virtue falls below the required threshold.

Adept (5+ Virtue): You can earn a Meditate for engaging in specified role-play related to the mission of your Road - see the table below.

Paragon (8+ Virtue): You gain +1 permanent Willpower, which can exceed the usual 10 WP limit.

Requirement to earn a meditate (pre-req 5 Road)

Road	Requirement
Humanity	Participate in a human lifetime event or milestone (e.g. wedding, funeral) for at least 10 minutes. <i>Note: The event does not need to be a traditional lifetime milestone as long as it is significant to the characters involved.</i>
Heaven	Preach the values of your religion for at least 10 minutes to a receptive audience.
Kings	Delegate and have someone complete a task which you could not have easily done for yourself.
Sin	Convince someone else to do something you know they consider sinful.
Beast	Frenzy, or cause another to Frenzy.
Lilith	Cause someone to suffer in a way that teaches them a lesson.
Blood	Punish someone unworthy of the position, rank, status or task they hold.
Bones	Learn something you did not know about your chosen area of esoteric study.
Metamorphosis	Spend ten consecutive minutes using Imitate on yourself.
Night	Hear someone confess a serious transgression.
Paradox	Openly flout a social convention in the presence of someone trying to enforce it.
Serpent	Praise and extol the virtues of Set for at least 10 minutes to a receptive audience.

Powers of the Blood

The Curse placed on Cain marked him as an outsider but also gave him power beyond any mortal. His descendants share a small portion of his power.

Blood Buff

Vitae can invigorate the body, making a Cainite stronger than any living human (see the Blood Buff power for more details).

Disciplines

Vampires have learned to hone the raw power of their Vitae to vital tools known as [Disciplines](#).

Giving Vitae

A Vampire's Vitae has powerful effects on those who consume it. See the summary table, below.

See [Cutting, Bleeding, and Drinking Blood](#), for instructions to roleplay giving someone your blood.

How Much Vitae	Recipient	Effect
Any amount, fed directly or via Potion	Anyone	Create a one-step Blood Bond , or advance an existing Blood Bond to a full Full Blood Bond
At least 2 points, fed directly	Human	Create or maintain a Ghoul .
Any Amount, fed directly	Human who is Dying	Embrace. Congratulations, you have a Childe.

Bleeding Vampires

Unlike other characters who bleed when you cut them, a Vampire's Vitae doesn't leave their veins unless they will it to. The only exception is if another character forcibly takes their Vitae by drinking it from them.

Healing with Vitae

Anyone whose Energy type is not Vitae heals one Health for every point of Vitae they consume from a Vampire. Be careful when doing this, however, because consuming Vitae can have multiple other effects - see Giving Vitae above for more information.

Blood Bonds

Blood Bonds are a type of Burden created when another character drinks your Vitae repeatedly. See the description and rules for [Burdens](#) for more information. Blood Bonds are among the scariest and most potent tools at a Vampire's disposal.



Blood Bonds are formed after another character drinks at least 1 Vitae from you twice in the same event, with at least a 10-minute gap between feedings. You are often referred to as a Regent in this Blood Bond relationship, and they are called your thrall.

After the first time they drink your Vitae, the character experiences a significantly heightened emotional attachment to you (romantic, adoration, veneration, etc). This is commonly referred to as a "one-step Bond". The victim should roleplay having additional interest in your actions and location. They may even try to have chance meetings or take small actions to please you.

The second time they drink your Vitae, they become fully Blood Bound to you. A character may only be Blood Bound to one character at a time. Additional attempts to Blood Bond a character have no effect, but other types of Burdens can still be established (e.g. Entrancement) and temporarily overpower the Blood Bond.

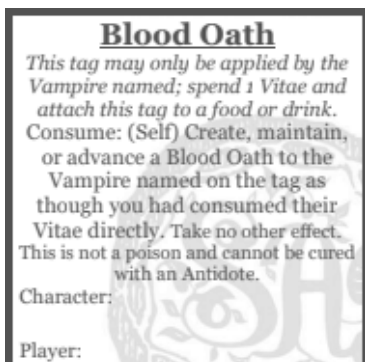
While fully Blood Bound, the victim experiences a deeper and more pervasive form of Burden, superseding the standard Burden effects with the following:

- You cannot resist any power used on you by the Regent.
- You cannot willingly harm your Regent, and you must make every effort to ensure your Regent does not come to harm.
- You have a deep respect and admiration for your Regent. You always see them in the best possible light. You overlook their negative qualities and always assume the best intentions.
- You will do whatever you think is in the best interests of your Regent, such as helping them further their goals, fighting their enemies, aiding their friends, telling them information that could help them, etc.

The character remains Blood Bound to you until they play through an entire event without drinking any more of your Vitae. In-game, it takes a few months for a Blood Bond to completely fade.

When making or maintaining Blood Bonds, you may give your Vitae to the target directly, or use a Blood Bond potion tag affixed to a food or drink that the target consumes.

Only one Blood Bond tag may be placed on a single food or drink, at the cost of a point of Vitae. Blood Bond tags are available at Check-In for any Vampire to take for free.



Blood Bond Roleplay Tips

While a Blood Bond creates a powerful emotional hold over your character, it is **not** mind control. You are still free to think and act as your character would, with the additional motivation that you now have another character who you care deeply about. You must act in your Regent's "best interests", but how you understand their best interests may differ from how they understand them, and may even conflict with direct instructions you receive from them.

Creating Ghouls

Giving a mortal your Vitae also imbues them with a small portion of your power. These Vitae-strengthened humans are called Ghouls, and are often employed by Vampire as more effective servants.

Any Human who consumes 2 or more Vitae from a Vampire within a 10-minute period will become a Ghoul. You may read the [Ghoul](#) section for more information.

Ghouls are not automatically Blood Bonded to the Vampire who made them - just like anyone else, becoming Blood Bonded requires them to drink your Vitae twice, at least 10 minutes apart.

Maintaining Ghouls

Ghouls do not generate their own Vitae, and must be replenished with Vitae from time to time, usually by consuming it from a Vampire. Ghouls must receive at least 2 points of Vitae directly from a Vampire at a single feeding each event or their Ghoul subfaction becomes dormant.

Embrace

New Vampires are created when you give any amount of Vitae to a Human while they are Dying. They must be fed at least 1 Vitae directly from a Vampire, while they are in the Dying state, and they must be Human. 13th Generation Vampires cannot Embrace.

If you are the target of an Embrace, you can choose whether to accept the change or to continue dying (and eventually become Dead). You can arise as a Vampire any time between the Vitae touching your lips and the precise moment you would become fully Dead. If you choose to accept the change, while your character 'dies' and is no longer alive for relevant mechanics, you return with 1 Health, 1 Max Health and as much Vitae as you were just given as part of your Embrace.

When you are Embraced, you are yanked back from the edge of death and reawakened as something no longer human. This period of Becoming can be peaceful or traumatic, depending on the preparation you've had, and you can roleplay it as you see fit. See the [Vampire Player's Guide](#) for more information.

After you are done roleplaying your Embrace, go to ST camp to have your sheet updated. See [Changing Factions - Vampires](#) in the Character Progression section.

Vampires and the Shallowing

Vampires in the universe of this game usually can't go out during the day, sleep, or eat food. *However*, our players certainly need to do those things, and we don't want to make them go OOG all the time to take care of themselves because that's no fun. Therefore, we have a plot device called **the Shallowing**: a conjunction of potent magical forces in the area around the town that causes the Vampire curse to work a little differently. Thus, Vampires in our town can eat, sleep, and drink as normal.

Curses of the Blood

Some Cainites try to ignore the uncomfortable fact that they exist partly to do penance for Cain's awful crime. These curses remind them.

Unhealed

Though healed through their own Regeneration and by magical healing, Vampires **cannot** be healed with the Medicine skill.

Sunsickness

While sunlight is usually repulsive to Vampires, Vampires in the Shallowing discover that their curse is significantly altered. They are not forced into deathly slumber during daylight hours, and can even walk uncovered in the sunlight with only minor discomfort. However, any Vampire who chooses to expose themselves to the sun's touch finds themselves Sunsick - detached from their undead strength and unable to wield any of the power of their blood. Some flock to the Shallowing to experience Sunsickness for themselves, as a novelty to break up the tedium of immortality, a spiritual experience, or a tonic. Others consider Sunsickness to be a weakness, uncomfortable, or downright distasteful to the very idea of being a Cainite.



Sunsickness causes characters who are exposed to the sun for more than 10 seconds to be unable to spend Energy or activate Powers for any reason until they have spent 10 minutes out of the sun, either covered with garb or inside a building. This includes spending Energy for giving blood, blood bonds, embraces, blood buffing, and Regeneration, as well as initiating Paralyzing Bite or Draining. Passive Powers are unaffected. Sunsickness affects characters whether they are in the Realm or the Umbra.

Sunsickness can cause a Cainite to feel drowsy, sluggish, and dull; or contented, pensive, and relaxed, depending on their frame of mind. Either way, the light of the sun itches and feels strange on undead skin.

Sun exposure is any natural light outside of a building between dawn and dusk. Standing in the shade or clouds does not protect from Sunsickness. Light from windows while inside buildings does not cause Sunsickness. To be protected from the sun while outside of buildings, Vampire players need to wear garb that covers their skin, including arms, legs, torso, hands to the fingers (long sleeves or gloves; fingerless gloves are fine), and head (with a hat or head covering that covers most of their head).

Travel Outside the Shallowing

Vampire characters are unable to travel outside the boundaries of the Shallowing during daylight hours without falling into torpor or being severely burned by the sun. STs have discretion over the boundaries of the Shallowing, but generally the Shallowing may extend a little ways from Arthorne but not as far as any surrounding cities.

Vampire players who wish to interact with the world outside of the Shallowing should send a trusted ally or wait until dusk to travel there themselves. Players should note that Cainites outside the Shallowing are likely to be in torpor during the day, so they can only be interacted with through their servants, ghouls, or other emissaries until night falls.

Stake in The Heart

Though wooden stakes are disruptive to most people's hearts, the vampiric curse responds uniquely to this wound. Stakes lodged in a Cainite's heart paralyzes them and halts their Vitae from flowing.

To stake a Vampire, hold a stake prop or blunted wooden stick to the target's chest as you roleplay hammering it in with large slow swinging motions for 10 continuous seconds, calling "Staking 1, Staking 2"... etc. Do not actually strike the stake prop.

The count can be disrupted by the target touching the stake, or any other means of Interruption. Staking counts as an attack for the purpose of disrupting other effects. Heavy armor protects the wearer from being staked. If you are wearing heavy armor, or have a Misplaced Heart, or no heart, call "No Effect" to a stake to your heart.

Once you complete a staking, say "Staking 10." If the target is not a Vampire, they will immediately take 10 damage. A staked Vampire will instead be Immobilized - meaning that they are still conscious and able to Regenerate, but are unable to take any other actions.

The target's player should hold the stake in place with one arm. They remain staked until the stake is removed or after 1 hour if they're left alone (because being Immobilized all game is no fun).

Clan Curses

Each lineage of Cainites suffer from echoes in their blood left by the misdeeds of their predecessors. These curses are generally loosely held secrets, and some can be transferred through the teaching of their blood disciplines.



Cainite Clans

Over generations, the lineage of Cain diverged into numerous bloodlines, the most prominent of which became the **Clans**. Each Clan has unique politics, traditions, powers, and prejudice

ASSAMITE

Proud and deadly, Assamites live by a strict personal code. Assamites consider themselves judges and guardians of the night.

Clan Curse: Drinking blood from a Vampire afflicts you with a condition that causes you to crave more of the target's blood: "Craving: <Target>'s Blood".

Disciplines: [Celerity](#), [Obfuscate](#), and [Quietus](#)

BAALI

Demon worshipers who perform deeds of depravity and horror, Baali have no regard for Humanity.

Clan Curse: You are <Holy> Scorched. Holy Water causes 1 point of Aggravated damage if consumed. While standing on Holy Ground or touching a Holy Symbol, you take <Holy> Scorched [Exposure](#) damage.

Disciplines: [Daimoinon](#), [Presence](#), and [Obfuscate](#)

BRUJAH

Made up of crusaders and philosophers, Brujah is a fiery Clan known for zeal and quick tempers.

Clan Curse: Cannot resist Frenzy through any means.

Disciplines: [Celerity](#), [Potence](#), and [Presence](#)

CAITIFF

Of unknown origin, Caitiff are looked down upon as having weak blood and are rarely welcomed in any court.

Clan Curse: Cannot start lower than 10th generation.

Disciplines: Pick three between [Animalism](#), [Auspex](#), [Celerity](#), [Dominate](#), [Fortitude](#), [Obfuscate](#), [Potence](#), and [Presence](#)

CAPPADOCIAN

Mystics and scholars, the Cappadocians are both feared and respected as they remain aloof from the intrigues of other high Clans, choosing quiet contemplation of the greatest mystery: death.

Clan Curse: You must wear dead-looking (e.g. pale, waxy) makeup on your entire face, as a makeup requirement.

Disciplines: [Auspex](#), [Fortitude](#), and [Mortis](#)

GANGREL

Inconsistent and indomitable, the Gangrel reject the chains of lord and vassal, Sire and Childe, choosing instead to roam the night free.

Clan Curse: Each time you lose Virtue to enter a [Frenzy](#), add a permanent animal feature as a makeup requirement.

Animal Mask: Select a predatory animal mask for your mask powers. Once you make this selection, you cannot change it. The most common animal mask for a Gangrel is a wolf mask; other animals should be considered rare or unusual.

Disciplines: [Animalism](#), [Fortitude](#), and [Protean](#)

GIOVANNI (Cappadocian Bloodline)

Concerned with wealth and power, this insular family of mages joined the fold of Cappadocians because of their powers over the dead.

Clan Curse: You must wear dead-looking (e.g. pale, waxy) makeup on your entire face, as a makeup requirement.

Disciplines: [Dominate](#), [Necromancy](#), and [Potence](#)

LAMIA (Cappadocian Bloodline)

These mainly-female followers of the Dark Mother are more physical and sensual than their studious parent Clan; they are great warriors and bolster the defenses of the Cappadocians.

Clan Curse: You have [Venomous Bite](#) as a Fundamental Power.

Disciplines: [Deimos](#), [Fortitude](#), and [Potence](#)

LASOMBRA

The kings of the shadows, Lasombra are among the Vampires' most skilled manipulators.

Clan Curse: Each time you see your reflection in a mirror, you must stare at it for 10 seconds, doing nothing else unless attacked.

Disciplines: [Dominate](#), [Obtenebration](#), and [Potence](#)

MALKAVIAN

Cursed by insight and madness, the Malkavian are damned to see the world as a shattered mosaic.

Clan Curse: Choose at least one [Derangement](#) at character creation.

Disciplines: [Auspex](#), [Dementation](#), and [Obfuscate](#)

NOSFERATU

Transformed into hideous creatures by the embrace, the Nosferatu are a tight-knit and formidable Clan.

Clan Curse: You have mottled or otherwise disfigured skin as a makeup requirement.

Disciplines: [Animalism](#), [Obfuscate](#), and [Potence](#)

RAVNOS

Confidence artists, negotiators, racketeers, spies, performers, emissaries, rogues, and wayfarers, the Ravnos make an impression anywhere they go.

Clan Curse: When you encounter something puzzling or confounding such as a riddle or a puzzle, you must engage with it and do nothing else for at least 60 seconds or until you solve it, unless you are attacked.

Disciplines: [Celerity](#), [Obfuscate](#), and [Presence](#)

SALUBRI

Once revered as healers and teachers, the few remaining Salubri are constantly on the run and live their nights in hiding, fearful to trust, desperate, or angry. Some still pursue Golconda, while others hunt the Tremere in vengeance.

Clan Curse: Feeding on an unwilling Human causes you 1 damage per Health drained. You also must wear a third eye in the middle of your forehead as a makeup requirement.

Disciplines: [Auspex](#), [Fortitude](#), and either [Valeren Healer](#) or [Valeren Warrior](#)

TOREADOR

Patrons of poets and muses, Toreador cultivate and curate beauty as suits their individual tastes.

Clan Curse: Each time you see something you deem beautiful, you must stare at it doing nothing else for 10 seconds unless attacked.

Disciplines: [Auspex](#), [Celerity](#), and [Presence](#)

TREMERE

The Tremere are mages who took the powers of Vampirism by force. Their unique powers make them useful in more and more courts.

Clan Curse: When you drink blood directly from a Vampire, you take the condition “Craving: Diablerize <Target>” unless you spend 1 Willpower to resist it.

Disciplines: [Auspex](#), [Dominate](#), and [Thaumaturgy: Rego Vitae](#)

Advantage: You may learn [Thaumaturgy: Creo Ignem](#) and [Thaumaturgy: Rego Aquam](#) without a teacher if you have Rego Vitae at level 3, and may teach those trees if you have them at level 3.

TZIMISCE

The Tzimisce revel in their inhumanity and rule over a frightened population as dreaded voivodes, seeking perfection of their physical forms far from the norms of humanity.

Clan Curse: You must have one of your tagged dirt pouches on your person in order to activate powers from disciplines. You get two new dirt tags at each Check-In.

Disciplines: [Animalism](#), [Auspex](#), and [Vicissitude](#)

VENTRUE

Leaders, politicians, and businesspeople, the Ventrue are slowly rising to challenge the Lasombra dominance of the medieval night.

Clan Curse: You can only feed from a select group of people. This could be determined by gender, hair color, religion, or any other obvious trait that comprises around half or less of the game population.

Disciplines: [Dominate](#), [Fortitude](#), and [Presence](#)



Cainite Disciplines

Different Clans of Cainite utilize their Vitae in unique and powerful ways. These are called Disciplines and are represented in-game by power trees. Your Clan determines your innate trees, and others must be taught to you.

Key

M	Mental	Ma	Mask
T	Touch	P	Passive
St	Status	D	Damage
Sn	Sensory	O	Other
Sf	Self	C	Condition

Click on a power to be taken to its writeup.

Common Disciplines

These disciplines are specialties of multiple Clans, and therefore aren't particularly secret. Training can usually be arranged for the appropriate price.

ANIMALISM

1	Beast Mind (M)
2	Disquiet (M), Induce Frenzy (T)
3	Frenzy Control (Sf)

AUSPEX

1	Sense Amaranth (Sn), Sense Emotion (Sn), Sense Item (Sn), Sense Vitae (Sn)
2	Telepathy (O)
3	Cloak Sight (P)

CELERITY

1	Disarm (D)
2	Avoidance (Sf)
3	Hasty Escape (Sf)

DOMINATE

1	Forgetful Mind (T)
2	Obedience (M)
3	Conditioning (O)

FORTITUDE

1	Endure (P), Withstand (Sf)
2	Resilience (Sf)
3	Toughness (P)

OBFUSCATE

1	Cloak (Sf)
2	Mask of a Thousand Faces (Ma)
3	Cloak Gathering (T)

POTENCE

1	Shatter (O)
2	Might (P)
3	Brutal Strike (D)

PRESENCE

1	Snarl (M)
2	Entrancement (M)
3	Majesty (M)

Clan Disciplines

These disciplines are the closely-guarded knowledge of the Clans that developed them. They are rarely taught to outsiders, and never without good reason. Of course, not all outsiders who know these disciplines were *taught*...

DAIMOINON (Baali)

Gaining a power in the Daimoinon tree causes your character to become **Permatainted**. When you gain any power in this tree, you also gain the Baali Clan Weakness.

1	Sense Desire (Sn)
2	Hellborn Investiture (P)
3	Balefire (D)

DEIMOS (Lamia)

When you gain any power in the Deimos tree, you gain the Lamia bloodline Weakness.

1	Black Ichor (O)
2	Dreamshape (TC)
3	Ranged 4 <Bile> (D)

DEMENTATION (Malkavian)

When you gain any power in the Dementation tree, you must select at least one [Derangement](#), unless you already have a Derangement from being Malkavian.

1	Confusion (M)
2	Visions (O)
3	Derange (M), Passion (M)

MORTIS (Cappadocian)

- 1 [Wither](#) (St)
- 2 [Meld <Earth>](#) (O)
- 3 [Decay](#) (D)

NECROMANCY (Giovanni)

- 1 [Insight](#) (T)
- 2 [Umbra Sight](#) (P)
- 3 [Umbra Drain](#) (P)

OBTENEBRATION (Lasombra)

- 1 [Root](#) (St), [Tentacles](#) (Sf)
- 2 [Terror](#) (M)
- 3 [Form of Vapor](#) (Ma)

PROTEAN (Gangrel)

- 1 [Clawed Form: Wolf Mask](#) (Ma), [Razor Claws](#) (D)
- 2 [Meld <Earth>](#) (Sf)
- 3 [Aggravated Claws](#) (D)

QUIETUS (Assamite)

- 1 [Silence](#) (St)
- 2 [Venom](#) (St)
- 3 [Daze](#) (T)

THAUMATURGY: CREO IGNEM (Tremere)

- 1 [Fire 2](#) (D)
- 2 [<Fire> Weapon](#) (D)
- 3 [Fire 4](#) (D)

THAUMATURGY: REGO AQUAM (Tremere)

- 1 [Silence](#) (St)
- 2 [Fabricate Armor](#) (O)
- 3 [Paralyze](#) (St)

THAUMATURGY: REGO VITAE (Tremere)

- 1 [Sense Vitae](#) (Sn), [Test Generation](#) (Sn),
[Test Blood Bond](#) (Sn)
- 2 [Ranged 2 <Blood>](#) (D)
- 3 [Aggravated 1](#) (D)

VALEREN HEALER (Salubri)

When you gain any power from the Valeren Healer tree, you gain a third eye as a makeup requirement. Your third eye must be visible in order to use any of the powers granted by this discipline.

- 1 [Healing Touch](#) (T)
- 2 [Serenity](#) (T)
- 3 [Revive](#) (T)

VALEREN WARRIOR (Salubri)

When you gain any discipline from the Valeren Warrior tree, you gain a third eye as a makeup requirement. Your third eye must be visible in order to use any of the powers granted by this discipline.

- 1 [Sense Health](#) (Sn), [Sense Maximum Health](#) (Sn),
[Sense Mental](#) (Sn)
- 2 [Body Wrack](#) (St)
- 3 [<Light> Weapon](#) (D), [Vengeance of Samiel](#) (P)

VICISSITUDE (Tzimisce)

- 1 [Weaponry](#) (O)
- 2 [Imitate](#) (Ma)
- 3 [Resilience](#) (Sf), [Powerful Form: Green and Black Spiked Mask](#) (Ma)

VISCERATIKA (Gargoyle)

This discipline can't be gained through Amaranth or learned.

- 1 [Cloak](#) (Sf), [Clawed Form](#) (Ma)
- 2 [Avoidance](#) (Sf)
- 3 [Powerful Form](#) (Ma), [Resilience](#) (Sf)

Dark Thaumaturgy

Dark Thaumaturgy trees are Corrupt trees that require you to be Tainted to use. Purchasing these trees at character creation requires Demon Lore.

These trees are dormant if you do not have a [Demon Patron](#).

PATH OF THE DEFILER

Gaining a power in the Path of the Defiler tree causes your character to become Permatainted.

1	Taint (P)
2	Derange (M)
3	Balefire (D)

REGO DOLOR (PATH OF PAIN)

1	Silence (St)
2	Body Wrack (St)
3	Horrid Reality (M)

REGO MANES (PATH OF SPIRIT)

Gaining a power in the Rego Manes tree causes your character to become Permatainted.

1	Scion of Evil (P), Sense Demon (Sn), Sense Spirit (Sn)
2	Umbra Sight (P)
3	Subjugate (M)

REGO PESTIS (PATH OF PESTILENCE)

1	Wither (St)
2	Venom (St)
3	Brittle Bones (St)

REGO PHOBOS (PATH OF FEAR)

1	Monsters (M)
2	Dreamshape (TC), Terror (M)
3	Leech of Fear (P)

Chapter 6: Wraiths



*Was it age? Illness? Perhaps a knife in the back?
Either way it's all come to an end, er, at least it was
supposed to. Wraith are those poor souls who could not
move on to find rest; instead you're tied to the world
and shall struggle against the pull of Oblivion until
you can come to terms with what ties you to the world.*

*The ghosts of mankind are still men; they suffer all
their faults of power and pride. The Kingdom of Iron is
a complex society built upon centuries of immortals
piecing together an empire the size of Europe. With a
united will its soldiers fight the enemies of Charon and
protect its citizens from the terrors of the Labyrinth.*

*You are in the golden age of Stygia. The Legions exist to
protect and serve while the Guilds thrive together as
expressions of their Arcanos' passionate practitioners.
Or at least that's what the kingdom sells you. Be
careful ye weary soul, for the end can come just as swift
the second time around.*

Basics

Wraiths have [Fetter Healing](#), [Portal Walk](#), [Sense Emotion](#), [Sense Living](#), [Sense Maximum Health](#), [Temporary Angst](#), and [Umbra Sight](#) as Fundamental powers.

Wraiths are Unliving.

Wraiths are Scorched by <Dark>. Wraiths are also Scorched by <Blood> and <Fire> while in the Realm.

Wraiths are Umbrabound.

Wraiths have a Regeneration Rate of 1.

Wraiths have an Energy cap of 20.

Energy: Pathos

Wraiths are beings of pure emotion, who feed on the emotions of those who are still living (...or living enough). Specifically, they feed on the emotions that align with their Passions (see below).

Wraiths use Harvesting to regain Pathos. To Harvest Pathos, a Wraith must use Sense Emotion on a non-Wraith target in the Realm. If the target responds with an emotion that is in line with one of the Wraith's Passions, the Wraith may then call "Harvesting" and begin a (silent) 60 second count after which the Wraith gains 1 Pathos. The Wraith may continue Harvesting 1 Pathos every 60 seconds until their Energy pool is full or the Wraith and their target are more than 10 feet apart. At the end of a Harvest, the Wraith calls "End Harvesting". If at any time during a harvest the target's emotional state changes, the target may also call "End Harvesting" (If the target is a Wraith, they should immediately respond "No Effect" to Harvesting attempts).. The Wraith may attempt a new Harvest after another call of Sense Emotion. At the end of a Harvest, the target may roleplay having less of the harvested emotion.

You may also replenish Pathos at [Haunts](#).

If you ever reach 0 Pathos, you enter [Catharsis](#) unless you spend a Willpower to resist doing so.

Teaching and Learning

You have three Innate trees, which you can teach. You can be taught any other Arcanoi.

Passions

Passions are the types of emotion that fuel a Wraith. You pick two for your Wraith at character creation, and can Harvest from those who are experiencing emotions related to one of your Passions. While the categories are quite broad, you're welcome to roleplay being drawn to particular "flavors" of that Passion more than others (e.g. hotblooded fury appeals to you more than the emotions of someone stewing in bitterness).

Passion Options

Passion	Example Emotions
Anger	Fury, revenge, animosity, etc.
Fear	Terror, panic, cowardice, anxiety, etc.
Hate	Spite, jealousy, loathing, disgust, etc.
Love	Friendship, romance, affection, etc.
Pain	Suffering, depression, sorrow, guilt, etc.
Pleasure	Joy, excitement, comfort, etc.

Fetters

Fetters are powerful physical objects that tie a Wraith to their continued existence and allow them to impact the Realm.

You cannot use any powers that interact with the Realm until you have touched one of your Fetters each event.

Your Fetters should be something that you have a strong emotional connection to, such as family heirlooms, sentimental objects, the weapon used to kill you, or even a piece of your own dead body. Other characters (except Wraiths) can also be Person Fetters. Person Fetters should carry the Fetter tag with their character sheet. Characters can be Fetters for multiple Wraiths. If the Person Fetter becomes Dead, the Fetter is destroyed (even if the character comes back later, e.g. as a Wraith).

If either player is uncomfortable with the other for OOG reasons, they may request an exemption from Safety Team or XO. If the request is granted the XOs will make sure both parties are aware.

You can touch your Fetter from either the Umbra or the Realm. It is extremely difficult for Wraiths to move their own Fetters: whether in the Umbra or the Realm, Wraiths can only carry their Fetters visibly with both hands. **Any** conscious character in the Umbra carrying at least one Fetter takes Aggravated [Exposure](#) damage. A character does

not take this damage simply by being a Fetter themselves.

You cannot attack someone who is carrying or holding your Fetter. They should state “Fetter, no effect” (although you might need to remind them – they may not know the rule, or realize they have your Fetter). The Fetter must be prominently displayed to make use of this.

Fetters can be destroyed just like any other in-game item, or through the power Fetter Consumption. When a Wraith is presented with their destroyed Fetter tag (in-game or OOG), they immediately take 4 counts of Aggravated damage that cannot be resisted (i.e. you lose 4 Max Health). If presented OOG, the Wraith gains no IG information as to who or what destroyed their Fetter. If all your Fetters are destroyed, you are not able to do anything that interacts with the Realm.

A Wraith may choose to “resolve” one of their own Fetters at any time not in Catharsis by simply removing the tag and destroying it. Resolving your own Fetter does not cause you to take Aggravated damage. Speak with CGs if you are unsure of how and why this would be appropriate.

If a Wraith is Forged or Devoured, after they have had their sheet changed, they must find their fetters and remove their tags OOG. Other tags found later, as well as fetters that are or are held by players not at game, must have their fetter tags destroyed.

Eating and Drinking

While Wraiths typically need specific powers to interact with the Realm, an exception is made for food and drink so that *players* are able to stay comfortable and well fed. The same logic applies to anything else that’s in the Realm that a Wraith player needs to pick up for player wellbeing reasons (e.g. you dropped your cloak, but it’s not a relic item).

Deathsight

As a Wraith, you can see the death and decay - the Oblivion - in all things.

See the [Sense Living](#) and [Sense Maximum Health](#) power for more information.



Healing

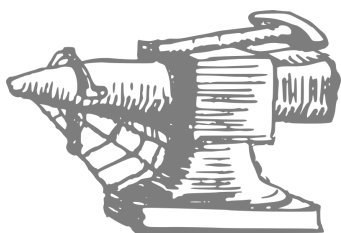
Wraith have a Regeneration Rate of 1 by default, and they gain +1 to their Regeneration Rate when touching a Fetter that belongs to them (doesn't stack for multiple Fetters; see the Fetter Healing power).

Though healed through their own Regeneration and by magical healing, Wraith cannot be healed with the Medicine skill.

Ways to Meet Your End

Forging

The horrifying secret of Oboli is that they are the condensed bodies of what was formerly a Wraith. You can turn another Wraith into a coin



provided you have the ritual and tools to do so, and are at the right location for Forging. See the "Mint Obolus" ritual for more information. Forging is a way for a Wraith character to fully be killed.

Devouring

Some Wraiths are able to absorb another Wraith into themselves, effectively ending their existence.

See the [Devour](#) power for more details.

For roleplay purposes, when you Devour a Wraith you have consumed their soul. You have destroyed another Wraith, but you've also prevented them

from falling to Oblivion - you get to live with that moral ambiguity. It is rumored that those devoured live on, affecting the mannerisms and personality of their assailant.

Harrowing

When a Wraith has 0 Maximum Health or has been Incapacitated for 10 minutes, instead of entering the Dying state, they enter a **Harrowing**. A Harrowing is an intense personal conflict between a Wraith and their Shadow within the Labyrinth, deep in the Tempest.

Upon entering a Harrowing, report to ST Camp (taking all your stuff with you). You must remain OOG for a minimum of one hour, either by NPCing or spending time in an OOG area. If returning in the same event, you must remain OOG until you can locate one of your Fetters. If you find a Fetter, you may then re-enter play with your Willpower, Max Health, and Pathos pools missing points equal to your Angst rating (e.g. if your character's max Willpower is 6 and their Angst is 4, you return with 2 current Willpower and may regain the remaining points during play). Upon going back into game (or at the end of the event if you don't go back into game) you gain 2 Angst. If you cannot find a Fetter within 1 hour, then all Fetters are assumed to be missing, and you cannot return during this event. In this circumstance, you may play a backup character or NPC for the rest of the event.

If the character returns as a Specter, you return with full Willpower, full Health, and full Pathos (including any gained upon becoming a Specter). You also gain access to a new power as dictated by your Shadow's **Thorn**.

If a Specter has 0 Maximum Health or has been Incapacitated for 10 minutes, they enter a Dying state and become Dead after another 10 minutes, per normal rules.

Wraith Society

Wraith society is multifaceted and complex. See the [Wraith Player's Guide](#) or talk to a Character Guide for more information. These specific aspects are discussed here because they relate to mechanical aspects of the rules.

Caul

Brand new Wraiths often first appear with a **Caul** that obscures their consciousness and dulls their personality. There are political implications for the first person to remove a new Wraith's Caul. See the Wraith Player's Guide for more information on Cauls. Players of new Wraith Characters can choose whether or not to begin Caulead, although it's recommended to do so if you are converting a character who has died into a Wraith; Wraiths with exceptionally high Willpower are sometimes able to remove their own cauls. While Caulead, a Wraith cannot use any powers, but can be injured and forced to Harrow.

A Wraith or character with Wraith Lore can remove the Caul. This is referred to as Uncauling or Reaping. The process requires 10 seconds of roleplay removing the covering from the target character's face/head while they are both in the Umbra with a slow count of Uncauling 1, Uncauling 2, ... Uncauling 10. At the end of the count, remove the Caul.

A Wraith, in rare circumstances, can remove their own Caul. Doing so requires accepting one's own death without any assistance, as well as a strong sense of self. A Caulead Wraith with at least 5 Willpower can choose to spend 1 Willpower to remove their own Caul.

Currency

Wraiths commonly trade Oboli (singular: Obolus) as currency. Oboli are represented in-game by 6" wide plastic disks that glow faintly. Oboli can be subdivided into four pieces, called Bits. Oboli are a raw material that is often used when creating

useful items like swords and armor, and are therefore very valuable.

Death Marks

The manner of your death may have left a trace on your undead form. You can choose to have a Death Mark as a makeup requirement.

Legions

Legions are political organizations within Wraith society. Wraiths are recruited to Legions based on the circumstances of their deaths, although determining which one they belong to can be subjective. Your Legion is an important roleplay aspect of your character, but doesn't have a mechanical effect. New Characters default to a Legion. They put the Legion which matches their deathmarks and backstory. This can be changed with one of a few Rituals.

The Iron Legion: comprised of victims of Age

The Skeletal Legion: claiming those taken by Sickness and Disease

The Grim Legion: claiming the victims of Violence

The Penitent Legion: claiming victims of Madness

The Emerald Legion: for victims of Happenstance

The Silent Legion: for victims of Despair

The Legion of Paupers: comprised of victims of Mystery and whomever the Beggar Lord can get away with

The Legion of Fate: consisting of those chosen by Fate. PCs cannot start as members of this Legion.

A character can refuse to be in a Legion. This makes them a Heretic or a Renegade. Heretics are those faithful who die and refuse to reject their Gods and practices, while Renegades reject the political power of the Hierarchy and are hunted ruthlessly by the powers that be. You can read more about Heretics and Renegades in the [Wraith Player's Guide](#).

Guilds

Guilds are another dimension that Wraith society is organized around. Guilds are specialists in certain Arcanoi and often carry out specific jobs. You may choose to have one of the Guilds as a subfaction at character creation, and may change it with appropriate roleplay and ST approval during game. If you do not choose a Guild at character creation, you may join one through RP with ST approval. The name of each Guild can be found next to their respective [Arcanoi](#), though knowing said Arcanoi is not a mechanical requirement for joining the Guild.

See the [Wraith Player's Guide](#) for more information about Guilds.

The Psyche and the Shadow

Shadows

New Wraiths are quickly made aware that their consciousness has been fractured. The Psyche is the part of a Wraith's personality that is the echo of what they were like in life. The Shadow is a sliver of Oblivion that attempts to wear the Psyche down and convince the Wraith to accept the inevitability of Oblivion, ideally pulling others there with them.

You play your Shadow when you are in Catharsis or if you become a Specter. Your Shadow Archetype (see below) determines your exact approach, but every Shadow's goal is the same: drive the Wraith, and all those around them, to the all-consuming darkness of Oblivion.

Even while your Psyche is in control, your Shadow is still present and acting on you. Depending on their relationship, the Shadow might be a subtle and manipulative influence trying to escape notice while wearing you down, or it might be an entirely distinct entity with its own name and a clear "voice" in your head screaming at you to do horrible things. Having a Shadow is a definite roleplaying challenge: you are simultaneously playing your character and their own worst enemy.

Player Wellbeing

More so than other factions, "Wraith Game" can be emotionally intense and exhausting. Wraith players tend to revel in the challenge. However, you are encouraged to do what you need to do to take care of yourself, whether that's pausing a scene that's getting to be too much, going OOG to take a break, or going to NPC for a bit to clear your head.

Virtue: Angst

A Wraith's Virtue type is **Angst**. Angst represents the potency of your Shadow and its sway over your thoughts and actions. Unlike other factions, Wraiths seek to keep their Virtue low.



Wraiths gain Angst when they:

- Harrow (gaining 2 Angst)
- Voluntarily enter Catharsis
- Devour another Wraith
- Are Tainted and choose to gain Angst instead of spending Willpower

When you reach **10 Angst**, you become a [Specter](#).

Catharsis

Catharsis is a period of time when your Shadow briefly has full control of your mind, body, and Powers. Catharsis lasts at least 10 minutes; after 10 minutes you can have your Psyche regain control whenever it's thematically appropriate. During Catharsis, your Shadow can use any Dark Arcanoi they have access to.

You enter Catharsis when:

- You choose to enter Catharsis voluntarily, by gaining 1 Angst
- You're targeted by the power Induce Catharsis and you don't resist
- You have 0 Pathos and you don't spend a Willpower to resist going into Catharsis

After leaving Catharsis, you may not be aware of what your Shadow has been doing, or you may be forced to relive each moment of the Catharsis in agonizing detail. It's up to your Shadow to decide how to torment you. However, if you choose for your Psyche not to know something, that doesn't mean it's erased from your character memory; truth telling powers like Hypnotism can still compel you to reveal your memories.

Spontaneous Taint

Even if you don't fully enter Catharsis, your Shadow can sometimes get very near to taking control. To represent this, you can become **Tainted** any time you choose (but you can't *untaint* yourself voluntarily); see the Temporary Angst power.

Thorns

When a Wraith's Shadow takes control, whether by Catharsis or the Wraith becoming a Specter, they gain access to an extra power called a Thorn. When selecting a Shadow archetype you choose which option will best fit your Shadow. Record your Thorn on your character sheet. You may only use your Thorn power while the Shadow is in control, paying the usual cost.

When you become a Specter, you gain permanent access to your Thorn power. You also get to use both Thorn options for your Shadow archetype.

Specters

Specters are Wraiths with 10 Angst. They have completely fallen to their Shadows, and can never have their Angst lowered again. Specters can use any Dark Arcanoi they have, and have access to the powers from both Thorn options of their Shadow Archetype.

You become a Specter immediately when you hit 10 Angst. Some unfortunates return in death already at 10 Angst.

Specters who do not have Fetters in the Shallowing can still affect the Realm so long as they are Tainted. This can be done via [Temporary Angst](#).

When a Wraith reaches Angst 10 in the Shallowing they must retrieve Tainted Fetter tags for each of their item Fetters while at ST Camp or at Check In (depending on if they become a Specter during game or via self-nerfing at Check In). Before entering game they must find each of their item fetters OOG and add a Tainted Fetter tag to them. Any fetter they cannot find, including those not at game, are considered resolved. Other players who are or have those fetters must be told to destroy the fetter tags

Shadow Archetypes

Your Shadow Archetype is the general template for how your Shadow tries to sabotage you. Your Archetype also determines what Thorn you have when entering [Catharsis](#) (you get to use both Thorns if you are a Specter). Examples for the types of ways your Shadow might act are provided in the description of each Archetype, but you're encouraged to develop your Shadow's personality and tactics to be unique to them.

ABUSER

This Shadow represents the battered "inner child" who has come full circle, grown up out of their terrible beginnings to inflict more pain on others. When dominant, this Shadow uses their power to abuse others or their Psyche.

Examples of RP: violently lashing out, demanding servitude, methodically inflicting pain and suffering.

Thorn Options: [Brutal Strike](#), [Body Wrack](#)

BETRAYER

This Shadow takes perverse pleasure in wrecking the Psyche's relationships with others. The Betrayer can be patient and may take years to spin a long scheme that destroys trust at the worst possible moment.

Examples of RP: Sharing secrets with people who you know shouldn't have them, attacking the Psyche's allies during a fight.

Thorn Options: [Despair](#), [Silver Tongue](#)

DELUSIONAL

The Delusional Shadow will try to unmoor you from reality by making you question everything around you. Why are people talking to the air? Did no one hear that very loud noise? How do you know what to believe? Can you trust your senses or your instincts? If nothing can be trusted, you're more likely to listen to what your Shadow tells you.

Examples of RP: Questioning everything, being stubborn about beliefs.

Thorn Options: [Derange <Delusional*>](#), [Horrid Reality](#)
*While your Shadow is in control, you have the Delusional derangement

DIRECTOR

This Shadow plays the long game and attempts to manipulate people like pieces on a chessboard. A Director Shadow has a great plan, which usually involves a descent into Oblivion while doing great harm to everyone the Psyche ever loved. While in Catharsis, do whatever is necessary to further your Shadow's plans.

Examples of RP: Threatening, coercing, blackmailing, doing whatever you can to convince others to complete your goals, making allies who will help your schemes, being bossy.

Thorn Options: [Smell Fear](#), [Taunt](#)

EXHIBITOR

The Exhibitor seeks to find out everyone's weaknesses, deepest desires, and darkest secrets and expose them all. The Shadow's goal is to embarrass and humiliate, pushing the Psyche into doing things it ordinarily would not do, creating situations where weaknesses are exposed, or divulging what was supposed to be secret information. So what if everything wasn't exactly true? The show was worth it.

Examples of RP: Publicly accusing another character for a taboo act, writing a harmful rumor on a blackboard, exposing secrets.

Thorn Options: [Sense Confidence](#), [True Form](#)

IMPULSIVE

The Impulsive Shadow tells you that there is no need to think about the risks or possible consequences. Don't just think about doing something, go do it. What could possibly go wrong?

Examples of RP: Stealing, trading for things even if you wouldn't normally, saying the first thing that comes to mind during conversations.

Thorn Options: [Decay](#), [Mimic <Pathos>](#)

INQUISITOR

Everyone has something to hide, and the Inquisitor aims to uncover it all by any means necessary. If trickery, coercion, and threats don't work then perhaps pain will do the trick. The Inquisitor is not afraid to make things public, especially when someone is hesitant to admit to the things they are "guilty" of. Once this information is acquired, the Shadow attempts to weaponize it to drive others toward Oblivion.

Examples of RP: Torturing characters to garner information and secrets from them, orchestrating a "witch-hunt" to find out how your target reacts to such a thing.

Thorn Options: [True Form](#), [Wounding Lies](#)

MARTYR

The Martyr encourages the Psyche to give of itself. Not out of nobility though, but because it is able to take pain better. And when it is done and over with, the Martyr will point out how fruitless it all was. It slowly undermines the meaning of giving of oneself. When in control, it tries to maneuver the Psyche into situations in which it will have to give something up no matter what.

Examples of RP: Never retreating from a fight, offering to pay for things when you don't have the money, taking on responsibilities that you can't fully bear.

Thorn Options: [Hero's Stand](#), [Mass Taunt](#)

MONSTER

The monster is a foul and unknowable thing. Of all the Shadows, the Monster most favors direct destruction, lashing out at everything around it. The Monster does not act mindlessly, but its motivations are usually opaque. While in Catharsis, this Shadow might try to physically harm as many people around it as possible, or pick a singular victim and see how much anguish they can cause them.

Examples of RP: Aggressive reactions when unnecessary, attacking people without much reason, speaking bluntly about sensitive topics.

Thorn Options: [Brittle Bones](#), [Frenzy Control](#)

PARANOID

The Paranoid is the Psyche's only friend, as everyone else is conspiring against the Wraith. Smiles and joyful greetings are merely facades to disguise their true feelings toward the Wraith. When in control, the Paranoid tries to enact vengeance for previous insults (real or not).

Examples of RP: Looking over your shoulder constantly, avoiding staying in the same place for too long, always assuming someone means you harm.

Thorn Options: [Cloak Gathering](#), [Meld <Outside/Sea of Shadows>](#)

PARENT

Overprotective, loving, and caring, this Shadow wants you to love only them and if you don't listen, they'll make you feel guilty for not listening. They know your dirty thoughts and vile secrets, but they still love you (though no one else could ever love such a monster). When in power, this Shadow openly seeks to "protect" other Wraiths and instill guilt for the things they've done. They will also attempt to destroy any and all relationships the Psyche has, because no one can love them more than their Shadow.

Examples of RP: Teaching other characters things about your Psyche that they will have issues with, pushing people through their trauma before they are ready.

Thorn Options: [Cloak Gathering](#), [<Tainted> Revive](#)

PESSIMIST

The Pessimist will continually bear bad news to the Psyche about any number of things, real or imagined. While in control, it does its best to dissuade the Wraith's companions from doing anything that might be beneficial to the Psyche. This Shadow's aim is to wear down the Psyche's resolve to resist the pull of Oblivion.

Examples of RP: Playing devil's advocate to the detriment to those around you, dismissing hopeful outcomes as impossible, fountering others' hopes and dreams.

Thorn Options: [Horrid Reality](#), [Paralyze](#)

RATIONALIST

This Shadow is the reasoning, thinking person's Shadow. They calmly discuss your situation with you, gently explaining why you should do what they want and offering totally logical reasons for doing so. They're not interested in openly lying to you. Instead, they riddle your mind with doubts – doubts that only they can allay. When in power, this Shadow creates conditions that prove their various postulates. They also “advise” other Wraiths, trying to trick them into “logical” behavior that serves their descent to Oblivion.

Examples of RP: Explaining why a beneficial action would be harmful in the long term, discussing how a harmful action would be helpful over time.

Thorn Options: [Majesty](#), [Sense Confidence](#)

TEACHER

The Teacher has seen it all, done it all, knows it all, and is willing to teach you too. Make sure you're ready to learn, because oftentimes anguish is the best instructor. Don't worry if the test feels impossible, the Teacher knows exactly how this will end.

Examples of RP: Instructing other characters in a way that may not actually benefit them in the long term, using unfortunate situations as punishing lessons without offering to assist in their resolution.

Thorn Options: [<Tainted> Healing Touch](#), [Terror](#)

THINKER

This Shadow is intellectual and emotionless, preferring to take time and think through all the possibilities before choosing to act. Snap decisions can ruin progress towards long-term goals, so it's better to avoid missteps. Everything around you will certainly wait for your decision, and freezing in a fast-paced situation never hurt anyone.

Examples of RP: Coming up with unnecessary contingencies and convincing others that they are necessary, freezing during a moment of importance, attempting to get others to consider the consequences of their actions prior to acting.

Thorn Options: [Frenzy Control](#), [Paralyze](#)

Arcanoi

Being Dead does have its perks. With millennia of study, Wraiths have developed diverse ways to utilize the power of Pathos to serve their own ends. Many Arcanoi are closely associated with Guilds, who develop and teach them. See the [Wraith Player's Guide](#) for more information.

Key

M	Mental	Ma	Mask
T	Touch	P	Passive
St	Status	D	Damage
Sn	Sensory	O	Other
Sf	Self	C	Condition

Click on a power to be taken to its writeup.

Core Arcanoi

ARGOS (*Harbingers*)

- 1 [Cloak](#) (Sf)
- 2 [Resilience](#) (Sf)
- 3 [Hasty Escape](#) (Sf)

CASTIGATE (*Pardoners*)

- 1 [Detect Taint](#) (Sn), [Sense Angst](#) (Sn), [Sense Shadow](#) (Sn)
- 2 [Disquiet](#) (M), [Shadow Coax](#) (T)
- 3 [Sanctuary](#) (M)

EMBODY (*Proctors*)

- 1 [Disembodied](#) (Sf)
- 2 [Appear](#) (Sf)
- 3 [Materialize](#) (Sf)

FATALISM (*Oracles*)

- 1 [Insight](#) (T), [Sense Pathos](#) (Sn)
- 2 [Visions](#) (O)
- 3 [Cloak Sight](#) (P)

FLUX (*Alchemists*)

- 1 [Move Object](#) (O), [Sense Item](#) (Sn)
- 2 [Shatter](#) (O), [Wither](#) (St)
- 3 [Ranged 4 \(Earth\)](#) (D)

KINESIS (Artificers)

1	Sense Item (Sn), Withstand (Sf)
2	Might (P)
3	<Dark> Weapon (D), Fabricate Armor (O)

INTIMATION (Solicitors)

1	Sense Desire (Sn)
2	Induce Sin (M)
3	Craving (TC)

KEENING (Chanteurs)

1	Passion (M)
2	Ranged 2 <Sonic> (D)
3	Conditioning (O)

LIFEWEB (Monitors)

1	Fetter Creation (T), Sense Fetter (Sn)
2	Detect Fetter (Sn), Fetter Consumption (T)
3	Disable (St)

MNEMOSYNIS (Mnemoi)

1	Forgetful Mind (T)
2	Telepathy (O)
3	Obedience (M)

MOLIATE (Masquers)

1	Weaponry (O)
2	Imitate (Ma), Mask of a Thousand Faces (Ma)
3	Resilience (Sf), Powerful Form (Ma)

OUTRAGE (Lifeliners)

1	Stonehand Punch (D)
2	Move Object (O), Realm Grasp (Sf)
3	Aggravated 1 (D)

PANDEMONIUM (Haunters)

1	Confusion (M)
2	Monsters (M)
3	Avoidance (Sf), Root (St)

PHANTASM (Sandmen)

1	Cognizance (P)
2	Dreamshape (TC), Hallucination (M)
3	Daze (T)

PUPPETRY (Puppeteers)

1	Control Voice (T)
2	Control Body (M)
3	Puppet Control (M)

USURY (Usurers)

1	Pathos Exchange (T), Paralyzing Touch (T)
2	Devour (T), Expel Corpus (Sf), Health Exchange (T)
3	Pathos Investment (O)

Dark Arcanoi

Dark Arcanoi are powers that a Wraith can only use when their Shadow is in control. Dark Arcanoi are not quite the same as **Corrupt** Powers, but they follow the same rules as Corrupt powers for the purpose of purchasing them.

The following powers can only be used by Specters or Wraiths that are in Catharsis. These trees cannot be taught or learned by Wraiths with less than 10 Angst unless they're in Catharsis.

CONTAMINATE

Gaining any power in the Contaminate tree causes your character to become **Permatainted** while their Shadow is in control.

1	Sense Fetter (Sn), Taint (P)
2	Rend the Lifeweb (O)
3	Induce Catharsis (T)

HIVE MIND

Gaining any power in the Hive Mind tree causes your character to become **Permatainted** while their Shadow is in control.

1	Detect Taint (Sn), Sense Angst (Sn), Sense Shadow (Sn)
2	Telepathy (O)
3	Subjugate (M)

LARCENY

1	Fast Healing (P)
2	Devour (T), Expel Corpus (Sf), Health Exchange (T), Paralyzing Touch (T)
3	Toughness (P)

MALEFICENCE

Gaining any power in the Maleficence tree causes your character to become **Permatainted** while their Shadow is in control.

1	Detect Taint (Sn), Scion of Evil (P)
2	<Tainted> Entrancement (M)
3	Hidden Taint (P), Secret Angst (Sf)

TEMPEST WEAVING

1	Cloak (Sf)
2	Meld <Outside/Sea of Shadows> (O)
3	Form of Vapor (Ma)



Chapter 7: Merits, Skills, and Powers

Merits

General Rules for Merits

Merits are additional perks that give unique flavor to your character. Each Merit can be purchased once, unless it explicitly says otherwise. Merits do not require a teacher, but you should have a solid story reason for why you've gained a new Merit.

Each character's first Merit costs 3 XP, except for Humans, whose first merit costs 0 XP. Each subsequent Merit costs 3 XP more than the last (so a Human's second merit costs 3 XP and a non-Human's costs 6 XP). If a Merit gets removed from your character sheet, it does not increase the cost of future Merits.

Adept

Each Check-In you may choose a single Production skill, except for Alchemy, to make an additional item with, provided you meet all requirements for crafting it. If you choose the Herbalism skill, you instead gain an additional Herbalism Point to make items with. If you choose not to use this merit, you gain 3 Copper.

Antiquarian

Your [Attunement](#) pool is increased by 4 points.

Averted Weakness (VAMPIRE ONLY)

You do not suffer the Weakness associated with your subfaction. Gargoyles, Cappadocians and Nosferatu cannot have this Merit. This does not affect Weaknesses gained from obtaining Disciplines.

Delirium (HUMAN ONLY)

If you witness something undeniably, unmistakably supernatural (such as a character wearing a Transformation Mask or sporting tentacles), you enter **Delirium**. Delirium is an altered Mental state that makes it easier to deny, discredit, or simply forget what you saw. You may choose to spend Willpower to resist Delirium for 10 minutes.

Immediately upon entering Delirium, you must choose to do one of the following:

- Lose your grip on reality, per the power Confusion.
- [Frenzy](#), choosing whether to fight or flee. You do not lose Virtue for this Frenzy.

After completing one of these actions, your character will have no memory of what they witnessed. They may have a vague recollection of being frightened or shocked but will not remember what caused them to feel this way.

You cannot purchase this merit if your character has previously had significant interactions with the supernatural (i.e. are "Unveiled"). You may choose to remove this Merit at Check-In if you feel it is no longer appropriate for your character. This Merit is lost if you are no longer a Human.

Commoners may take this Merit for free. This merit **does not increase the cost of future merits**, nor do other merits increase the cost of this one.

Doomslayer (WRAITH ONLY)

Choose a Dark Arcanoi tree; you may use this tree without being in Catharsis. At 10 Angst, your maximum Pathos pool is increased by 2. Characters with the Doomslayer merit are considered to have 10 Angst for the purpose of casting Rituals that require characters to have 10 Angst.

This Merit may be purchased multiple times.

Eidolon (WRAITH ONLY)

A Wraith's Shadow is a constant voice in one ear, whispering to bring them ever closer to Oblivion. You have a voice whispering in your other ear – a softer, kinder voice – one which gives you encouragement and brings you strength.

Your Eidolon helps you resist and overcome the destructive influence of your Shadow. With this merit, you may leave Catharsis after a minimum of 5 minutes instead of the usual 10.

Enhanced Blood Buff (VAMPIRE ONLY)

You gain the [Enhanced Blood Buff](#) power, which lets you spend 3 Energy to gain Augment 1 for 10 minutes (this doesn't stack with Blood Buff).

Escape Artist

You gain the [Escape](#) power, which lets you slip free of Restraints or being locked in a room after 60 Uninterrupted seconds of dedicated RP.

Font of Sustenance (GHOUL ONLY)

Once per event you may choose for your blood to be worth one additional Vitae per Health lost when fed upon by a Vampire.

If your Ghoul subfaction goes dormant, so does this Merit.

Hardy

You may resist any one Status each day by calling "Resist". This resistance refreshes at sunrise.

Healthy

Your Maximum Health is increased by two.

Herd (VAMPIRE ONLY)

This Merit represents having a source of Vitae outside of town. Once per event, you may leave game space for at least an hour and return with five additional Energy in your Energy pool, up to your maximum.

This merit may be purchased multiple times.

Multiple returns may be used together after one hour, or on separate trips out of game space. This merit can only be used at night. Players should consult with their CG about what this merit represents for their character and they should submit a downtime report to STs about who they are feeding on.

Hidden Amaranth (VAMPIRE ONLY)

You always answer the Sense Amaranth power with "Zero".

Hypnotist

You gain the [Hypnotism](#) power, which lets you force a target to answer your questions truthfully. The type of roleplay you use to activate Hypnotism may take the form of staring into the target's eyes, doing rhythmic motions, playing an instrument, or another activity appropriate to your character.

Income

You have a small income source from a job, small business, or benefactor. Most of your earnings go to supplies but you gain 6 Copper at Check-In each game. If your faction is Wraith, you may choose to receive 1 Bit instead.

This merit may be purchased multiple times.

Innovator: <Skill>

Prerequisites: Academics 3, One of [Alchemy, Armory, or Herbalism] 3, Adept Merit

When you purchase this merit select a skill that you have at rank three from **Alchemy, Armory, or Herbalism**.

Each Check-In you may choose to create a **single** Recipe whose Skill matches the skill on this merit and for which you meet the prerequisites for. You collect one fewer Tag (or point in the case of Herbalism) for that skill. You may only ever collect **1 Recipe** at Check-In regardless of how many times this merit has been purchased.

This merit may be purchased multiple times with a different skill selected each time.

Kinfolk (ANY NON-SHIFTER)

Select a Shifter Tribe. You do not gain the Weaknesses, Advantages, or Energy restrictions of the chosen subfaction. You cannot purchase gifts and your Energy type does not change. A new character with this merit may begin play with Shifter Faction lore and lore for their Tribe at no additional cost. At Check-In, if you are Human, you may gain the **Gifted Kinfolk Subfaction** or put your name in for the **First Change** drawing to become a Shifter. You must have CG approval if purchasing this merit after character creation without ST intervention or a ritual.

This merit **does not increase the cost of future merits**, nor do other merits increase the cost of this one.

Lost Soul (SHIFTER OR VAMPIRE ONLY)

You have the option to become a Wraith at the next event after you die, even though your faction is normally prohibited from doing so. This Merit will not work if the character is killed through [Amaranth](#). You cannot have this merit at the same time as Mortwright.

Medium (ANY NON-WRAITH)

You can hear the Umbra. This does not allow you to see or target characters in the Umbra with effects.

Misplaced Heart <Location> (VAMPIRE ONLY)

After your embrace, your heart relocated to another location in your body. Choose one: right arm, left arm, right leg, or left leg. A stake in the heart will not affect you. You are considered staked only if the stake is targeted at your chosen <location>.

Mix Morph (SHIFTER ONLY)

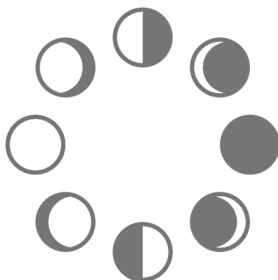
You may use claws without putting on a mask, but do not gain Augment from War Form when doing so.



Moon Ties (SHIFTER ONLY)

Taking this merit has both benefits and foibles to exemplify each Auspice. On your moon phase, in addition to a static effect you gain the Lunar Phase benefit.

Auspice	Static	Lunar Phase
Ahroun	While in Frenzy, gain Augment 1	During your phase, gain Augment 1.
<i>Ahroun Foible: Cannot direct Frenzy (even with Song of Rage or Frenzy Control) and must spend 1 additional Gnosis when casting non-Ahroun specific rituals.</i>		
Galliard	You gain the ability Sense Rank.	Once during your phase, you may use Mass Song of Rage at no cost.
<i>Galliard Foible: Cannot resist passion compelling abilities.</i>		
Philodox	You may use Meditate on yourself.	Once during your phase, you may use Unresistable Hypnotism at no cost.
<i>Philodox Foible: Cannot resist truth compelling abilities.</i>		
Ragabash	You gain the power Reverse Mimic <Gnosis>	Once per day during your phase, you may use Mass Hallucinate at no cost.
<i>Ragabash Foible: Cannot use Bestial Frenzy.</i>		
Theurge	Add 1 free Gnosis to every Spirit summoning you perform.	Once during your phase, you may gain Gnosis from a Node a second time.
<i>Theurge Foible: Cannot resist Daze.</i>		



Nimble

You may resist any one damage attack each day by calling "Resist". This resistance refreshes at sunrise.

Oracle

Prerequisites: Theurge Auspice, Dementation 1, Fatalism 1, or Guidance 3

You receive one Prophecy at Check-In; this is cumulative with the Visions power.

Pale Aura

You answer "Human" to "Sense Faction." You answer as if you have Vitality to powers that sense your Energy type. You answer "Commoner" to "Sense <subfaction>". You answer "No Effect" to "Sense Rank". You answer "Yes" to "Sense Living".

This Merit does not alter your answer to Test Faction.

Steel Trap

Your mind does not smooth over the holes left by missing memories. Each sunrise, you may spend 1 Willpower to realize whether you were the victim of the power Forgetful Mind. This expenditure of Willpower reveals each instance the power was used on you, since the previous sunrise.

This Merit does not restore your missing memories. However, you do become aware that some of your memories are now missing and you recall what you were doing before and after the gaps. This Merit does not automatically allow you to know who or what used Forgetful Mind on you, although you may now be in a better position to guess.

Strong Will

Mental powers last 5 minutes on you instead of 10.

Tainted Soul

You are Permatainted.

Taste of Oblivion (WRAITH ONLY)

This merit is only active while you are Tainted.

Whenever a character attempts to drain you with Health or Pathos Exchange, say "Taste of Oblivion! Induce Catharsis!" Unless resisted by spending 1 Willpower, that character then immediately goes into Catharsis, gaining an Angst as normal. They may then proceed with draining. Specters are unaffected.

Umbral Affinity (SHIFTER ONLY)

Stepping Sideways when not at a Gaian Node takes you 30 seconds of meditation instead of 60.

Unbondable (HUMAN ONLY)

Through some strange quirk, you're harder to bring under a Blood Bond. You must be fed blood three times from the same Vampire during the same event to become Blood Bound to them, rather than the usual two times. These three feedings must all take place at least 10 minutes apart.

If purchased while under the effects of a Blood Bond, this merit will not invalidate an existing Blood Bond. Instead, it will apply to future attempts to form Blood Bonds.

This merit is lost if you are no longer a Human.

Skills

General Rules for Skills

Skills represent the mundane (and not so mundane) crafts your character has been trained in or has picked up over time. It's a good idea to consider your character's occupation (i.e. how they spend their time when they're not fighting for their life) when picking starting skills.

You may use every level of skill you have unless otherwise specified.

Many skills allow you to use certain powers once-per-day for free. These powers are not necessarily supernatural, and do not count as being on your character sheet for any purpose other than using them.

Combat skills allow you to use weapons and shields you might not otherwise have access to.

Production skills allow you to gain crafted item tags at Check-In. You can read and understand in-game any tag you meet the crafting requirements for by inspecting it for 10 seconds. Some skills require tagged tool props to use the skill or to attach a crafted item tag to its prop in-game. Tool props are tagged as generic items. Example tool props are listed with each skill. To attach a crafted item tag to an appropriate prop during game, roleplay with the prop and 2 appropriate, tagged tool props for 60 seconds.

Production for Umbrabound Characters works slightly differently. When an Umbrabound character creates items with either Armory or Locksmithing, it is assumed the object is a Relic. They do not pay extra to obtain these. If they wish to produce an object which is not a Relic, they should consider whether their character would have access to the Realm to do so. Furthermore, use of the Alchemy, Herbalism, or Holy Water skill to generate tags also should require the ability to affect the Realm (potions and poisons cannot be tagged as Relics, so without this ability an Umbrabound character cannot create tags with Herbalism)

Academics

OTHER

1. **Literacy:** You may read and write in any languages you can speak.
2. **Tutor:** You may teach an additional skill to an additional person each game.
3. **Mentor:** You may teach an additional power to an additional person each game.

Alchemy (SORCERER ONLY)

PRODUCTION

1. **Bottle Essence:** You may gain 1 Bottled Essence each Check-In.
2. **Energy Conversion:** You may exchange 1 bottled Energy tag each Check-In for any other bottled Energy tag(s). A bottled Energy tag is a Blood Vial, Bottled Essence, Bottled Pathos, or Spirit Brew (potions that restore 4 Energy of a particular type).
3. **Alchemical Wisdom:** You may exchange 1 of each of the four types of bottled Energy tags each Check-In for 1 Potion of Mind.

You may choose not to receive or exchange any tags at Check-In to instead receive 1 Copper per level in this skill.

Archery

COMBAT

1. **Proficiency:** You may use a bow or crossbow to deal 3 damage, increased by your Augment and any magical enchantments.
2. **Pinning Shot:** You may use the Root power once per day at no cost, using a thrown packet as the delivery method (roleplay drawing it from your bow).
3. **Overdraw:** You may use the Brutal Strike power once per day at no cost, using a fired arrow or bolt as the delivery method.

Armory

PRODUCTION

1. **Production:** You may receive 1 item tag each Check-In that you meet the crafting requirements for, chosen from the table below.
2. **Repair:** You may repair any armor by role-playing with the armor prop and an appropriate tagged tool prop for 60 seconds per point of armor repaired. You cannot repair armor while it is worn.
3. **Rapid Repair:** The time it takes for you to repair armor is reduced to 10 seconds per point of armor repaired.

<i>Crafted Item</i>	<i>Crafting Requirements</i>
Ranged Weapon	Armory 1
Light Armor	Armory 1
One-Handed Weapon	Armory 1
Medium Armor	Armory 2
Shield	Armory 2
Two-Handed Weapon	Armory 2
Versatile Weapon	Armory 2
Heavy Armor	Armory 3
Silvered Weapon	Armory 3

You can add crafted item tags from this skill to an appropriate weapon, shield, or armor prop in-game by roleplaying with the tag, prop, and 2 appropriate, tagged tool props for 60 seconds. Example tool props include: hammers, tongs, mallets, leather hole punches, whetstones, etc.

You may choose not to receive or exchange any tags at Check-In to instead receive 1 Copper per level in this skill.

Brawl

COMBAT

1. **Proficiency:** You may use a brawl boffer in each hand at the same time. Additionally, the damage you deal with brawl boffers is increased by your Augment.
2. **Deflect:** You may block attacks with brawl boffers as if they were martial weapons.
3. **Knockout:** You may use the Daze power once per day at no cost, using a brawl boffer as the delivery method (the brawl boffer must make contact with the target without being blocked by a weapon or shield). **Never** aim for a target's head.

Guidance

OTHER

1. **Fascination:** You may use the Guidance power once per day, using it with the Passion power.
2. **Inspiration:** You may now use the Guidance power a total of twice per day, and may instead choose to use it with the Meditate power.
3. **Foreboding:** You may now use the Guidance power a total of three times per day, and may instead choose to use it with the Despair power.

The type of roleplay you use to activate Guidance may take the form of telling the target's fortune, hearing confession, engaging in a deep spiritual or philosophical discussion, reflecting on the past and future, or any other activity appropriate to your character. The chosen power should be appropriate to the outcome of this roleplay.

Herbalism

PRODUCTION

1. **Production:** You gain 1 Herbalism Point per level in this skill each Check-In to spend on item tags chosen from the table below. See [Potions and Poisons](#) for more information.
2. **Medicinal Application:** You may choose to drink a poison to gain a Meditate once per day at no cost.
3. **Mithridatism:** You may use the Resist Poison power once per day at no cost.

<i>Crafted Item</i>	<i>Herbalism Point Cost</i>	<i>Crafting Requirements</i>
Foxglove	1	Herbalism 1
Golden Chain	1	Herbalism 1
Hemlock	1	Herbalism 1
Belladonna	2	Herbalism 2
Healing Potion	2	Herbalism 2
Antidote	3	Herbalism 3

You can add crafted item tags from this skill to an appropriate container prop during game by roleplaying with the tag, prop, and 2 appropriate, tagged tool props for 60 seconds. Example tool props include: alembics, beakers, stirring rods, a mortar and pestle, jars of herbs, bags of salt or iron filings, etc.

You may choose not to spend some or all of your Herbalism points at Check-In to instead receive 1 Copper per unspent Herbalism point.

Holy Water (HUMAN ONLY)

PRODUCTION

1. **Production:** You may receive 1 Holy Water tag each Check-In.
2. **Purify:** You may use the Cleanse power once per day at no cost by roleplaying pouring Holy Water on a target. This consumes the tag, and the target takes the effect of Holy Water as if they had imbibed it.
3. **Sanctify:** You may use the Sanctuary power once per day at no cost by roleplaying anointing yourself with Holy Water or scattering it around you. This consumes the tag.

You can add Holy Water tags to an appropriate container prop during game by roleplaying with the tag, prop, and 2 appropriate, tagged tool props for 60 seconds. Example tool props include: prayer bowls, religious or spiritual symbols, jars of salt, silver jewelry, bottles, holy text, etc.

You may choose not to receive or exchange any tags at Check-In to instead receive 1 Copper per level in this skill.

Locksmith

PRODUCTION

1. **Keysmith:** You may collect any number of generic Key item tags at Check-In and match them to any Key or unattached Lock tag in your possession.
2. **Production:** You may receive 1 Lock tag each Check-In.
3. **Lockpick:** You may bypass any Lock through dedicated roleplay with the prop and an appropriate tagged tool prop for 60 seconds.

You can add crafted item tags to an appropriate lock or key prop during game by roleplaying with the tag, prop, and 2 appropriate, tagged tool props for 60 seconds. Example tool props include: files, lock picks, tweezers, pliers, tension wrenches, mallets, hand drills, etc.

You may choose not to receive or exchange any tags at Check-In to instead receive 1 Copper per level in this skill.

Medicine

OTHER

1. **Health Check:** You gain the [Medicine](#) <2> and Sense Health powers.
2. **First Aid:** You gain the Medicine 4, Detect Dead, Detect Dying, and Detect Incapacitated powers.
3. **Diagnosis:** You gain the Medicine 6 and Detect Condition powers.

You can use Medicine to heal a target by roleplaying with them and an appropriate tagged tool prop for 60 seconds. Example tool props include: bandages, salves, splints, sutures, etc.

Unliving characters cannot be healed by Medicine and call "No Effect" instead.

Melee

COMBAT

1. **Proficiency:** You may use a Martial weapon in each hand at the same time. Additionally, the damage you deal with Martial weapons is increased by your Augment and any magical enchantments.
2. **Great Weapons:** The damage you deal with Two-Handed and Versatile weapons held in both hands is increased to 2 plus your Augment and any magical enchantments.
3. **Flourish:** You may use the Disarm power once per day at no cost, using a Martial weapon.

Rituals

OTHER

1. **Scribe:** Receive 1 Simple Public ritual you can cast.
2. **Journey Level Scribe:** Receive 1 Simple Public or Guarded ritual you can cast.

Research: Turn in 3 Simple or higher Potency ritual scrolls you can read to receive 1 Complex Public or Guarded ritual you can cast.

3. **Expert Level Scribe:** Receive 1 Simple Public, Guarded, or Secret ritual you can cast.

Thesis: Turn in 3 Complex or higher Potency ritual scrolls you can read to receive 1 Expert Public, Guarded, or Secret ritual you can cast.

See the [Rituals](#) section for full access requirements, Knowledge and Potency definitions, and Check-In access rules.

Shields

COMBAT

1. **Proficiency:** You may use a Shield in one hand and a Melee weapon in another hand at the same time.
2. **Glancing Blow:** You may use the Withstand power once per day at no cost while wielding a Shield.
3. **Deflection:** You may use the Avoidance power once per day at no cost while wielding a Shield.

Powers

General Rules for Powers

Breacheable Umbra -> Realm means a power can optionally be used across the Gauntlet by Umbrabound characters in the Umbra by adding the “Breach” meta call. This allows them to affect a target in the Realm, and does not affect the cost of the power.

Note that Energy is spent upon activation of a power, so if the user is interrupted before activation, the Energy is not spent.

Unless otherwise noted in a power’s writeup, there is no limitation on how often a power can be cast save for delivery limitations.

Powers are designated by type. You can read about each type below:

- [Counted Touch](#)
- [Damage](#)
- [Mask](#)
- [Mental](#)
- [Other](#)
- [Passive](#)
- [Self](#)
- [Sensory](#)
- [Status](#)
- [Touch](#)

Faction Occurrence Key

<i>Factions</i>	H	Human tree (Faithful, Sorcerer)
	S	Shifter Gift
	V	Vampire Discipline
	W	Wraith Arcanoi
<i>Modifiers</i>	r	“Rare” tree
	c	Corrupt tree / Dark Arcanoi
	f	Fundamental Power
	1/2/3	Level in the tree
<i>Other Sources</i>	Wt	Wraith (Specter) thorn
	K	Skill Power
	M	Merit Power
	C	Charm Power (Powers found only in the ST rulebook)

Example: Silence (Status) is in Messianic Voices 1 (Sorcerer, restricted), Death 1 (Sorcerer, Corrupt), Silent Strider 1 (Shifter), Thaumaturgy: Rego Aquam 1 (Vampire) Quietus 1 (Vampire, restricted), and Rego Dolor 1 (Vampire, Corrupt). It is not in Wraith. Its designation is “Hr1 S1 V1 Vr1 Vc1”

Player Powers

This is the only power section you are expected to be familiar with as a player, though it is always acceptable to ask for clarification on powers you do not recognize.

A

AGGRAVATED 1 (DAMAGE)

S3 V3 W3

Cost: 1 Energy Call: "Agg 1"

Throw a packet that does 1 Aggravated damage.

AGGRAVATED CLAWS (DAMAGE)

V3

Cost: 1 Energy Call: "Agg <Number>"

Add the "Agg" <type> to a single natural weapon attack.

AMARANTH (COUNTED TOUCH)

Vf

Cost: None Call: "Amaranth 1,
Amaranth 2,
Amaranth 3"

This power may only be activated after successfully using **Paralyzing Bite** or **Draining** on a Vampire with 0 Vitae. Other targets state "No Effect". During the Amaranth, the target remains paralyzed per the power Paralyze.

Begin an "Amaranth 1, Amaranth 2, Amaranth 3" call. After the "Amaranth 3" call, the target may spend 1 Willpower to resist, calling "Resist". If they do, you **must** immediately begin the call again at "Amaranth 1". You cannot voluntarily stop using this power once you have started, though if you are removed from the target or rendered unconscious the power ends.

If the target does not resist, they immediately become Dead and go OOG. They cannot be played again (e.g. even with the Lost Soul merit).

Once the scene is completed, go OOG and go with the target's player to ST Camp. You lose 1 Virtue and add 1 to your Amaranth count. If the target's Generation was lower than yours, lower your Generation by 1 and gain maximum Vitae up to the appropriate new value. You may take one tree on their character sheet as learned, and spend XP to learn the first dot next Check-In.

APPEAR (SELF)

W2

Cost: 1 Energy Call: "Realm", "Umbra"

You cannot use this power within 10 seconds of having made an attack.

You enter the Realm for 10 minutes. You cannot use Paralyzing Touch or spend Energy, except to Regenerate. You may return to the Umbra at any time by stating "Umbra".

<TYPE> ARMOR (PASSIVE)

S3 Sf

Cost: None Call: None

You have <type> armor (<type> no longer Scorches you), where <type> is indicated by the power's source. The <type> cannot be Agg.

AVERT (MENTAL)

H1 S1

Cost: 1 Energy Call: "Avert"

Hold out your hand with your palm facing the target. Alternatively, hold out a non-boffer, non-shield item.

The target cannot advance towards you while you're within 10 feet of the target. The target cannot attack you. Only one target may be Averted by you at any time.

This power may be used from the Realm on a target in the Umbra that you can see in-game by adding the "Breach" meta call.

This power ends immediately when you lower your hand.

AVOIDANCE (SELF)

K3 H3 S2 V2 W3

Cost: 1 Willpower Call: "Resist"

Resist a single damage attack and any Meta calls associated with it.

B

BALEFIRE (DAMAGE) Sc3 Vr3 V3c		
Cost: 2 Energy	Call: "Tainted Agg 4"	
Throw a packet that does 4 Aggravated damage and Taints the target.		

BEAST MIND (MENTAL) H1 S2 V1		
Cost: 1 Energy	Call: "Beast Mind" and "predator" or "prey"	
The target must roleplay as an animal that is either a predator or prey based on the sig call used. The target cannot use language; whether verbal, written, or telepathic.		

BESTIAL FRENZY (SELF) Sf, Vf		
Cost: 1 Virtue	Call: None	
You enter a Frenzy .		

BESTIAL HEALING (SELF) Sf		
Cost: 1 Virtue	Call: None	
You cannot use this power if unable to Frenzy (e.g. if affected by Disquiet).		
You may only use this power immediately upon reaching 0 Health. You gain 1 Health (not exceeding your maximum), remain in your current realm, and enter a Frenzy that cannot be directed (e.g. even with Frenzy Control).		

BLACK ICHOR (OTHER) Vr1		
Cost: None	Call: None	
Receive one Vitae Poison tag at each Check-In.		

BLOOD BUFF (SELF) Vf		
Cost: 2 Energy	Call: None	
Gain Augment 1 for 60 seconds. Different sources of Augment stack with one another.		

BODY WRACK (STATUS) H2 S2 Vr2 Vc2		
Cost: 1 Energy	Call: "Body Wrack"	
The target must roleplay being in intense pain. The target may only move at a slow walk. The target may only make boffer attacks.		
Breachable Umbra -> Realm		

BRITTLE BONES (STATUS) Vc3 Wt		
Cost: 2 Energy	Call: "Brittle Bones"	
Any <type> damage the target takes is treated as though it is <Agg>.		

BRUTAL STRIKE (DAMAGE <META>) K3 H3 S3 V3 Wt		
Cost: 2 Energy	Call: "Brutal <Number>"	
Add the "Brutal" Meta call to a single weapon attack. Brutal attacks are considered successful and cause damage even if blocked.		

C

CLAWED FORM (MASK) Hr2 V1		
Cost: None	Call: None	
You may use claw natural weapons. You may also put on a mask determined by the power source.		

CLEANSE (TOUCH) K2 H2		
Cost: 2 Energy	Call: "Cleanse Taint"	
The target is cleansed of Taint.		

CLOAK (SELF)

H2 Sr1 V1 W1 Wc1

Cost: 1 Energy

Call: "Cloak"

You cannot use this power within 10 seconds of having made an attack.

Spread your hand out in front of your face. You are Cloaked and are no longer visible in-game.

This power ends if you speak in-game (except through Telepathy), make distinct noises, touch an object or person, attack, are targeted by an attack with the "Cloak Sight" or "Mass" meta call, or no longer have your hand splayed in front of your face.

CLOAK GATHERING (TOUCH)

Sc2 V3 Wt

Cost: 1 Energy

Call: "Cloak Gathering"

You may use the Cloak power. While doing so, you may touch a target person or object to Cloak them as per the Cloak power.

Cloak ends for the target if you are no longer touching the target or if you become uncloaked.

CLOAK SIGHT (PASSIVE)

H3 S3 V3 W3

Cost: None

Call: "Cloak Sight"

You can see characters that are Cloaked, and can attack and target them with powers after making the sig call.

COGNIZANCE (PASSIVE)

W1

Cost: None

Call: "No Effect"

You are immune to the Daze and Dreamshape powers.

CONDITIONING (OTHER <META>)

V3 W3

Cost: 4 Energy

Call: "Unresistable
<Mental>"

You must have a conversation with a target for at least 60 consecutive seconds directly before using this power.

You may add the "Unresistable" Meta call onto one Mental power against that target, unless the power uses the "Mass" meta call.

CONFUSION (MENTAL)

H1 S1 Sc1 V1 W1

Cost: 1 Energy

Call: "Confusion"

The target loses all personal knowledge and does not know who they are, who anyone else is, or the context for what is happening around them. They may still attack and defend themselves as normal. When this power ends, the target loses all memories that took place while under this power.

Breachable Umbra -> Realm

CONTROL BODY (MENTAL)

W2

Cost: 1 Energy

Call: "Breach Control Body
<command>"

You must be in the Umbra and your target must be in the Realm to use this power.

The target must obey the stated command, which can be one of: "Sit", "Stay", "Grovel", "Babble", or "Walk".

CONTROL VOICE (TOUCH)

W1

Cost: 1 Energy

Call: "Breach Control Voice"

You must be in the Umbra and your target must be in the Realm to use this power.

The target must speak aloud anything you whisper to them for as long as you are touching them.

CORRUPTED POWERS (PASSIVE)

Sc2

Cost: None

Call: None

You may teach any power tree you know (even a Learned tree) as a Corrupted power.

CRAVING (TOUCH <CONDITION>)

W3

Cost: 1 Energy

Call: "Condition: Craving
<three word
description>"

The target's primary desire becomes the description spoken. This condition ends as soon as they satisfy this desire once.

D

DAZE (TOUCH)

K3 Hr3 Sr3 Vr3 W3

Cost: 1 Energy Call: "Daze"

The target is put into a deep slumber that is difficult to awaken from. While asleep, they have no memory of things happening around them.

The target will not awaken from soft noises, distant sounds, or gentle touches (they should be generous). However, taking damage, being attacked, getting shaken or jostled, loud noises, etc. will wake the target. If left alone for 10 minutes, they may choose to wake up on their own.

Breachable Umbra -> Realm

DECAY (DAMAGE)

Sc3 V3 Wt

Cost: 1 Energy Call: "Decay", "Agg 1"

Touch a target. After every 10 seconds, say "Agg 1" to cause one Aggravated damage to them. Each point of damage counts as a separate attack. A target who is Dying or Dead immediately dies and turns to ash (goes OOG) when damaged.

This power ends if you stop touching the target or move your feet.

DERANGE (MENTAL)

Sc2 V3 Vc2

Cost: 1 Energy Call: "Derange
<Derangement>"

The target must roleplay as if they have the stated Derangement, which must be one present on your character sheet.

DESPAIR (TOUCH <CONDITION>)

K3 Wt

Cost: 1 Energy Call: "Condition: Despair, do not regain Willpower"

The target does not regain Willpower at sunrise.

DETECT CONDITION (SENSORY)

K3

Cost: None Call: "Detect Condition"

Touch the target for 10 seconds. They must answer OOG "yes" or "no" if they are currently affected by a Condition.

DETECT DEAD (SENSORY)

K2

Cost: None Call: "Detect Dead"

Touch the target for 10 seconds. They must answer OOG "yes" or "no" if they are currently Dead.

DETECT DYING (SENSORY)

K2

Cost: None Call: "Detect Dying"

Touch the target for 10 seconds. They must answer OOG "yes" or "no" if they are currently Dying.

DETECT FETTER (SENSORY)

H2 W2

Cost: 1 Energy Call: "Detect Fetter" or
"Detect Fetter <item>"

Touch the target for 10 seconds. The target responds "No Effect" if they are not a Wraith. Otherwise, they must OOG describe one of their Fetters and where they saw it last. If an item is stated, they must describe one of their Fetters that best matches it.

DETECT INCAPACITATED (SENSORY)

K2

Cost: None Call: "Detect Incapacitated"

Touch the target for 10 seconds. They must answer OOG "yes" or "no" if they are currently Incapacitated.

DETECT TAINT (SENSORY)

H1 S1 Sc1 W1 Wc1

Cost: None Call: "Detect Taint"

Touch the target for 10 seconds ((If appropriate for your character, you may sniff the Target from within touching distance for 10 seconds instead). They must answer OOG "yes" or "no" if they are currently Tainted.

You can also determine if an item or Node is Tainted by reading the item tag. This power does not grant you any other IG knowledge from reading the tag.

DEVOUR (COUNTED TOUCH)

W2, Wc2

Cost: None

Call: "Devouring 1,
Devouring 2,
Devouring 3"

This power may only be activated after successfully using [Paralyzing Touch](#) or [Health Exchange](#) on a Wraith with 0 Health. Other targets state "No Effect". During the Devouring, the target remains paralyzed per the power [Paralyze](#).

Begin a "Devouring 1, Devouring 2, Devouring 3" call. After the "Devouring 3" call, the target may spend 1 Willpower to resist, calling "Resist". If they do, you may immediately begin the call again at "Devouring 1".

If the target does not resist, they immediately become Dead and go OOG. They cannot be played again (i.e. they do not Harrow).

Once the scene is completed, go OOG and go with the target's player to ST Camp. You gain 1 Angst and add 1 to your Devour count. You may take one tree on their character sheet as learned, and spend XP to learn the first dot next Check-In.

DISEMBODIED (SELF)

S2 W1

Cost: None

Call: "Vocalize <speech>"

You may speak across the Gauntlet at any volume and be heard. You may also touch a target in the Realm from the Umbra and have them feel it (cross your fingers and say "you feel this").

DISQUIET (MENTAL)

H2 V2 W2

Cost: 1 Energy

Call: "Disquiet"

The target cannot enter a Frenzy or Catharsis.

If they are already in Frenzy or Catharsis, they immediately exit and cannot re-enter either.

DISABLE (STATUS)

H3 S3 Sc3 W3

Cost: 2 Energy

Call: "Disable"

The target cannot expend Energy for any reason.

DISARM (DAMAGE <META>)

K3 H2 S1 V1

Cost: 1 Energy

Call: "Disarm <Number>"

Add the "Disarm" Meta call to a single weapon attack. Unless resisted, the target must drop any non-natural weapon used to block the attack.

DRAINING (COUNTED TOUCH)

Srf, Vf

Cost:	None	Call:	"Draining 1, Draining 2, Draining 3, etc." and "Aggravated End Drain"
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This power may only be activated after successfully using [Test Faction](#) on the target you are draining from. During the Draining, the target remains paralyzed per the power Paralyze if you initiated the drain with Paralyzing Bite.

For every call of "Draining", the target loses 1 Health (or 1 Energy if the target is a Vampire) and you gain 1 or 2 Energy as per the [blood effects](#) table. The target should inform you when the pool you are draining from becomes empty, and may roleplay slumping over, if appropriate. "Draining" doesn't count as an attack for the purpose of ending other effects.

Draining ends if you or the target are Interrupted, your Energy pool becomes full, or if you take your hand off of the target. At the end of the Draining, state "Aggravated End Drain" if you drained any Health from the target. They lose 1 Maximum Health if they are not a Vampire, and this counts as an attack.

Your target becomes Tainted if you are, and you become Tainted if they are (cross your fingers and ask them). You also take effects as per the **blood effects** table.

Blood Effects

Faction / Subfaction	Energy Value	Additional Blood Effects
Human	1 Health: 1 Energy	None
Vampire	1 Energy: 1 Energy	Blood bond may apply (see Blood Bond section)
Shifter	1 Health: 2 Energy	Drainer affected by Passion: Anger
Ananasi		Drainer affected by Venom
Wraith	1 Health: 1 Energy	Vampire is shunted to the Umbra (if not already in the Umbra). <i>Vampire players should carry white headbands</i>
Anything Umbra-bound		
Demon	1 Health: 2 Energy	Vampire affected by Tainted Induce Sin <Demonic Vice>

DREAMSHAPE (TOUCH <CONDITION>)

Hr2 S2 V2 Vc2 W2

Cost:	1 Energy	Call:	"Condition: Dreamshape <dream> <action> <non-plural noun>"
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The target must be Incapacitated or asleep (asleep OOG or with the Daze power). If the target is asleep OOG, leave a 3x5 card with the call written down.

The target has the described dream. When they awake, they immediately carry out the stated action to the best of their ability. The condition ends once the action has been performed one time. The target may attack and defend themselves as normal. This power cannot be used to cause a target to physically harm themselves.

Breachable Umbra -> Realm

EXAMPLES

"You dream of a mysterious fish beneath the surface of a large body of water (dream). Go (action) to the edge of the lake (noun)" is an acceptable use of this power.

"You dream of the endless void. Stab yourself" is **not** an acceptable use of this power because it requires the target to directly harm themselves.

"You dream of the beating of war drums (dream). Kill (action) the leader of this town (noun)" is an acceptable use of this power. Even though the target will likely come to harm as a result of the action, you did not cause them to directly harm themselves.

E

ENDURE (PASSIVE)		H1 V1
Cost:	None	Call: None
You take exposure damage every 60 seconds instead of every 10 seconds.		

ENHANCED BLOOD BUFF (SELF)		M
Cost:	3 Energy	Call: None
Gain Augment 1 for 10 minutes. Different sources of Augment stack with one another, except that this power does not stack with Blood Buff.		

ENTRANCEMENT (MENTAL)		Hr3 Sr2 V2 Wc2
Cost:	1 Energy	Call: "Entrancement"
The target behaves as though they have a Blood Bond to you for the duration of this power. The Burden ends if you attack the target. The Target may spend Willpower to resist this power even though they normally could not while under a Blood Bond.		

ESCAPE (SELF)		M
Cost:	None	Call: "Escape"
Spend 60 Uninterrupted seconds of dedicated RP with a Lock, ropes, or chains to activate this power. You slip free from any Restraints or open any Lock keeping you trapped inside a building or other space. You must immediately exit through and close any such locked door behind you.		

EXORCISM (MENTAL)		H3
Cost:	1 Energy	Call: "Breach Mass Exorcism"
You must be in the Realm to use this power. All targets in the Umbra end any Possession and move at least ten feet away from you. The targets cannot advance towards you unless you are at least 10 feet from them. While under the effects of this power, the target(s) cannot attack you. This power does not affect characters in the Realm.		

EXPEL CORPUS (SELF)		W2 Wc2
Cost:	None	Call: "Expel Corpus"
Lose one Health. This power cannot be used to reduce your Health below 1 (i.e to Incapacitated). Typically, this power is used to prepare for a Devouring.		

F

FABRICATE ARMOR (OTHER)		H2 S2 V2 W3
Cost:	1 Energy	Call: "Fabricate Armor 4"
Spend 60 Uninterrupted seconds roleplaying building invisible armor on the target before activating this power. You may target yourself with this power. The target receives 4 additional armor points that do not require a phys-rep. These armor points are the first to be used when the target is struck for damage. A character may only have one fabricated suit of armor at any time; additional uses of this power only refill the fabricated armor to a maximum of 4 armor.		

FAST HEALING (PASSIVE)		S1 Wc1
Cost:	None	Call: None
Your Regeneration Rate is increased by 1.		

FETTER CONSUMPTION (TOUCH)		H2 W2
Cost:	1 Energy	Call: "Breach Fetter Consumption"
Touch a Fetter and remove the Fetter tag (if a character is the Fetter, ask them for the tag). Characters who are Fetters may resist by spending 1 Willpower as usual. The Fetter is destroyed. Inform the owner of the Fetter OOG as soon as possible that it has been destroyed. They receive no IG information as to who destroyed it. Tags from Fetters destroyed with this power may be exchanged for blank Fetter tags at Check-In.		

FETTER CREATION (TOUCH)

W1

Cost:	1 Energy	Call:	"Breach Fetter Creation"
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Touch an item at least 3 inches long or a Human, Vampire, or Shifter for 10 seconds to turn it into a Fetter for a target Wraith. If making a Fetter for another Wraith, you must be holding their hand along with the item or person. If the non-Wraith target is not a Human, Vampire, or Shifter, they state "No Effect". Upon successful Fetter creation, fill out a Fetter tag and attach it to the item or give it to the non-Wraith.

You receive one Fetter tag at each Check-In.

FETTER HEALING (SELF)

Wf

Cost:	None	Call:	None
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Your Regeneration Rate is increased by 1 while touching any Fetter(s) that belong to you (even if you cannot otherwise affect the Fetter by touching it).

FIRE 2 (DAMAGE)

Hr1 S2 V1

Cost:	1 Energy	Call:	"Fire 2"
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Throw a packet that does 2 <Fire> damage.

FIRE 4 (DAMAGE)

S3 V3

Cost:	2 Energy	Call:	"Fire 4"
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Throw a packet that does 4 <Fire> damage.

FIRE WEAPON (DAMAGE <TYPE>)

Sr2 V2

Cost:	1 Energy	Call:	"Fire <Number>"
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Add the "Fire" <type> to a single weapon attack. This cannot be used with Natural weapons.

FORGETFUL MIND (TOUCH)H1 S1 Sr1
V1 W1

Cost:	1 Energy	Call:	"Forgetful Mind"
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The target loses the last 10 minutes of character knowledge and can never recover those memories.

FORM OF VAPOR (MASK)

S3 Sr3 V3 Wc3

Cost:	None	Call:	"Form of Vapor", "Resist", or "No Effect"
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You cannot use this power within 10 seconds of making an attack. You may put on a silver or black full-face mask.

While wearing this mask, you may resist damage for 1 Energy, are immune to Status powers and Counted Touch actions and may pass through locked doors (immediately open, pass through, then close them to indicate phasing through them). You cannot make any attacks, or block with boffers. You cannot interact with objects, bodies, or open doors. Any object on your person becomes a part of your form and cannot be removed or interacted with while in Form of Vapor.

FRENZY CONTROL (SELF)

H3 S3 V3 Wt

Cost:	1 Willpower	Call:	"Frenzy" or "No Effect"
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You may activate this power to enter a Fear [Frenzy](#) or Attack Frenzy without losing Virtue. If you opt for an Attack Frenzy, you may choose which character(s) to attack first. If none of your original targets are present you must then attack the nearest character.

You are also immune to "Induce Frenzy" and all other effects that would force you to Frenzy against your will.

G**GAUNTLET WALK (SELF)**

S3

Cost:	1 Energy	Call:	"Umbra" or "Realm" as your destination
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You cannot use this power within 10 seconds of making an attack.

Travel from the Realm to the Umbra or from the Umbra to the Realm.

GUIDANCE (OTHER) K1			
Cost:	None	Call:	"Guidance Unresistable <Power>"
Spend 60 Uninterrupted seconds roleplaying a profound interpersonal interaction with a willing target before activating this power. The target takes the effect of the chosen power as determined by this power's source. This effect is delivered per the chosen power (e.g. as a Mental, a Touch, etc.).			

H

HALLUCINATION (MENTAL) M Hr1 Sr1 Wt			
Cost:	1 Energy	Call:	"Hallucination <three word description>"
The target has a hallucination fitting the description.			

HASTY ESCAPE (SELF) Hr3 S3 Sr3 V3 W3			
Cost:	4 Energy	Call:	"Hasty Escape" or "No Effect"
Cross your arms over your chest and leave the area as quickly as possible. You cannot return until this power ends. Until then, you cannot make attacks or activate powers, and are immune to attacks, though this power does not end effects already active on you. This power ends once you have moved 60 feet away from where you activated it or 60 seconds pass, whichever happens sooner.			

HEAL SELF (SELF) H1 S1			
Cost:	None	Call:	None
Roleplay prayer or meditation. While doing so, you may convert 1 Energy to 1 Health every second. This does not stack with Regeneration.			

HEALING TOUCH (TOUCH) H1 S1 Vr1 Wt			
Cost:	1 Energy	Call:	"Healing Touch 4"
The target gains 4 Health, not to exceed their Maximum Health.			

HEALTH EXCHANGE (COUNTED TOUCH) W2 Wc2			
Cost:	None	Call:	"Giving Health" or "Draining Health"
You may use the Paralyzing Touch power. Health Exchange may only be activated after successfully using Paralyzing Touch on a target. During the Exchange, the target remains paralyzed per the power Paralyze. You may choose to either give the target Health or drain their Health. For every call of "Giving Health 1, Giving Health 2, etc." the target gains 1 Health and you lose 1 Health. For every call of "Draining Health 1, Draining Health 2, etc." the target loses 1 Health and you gain 1 Health. This power ends if you or the target are Interrupted, you or your target's Health reaches its maximum, or if you take your hand off of the target. Your target becomes Tainted if you are, and you become Tainted if they are (cross your fingers and ask them).			

HELLBORN INVESTITURE (PASSIVE) Vr2			
Cost:	None	Call:	None
You have <Fire> armor (<Fire> no longer Scorches you).			

HERO'S STAND (SELF) S3 Wt			
Cost:	None	Call:	"Resist" or "No Effect"
Plant one foot in place. For the next 10 minutes you are immune to damage attacks and you may resist Status attacks for 1 Energy. You may still pivot around your foot and can move it for OOG safety reasons. Do not physically block others from moving past you. At the end of 10 minutes, or if you lift your foot for any reason, you immediately drop to 0 Health.			

HIDDEN TAINT (PASSIVE)

Sc3 Wc3

Cost: None Call: None

You always answer “no” to Detect Taint. You may always pass through a Ward Against the Wyrms. If you have the Taint power, you may choose whether to use it.

HIDE OF THE WYRM (PASSIVE)

Sc1

Cost: None Call: None

Your Maximum Health is increased by 2.

HORRID REALITY (MENTAL)

S2 Sc2 Vc3 Wt

Cost: 1 Energy Call: “Horrid Reality <three word description>”

The target must roleplay as though they are dying in the way described. They cannot make attacks.

HYPNOTISM (MENTAL)

M H3

Cost: 1 Energy Call: “Hypnotism”

You must spend 60 Uninterrupted seconds performing hypnotic roleplay engaging the target, as described in this power’s source directly before you activate this power.

The target enters a trance and will do nothing but truthfully answer any question you ask them per character knowledge. All events that take place while under the effects of this power are removed from their character knowledge.

This power ends early if you stop your hypnotic roleplay or if any other Interruption occurs for you or your target.

IMITATE (MASK)

Vr2 W2

Cost: 1 Energy Call: “Imitate”

Spend 10 seconds molding the face of a target. The target can be yourself.

Put a transformation mask of your choice on the target, or remove a mask that has been put on them with this power. This power can also be used to add or remove prosthetics and makeup (with the player's OOG consent), but cannot be used to remove Makeup Requirements.

The target can remove any mask or makeup given to them through this power after 10 minutes.

INDUCE CATHARSIS (TOUCH)

Wc3

Cost: 1 Energy Call: “Induce Catharsis”

If the target is a Wraith, they enter Catharsis and gain 1 Angst. This has no effect if they are already in Catharsis.

INDUCE FRENZY (TOUCH)

H2 Sc3 V2

Cost: 1 Energy Call: “Induce Frenzy”

The target enters an Attack [Frenzy](#).

INDUCE SIN (MENTAL)

Hr2 Sc2 W2

Cost: 1 Energy Call: “Induce Sin <Sin>”

The sin you name must be one of the seven deadly sins (envy, greed, gluttony, lust, pride, sloth, or wrath).

The target becomes obsessed with that sin and seeks to indulge in it. Characters with a matching Demonic Vice cannot resist this power.

Breachable Umbra -> Realm

INSIGHT (TOUCH)

S1 V1 W1

Cost:	1 Energy	Call:	"Insight <questions>"
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The target must be Dying. Targets who are not Dying call "No Effect".

The target must answer any questions you ask truthfully per character knowledge. Both the questions and the answers are spoken in-game. Silver Tongue does not bypass this power.

You may ask as many questions as you like with a single use of this power. The power ends when the target becomes Dead, you stop touching them, or you are Interrupted.

Breachable Umbra -> Realm

L**LEECH OF FEAR (PASSIVE)**

Vc3

Cost:	None	Call:	None
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Each time you use the [Dreamshape](#) power on a target, your maximum Energy is increased by one for the remainder of the event. This bonus can only be received once per target per event, to a maximum of 10 more Energy.

LIGHT WEAPON (DAMAGE <TYPE>)

Vr3

Cost:	1 Energy	Call:	"Light <Number>"
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Add the "Light" <type> to a single weapon attack. This cannot be used with Natural weapons.

M**MAJESTY (MENTAL)**

Hr3 V3 Wt

Cost:	2 Energy	Call:	"Mass Entrancement"
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All targets behave as though they are [Blood Bound](#) to you for the duration of this power.

The Burden ends for an individual target if you attack them. Targets may spend Willpower to resist this power even though they normally could not while under a Blood Bond.

MASK OF A THOUSAND FACES (MASK)

Hr2 Sr2 V2

Cost:	None	Call:	None
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You may put on any Transformation mask you desire.

You may disregard any Makeup Requirements.

You may [Disguise](#) yourself without a face covering, or wearing a second layer of garb, as though adopting a new identity (not as any existing PC or NPC). You may wear a different set of garb.

MASS TAUNT (MENTAL)

Wt

Cost:	2 Energy	Call:	"Mass Taunt"
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Insult the characters around you. They must attack you to the best of their ability as long as they can see you.

This power ends early if you fall to the ground.

MATERIALIZE (SELF)

W3

Cost:	1 Willpower	Call:	"Umbra", "Realm"
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Touch a Fetter belonging to you and enter the Realm. You have full use of your powers.

This power ends 1 hour after the last time you touched a Fetter belonging to you. You can also choose to end this power at any time. When the power ends, you return to the Umbra.

MEDICINE (TOUCH)

K1

Cost: None Call: "Medicine <Number>"

You must spend 60 Uninterrupted seconds roleplaying tending to a target's wounds with an appropriate, tagged medical tool prop before you activate this power.

The target's Current Health is raised to the number called (as determined by this power's source), not exceeding their Maximum Health.

Vampires, Wraiths, Gorgons, and Spirits cannot be healed by Medicine and call "No Effect" instead.

EXAMPLES:

Louise currently has 3 Health, and Arthur is roleplaying wrapping her arm with a bandage. After 60 Uninterrupted seconds he calls "Medicine 6". Louise's Current Health is now 6.

Pierre currently has 1 Health and 5 Maximum Health. Arthur also patches their wounds and calls "Medicine 6". Pierre's Current Health is now 5.

MEDITATE (TOUCH)

M K2 Hr2 S2

Cost: 1 Energy Call: "Meditate"

The target must spend 60 Uninterrupted seconds roleplaying meditation to be affected by this power.

The target may resist the next Mental attack for free and take the identity of the caster as in-game knowledge. This protection is still expended even if the target chooses not to resist the Mental.

MELD <X> (OTHER)

Sr3 V2 Wc2 Wt

Cost: 4 Energy Call: "Melding 1, Melding 2, ..., Melding 10, Meld Into X" and "End Meld"

You must obviously touch with your hand (if X is a physical object) or be fully inside of (if X is an environment) the object or environment specified by the source of this power to activate it.

Begin a "Melding 1, Melding 2,... Melding 10" call. This count can be Interrupted. Otherwise, at the end of the count call "Meld Into X".

Go OOG for a minimum of 1 hour. All items you are carrying go OOG with you. You may sleep OOG or play

NPCs. During this time, your character is completely unaware of their surroundings and cannot make decisions about when to end this power based on what is happening IG.

To return to game you must return to the area you used this power and make the call "End Meld".

MIGHT (PASSIVE)

H2 S2 V2 W2

Cost: None Call: None

You gain Augment 1. Different sources of Augment stack with one another.

MIMIC (TOUCH)

S3 Wt

Cost: 1 Energy Call: "Mimic <Energy type> <Power>"

The target must have the stated Energy type and the stated power on their character sheet. The power cannot be Fundamental, Corrupted, or Dormant. If any of these requirements are not true they state "No Effect". If they Resist this power, you must assume IG failed because they did not meet the requirements.

You count as having the chosen power on your character sheet for the next 10 minutes, except for meeting ritual requirements. You cannot use Mimic again until these 10 minutes pass.

MONSTERS (MENTAL)

Sr2 Vc1 W2

Cost: 1 Energy Call: "Monsters"

The target believes every character they see is a horrible monster out to kill them.

MOVE OBJECT (OTHER)

W1

Cost: None Call: None

You may touch and move any object in the Realm as long as it remains in contact with something else in the Realm. You cannot make attacks with the object, but can fling it (be safe) or use it to touch a person.

O

OBEDIENCE (MENTAL)		H3 S3 V2 W3
Cost: 1 Energy	Call: "Obedience <command>" (command spoken IG)	
You must speak the command part of the sig call IG. The command must be an action or an action and a targeted noun. The target must immediately obey the command to the best of their ability. They may attack and defend themselves as normal, unless prohibited by the command. This power cannot be used to cause a target to do something that the target knows will cause them to directly take damage. This power early ends when the command is obeyed once.		
EXAMPLES "Obedience: Go into the church" - Totally valid. The power will end when the target goes inside the church. If they are far away from the church, they must spend 10 minutes trying to get there. "Obedience: Don't go into the church" - Not okay. You must give a command, and inaction isn't a command. "Obedience: Stay in the church until I come back" - Not okay, because you can't add qualifiers like this. "Obedience: Go into the church" (to a Baali) - Not okay, since Baali take Exposure damage from being on Holy Ground. This is functionally the same as ordering someone to put their hand in a fire. "Obedience: Go into the church" (when the church is full of their worst enemies waiting to attack them) - Valid. Even though they may get hurt, the damage is not coming directly from your command to go into the church.		

P

PARALYZE (STATUS)		H3 S3 V3 Wt
Cost: 2 Energy	Call: "Paralyze"	
The target is held in total paralysis, unable to speak or do anything else other than use Regeneration. They are aware of what is happening around them. This power ends early if the target is attacked or damaged. (Paralyzing Bite and Touch do not count as attacks).		

PARALYZING BITE (COUNTED TOUCH)		Srf, Vt
Cost: None	Call: "Biting 1, Biting 2, Biting 3, Paralyzing Bite"	
Place your hand on the target's shoulder and begin the count, making no more than one call per second. The call can be interrupted, including by the target moving away from you, attacking you, or using another power on you. This power does not count as an attack. If you successfully complete the count, the target is now Paralyzed per the power. This ends unless you proceed with draining (i.e. Test Faction and Draining).		

PARALYZING TOUCH (COUNTED TOUCH)		W1, Wc2
Cost: None	Call: "Tapping 1, Tapping 2, Tapping 3, Paralyzing Touch"	
Place your hand on the target's shoulder and begin the count, making no more than one call per second. The call can be interrupted, including by the target moving away from you, attacking you, or using another power on you. This power does not count as an attack. If you successfully complete the count, the target is now Paralyzed per the power. This ends unless you proceed with draining (i.e. Health Exchange or Pathos Exchange).		

PASSION (MENTAL)

K1 Hr3 S3 V3 W2

Cost: 1 Energy

Call: "Passion <emotion>" or
"Passion <emotion> for
<object or person>"

The target feels the stated emotion, towards the stated person or object (if specified).

Breacheable Umbra -> Realm

PATHOS EXCHANGE (COUNTED TOUCH) W1

Cost: None

Call: "Giving Pathos," or
"Draining Pathos"

You may use the **Paralyzing Touch** power. Pathos Exchange may only be activated after successfully using Paralyzing Touch on a target. During the Exchange, the target remains paralyzed per the power Paralyze.

You may choose to either give the target Pathos or drain their Pathos. For every call of "Giving Pathos 1, Giving Pathos 2, etc." the target gains 1 Pathos and you lose 1 Pathos. For every call of "Draining Pathos 1, Draining Pathos 2, etc." the target loses 1 Pathos and you gain 1 Pathos. Targets without Pathos call "No Effect" and the power ends.

This power ends if you or the target are Interrupted, you or your target's Pathos reaches its maximum, or if you take your hand off of the target.

Your target becomes Tainted if you are, and you become Tainted if they are (cross your fingers and ask them).

PATHOS INVESTMENT (OTHER)

W3

Cost: None

Call: None

Receive two Bottled Pathos tags at each Check-In.

PENCE FROM HEAVEN (OTHER)

H1 Hr1 S1

Cost: None

Call: None

Receive 6 copper at each Check-In.

POISON IMMUNITY (PASSIVE)

Sf

Cost: None

Call: "No Effect"

You are immune to poisons and the [Venom](#) power.

PORTAL WALK (SELF)

Wf

Cost: None

Call: "Portal Walk"

You are able to pass through a closed door, whether locked or not. Immediately open, pass through, then close said door to indicate phasing through it.

POWERFUL FORM (MASK)

Hr2 Vr2 Vr3 W3

Cost: None

Call: None

You may put on a mask as described by this power's source. While wearing any power mask, you gain Augment 1. Different sources of Augment stack with one another.

PUPPET CONTROL (MENTAL)

W3

Cost: 2 Energy

Call: "Breach Puppetry <up to 10 seconds of command>"

You must be in the Umbra and the target must be in the Realm. The command part of the sig call is OOG. The command must be an **action** or an **action and a targeted noun** that is described in no more than 10 seconds of speech. The action should specify what the target does (a verb), and if relevant, include the method, tool, or location needed to complete it. If you include a duration or condition (such as "until X happens"), the target must continue the action until that condition is met. Otherwise, the command ends after the target fulfills it once.

The target must immediately obey the command to the best of their ability. They may attack and defend themselves as normal, unless prohibited by the command. This power may be used to cause a target to do something that the target knows will cause them to directly take damage.

This power ends early when the command is obeyed to its fullest once.

Note: This power can never be made Unresistable (example: via Conditioning).

EXAMPLES

"Breach Puppetry: Kill your Friend" - Target must attack their friend. While still affected by this power, they will continue to try to take their friend to the dead state (and if they do, it ends early).

"Breach Puppetry: Go stand in a Fireplace" - Valid. Target will walk to a Fireplace they know of, stand for 1 second while taking exposure damage, then have fulfilled the command and can exit.

"Breach Puppetry: Go stand in the Fireplace in <Name of Place> until you die" - Valid. Target must stay in the Fireplace and will not exit willingly while under the effect of the power, until they drop to 0 Health.

R

RANGED 2 <TYPE> (DAMAGE) Hr2 S2 V2 W2

Cost: None Call: "<Type> 2"

Throw a packet that does 2 <type> damage, where <type> is indicated by the power's source. The damage type cannot be <Fire> or <Agg>.

RANGED 4 <TYPE> (DAMAGE) Vr3 W3

Cost: 1 Energy Call: "<Type> 4"

Throw a packet that does 4 <type> damage, where <type> is indicated by the power's source. The damage type cannot be <Fire> or <Agg>.

RAZOR CLAWS (DAMAGE) V1 Vr1 S1 Sr1

Cost: 1 Energy Call: None

Gain Augment 1 for a single swing made with natural weapons. Different sources of Augment stack with one another.

READ MAGIC (PASSIVE) H2

Cost: None Call: None

You may read the rules portion of any ritual scroll or item tag and take the information in-game.

REALM GRASP (SELF) S1 W1

Cost: 1 Energy Call: "Breach"

Pick up an object in the Realm.

RELEASE SPIRIT (TOUCH) S1

Cost: None Call: "Release Spirit"

Roleplay honoring a Dying Spirit for 10 seconds. If the target is not a Spirit in the Dying state, the power fails and they should respond "No Effect".

The Spirit immediately becomes Dead and dissipates (goes OOG). You gain 1 Willpower, up to your maximum.

REND THE LIFEWEB (OTHER) Wc2

Cost: 1 Energy Call: "Rend the Lifeweb"

Attach a green Tainted Fetter tag to a Fetter prop, next to its Fetter tag. This cannot be done to characters that are Fetters. This tag is permanent until the Fetter is destroyed.

Every time the owner of the Fetter sees the "Tainted Fetter" tag, they become Tainted.

You receive as many Tainted Fetter tags as you want each Check-In.

RESILIENCE (SELF) H2 S2 V2 W2

Cost: 1 Willpower Call: "Resist"

Resist a single Status attack, ending its effect.

RESIST GAUNTLET (SELF) H1

Cost: 1 Willpower Call: "Resist"

Resist a single attack with the "Breach" Meta call.

RESIST POISON (SELF) K3

Cost: 1 Willpower Call: "Resist"

Resist any effect that would cause you to gain a poison condition.

RESIST TAINT (SELF)

H3 S3

Cost: 1 Willpower Call: "Resist Taint"

You are aware of when you become Tainted (you can hear the "Tainted" portion of calls directed towards you IG).

After roleplaying resisting Taint for 60 seconds, you can use this power to cleanse yourself of Taint.

REVERSE MIMIC (TOUCH)

M

Cost: 1 Energy Call: "Reverse Mimic
<Energy Type>
<Power>"

The target must have the stated Energy type Active on their character sheet (not Dormant or Unique.) The power also cannot be Fundamental for that character unless they also have that power on their sheet from some other source. If any of these conditions are not met they call "No Effect". If they Resist this power, you must assume IG it failed because they did not meet the requirements.

The target may use the power from your character sheet that you name in the sig call for the next 10 minutes. The named power may not be used to meet ritual requirements. The target must pay any costs needed to use the power. A target may have multiple powers granted to them at the same time. This power may not grant powers with the Legendary or NPC Only tag.

REVIVE (TOUCH)

H3 Vr3 Wt

Cost: 1 Willpower Call: "Revive"

Spend 60 seconds meditating while touching the target. A Dying target has their current and Maximum Health set to 1. A target that is not Dying is healed 1 point of Aggravated damage and gains 1 Health, not to exceed their Maximum Health.

ROOT (STATUS)

K2 Hr1 S2 V1 W3

Cost: 1 Energy Call: "Root"

The target is unable to move either foot. This power ends early if the target is damaged.

Breachable Umbra -> Realm**S****SANCTUARY (MENTAL)**

K3 H3 W3

Cost: 1 Energy Call: "Mass Sanctuary"

Tainted targets cannot advance towards you while you're within 10 feet of them. Tainted targets cannot attack you. Targets who are not Tainted call "No Effect".

SCION OF EVIL (PASSIVE)

Sc1 Vc1 Wc1

Cost: None Call: "No Effect", "Resist"

You may call "No Effect" to the Sanctuary power. You may resist the Subjugate power as normal even if you are permanently Tainted.

SECRET ANGST (SELF)

Wc3

Cost: None Call: None

You are aware IG of any effect that would force you to reveal your Angst, and the caster of any such power. You may then respond with any Angst rating between 1 and 10.

You may always pass through a Ward Against Oblivion regardless of your Angst rating.

SENSE AMARANTH (SENSORY)

H2 V1

Cost: None Call: "Sense Amaranth"

Stare at the target for 10 seconds. They must answer OOG the number of times they have committed amaranth. Non-Vampires respond "Zero".

SENSE ANGST (SENSORY)

H1 W1 Wc1

Cost: None Call: "Sense Angst"

Stare at the target for 10 seconds. They must state OOG their current Angst rating. Targets without Angst call "No Effect".

SENSE CONFIDENCE (SENSORY) H3 Wt

Cost: 1 Energy Call: "Sense Willpower"

Stare at the target for 10 seconds. They must state OOG their current Willpower.

SENSE DEMON (SENSORY) H2 Hr1 Vc1

Cost: None Call: "Sense Demonic Vice"

Stare at the target for 10 seconds. The target must state OOG their Demonic Vice. Targets that do not have a Demonic Vice call "No Effect".

SENSE DESIRE (SENSORY) H3 Vr1 W1

Cost: None Call: "Sense Desire"

Stare at the target for 10 seconds. They must state OOG their character's greatest current desire and offer enough clarification that the caster understands the desire itself, though not necessarily the rationale behind it.

EXAMPLES

Imagine you are an assassin on a mission to kill the Vampire Lord Fangsalot, and your current greatest desire is to succeed at that. Someone uses Sense Desire on you:

"Kill Lord Fangsalot." - This is a great answer.

"Kill a Vampire." - Not ok, since it implies that your goal is to kill any Vampire, and in reality your goal is more specific.

"Find Lord Fangsalot" - Not okay; even though finding him is presumably a prerequisite to killing him, you're being evasive about your actual desire.

"Complete my mission." - A gray area: this answer might be okay depending on your character's emotional connection to the task. If you're a hardened professional killer and this is just another day at work for you, fine! But if you burn with hatred for Lord Fangsalot and want him dead on a personal level, this answer would be an intentional obfuscation of your actual desire and therefore not okay.

On the other hand, you don't need to be overly specific in your answers. "Speak with the Constable" could mean you want to report a crime, blackmail them, or complain about not getting your payment for guard duty.

SENSE EMOTION (SENSORY) H1 S1 V1 Wf

Cost: None Call: "Sense Emotion"

Stare at the target for 10 seconds. They must answer OOG with their character's greatest current emotional state and offer enough clarification that the caster understands the emotion itself, though not necessarily the rationale behind it.

SENSE ESSENCE (SENSORY) H1

Cost: None Call: "Sense Essence"

Stare at the target for 10 seconds. They must answer OOG "yes" or "no" if their current Energy type is Essence.

SENSE FAE (SENSORY) Hr2, Sr2

Cost: None Call: "Sense Fae"

Stare at the target for 10 seconds. They must answer OOG "yes" or "no" if their current Faction is Fae.*

SENSE FETTER (SENSORY) H1 W1 Wc1

Cost: None Call: "Sense Fetter"

Stare at the target for 10 seconds. They must answer OOG "yes" or "no" if they are carrying any Fetters or are themselves a Fetter. If the target is a Fetter, they must also state OOG the name of the character they are a Fetter for. Additionally, you may read Fetter item tags and take that information in-game.

SENSE GNOSIS (SENSORY) S1

Cost: None Call: "Sense Gnosis"

Stare at the target for 10 seconds. They must answer OOG "yes" or "no" if their current Energy type is Gnosis.

SENSE HEALTH (SENSORY) K1, Vr1

Cost: None Call: "Sense Health"

Stare at the target for 10 seconds. They must state OOG their Current Health.

SENSE ITEM (SENSORY)			H1 S1 V1 W1
Cost:	None	Call:	"Sense Item"
Stare at the target for 10 seconds. They must answer OOG "yes" or "no" if they are carrying any items that require Attunement or which are marked Talisman (except Talismans that are just Relics and have no other power).			
Additionally, you may read any item tag and take the information in-game.			

SENSE LIVING (SENSORY)			Wf
Cost:	None	Call:	"Sense Living"
Stare at the target for 10 seconds. They must answer OOG "yes" or "no" if they are Living .			

SENSE MAXIMUM HEALTH (SENSORY)			Vr1 Wf
Cost:	1 Energy	Call:	"Sense Maximum Health"
Stare at the target for 10 seconds. They must state OOG their current Maximum Health.			

SENSE MENTAL (SENSORY)			H1 Vr1
Cost:	None	Call:	"Sense Mental"
Stare at the target for 10 seconds. They must state OOG if they are currently affected by a Mental power.			

SENSE PATHOS (SENSORY)			W1
Cost:	None	Call:	"Sense Pathos"
Stare at the target for 10 seconds. They must answer OOG "yes" or "no" if their current Energy type is Pathos.			

SENSE RANK (SENSORY)			M H2
Cost:	None	Call:	"Sense Rank"
Stare at the target for 10 seconds. The target must state OOG their Rank. The target may choose to use Garou or Fera Ranks as appropriate. Targets that are not Shifters or targets with Pale Aura call "No Effect".			

SENSE SHADOW (SENSORY)			H1 W1 Wc1
Cost:	None	Call:	"Sense Shadow Archetype"
Stare at the target for 10 seconds. They must answer OOG with their Shadow Archetype. Targets without a Shadow call "No Effect".			

SENSE SPIRIT (SENSORY)			H1 S1 Vc1
Cost:	None	Call:	"Sense Spirit"
Stare at the target for 10 seconds. They must answer OOG their Spirit power level, or "Claimed" if they have any Claimed subfaction active. Other targets call "No Effect".			

SENSE VITAE (SENSORY)			V1
Cost:	None	Call:	"Sense Vitae"
Stare at the target for 10 seconds. They must answer OOG "yes" or "no" if their current Energy type is Vitae.			

SENSE VITALITY (SENSORY)			H3
Cost:	None	Call:	"Sense Vitality"
Stare at the target for 10 seconds. They must answer OOG "yes" or "no" if their current Energy type is Vitality.			

SERENITY (TOUCH)			H2 S2 Vr2
Cost:	1 Energy	Call:	"Serenity"
The target immediately exits Frenzy and/or Catharsis, and any Status and Mental effects active on them end.			

SHADOW COAX (TOUCH)			W2
Cost:	1 Energy	Call:	"Shadow Coax"
If the target is a Wraith, they must play their Shadow for as long as you touch them. If the target is a Specter, they must instead play their Psyche. In either situation, they cannot use Touch or Counted Touch powers. This power does not induce Catharsis or affect the target's Angst.			
If the target is not a Wraith or a Specter, they call "No Effect".			

SHATTER (OTHER)

H1 S1 V1 W2

Cost: 1 Energy Call: "SHATTER!" (shouted)

Roleplay breaking an object for 10 seconds while touching it with both hands. You must then shout the sig call as loud as you safely can.

Remove and destroy the item tag. If used on Restraints, free yourself from them. This power cannot destroy Wards.

Breachable Umbra -> Realm**SILENCE (STATUS)**

Hr1 S1 V1 Vr1 Vc1

Cost: 1 Energy Call: "Silence"

The target cannot speak and may only make soft mumbling sounds.

SILVER ARMOR (PASSIVE)

Sf S3

Cost: None Call: None

You have <Silver> armor (<Silver> no longer Scorches you).

SILVER CLAWS (DAMAGE <TYPE>)

S3

Cost: 1 Energy Call: "Silver <Number>"

Add the "Silver" <type> to a single natural weapon attack.

SILVER TONGUE (PASSIVE)

Hr3 Wt

Cost: None Call: None

You may lie in-character, ignoring any restrictions and negative effects of truth-telling powers, items, merits, skills, and rituals, except the Insight power.

SMELL FEAR (PASSIVE)

Sc1 Wt

Cost: None Call: None

You know in-game whenever the Detect Taint power is used on you.

SNARL (MENTAL)

Hr1 S1 V1

Cost: 1 Energy Call: "Snarl"

The target must stay where they are and roleplay deference to you. They cannot attack you.

This power ends early if you move out of Mental range of the target, use this power on another target, or if the target is attacked.

SONG OF RAGE (MENTAL)

S3

Cost: 1 Energy Call: "Song of Rage"

Shout a warcry. The target may enter a [Frenzy](#) at any time without losing Virtue. When they do, they choose a single character to attack first. Once that character falls to the ground the target Frenzies as normal and must attack the nearest character.

During this Frenzy, the target also gains Augment 1. Different sources of Augment stack with one another.

STEP SIDEWAYS (SELF)

Sf

Cost: None Call: None

You must have at least 1 Energy to use this power.

Unless you are within 10 feet of a Gaian Node, spend 60 Uninterrupted seconds meditating. Travel from the Realm to the Umbra or from the Umbra to the Realm.

STONEHAND PUNCH (DAMAGE)

W1

Cost: 1 Energy Call: "Breach 1"

Make a single attack with a brawl boffer that does 1 damage and can affect targets in either realm.

SUBJUGATE (MENTAL)

Sc3 Vc3 Wc3

Cost: 1 Energy Call: "Subjugate"

If the target is Tainted, they must follow all your commands to the best of their ability. If they are permanently Tainted this power is Unresistable.

If the target is not Tainted, they call "No Effect".

T

TAINT (PASSIVE)

Sc1 Vc1 Wc1

Cost: None Call: "Tainted"

You must add the Tainted <Meta> call to all attacks.

This does not apply to Subjugate, Sanctuary, Cleanse, Absolution, Gaian Cleanse

TAUNT (MENTAL)

H1 S1 Wt

Cost: 1 Energy Call: "Taunt"

Insult the target. They must attack you to the best of their ability as long as they can see you.

This power ends early if you fall to the ground.

TELEPATHY (OTHER)

H2 S2 V2 W2 Wc2

Cost: None Call: "Telepathy"

Hold two fingers to your temple and whisper to a target you can see who is within Mental range. This can be used across the Gauntlet. These whispered words are heard only in the target's mind. The target may hold two fingers to their temple to respond. This power ends if either of you remove your fingers from your temples or if you move outside of Mental range of each other.

You may also hear in-game any words spoken by other characters who are using this power, without placing your fingers on your temple.

Using Telepathy does not count as an attack.

When using this power on someone who is not in the same Realm one only needs to be able to see them. No additional call is needed.

TEMPORARY ANGST (SELF)

Wf

Cost: None Call: None

You become Tainted.

TENTACLES (SELF)

V1

Cost: None Call: None

You may use tentacle natural weapons.

TERROR (MENTAL)

S3 Sc3 V2 Vc2 Wt

Cost: 1 Energy Call: "Terror"

The target is terrified of you and must make all possible attempts to break line of sight of you.

TEST BLOOD BOND (SENSORY)

V1

Cost: None Call: "Test Blood Bond"

Consume at least 1 point of the target's blood or Vitae. The target must answer OOG "yes" or "no" if they are currently under the effect of a Blood Bond.

TEST FACTION (SENSORY)

Srf Vf

Cost: None Call: "Test Faction"

This power can only be activated on a target affected by your [Paralyzing Bite](#) or that you are touching and have completed a [cutting](#) call against.

The target must answer with their Faction as it appears on their character sheet. You may then use [Draining](#) on them.

TEST GENERATION (SENSORY)

V1

Cost: 1 Energy Call: "Test Generation"

Consume at least 1 point of the target's blood or Vitae. The target must state OOG their generation. Targets that are not Vampires call "No Effect".

TEST VITAE (SENSORY)

Hf, Vf

Cost: None Call: "Test Vitae"

Consume at least 1 point of a target's blood or Vitae. The target must answer OOG "yes" or "no" if their current Energy type is Vitae.

TOTEMIC FORM (MASK)

Sc2

Cost: None Call: None

You may put on a mask that represents your patron. While wearing any transformation mask you gain Augment 1. Different sources of Augment stack with one another.

TOUGHNESS (PASSIVE)

H3 Hr3 S3 V3 Wc3

Cost: None Call: None

Your Maximum Health is increased by 4.

TRUE FORM (MENTAL)

Hr2 S2 Wt

Cost: 1 Energy Call: "True Form"

The target must remove any transformation mask they are currently wearing and cease using the Cloak power. The target cannot wear any transformation masks, activate any Mask powers, or use the Cloak power.

U**UMBRA DRAIN (PASSIVE)**

Vr3

Cost: None Call: "Breach"

While in the Realm, you may add the "Breach" meta call to any Counted Touch power. You must have a way to see a target to touch them across the Gauntlet.

UMBRA SIGHT (PASSIVE)

H2 Hr3 S2 Vr2 Vc2 Wf

Cost: None Call: "Breach"

You can see and hear characters and landmarks in the Umbra while you are in the Realm. You can use Sensory powers that only require sight on targets in the Umbra.

UMBRA STRIKE (SELF)

H3 S3

Cost: 1 Energy Call: "Breach <attack call>"

While in the Realm, you may make a Damage, Status or Mental attack on a target you can see IG in the Umbra. This power does not give you the ability to see into the Umbra.

V**VENGEANCE OF SAMIEL (PASSIVE)**

Vr3

Cost: None Call: None

You gain Augment 1. Different sources of Augment stack with one another.

VENOM (STATUS)

Hr1 S2 Sr2 V2 Vc2

Cost: 2 Energy Call: "Venom"

The target must roleplay being ill and cannot make any attacks.

VENOM BLOOD (PASSIVE)

Srf

Cost: None Call: "Unresistable Venom"

You must call "Unresistable Venom" immediately after someone ends a "Draining" or "Draining Health" (i.e. from Health Exchange) call against you. The target is affected by the Venom Status.

VENOMOUS BITE (PASSIVE)

Vrf

Cost: None Call: "Unresistable Venom"

You must call "Unresistable Venom" immediately after ending a use of Draining. The target is affected by the Venom Status.

VISIONS (OTHER)

Hr1 V2 W2

Cost: None Call: None

You receive a prophecy at Check-In. This power is cumulative with the Oracle merit.

W

WAR FORM (MASK)

Sf

Cost: None Call: None

You must have at least 1 Energy to use this power.

You may use the [Powerful Form](#) power, with a mask that represents your Tribe. While doing so, you may use claw boffers.

<TYPE> WEAPON (DAMAGE <TYPE>)

W3 Sr2 V2

Cost: 1 Energy Call: "<Type> <Number>"

Add the <type> to a single weapon attack, where <type> is indicated by this power's source. This cannot be used with Natural weapons.

WEAPONRY (OTHER)

Vr1 W1

Cost: 1 Energy Call: "Weaponry"

Spend 10 seconds reshaping a target's limb(s) into claws and/or tentacles and place an appropriate boffer into their hand(s). You may be the target of this power; if so, it costs no Energy and is immediate.

The target of this power may use the claw and/or tentacle boffer(s) you placed in their hands until they release them OOG. If the target is unwilling, they cannot remove them for 10 minutes.

WITHER (STATUS)

Hr2 S1 V1 Vc1 W2

Cost: None Call: "Wither"

The target's maximum damage with boffer attacks is reduced by 1, to a limit of 1 damage.

Breachable Umbra -> Realm

WITHSTAND (SELF)

K2 H1 Sr1 V1 W1

Cost: 1 Energy Call: "Withstand"

Remove the <type> or Agg meta-call, from a damage attack that hits you or from [Exposure](#) damage. You still lose Current Health from attacks and Exposure damage.

This power does not work against the Aggravated damage from Draining.

WOADLING (TOUCH)

S2

Cost: 1 Energy Call: "Woadling"

Paint or draw a ritually significant symbol (from the casting characters beliefs) at least 3 inches across somewhere visible on the target's skin. The target may resist the next Status attack that hits them at no cost. Each use of the power requires a new symbol to be drawn on the target.

WOUNDING LIES (MENTAL)

S2 Wt

Cost: 1 Energy Call: "Wounding Lies"

Each time the target makes an untruthful statement per character knowledge, they suffer one Aggravated damage that cannot be resisted or soaked by armor. The target must cry out in pain if they take damage from this power.

Appendices

Appendix A – How to Prepare for Game

Getting Ready

First of all, Welcome! We're so excited that you're interested in joining Shadow Accord. Getting everything ready for your first game seems like a lot at first, but it can be broken down into a few simple steps:

1. Join the Shadow Accord Discord server (<https://discord.gg/VVYypndKaS>) to meet the community, get inspiration, and ask questions. This is also a place where you can generate character ties once you know what you're playing.
2. Register for the next game: <https://forms.gle/C52dkgZdVqSEQkRa9>. This form walks you through the information Staff needs from you so we can help you get ready.
3. (Optional) Invite your fellow nerdy friends! LARPing is very much a social activity, and you'll definitely meet people, but it can also be nice to have someone you already know.
4. (Optional) Read the [Player's Guide](#) for your chosen faction. *You can find this link on the Discord or the website.*
5. Build your character. See the guide on character building, above. You can email the Character Guides (CGs) at any point in the process but earlier is generally better (sa.characterconcepts@nwlarpers.org).
6. Plan how you're getting to game, or offer carpool spots (a great way to meet people). *Use the #need-transport channel on Discord.*
7. Figure out where you'll be sleeping. You can ask around in the faction chats to see where other members of your faction like to stay. *You can also post in #housing-and-lodging on Discord.*
8. Buy, make or borrow garb, props and boffer weapons for your character. *You can see examples or ask for things to borrow in #getting-crafty on Discord.*
9. (Optional): attend a boffer fight practice to learn the combat rules, test out your sheet, and meet other players ahead of time. *See the #fight-practice channel in the Discord.*
10. Pack your bags! See the packing list below. Make sure you have what you need to stay warm, dry, rested and fed during the weekend.

Shadow Accord Website

All of the reference materials mentioned in this rulebook are available on the Shadow Accord website:

<https://sites.google.com/nwlarpers.org/shadowaccord/wiki>

You can also find guides for building your own boffer weapons, making garb, ideas for period food, roleplaying tips, and more.

Contact Staff

Don't hesitate to ask us questions! Here's the list of the emails for the different staff teams and an outline of what each team does. You can also use the #ask-staff channel of the Discord server if you don't know who to address your question to.

Executive Officers (XOs):

sa.executiveofficers@nwlarpers.org

Email with any question, and they'll get it to the right place; also they collect reports regarding Code of Conduct violations or concerning behaviors.

Character Guides (CGs):

sa.characterconcepts@nwlarpers.org

Email to design your character or for help with character questions later on.

Check-In: sa.checkin@nwlarpers.org

Email for character sheet questions, late check-in requests, or tag requests.

Crew & Deco: sa.crew@nwlarpers.org

Email for questions about decorations & site set up! You can also contact them for questions about appropriate garb and deco for our game.

Rules Team: sa.rules@nwlarpers.org

Email with questions or suggestions about rules or game mechanics.

Safety: sa.safety@nwlarpers.org

Email for medical accommodations, safety recommendations for game, finding a place to sleep, safety questions, or to submit your food handlers card.

Storyteller Team (ST):

sa.storytellers@nwlarpers.org

Email with questions about engaging with plot, submitting downtimes, or to volunteer to NPC.

Tech: sa.tech@nwlarpers.org

Email regarding our website, social media, or other digital platforms.

Treasurer: sa.treasurer@nwlarpers.org

Email for questions about paying for a ticket, donating to the organization, event pre-registration, or moving a ticket should you not be able to attend an event.

During the Event

This section gives you a sense of what a "typical" weekend at Shadow Accord might look like. If you're struggling to conceptualize what spending an entire weekend LARPing is like, this section can help you out. Of course there are always going to be surprises and unexpected occurrences in-game!

2-9pm Friday: Staff arrives on site between noon-2pm, and most players start arriving between 4-6pm. Once you've dropped off your own gear and set up your space, come help deco (decorate) the common buildings like the tavern. You'll get XP!

5-9pm Friday: Check-In opens! Make updates to your character sheet, collect your coins and tags, get your weapons checked, pay for game, etc. Also a time to ask staff any last minute questions. As a bonus, the line outside Check-In is also a great place to meet other players and introduce yourself!

9pm Friday: *Game on!*

Don't worry if you're not ready at exactly 9pm; people filter into game as they're ready.

Most characters will be at the Tavern. You can introduce yourself in-character to the people you just met out-of-character. People are usually on the lookout for others "of their own kind", so you should get linked up with your faction relatively quickly. From there, this is your chance to start meeting people and working on your character goals.

Inevitably at some point in the evening, there will be screams from the woods, sending people running into the dark. Will you lead the pack, hang back, or use the opportunity to do something else while everyone is distracted? The choice is yours.

As the night wears on, folks may start to retire to the smaller rooms and businesses like the Teahouse, the Healer's Guild, the Lady's Lodge, or the Rune and Rod for more socializing and

back-room plotting. This is a great time to make stronger connections with potential friends and allies. Expect chances to talk about your philosophy or your backstory – but be careful what you say to whom!

There's no curfew, and some people stay up into the wee hours. You're encouraged to retire when it feels right to you, but keep in mind that plot can always come to find you in the night.

Tips for a Fun Friday Night

- **Seek out members of your faction or subfaction right away.** If you don't have Sensory powers that let you check others, you'll need to make yourself a bit conspicuous so that others have the chance to check you (keep in mind that having the Pale Aura Merit may make it difficult for your faction to find you). Try engaging in conversation around the bar in the tavern. **We expect returning members to use positive metagaming to welcome new members of their faction.**
- Join your faction's Discord channel. If you **establish some character ties** in advance, you'll have a natural starting point and some characters you can talk to right away. Be sure to make sure you know what those players / characters look like!
- Keep in mind that this is a game about **secrets**, and so you likely won't be told everything right away. This is NOT because people don't like you! The slow reveal is part of the challenge and suspense of the game.
- **"Dive in and say yes".** It can take some courage to get involved. You're socializing with (in-game) Monsters! Be bold and play along with things happening around you as best you can. It'll get easier sooner than you think.

Saturday Morning:

The sleepy town rises slowly. It's likely that breakfast will be served somewhere, and finding it can be your first quest for the day. Saturday morning is a good time to explore the whole town if you didn't get a chance to on Friday during setup.

Watch out, there could be danger lurking on the roads even in the fresh light of day!

Many factions have meet-ups some time on Saturday morning to talk about their particular business. This is your chance to introduce yourself openly to your fellows. Keep in mind that many of them are keeping secrets, and you're perfectly justified keeping some secrets of your own...

Saturday Midday:

Each Saturday in Arthorne there's either a Market or a Festival. Festivals mark the seasons or honor the old traditions of the town – if you're new around here, find the town's Tradition Keeper who will explain what to do. At markets, you can find various merchants and visitors to the town, all with their own agendas.

Veteran players should be employing **positive meta** to help steer you towards plot hooks that may be coming into town. If not, you may need to be a little more forward in inviting yourself into encounters. This can be intimidating, and we've all been there. Sit down with a stranger and ask them what they need help with. Go stand next to someone you recognize and listen in on their conversation. Keep in mind your own goals too, and look for opportunities to push them forward.

Saturday Afternoon:

If you need a change of pace, you can go play an NPC! Some Storyteller teams invite walk-in NPCs, others prefer to cast everyone in advance. When you NPC, you are given a pre-made character, a different character sheet, and get to choose garb to wear. You are told what your character's motivations are and usually given a specific task to try to accomplish. You will likely go out with a group for your first couple NPC shifts. When you get back, you debrief with an ST about what happened. The ST also helps you come up with an explanation as to why your character left town, and what they saw or did on the way.

Saturday Evening:

If there hasn't been a big fight or some dramatic occurrence so far this weekend, it'll likely happen on Saturday evening. For many in-progress plotlines, there's some kind of climax on Saturday. It's also a time when plots can overflow the factions and affect the entire town.

Saturday night is also where you can experience some deep roleplay. At this point, things have probably happened that have drawn you nearer to some characters, or made adversaries of others. Private talks in back rooms or delicate discussions around a fire to digest the happenings of the day are a satisfying nightcap.

Sunday Morning:

Sunday might include some fallout from whatever happened on Saturday – a trial, an important gathering, many hushed conversations. Or, it's a time for lighter roleplay now that the trouble has passed (for the time being). Teaching and Learning is often done on Sunday, as is the casting of certain rituals that take a lot of energy. There's usually an in-game Church service or some sparring to join.

2pm: *Game off!*

This is announced by the ringing of the bell at the Tavern and lots of shouting. Take a few minutes to collect yourself, shake yourself out of character, and then when you're ready come meet at the Tavern for closing announcements!

After announcements, we'll need help tearing down and packing up. Pack up and clean your own areas first, and then move to the public buildings to see what you can help with. Specific tasks will be assigned at closing announcements. You get more XP for helping!

??? O'Clock: Afters! Follow the U-haul truck back to Monroe. After we're done unloading at the storage unit, we'll go eat tacos, socialize, share game highlights, and generally have a good time. The address will be posted in the Discord. If you

can't join us, check out the Discord for people sharing their event stories, fun quotes, and hyping for the next game.

Help! What if I get bored?

It's normal to have some dull moments during a weekend event alongside all the exciting ones. As much as possible, try to keep yourself from lapsing out-of-character. What would you do if you were bored at home? You wouldn't stop existing as a person. Here are some things you can do to help stay in character when you don't have much going on:

Record things that have been happening in an in-game diary or letter to send back home.

Take time to interact with a prop or a piece of your garb and think about how your character acquired that gear. Is there a neat story?

Go see if you can sell something, or find out if anyone has something they're looking to sell.

Ask another character a question about their past or try to uncover a secret about them, no matter how small

Visit the church or a Glade or an in-game spot that resonates with your character and spend time meditating on your thoughts and feelings ("Personal RP").

Personal Plot

At Shadow Accord, the actions of player characters determine where the story goes. As a player at this game, you're not simply an audience member to drama happening around you – you **are** the drama. This can take some getting used to.

If you're familiar with tabletop RPGs, you might be accustomed to having a plot hook to drag you into the action: a quest storyline with an obvious trail to follow. At Shadow Accord, that's less likely to happen. The plot is primarily generated by the actions of characters and where they come into conflict with each other.

This means that an essential step to developing a character is to also develop a strong understanding of their in-character goals. What do they want, in the short term, and in the long term? What motivates them to get out of bed and put on their boots each day? What are they willing to do to get what they want? Having clear answers to these questions in mind will help you generate interesting stories around you.

Here are some tips for developing your own personal plot:

Stay in character! It's one of the key rules of the game, and it's there for your own good. If you need to break character (because of a rules question or simply because the scene is overwhelming... really, it sometimes happens) separate yourself from what's going on and take care of it quietly. Otherwise, do your best to stay in character as much as possible. Once you're acting and thinking as your character, it gets easier to find things that interest them.

Don't be scared to **try something new!** If this is your first LARP experience, everything is new. If it's your hundredth, then it can be hard to find that new thing. Either way, don't be scared! We're all here, setting aside our fears and trying the things we've never done before. Give it a chance, and you might discover something you didn't expect to really love doing.

Shoot for success, but accept failure! No plan ever goes the way you want it to. You may find that while you're mocking someone's failure, someone is driving a cart through your plans. Wrenches (and wenches) will get thrown into the best of machinations. The better you can roll with it and adapt, the happier you'll be. There's nothing wrong with losing uphill.

Make bold choices. While the "smart" thing for your character might be to wait and bide your time, that probably won't be very interesting for you as a player. Your Vampire might live for hundreds of years, but you only get a few weekends a year to

play them. Go investigate strange deaths, run toward that sound in the woods, summon that Totem, pick fights, talk to that mysterious merchant, etc.

Do a bit of research and **know the setting.** We're playing in Medieval Brittany. Do you know who the Duke is? Do you know what's going on with the Church? What about your own backstory – what town did you come from, what were your parents like, etc? Details like this shape the interactions you have during game. A bit of research is the difference between an interesting conversation and a blank response.

Character Trouble & Goals

Here's an exercise you can use to develop your own personal plot. Come up with a few items in each category for your character. You can come back and reflect on them each game as you make progress and experience character development.

Short term goals - These are specific tasks that you can realistically achieve in 1-2 games. *E.g. Get a job in town, figure out what the barkeeper's keeping secret, steal Fred's hat, make a new Ghoul, learn Moliarte, befriend a Shifter, introduce yourself to the new Sheriff, etc.*

Long term goals - These may take years (5 games or more) to complete, but when you do it'll be a major achievement for your character. Potentially, finishing all your long term goals is a cue to you to retire your character – or you'll have a new set of long term goals to work towards. *E.g. Be embraced by the Giovanni, train an apprentice in your fellowship, earn the rank of Athro, take over ownership of the tavern, lead a coup against the baron, etc.*

Lifelong Goals - These are probably not achievable in-game, at least on the timescales we play with. But they should be on your character's mind at all times, and they should have an understanding of how their other goals support their ultimate ambitions. *E.g. Kill every bane spirit, diablerize Mithras, find the Holy Grail, defeat death itself, become the greatest baker in all of France, etc.*

Lifelong trouble - These are the kinds of trouble that will stick with your character for the rest of their lives, and probably haunt their dreams. They may be trying to resolve these problems, or they may have come to peace with how things are (for now!) *E.g. I will always have to hide my powers from humans, I've angered an immortal being, there are people hunting me for who I am, I will always be an outsider, I've fallen to the Wyrms, I never knew the love of my family, etc.*

Long term trouble These are sticky situations that you may be able to clear up in the long term, but it may take some effort (and plot!) to do so. *E.g. I'm wanted for murder, I know a secret that could get me killed, I'm grieving the death of my brother, I've sworn an oath to help someone I hate, I made a mistake that cost me Rank, I've never been on my own before, etc.*

Short term trouble - These are little faux pas that you should be able to resolve in the span of 1-2 games. *E.g. I offended the innkeeper, I owe a bunch of shillings, I lost my sword, I don't have a reliable source of Vitae, I haven't been able to prove my prowess in battle, I need to return this diary before anyone realizes it's missing, etc.*

Logistics

Regardless of the character you're playing, you yourself are still a human being during this weekend. Here's some info to help you plan for your regular human needs during the weekend.

Sleeping

Buildings are "owned" in-game by characters or groups of characters, who determine who is able to sleep in them. However, you are guaranteed a suitable place to sleep when you sign up for game. Safety Team reserves some of the beds in the (heated) Lady's Lodge Inn for medical accommodations, and those beds are available by arrangement for players who can't find another place to sleep. Contact Safety Team for more info.

Be aware that some of the sleeping areas are in unheated cabins. The cabin bunks also do not have mattresses. If you're planning to sleep in those

buildings, come prepared with what you need to be comfortable. Bedding does not need to be super "period", but it would be great to avoid bright colors if possible, or stash it away during the day.

Food and Cooking

Unlike other LARPs, the organizers of Shadow Accord **do not provide food during the event.** However, there are usually players selling refreshments for either in-game coin or through pre-purchased meal tabs, and these schemes are announced before game. You're also welcome to sell food, but if you're doing any food prep other than for yourself, you'll need to have a food handlers card. You also need a food handlers card to use the industrial kitchen on site. There are several kitchenettes and fridges in the main buildings you can use to store and make food. We ask that if you are eating obviously non-medieval foods (cheetos, soda, candy bars, etc.), you either do it somewhere private or transfer the food to a more discreet container.

Bathrooms and Showers

There are bathrooms in or near all the buildings, and at the lake. All the heated buildings also have showers; check with the in-game "owners" of the space whether it's okay to use them. There are also showers in the bathrooms near the unheated cabins. Bathrooms are always OOG spaces.

Getting to Game

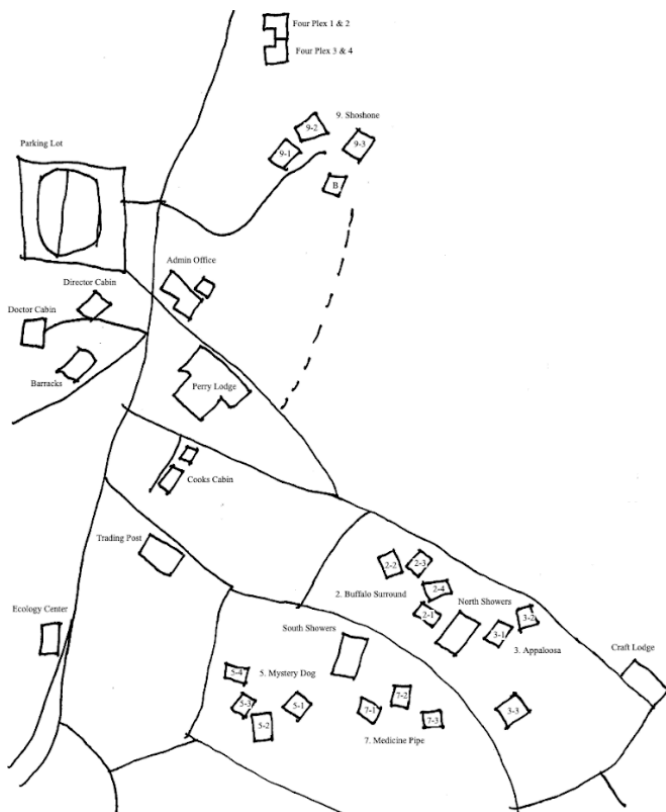
Most players drive themselves or carpool with others. You can use the Discord to ask about getting a ride to and from game. Most players are happy to help, especially if you can get to a nearby town like Monroe or Everett. We offer XP for players who help others get to game.

Moving Around Site

Site is a mixture of gravel roads and forest trails. You may encounter mud puddles, uneven surfaces, face-height branches, and other obstacles. We

mark the major paths and main hazards with small electric candles, but we also encourage players to use caution. Some players carry small red flashlights to see where they're going without ruining their night vision. Most of the main buildings have step-free access, but there are some loft areas with steep, narrow stairways. There are carts available in the parking lot to help move your things to where you'll be staying.

Map of Site with OOG building Names



Medical Accommodations

Many of our players need accommodations for real-life conditions, and we welcome you to be vocal about letting us know what your needs are. Safety Team can help get you what you need, whether it's an outlet for a CPAP machine or a fridge to store medication. Additionally, we have "non-com" rules for players who can't engage in boffer combat for whatever reasons.

What to Pack

Packing can seem daunting at first, but it breaks down into a two simple categories:

Things you need for a regular overnight camping trip:

- Bedding (sleeping pad, sleeping bag, pillow)
- Toiletries and medication
- Clothing, including base layers for your character
- Extra socks
- A water bottle
- Food and snacks that you want to eat during the weekend

Things you need for your character:

- Garb, including a warm layer like a cloak or a wool hood
- Backup garb in case you get wet and want to swap a layer or two
- Sturdy footwear
- Boffer weapons or packets
- A bag or pouch to hold loot
- Props and items for your character, like a Crinos mask, Fetters, Foci, or other objects
- Your character sheet (returning characters)
- Optional: a small flashlight or lamp

Appendix B – Things that Go Bump in the Night

The Menagerie

Even Monsters have Monsters. The world is vast and very few can claim perfect knowledge of everything in it.

This is a smattering of the types of rare encounters a character in this world may have, provided here to give you a sense of what kinds of things are possible for you to encounter as your character, in case it helps shape your character goals. You still must have the appropriate Lore in order to take any of this information into game. This list is not exhaustive of everything available in the ST rulebook.

Some of these creatures are possible for a PC to become during game, even if they aren't available at character creation. Consider this the Shadow Accord "Secret Menu" if you will.

Ahrímanes (Vampire) – Fiercely independent like their parent Clan, these Norse nomads communicate with their secretive sisters with runic symbols to mark territories.

*In theory, a PC could be embraced as an Ahrímanes. Their tree **can** be taught or gained through Amaranth.*

Angels (Several Factions) – Messengers of God. Those of any religion are wise to be respectful of these powerful spirits.

Angels can be summoned by characters using the appropriate rituals or roleplay.

Barghest (Wraith) – The secret ritual art of the Masquer's Guild, the Barghest is the backbone of many Legion outfits and the protectors of Wraith who can afford to have them made. Their brains are muddled and bound to the service of their master and their bodies are augmented to terrible strength and resilient bodies.

Barghests are created by performing a ritual on a Wraith; it's possible for PCs to become a Barghest.

Demons (Several Factions) – Demons' goals are esoteric, complicated and vile. Each individual Demon has a myriad of plots and plans active at any time, but their methods and tools are often quite similar. They aren't usually able to affect the physical world directly, so Demons must use mortal humans (and sometimes supernatural creatures) to accomplish their goals.

PCs can have pacts with demons. [See below](#) for more information on that.

Djinn (Sorcerer) – A powerful Spirit which can be summoned and dealt with. However, one must be wary in its presence.

Characters can summon Djinn using the appropriate rituals.

Fae (Several Factions) – The Fae are otherworldly creatures of myth and legend. They've been known to meddle in the affairs of humans and other non-Fae, though it is unclear if they do so for their own amusement or some greater purpose.

Fae can be summoned with the appropriate rituals or roleplay. Fae can make deals that grant unique, story altering powers, but at similarly story-altering costs.

Ferryman (Wraith) – The Ferryman have existed as an organization since before the dawn of Stygia, following their sacred duty to shepherd all Wraith towards Transcendence. Their influence is incredible as they are expected to be beyond reproach in their duties.

PCs may begin the process of joining the Ferryman by first resolving their Fetters and undergoing extensive Pardoning to reduce their Angst to 1. From here you may work with the Ferryman to join

their ranks and finish the process to banish your Shadow and fulfill your duty to the dead. You **cannot** be a PC Ferryman; this is a route to character retirement.

Followers of Set (Vampire) – Also called Settites, these Cainites don't believe that they are descended from Cain, instead they understand themselves to be the descendants of an ancient god. When they begrudgingly associate with Vampires, they are known to be quite vocal in correcting the misconceptions about themselves, which has earned them a reputation for fanaticism.

This was previously a PC subfaction, meaning that there are potentially active characters out there who are Settite. It **is** possible for a PC to become a Settite through embrace or be taught or gain their tree through Amaranth.

Gargoyle (Vampire) – Fearsome stone servants of the Tremere, who have discovered a means to hijack the blood properties of several different Clans.

Vampires of Clans Tzimisce, Gangrel, or Nosferatu can be transfigured into a Gargoyle, with a new set of Innate Disciplines. Their tree **cannot** be taught or gained through Amaranth.

Gurahl (Shifter) – Mighty protectors of Gaia, the were-bears are incredibly rare and wise. They are usually patient and slow to anger, but ferociously dangerous when enraged. Gurahl are very rare in the world, never having recovered from extensive losses in the war of rage.

In theory, a PC kinfolk could become Gurahl, although it's very unlikely. However, their tree **can** be taught.

Kiasyd (Vampire) – The children of Marconius have been forever changed by the Fae blood that was ritually imbued into their progenitor. These Vampire-Fae hybrids do not fully belong in the Fae or Vampire worlds, but must exist in both.

In theory, a PC could be embraced as a Kiasyd, but it is unlikely to happen. Their tree **cannot** be taught or gained through Amaranth.

Legion of Fate (Wraith) – The Legion of Fate is the most exalted of the Legions, composed of those whose deaths were foretold.

Representatives of this Legion may appear in-game, but it is **not** an option for PC concepts.

Lhiannan (Vampire) – Priestesses of the old ways, Lhiannan are hunted to near-extinction by Christianity, Gangrel, and Lupines alike.

In theory, a PC could be embraced as a Lhiannan, but it is unlikely to happen. However, their tree **can** be taught or gained through Amaranth.

Lich (Sorcerer) – Although the method of doing so remains a guarded secret, it's known to be possible for a Sorcerer to bring themselves back from Death over and over again. It's presumed that the method of doing so is so unspeakably evil that only a few would choose it for themselves.

Sorcerers PCs **can** create phylacteries that allow them to return to life if they die.

Mage (Sorcerer) – Mages are humans who have Awakened to a different plane of understanding. Their reality-warping power is enough to make even the toughest Garou or Cainite steer clear of offending them. While Sorcerers share some of the same philosophies, rituals, and abilities, Mages are exponentially more powerful.

NPC Mages may appear from time to time. PCs **cannot** become Mages, even as a route to character retirement.

Mokolé (Shifter) – The were-lizards are gifted with Mnesia – the collective memories of their ancestors, stretching back to the great Dragon Kings. The Mokolé are one of the rarest remaining Changing Breeds.

*In theory, a PC kinfolk could become Moloké, although it's very unlikely. However, their tree **can** be taught.*

Nagah (Shifter) – The were-snakes are descended from and taught by the Mokolé. They are consummate assassins and dispassionate observers. Other Changing Breeds believe the Nagah to be extinct, and this suits them quite nicely.

*In theory, a PC kinfolk could become Nagah, although it's very unlikely. However, their tree **can** be taught.*

Plasmics (Wraith) – In the Sea of Sorrows everything that has ever been dreamt, every story that has ever been told, every myth ever held as truth has form. These forms are called Plasmics. Ranging from the mundane to the fantastical to the unquantifiable, Plasmics are the stuff of dreams made real within the Deadlands.

Plasmics are semi-frequent visitors to game space.

Rokea (Shifter) – The were-sharks have little concern for the matters of the surface world, which they call the "Unsea". They have neither fear nor hate of the inhabitants of the surface, but their intolerance for those who do not understand the Sea makes them dangerous nonetheless.

*In theory, a PC kinfolk could become Rokea, although it's very unlikely. However, their tree **can** be taught.*

Spirits (most Factions) – The umbrella term for a vast mosaic of umbral beings, from the barely sentient spirits representing the simplest concepts, to god-like entities with intricate motives and methods. Spirits have a complex relationship to the Material Realm; they may be birthed by strong emotions, the creation of objects or the birth of new life, or perhaps ephemera simply finds a home and identity by connecting with such things. Spirits begin their lives as tiny dormant motes of energy. Eventually, as their material reflection grows and strengthens, they

become powerful enough to awaken (or be awakened by something else). While some spirits may exhibit complex behavior and high levels of intelligence, they always act according to their natures.

*Spirits may be summoned using appropriate rituals or roleplay. Spirits, especially powerful ones, **can** grant abilities or gifts.*

Zombie (Vampire and Mage) – A soulless, mindless, reanimated corpse. Brought back from the grave (or mortuary table) for the sole purpose of serving its animator's bidding. Their time is short, however, and within a matter of weeks they will likely return to the grave.

*Zombies are created via a ritual performed on a Dead character; it **is** possible to perform this ritual on a PC.*

Demon Rules

A Demon can invest some amount of their own power to grant their servants greater abilities or resources in return for their service.

Demon followers generally fit into one of four categories: members of **Demonic cults** follow a Demon openly and knowingly to cast aside the constraints of the laws of man and God for power; **Redemption cults** are filled with those who knowingly follow a Demon in an attempt to bring them back to God's favor; **Angelic cults** follow Demons who disguise themselves in their former glory to trick followers out of the service of God; **God cults** are led by powerful Demon lords who can challenge, trick, and steal the worship of other Gods and Spirits in the world.

Being the servant of a Demon is a double-edged sword. On the one hand, it opens up the servant's eyes to the greater universe. They are given a deeper understanding of God's creation, through their connection to what was once an angelic being. On the other hand, that connection also warps them into an image of their dark master. In their service they are given a taste of the true power that lies just out of reach of humankind; with each further taste of that power, they are driven further into the darkness where it emanates.

Relationships with Demons are developed in stages, from simple bargains to fully selling one's soul. Only Humans, Vampires, Shifters, and Mages may be made into full Thralls; Wraiths are souls, and thus unable to bargain them away. Wraiths may still be bargained with, but will rarely go past stage 1 (and can never become invested Thralls at stage 3). Demons who make agreements are bound by those agreements, and must do everything in their power to accomplish them.

Stage 1: Bargains and Agreements

Demons do not have the power to force another to give up a part of its soul for their use. This can only be done voluntarily, though the demon may use seduction or bribery as a means to convince their target. They may lie about details outside of the pact to convince their target to agree, but they cannot lie about the pact itself (i.e. the demon may say they are an angel, but they cannot offer something they cannot or do not intend to give if the person swears themselves.)

As such, Demons will often begin a relationship with generosity and bargains. Demons have access to a number of powers and resources (e.g. temporary use of powers, wealth, status and favors from other NPCs, rituals or small magic items, etc.) that they can offer in exchange for specific services. All exchanges made in this way will likely be temporary and minor. The subject has not given up any part of their soul yet or even made any permanent offerings, and as such the Demon is unlikely to give up anything of significant value. They can make it clear to the target that more power awaits if they agree to accept a greater degree of connection, service, and ultimately submission to the Demon.

Making a one-off exchange with a Demon does not change your character sheet or affect your answer to Sense Demon.

Stage 2: Pacts and Patronage

As before, patronage and servitude is negotiated as part of a bargain or agreement. The offer by the Demon will likely be of more significant value in exchange for the risks of a formalized demonic connection (there are in-game effects that can determine patronage). The most common pact made with Demons is to be able to learn corrupt powers (Fallen Paths and Dark Thaumaturgy), but other benefits are available as well. Demons are bound to follow through on their agreements.

Demonic patronage cannot be forced and must be a voluntary choice of the target. It is very difficult and exceedingly dangerous to end a Demonic patronage or change your patronage to a different Demon. Players can begin with a Demon patron at Character Creation; consult the Character Guides for information on which Patrons are available.

Having a Demon patron does add the Demon to your character sheet, but it does not give you a Demonic Vice or affect your answer to Sense Demon.

Stage 3: Invested Thralls

The final stage of demonic servitude comes with the exchange of part of the servant's soul for a gift of what they desire: enormous wealth, social influence, great powers, or some other reward. Effectively, almost anything available within the mechanics of the game is available as a reward from a Demon. These gifts are called Thrall Arcana. As with previous bargains and pacts, Demons must honor the promises they make.

Investment of demonic powers into a non-Demon provides them some measure of the Demon's own twisted evil. Invested thralls have a Torment rating that increases with each Thrall Arcana given to them by their master. These Torments have increasingly debilitating weaknesses as the Thrall becomes more and more filled with the blasphemous powers their master grants them. There are specific consequences to higher Torment ratings that STs will explain to you as they become relevant.

Thralls gain a Demonic Vice matching that of their Demon, which is detectable to those using the Sense Demon power. In addition:

- Thralls cannot buy additional Virtue; once you have sold your soul, your Virtue can only ever go down, never back up.

- Thralls that die cannot return as a Wraith; their souls go to their demonic master upon death. If they have either the Lost Soul or Mortwight Merit, those are removed upon investment.
- Thralls cannot resist the power Induce Sin if the sin chosen matches their Demonic Vice.
- Thralls cannot resist Mental powers used on them by their demonic master.
- Thralls treat <Holy> damage as Aggravated, and take <Holy> [Exposure](#) damage while in contact with a cross or standing on Holy Ground (e.g., inside a church).

Invested Thralls cannot change their patron. Their Demon master is permanently imprinted upon them. Torment and Thrall Arcana are permanent. Once you have sold your soul, there is no getting it back.

Demons banished to the Pit cannot maintain their Thralls in the same way as before. The power that they grant is temporarily cut off, but the negative effects of close connection to a Demon remain.

Becoming a Demon thrall can only happen in-game and is not available from Character Creation. Players should be aware that becoming a Demon Thrall puts your character at risk of being killed, and even though you now have access to great power, you have little choice in the matter when your Demonic master calls you to serve.

Appendix C – Unofficial Roleplay Rules

Players are welcome to roleplay their characters between official events, either through in-person events (e.g. faction meetups) or text roleplay with other players. While such roleplay can and does affect the narrative of the world we play in, be aware that the staff of Shadow Accord does not have the ability to monitor or arbitrate what happens in unofficial roleplay.

The Shadow Accord Code of Conduct is in force anywhere Shadow Accord players interact, including in unofficial roleplay settings. Keep in mind that requirements to ask for physical touch extend to text description of physical touch as well.

No permanent character changes may occur during unofficial RP. This includes character death, embrace, change in rank, or any other changes to character sheets. Of course, your *character* doesn't know this. You can roleplay Teaching, but that character will not be eligible to purchase that power or skill until they've also been taught during an official event.

Do not steal tagged items at unofficial events, because doing so can bring about consequences that cannot occur outside of official roleplay space (e.g. the other character decides to kill your character).

During unofficial RP, and especially text RP, **you may choose how closely you adhere to mechanics.** Text roleplay is an opportunity to represent actions and aspects of powers that can't be fully represented in normal game-space, such as flying and certain types of shape-shifting. However, if you deviate from the standard mechanics for SA, you should check with the other players you're roleplaying with so that you all agree on conventions.

Be mindful if you introduce a character in unofficial roleplay who's an unwanted interloper. It isn't possible to kill anyone through unofficial RP, so if your character is, say, openly a servant of the

Wyrms, then don't go to Moot. It disrupts other people's game if they have to deal with that sort of character without being able to do permanent harm. If you do bring such a character, respect other players' wishes if they choose to run you off.

Do not introduce a new player character in unofficial roleplay until they've been approved by Character Guides. Don't ask CG to approve characters just for text roleplay that you don't intend to also play at an official event.

Unofficial roleplay cannot be used as a means of meta-gaming. For example, you cannot contrive a roleplay scene so that your PC conveniently stumbles upon a secret or uncovers information that you as a player know about. Another PC may choose to reveal new information to you during text roleplay, but you cannot engineer a scene to gain information. Characters belonging to the same player can never interact, even indirectly.

While not encouraged, you may create NPCs to interact with in text roleplay, such as an NPC from your character's backstory. Player-made NPCs cannot be used to transmit any information of consequence to PCs. (Acceptable: A PC talks with their NPC sire, and the sire reminds them of the tenants of their Clan. Unacceptable: The NPC sire has been off spying on rival Clans and fills the PC in on all the details). STs cannot interact with player-made NPCs.

You are not required to participate in any between-game roleplay. Some players are enthusiastic about it and others don't care for it. If you are organizing a faction meetup, please invite the whole faction and send a summary of what was discussed to those who weren't able to attend. Engage in unofficial roleplay at your own risk; things your character says and does can affect your interactions at official events in ways you might not expect. Most of all, take the time to check in with other players and make sure they're having a good time.

Appendix D – ST and Me

The STs have compiled a guide called “ST and Me”, which is available on the Discord and the Website. Some of the most important parts of that guide are reproduced here.

The Wider World

The Storyteller (ST) Team is responsible for representing the wider world of Shadow Accord, outside the borders of our small town. This wider world has its own stories and problems that sometimes spill over into town. The world is also inhabited by a variety of friends, foes, and forces who may choose to react to things happening inside the town.

Unlike some LARPs (and most TTRPGs), our Storyteller team does not necessarily drive the plot themselves, and is not responsible for providing plot hooks to you. Instead they focus the majority of their energy on assisting you in telling your own stories, and representing the presence of non-player characters (NPCs) and their reactions to your choices.

Storyteller Camp

Storytellers work out of the Storyteller Camp (ST Camp) during the game weekend. ST Camp is located in the craft building near the archery range.

During game weekends, STs are often juggling many pieces at once (and some of those pieces

are on fire). Please bring your patience and be prepared to wait your turn to talk to them. Each ST may have their own system, but generally you will check in with an ST, briefly explain what you're here for, and the ST will call you back when they're ready for you.

Going Out of Town

Players can choose to have their characters leave town for a period of time during an event, for instance to investigate something nearby or talk to an out of town NPC. To leave town, come to Storyteller's Camp. STs determine how far or how fast a character can go, taking into account any supernatural advantages you have (e.g. being able to fly or run faster than a normal human). You must stay out of the game for the appropriate amount of time to represent the time it takes to travel - this is a great time to NPC!

NPCs

STs rely on volunteers from the community to take shifts playing the non-player characters (NPCs) who populate the wider world of the game and drive plots. Between games the Storytellers will use NPCs in downtime responses and will plan for their use in the next game. If you have signed up for the NPC interest form you may receive an email asking for your assistance in the upcoming game for a scheduled shift. NPCs from this shift may turn into recurring NPCs that can be scheduled for multiple games in the future. During the game weekend you may find free time or have something to do out of town; in this case coming to ST camp to perform an NPC shift is appropriate



and you will be received and given a shift as needed by the Storytellers.

Downtime Reports

As Storyteller bandwidth permits, you may have the opportunity to submit **Downtime Reports**. This is where you describe what your character does or attempts to do between games. The STs set the restrictions on how extensive these can be. Generally, you shouldn't expect major plot events to occur during downtimes, but your downtime actions may help lay groundwork for a new plot or continue an existing plot.

Summonings

Certain Rituals allow characters to summon powerful NPCs to talk to or deal with. It's important to give ST ample notice when you're planning to cast these rituals, because they're the ones sending out the NPC – ideally let them know many weeks before an event when and what you're trying to summon, then send in-game someone to let them know that you've done the summoning. Each ST team will have their own guidelines for how summonings work.

Newsletters

The STs publish an in-game “newsletter” for each faction with updates on rumors, gossip, and happenings from the time between each event. Newsletter items are things you may choose to follow up on in-game, such as when you go OOG to NPC. These newsletters are published on the Discord in the week before each event.

Prophecies

Some characters receive prophetic knowledge through powers or abilities they have. If you have this ability, you can request a Prophecy from ST that you will pick up at Check-In. Each team has their own guidelines about how prophecies work.

Character Sheet Changes

If something happens to you during an event that causes a permanent change to your character sheet (e.g dying, a change in faction, gaining a patron, etc.), you should go to ST camp as soon as you can after the roleplay is done to have your sheet updated. The change will be added by the STs to your sheet and recorded and sent to the Check-In team to have your sheet updated.

Appendix E – Victim's Guide

There are a lot of rules in this game, we know. You can always make the OOG sign to ask someone to explain a power, but it's best to have an awareness of how you should react to the most common powers and actions people will use against you. It's always okay to forget how a power someone else uses works, as long as you ask and don't assume. It's **never** okay not to know how your own powers work - you should always be prepared to explain to your own victims. Remember someone can only hit you once per second, and any more than that you don't hit. If someone is swinging too fast or too hard, put your hand above your head and let them know OOG so that they can adjust.

Someone makes a call that goes 1... 2... 3...

They're probably trying to do something bad to you!

You can stop this count by doing really *anything*. Move away from them, hit them with a boffer, use a power on them, etc. You only have until the count of three though, so act fast. This doesn't count as an attack, so it won't end things like Paralysis.

Bitten vs Tapped

If the counted call ends in 'Paralyzing Bite', you were bitten by a Vampire or an Ananasi (Werespider)! Until the draining ends (which includes if you run out of Health, so slump over when that happens), you can't move. Once it's over, you should roleplay being woozy and unsure what just happened. A Vampire's bite feels oddly pleasant and intoxicating, while an Ananasi's feels like being bitten by giant spider fangs. If your attacker makes it clear which they are, feel free to roleplay accordingly.

If the counted call ends in 'Paralyzing Touch', you're similarly paralyzed as they give or take your Health or Pathos (if you have any). Once free,

you'll feel chilled, like getting dipped in freezing water or having an ice cube run up your spine.

Someone hits me with a boffer...

If they say a number you take that much damage.

If they say a <type> (e.g. "Dark") that you're Scorched to, you also lose 1 Maximum Health.

- **"Disarm"** - if you block this attack with a martial weapon, drop that weapon.
- **"Brutal"** - if you block this attack with anything, take the full damage and effect as if it hit you.

Someone hits me with a packet...

If they say a <type> and a number (e.g. "Fire 2") you take that much damage.

If they say something else, you do that thing for the next 60 seconds. Unlike damaging packets, those cannot be blocked with shields. Most of the calls are descriptive of what they do, but you can always ask to clarify.

- **"Body Wrack"** - roleplay being in intense pain. You can only attack with boffers (no using other powers back at them) and move at walking speed.
- **"Disable"** - you can't spend Energy.
- **"Paralyze"** - you're frozen in place. Ends early if you take damage or are attacked with a power.
- **"Root"** - your feet are stuck to the ground. Ends early if you take damage.
- **"Venom"** - roleplay being horribly ill. You can't make any attacks, but you can run away.

Someone touches me on the arm...

Unless they say “Detect...”, you can spend a Willpower to resist the effect:

- **“Detect X”** - they are using a Sensory power on you. Respond yes or no based on whether it applies to you (or ask if you’re not sure).
- **“Daze”** - Resist or roleplay falling asleep until something wakes you up (a push, loud noise, attack) or you’re left alone for 10 minutes.
- **“Forgetful Mind”** - Resist or permanently forget the last 10 minutes.
- **“Healing Touch <X>”** - gain X Health.
- **“Induce Frenzy”** - Resist or [Frenzy](#).
- **“Medicine <X>”** - gain Health, up to X or your maximum (whichever is lower).
- **“Revive”** - if you’re Dying, gain 1 Maximum Health and 1 Current Health. Otherwise, heal 1 Aggravated damage.
- **“Serenity”** - Resist or every Frenzy, Catharsis, Status, and Mental effect on you ends.

Someone looks at me and says something...

If the call begins with “Sense”, they’re using a Sensory power on you. Answer with the truth (as per your character sheet). If you don’t know what something is, it probably doesn’t apply to you, but you can always check.

- **“Sense Emotion”** - How are you feeling? Pick a single adjective.
- **“Sense Desire”** - What is your current greatest desire? You need to be specific. See the Sense Desire power for examples.
- **“Sense Faction”** - Answer with your faction as per your character sheet.
- **“Sense Health”** - How much Health do you currently have?
- **“Sense Item”** - Do you have a Talisman or magic item that requires Attunement on you?
- **“Sense Spirit”** - Answer “Claimed” if your subfaction is Claimed, or your Spirit Type if you are playing a Spirit NPC; otherwise say “No Effect”.
- **“Sense Vitae”/“Sense Essence”/“Sense Pathos”/“Sense Gnosis”** - Answer yes or no if this is your Energy Type.

- **“Sense Willpower”** - What’s your current Willpower?

The call is something else...

This is probably a Mental, but you can check if you’re not sure. You can spend a Willpower to resist these effects if you have an in-game reason to do so. See the section on [Mental Powers](#) for more information.

- **“Avert”** - Resist or be unable to attack or step closer to the caster (whose palm will face you).
- **“Beast Mind <Predator/Prey>”** - Resist or roleplay as a predatory / prey animal (no talking).
- **“Confusion”** - Resist or roleplay not knowing who you or anyone else is, or what’s going on. You can still defend yourself but you won’t remember what you did while affected.
- **“Entrancement”** - Resist or roleplay being Burdened to the caster. You may read the [Burdens](#) section for more information.
- **“Hallucination <Description>”** - Resist or roleplay perceiving that hallucination.
- **“Monsters”** - Resist or roleplay perceiving everyone else as a horrible monster.
- **“Obedience <Command>”** - Resist or follow the command to completion.
- **“Passion <Emotion> (<Target>)”** - Resist or roleplay feeling that emotion towards that target (if specified).
- **“Subjugate”** - if you’re Tainted, Resist or follow the caster’s commands; otherwise say “No Effect”. If you’re Permatainted, you can’t resist.
- **“Taunt”** - Resist or attack the caster.
- **“Terror”** - Resist or break line of sight with the caster however possible.

Someone holds their arms out and says “Mass <Call>”...

If you’re within 10 feet, you just got hit by that call, even if you’re Cloaked. Treat it as if it were a single target power that was targeted normally.

Someone says “Tainted <Call>”...

If the call hits you and you don't (or can't) immediately Resist, you're now Tainted. See the section on [Being Tainted](#) for information on how to roleplay this.

Someone feeds me their blood....

If you can move your mouth away, you avoid

drinking it. Otherwise, that character is likely a Vampire and drinking their blood will Blood Bond you - they should explain if this is the case. See the section on [Burdens](#) for information on how to roleplay this. If you're a Human and drink more than 1 point of this blood at once, you become a Ghoul

Appendix F – What Do You See?

While Shadow Accord is a mostly WYSIWYG game (What You See Is What You Get), there are some effects that require use of the imagination to understand what is being represented. This table lists some common things that you may hear or see that are indicative of a supernatural or mechanical effect.

What you See/Hear Out-of-Game	What it Means In-Game	Source
Arms crossed over chest	The hand signal is OOG. The character is immune to attacks.	Hasty Escape power
Black boffers	Black Boffers are OOG unless being held in a character's hand, at which point they represent fists, claws, or tentacles.	Natural Weapons
Blue light	Light emanating from the Umbra.	
Someone is wearing a face covering (other than an OOG medical mask)	The face covering is visible in-game. The character may be Disguised , but unless you recognize their garb in-character you do not immediately recognize who they are (you can still figure it out if they act exactly like a character you know but you should assume they are playing someone new otherwise).	
Fingers crossed in front of face	The player is briefly OOG. This is usually used for checking in on another player or getting clarifications.	
Fingers to the temples while whispering to someone	The hand signal is OOG. The character is speaking telepathically; only the target or those with Telepathy may hear the speech.	Telepathy power
“Flub” sig call	A player did not hear a sig call you used against them, or believes it was used incorrectly (e.g. calling “Mass Unresistable Entrancement” or “Hallucinate: <ten words>”). You can repeat the call more clearly, and they should clarify if they can understand it but believe it to be invalid.	
Hand in front of face, fingers splayed	This hand signal is OOG. The character is invisible and untaractable, unless you have the Cloak Sight power.	Cloak power
Hands held outstretched to either side	This hand signal is OOG. The power just used by this Character affects everyone in a 10 foot radius.	Mass powers

Hand or boffer placed on head	The player is OOG (this is used for signaling at a distance).	
Hand stretched out in front of you ("stop" gesture)	This hand signal is in-game. The character receiving this gesture is unable to attack or approach the caster.	Avert Power
"Hold!" (or "Stand Down!")	Someone is injured or needs a break. Go OOG until the situation is resolved, repeating the call to anyone who hasn't paused the scene. Resume play after the person who called the Hold says "Lay on!"	
Item tags	Tags are OOG, and can be attached to items. Tagged items can be stolen and might have mechanical effects. Tags cannot be read in-game except with Sense Item and similar abilities. You can always read a tag OOG for clarity on how it looks or affects you mechanically.	
"3, 2, 1, Lay on!"	This should only be called by someone who called "Hold!" or "Stand down!" to pause a scene for health or safety reasons, after the issue has been resolved or moved to another location. After the call is made, play resumes.	
Someone wearing a mask that is obviously non human - animal, monster, etc.	This character is obviously and monstrosly supernatural (the mask is OOG until it's worn). However, if you can recognize the character's garb, you can still recognize the character.	Various: Mask powers such as Powerful Form, Totemic Form, etc., or effects of Rituals.
"No Effect" sig call	Whatever power of effect is being used on that character isn't relevant, or they're immune to it. However, you don't necessarily know in-character that your attack failed (unless it's obvious that they're not under the effect). "No Effect" is used instead of "Resist" so that the attacking player understands that their target isn't cheating if their attack is still unsuccessful after multiple attempts.	
Numbers associated with weapon swings	Anyone witnessing the attack can tell approximately how powerful it is - calls for "two" and above look like incredibly powerful blows, while calls for "zero" look like sparring more than fighting.	
Orange headband or markings	The player is OOG, or the marked container is OOG.	
Packets	Packets are OOG except when they're being thrown, at which point they appear as a visibly obvious spell or damage power that may be recognized by characters familiar with that power.	Various: Status and Damage powers
Pink headband, sash or glowstick	The player is Non-Combative. Do not hit them with boffer weapons. See the Non-Com rules for how to attack their character,	Non-Com rules

"Resist" sig call	That character has expended a resource (likely Willpower) to resist an effect. However, you don't necessarily know in-character that your attack failed (unless it's obvious that they're not under the effect). Likewise, that character won't necessarily know that you tried to do something to them, but is aware that they resisted an effect and can make obvious deductions.	Various powers
Silver or black full face mask	The character is visible, but appears as a gaseous form.	Form of Vapor power
Small white tags attached to objects	These are Item tags .	
"Stand Down!"	As "Hold" above.	
White full face mask or veil	The character is an expressionless being.	See the Caul rules for Wraith.
White headband	The character is in the Umbra. Unless you have the Medium merit, Umbra Sight, or a similar ability, you cannot see, hear, or otherwise perceive them.	Various: being Umbrabound, stepping sideways, Gauntlet Walk, Shunt, etc.

Appendix G – ST Powers

These powers are listed for transparency and so you can be less surprised when you hear an unfamiliar call. NPC Only powers can **never** be used by Player Characters, even through items or being temporarily bestowed. Legendary powers are reserved for only the most powerful NPCs, and are always also NPC only.

A

Legendary, NPC Only

ABSOLUTION (TOUCH)

Cost: 5 Energy Call: “Absolution”

Place your hand on the target's head and pray for 60 Uninterrupted seconds. Demons or characters with a Demon Patron drop to 0 Maximum Health. Vampires, Wraiths, Shifters and Fae drop to 0 Health. If the target is a Claimed or possessed (via the Possession power), these effects end immediately. The target is also cleansed as per the Cleanse power.

ABSORB FETISH (SELF) C2

Cost: None Call: “Absorb Fetish”

Spend 60 Uninterrupted seconds with both hands holding a Fetish. Remove the Fetish Tag.

Gain Energy equal to double the Fetish's Attunement. If there is no Attunement, you gain 4 Energy.

ABSORB MAGIC (SELF) C3

Cost: None Call: “Absorb Magic”

Spend 60 Uninterrupted seconds with both hands holding a magic item. Remove the item Tag.

Gain Energy equal to double the magical item's Attunement. If there is no Attunement, you gain 4 Energy.

AGGRAVATED 4 (DAMAGE) C3

Cost: 2 Energy Call: “Agg 4”

Throw a packet that does 4 Aggravated damage.

Legendary, NPC Only, Demon Only

APOCALYPTIC FORM (MASK) C

Cost: None Call: None

You have a makeup requirement of wearing a Demon Mask or prosthetics. This cannot be suppressed by True Form, but can be hidden by Mask of a Thousand Faces.

You may also use claw natural weapons.

NPC Only

<TYPE> ATTACK (PASSIVE) C3

Cost: None Call: “<Type><Damage>”

Add <type> to damage calls using natural weapons, where <type> is indicated by the power's source. You must use this <type> when making damage calls with natural weapons.

B

<i>NPC Only</i>		
BANISH DEMON (TOUCH) C3		
Cost:	3 Willpower	Call: "Banish Demon"
If the target is a Demon they immediately go OOG as though they were Dead. If the target is not a Demon, they call "No Effect".		

<i>NPC Only</i>		
BARTER PATHOS (TOUCH) C1		
Cost:	1 Energy	Call: "Barter Pathos", "Granting <X> Pathos" or "Taking <X> Pathos"
Shake hands with a willing target. You gain or lose the stated amount of Pathos. Pathos exchanged this way cannot exceed your maximum or the target's maximum Energy pool. Targets who don't have Pathos call "No Effect".		

<i>NPC Only</i>		
BESTOW PATRON (OTHER) C3		
Cost:	None	Call: "Bestow Patron <Patron>"
You must state the name of your Patron, if you have one. If you do not have a Patron, you must state yourself. The target may choose to take that Patron as their own and record it on their character sheet. If the target already has a Patron, the new Patron replaces the previous one.		

<i>Legendary, NPC Only</i>		
BESTOW POWER <POWER> (TOUCH)		
Cost:	1 Energy	Call: "Bestow Power <Power>, <Duration>"
The target may use the stated power for the stated duration, as though it was on their character sheet. They are aware in-game that they have this ability. Options for <duration> are: • "for a single use" (cannot be used for Passive powers) • "three times" (cannot be used for Passive powers) • "until sunset" • "until sunrise" • "until the next full/new moon" (effectively, the rest of the event) • "as long as you are tainted this weekend/this moon" (this ends after the event) The target cannot use the power to cast rituals or to teach. The target must pay any costs needed to use the power. The target may only have a single power Bestowed on them at a time; subsequent Bestowings overwrite previous ones. The power Bestowed is determined by the source of this power. This power cannot be used to bestow powers that are NPC only.		

<i>NPC Only</i>		
BLAST (DAMAGE) C2		
Cost:	1 Energy	Call: "<Type> <Damage>"
Throw a packet of the specified <type> for your full damage amount.		

<i>NPC Only</i>		
BLOOD SUCKING (COUNTED TOUCH) C2		
Cost:	None	Call: "Biting 1, Biting 2, Biting 3, Paralyzing Bite"
You may bite and drain Health as per the rules for Vampires (using the powers Paralyzing Bite, Test Faction, and Draining). Health or Energy drained becomes Energy.		

NPC Only

BREAK ATTUNEMENT (TOUCH) C3

Cost: 3 Energy Call: "Break Attunement"

For the rest of the event, the target cannot activate any items attuned to them at the time this power was used on them (they may still attune to new items).

BREACH (SELF) C3

Cost: 1 Energy Call: "Breach <attack call>"

While in the Umbra, you may make a Status or Mental attack on a target in the Realm.

C

NPC Only

CANNOT TEACH (PASSIVE) C1

Cost: None Call: None

You cannot teach Power Trees or Skills.

NPC Only

CHAMELEON (SELF) C3

Cost: 2 Energy Call: None

As a passive effect without spending Energy, you know when a Sensory power is used on you and what question was asked. You may spend 2 Energy when a Sensory power is used on you to give a false answer. False answers given must still be valid responses to the Sensory power used.

CLAWS (SELF) C1

Cost: None Call: None

You may use claw natural weapons.

NPC Only

<TYPE> CLAWS (DAMAGE) C2

Cost: 1 Energy Call: "<Type> <Damage>"

Add the <Type> onto a single natural weapon attack, where <Type> is indicated by the power source.

NPC Only

CONDUIT (SELF) C2

Cost: None Call: None

Spend 60 Uninterrupted seconds meditating at a Node, then gain the Energy listed on the Node. As a passive effect, you can see Nodes in the Umbra, even if you do not have Umbra Sight and would not usually be able to perceive the Node. This power does not allow you to see other things in the Umbra.

NPC Only

CRAFT (SELF) C3

Cost: 3 Energy Call: None

Spend 60 Uninterrupted seconds roleplaying with an appropriate prop, then attach an Item tag to the prop. This allows a character to create magic items in-game without a ritual, as long as they have the tag.

D

NPC Only

DARK KNOWLEDGE <CORRUPTED TREE TYPE> (SELF) C3

Cost: None Call: None

Choose one of the following: Fallen Paths, Dark Arcanoi, Dark Thaumaturgy, or Wyrms Gifts. You may teach those trees.

Legendary, NPC Only, Demon Only

DIVINE POTENCY (PASSIVE)

C

Cost: None

Call: None

You gain Augment determined by your Demonic Vice. Different sources of Augment stack with one another.

Gluttony, Lust, and Sloth Demons gain Augment 2.
Envy, Greed, and Pride Demons gain Augment 3.
Wrath Demons gain Augment 4.

DRAIN THE EARTH (SELF)

C1

Cost: None

Call: None

Spend 60 Uninterrupted seconds meditating at a Gaian node, then gain 2 Energy. You may only do this at each node once per event. As a passive effect, you can see Nodes in the Umbra, even if you do not have Umbra Sight and would not usually be able to perceive the Node. This power does not allow you to see other things in the Umbra.

E

NPC Only

EMPATH (SELF)

C2

Cost: None

Call: None

Spend 60 Uninterrupted seconds meditating at a Haunt, then gain the amount of Energy listed on the card. You may only do this at each Haunt once per event. As a passive effect, you can see Haunts in the Umbra, even if you do not have Umbra Sight and would not usually be able to perceive the Node. This power does not allow you to see other things in the Umbra.

NPC Only

EMPOWER WEAPON (SELF)

C2

Cost: 3 Energy

Call: None

Spend 60 Uninterrupted seconds meditating with a non-natural weapon. You may deal 1 additional damage with that weapon for the rest of the event.

NPC Only

ENCHANT WEAPON (OTHER)

C3

Cost: 2 Energy

Call: "Enchant Weapon"

Meditate with a martial weapon for at least 10 seconds, then attach an Enchanted Weapon tag to that weapon.

NPC Only

ENERGY EXCHANGE (COUNTED TOUCH)

C3

Cost: None

Call: "Breach", "Giving Energy," or "Draining Energy"

You may use the **Paralyzing Touch** power, and may optionally add the "Breach" meta call to choose a target in a different realm. Energy Exchange may only be activated after successfully using Paralyzing Touch on a target. During the Exchange, the target remains paralyzed per the power Paralyze.

You may choose to either give the target Energy or drain their Energy. For every call of "Giving Energy 1, Giving Energy 2, etc." the target gains 1 Energy and you lose 1 Energy. For every call of "Draining Energy 1, Draining Energy 2, etc." the target loses 1 Energy and you gain 1 Energy.

This power ends if you or the target are Interrupted, you or your target's Energy reaches its maximum, or if you take your hand off of the target.

Your target becomes Tainted if you are, and you become Tainted if they are (cross your fingers and ask them).

F

<i>NPC Only</i>			
FALSE MEMORY (TOUCH <CONDITION>)			C3
Cost:	3 Energy	Call:	"Condition: False Memory <description>"
Have a conversation with a target for at least 60 Uninterrupted consecutive seconds immediately before using this power. Touch the target and describe a short memory. The <description> is limited to two sentences. Explain OOG to the target that this memory has been implanted into them and is indistinguishable from their own memories. If the condition is removed, they will still remember the new memory, but will know it more as an errant idea, not as a memory.			

<i>NPC Only</i>			
FLUID FORM (MASK)			C1
Cost:	None	Call:	None
You may put on or take off any Transformation mask.			

FORTITUDE (PASSIVE)			C3
Cost:	None	Call:	None
Your Maximum Health is increased by 4.			

<i>NPC Only</i>			
FREE SPIRIT (PASSIVE)			C3
Cost:	None	Call:	"No Effect"
You are immune to the Rite of the Fetishcraft ritual.			

G

<i>NPC Only</i>			
GAIAN CLEANSE (TOUCH)			C2
Cost:	1 Energy	Call:	"Cleanse Taint"
The target is cleansed of Taint.			

<i>NPC Only</i>			
GIVE ENERGY (TOUCH)			C3
Cost:	<X> Energy	Call:	"Giving <X> Energy"
The target gains the number of Energy called, not exceeding their maximum Energy. This transfers Taint.			

<i>Legendary. NPC Only</i>			
GRACE (TOUCH)			
Cost:	5 Energy	Call:	"Grace, heal all Agg"
The target is healed of all Aggravated damage. Their Current Health is unchanged.			

<i>NPC Only</i>			
GRANT ENERGY (PASSIVE)			C1
Cost:	None	Call:	"Grant Energy 4"
The target must have just successfully used Release Spirit on you. The target receives 4 Energy in addition to the 1 Willpower they receive for Release Spirit. This power may be purchased multiple times, with each purchase increasing the amount of Energy granted by 4.			

Legendary, NPC Only

GRANT POWER <POWER> (TOUCH)

Cost: 1 Energy Call: "Grant <Power>"

The target may use the stated power for the stated duration, as though it was on their character sheet. They are aware in-game that they have this ability.

The target cannot use the power to cast rituals or to teach. The target must pay any costs needed to use the power. The target may have multiple powers Granted to them at the same time.

The power Granted is determined by the source of this power. This power cannot be used to Grant powers that are NPC only.

H

Legendary, NPC Only

HARDENED (SELF)

Cost: 1 Energy Call: "Resist"

Resist a single Status attack.

Legendary, NPC Only

HEALING TOUCH 10 (TOUCH)

Cost: 2 Energy Call: "Healing Touch 10"

The target gains 10 Health, not to exceed their Maximum Health.

I

NPC Only

IMBUE CURIO (OTHER) C3

Cost: 2 Energy Call: "Imbue"

Meditate with an object for at least 10 seconds, then attach an Imbued Curio tag to that object.

NPC Only

<TYPE> IMMUNITY (PASSIVE) C2

Cost: None Call: "No Effect"

You are immune to damage of the specified <type>. The <type> cannot be regular damage (i.e. <Iron>). This power cannot be used to grant immunity to a type of damage you are Scorched by.

Legendary, NPC Only

INDOMITABLE (SELF)

Cost: 2 Energy Call: "Resist"

Immediately resist a Mental attack. You cannot use this power to resist Mentals after they have taken effect.

L

Legendary, NPC Only

LEGENDARY AVOIDANCE (SELF)

Cost: 2 Energy Call: "Resist"

Resist a single damage attack and any Meta calls associated with it.

Legendary, NPC Only

LEGENDARY STRENGTH <NUMBER> (PASSIVE)

Cost: None Call: None

You gain Augment <Number>, where Number is defined by the power. Different sources of Augment stack with one another. Total Augment cannot exceed 9.

M

NPC Only

MANIPULATE GLADE (OTHER) C2

Cost: 4-14 Energy Call: None

Hang a temporary Glade tag at an appropriate location, the value of which is half of the amount of Energy used to activate this power (rounded down). This temporary Glade lasts the duration of the Event. Only one temporary Glade may exist at a time.

Additionally, you may spend twice the value of a Glade to close it for that event. If the Glade is not temporary, it reopens at the next Event. Only one Glade may be closed this way per Event.

MASS CONFUSION (MENTAL) C3

Cost: 3 Energy Call: "(Breach) Mass Confusion"

All targets are affected by the power Confusion. You may use this power from the Umbra to the Realm by adding "Breach" before the call.

MASS DERANGE (MENTAL) C3

Cost: 3 Energy Call: "Mass Derange <Derangement>"

All targets are affected by the power Derange. The Derangement selected must be one that is present on your character sheet.

Legendary, NPC Only

MASS <MENTAL> (MENTAL)

Cost: 2 Energy Call: "Mass <Mental>"

Add the "Mass" call to one use of the Mental specified in the source of this power.

Mass powers can never be Unresistable.

This power cannot be used with the following Mentals: Avert, Control Voice, Hypnotism, or any mental that already calls "Mass"

N

NATURAL ARMOR (PASSIVE) C2

Cost: None Call: None

You have a pool of 4 armor points which refreshes each sunrise. These armor points do not require a phys-rep and are added to any other armor you have, except those gained from this power. These armor points are used before any other type of armor and are not regained until the next sunrise.

O

Not intended to be put on items

OCCULT ACCLIMATION <ENERGY TYPE> (PASSIVE) C2

Cost: None Call: None

Choose an Energy type. You may attune to and use items that require this Energy type as though you had the required Energy type.

Not intended to be put on items

OCCULT MASTERY <RITUAL TYPE> (PASSIVE) C3

Cost: None Call: None

Choose one of the following: Mystic, Glyph, Blood, Arcanos. You may read and use these rituals as if you have the required Energy type and Power Tree requirements, unless the ritual is marked "Faction Locked". All energy costs/benefits affect your energy type.

You must still possess powers used as part of the ritual's casting instructions or effects. This power does not allow you to ignore casting requirements beyond energy type and Power Tree, such as belonging to a particular subfaction, having a certain Rank, having a Shadow in control, Skill Tree requirements, etc.

Note that this does not let you cast rituals if you do not have the Rituals skill.

EXAMPLES:

Empowered Healing requires Gurahl 1 and “caster must be a Gurahl”, and increases the effects of the caster’s Healing Touch power to restore 6 Health. A character with Occult Mastery (Glyph) could cast this ritual, but would gain no benefit unless they also had Healing Touch.

Tapping Ananasa’s Wisdom requires Ananasi 2 and “caster must be an Ananasi”, and allows the caster to learn new gifts while Melded. A character with Occult Mastery (Glyph) could cast this ritual only if they had the Meld power, as using this power is listed in one of the instructions for casting the ritual.

Legendary, NPC Only

OMNISCIENCE (PASSIVE)

Cost:	None	Call:	None
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You hear all OOG sig calls, knowing what powers are used, who their casters and targets are, and whether or not they are resisted.

P

Legendary, NPC Only

PASS WARD (SELF)

Cost:	5 Energy	Call:	None
-------	----------	-------	------

Meditate for 30 seconds before a ward. You may pass through it a single time as if it were not there.

Not intended to be put on items

PATTERN SENSE (PASSIVE)

C3

Cost:	None	Call:	None
-------	------	-------	------

You hear all OOG sig calls used against you, knowing what powers are used and their casters. You hear “Resist” calls against powers and attacks made by you.

PORTAL MASTERY (SELF)

C1

Cost:	1 Energy	Call:	“Portal Mastery”
-------	----------	-------	------------------

Open or close a locked door.

POSSESSION (MENTAL)

W3

Cost:	1 Energy	Call:	“Breach Possession”
-------	----------	-------	---------------------

You must be in the Umbra and the target must be in the Realm. Roleplay puppeting the target for 10 seconds then place your hands on the target’s shoulders.

The target may only perform actions that you instruct them to do. The target cannot activate any powers but retains the use of any passive powers. You may direct the target to use your powers by spending the appropriate cost yourself and having the target perform any associated actions. You and the player of the target character should work together to maintain hand-on-shoulder contact.

While this power is active, Touch, Damage and Status attacks affect the target of your Possession, but Mental attacks affect you and do not break the Possession. Other characters with Umbra Sight can see that Possession is occurring.

This power ends if you or the target become Incapacitated or if you are further than 10 feet from the target.

PURIFY (TOUCH)

C2

Cost:	1 Willpower	Call:	“Purify”
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The target immediately exits Frenzy and every condition affecting the target ends.

Note: this power was removed from a PC tree in 2019. It’s kept as an ST power in case it appears on any items that are still in use. It is recommended to not be placed on future items.

NPC Only

POISON (SELF)

C2

Cost:	1 Energy	Call:	None
-------	----------	-------	------

Affix a poison tag to a food or drink container prop without needing to use a vial prop to “pour the poison in”.

Q

Legendary, NPC Only

Q: AUTUMN'S CHAMPION (SELF)

Cost:	1 Quintessence	Call:	"Unresistable Daze" and "Mass Disquiet"
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For the next 10 minutes, you gain and may use Unresistable Daze and Mass Disquiet at no cost.

Legendary, NPC Only

Q: CALL TO ADVENTURE (SELF)

Cost:	1 Quintessence	Call:	"Mass Craving" and "Mass Meditate"
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Spend 10 minutes telling a story to activate this power.

For the next 10 minutes, you gain and may use Mass Craving and Mass Meditate at no cost.

Legendary, NPC Only

Q: CALL BACK THE SPIRITS (SELF)

Cost:	1 Quintessence	Call:	"Mass Heal 8" and "Mass Revive"
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For the next 10 minutes, you may concentrate for 10 seconds while doing nothing other than standing or sitting still to call "Mass Heal 8" at no cost.

Additionally, you may concentrate for 60 seconds while doing nothing other than standing or sitting still to call "Mass Revive" at no cost, ending this power early.

Legendary, NPC Only

Q: COMMANDING VOICE (SELF)

Cost:	1 Quintessence	Call:	"Mass Obedience" and "Conditioning"
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For the next 10 minutes, you gain and may use Mass Obedience and Conditioning at no cost (note that Conditioning can only be applied to Mental powers without the "Mass" meta call).

Legendary, NPC Only

Q: CONTROL CROWD (SELF)

Cost:	1 Quintessence	Call:	"Mass Induce Frenzy" and "Mass Serenity"
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For the next 10 minutes, you gain and may use Mass Induce [Frenzy](#) and Mass Serenity at no cost.

Legendary, NPC Only

Q: CONTROL FREAK (SELF)

Cost:	1 Quintessence	Call:	"Mass Obedience" and "Unresistable Obedience"
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For the next 10 minutes, you gain and may use Mass Obedience at no cost.

Additionally, during these 10 minutes you gain and may use Unresistable Obedience on any Demon or target with a Demon Patron at no cost. You must be aware in-game that the target is a Demon or has a Demon Patron.

Legendary, NPC Only

Q: DISTANT WAILS (SELF)

Cost:	1 Quintessence	Call:	"Tainted Brittle Bones and "Tainted Derange <Derangement>"
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For the next 10 minutes, you gain and may use Tainted Brittle Bones and Tainted Derange at no cost. Any Derangement selected must be one that is present on your character sheet.

Legendary, NPC Only

Q: EMPOWER SELF (SELF)

Cost:	1 Quintessence	Call:	None
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For the next 10 minutes, you may replace the numeric call of all damage powers, melee attacks, and healing powers with your current Quintessence.

Legendary, NPC Only

Q: ENHANCE CONSCIOUSNESS (SELF)

Cost:	1 Quintessence	Call:	"No Effect" and "Restore 2 Willpower"
-------	----------------	-------	---------------------------------------

All Mental powers and Despair end on you and your Willpower is fully refreshed.

Additionally, for the next 10 minutes, you are immune to Mental powers. During these 10 minutes you may touch any character and say "Restore 2 Willpower", at no cost, once per target.

Legendary, NPC Only

Q: ESSENCE FONT (SELF)

Cost:	1 Quintessence	Call:	"Restore Essence"
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Your Essence is fully refreshed.

Additionally, for the next 10 minutes, you gain and may use Restore Essence at no cost. During these 10 minutes you may use any of your packet-throwing powers at no cost.

Legendary, NPC Only

Q: FEAR ME (SELF)

Cost:	1 Quintessence	Call:	"Mass Taunt" and "Mass Terror"
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For the next 10 minutes, you gain and may use Mass Taunt and Mass Terror at no cost.

Legendary, NPC Only

Q: FRENZIED WARRIOR (SELF)

Cost:	1 Quintessence	Call:	"No Effect" and "Brutal <Number>"
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For the next 10 minutes, you gain all mechanical benefits and immunities of being in a [Frenzy](#) but may still act rationally and use powers as normal.

Additionally, during these 10 minutes you gain the Brutal Strike power (at the normal cost).

Legendary, NPC Only

Q: GOD'S GRACE (SELF)

Cost:	1 Quintessence	Call:	"Grace, heal all Agg" and "Mass Serenity"
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For the next 10 minutes, you gain and may use Grace and Mass Serenity at no cost.

Legendary, NPC Only

Q: INFERNAL TORMENT (SELF)

Cost:	1 Quintessence	Call:	"Tainted Body Wrack" and "Tainted Decay"
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For the next 10 minutes, you gain and may use Tainted Body Wrack and Tainted Decay at no cost.

Legendary, NPC Only

Q: KNOW THE TRUTH (SELF)

Cost:	1 Quintessence	Call:	"Mass True Form", "Grant Power (Umbra Sight)", and "Grant Power (Cloak Sight)"
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For the next 10 minutes, you gain and may use Mass True Form, Grant Power (Umbra Sight), and Grant Power (Cloak Sight) at no cost.

Legendary, NPC Only

Q: MANIPULATE CRAY (OTHER)

Cost:	1-5 Quintessence	Call:	None
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You must have 3 or more maximum Quintessence to use this power.

Hang a temporary Cray tag at an appropriate location, the value of which is the amount of Quintessence used to activate this power. This temporary Cray lasts the duration of the Event. Only one temporary Cray may exist at a time.

Additionally, you may spend half the value of a Cray (rounded up) to close it for that event. If the Cray is not temporary, it reopens at the next Event.

Legendary, NPC Only

Q: MASTER OF CORRUPTION (SELF)

Cost:	1 Quintessence	Call:	"Mass Induce Sin <Sin>" and "Mass Derange <Derangement>"
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For the next 10 minutes, you gain and may use Mass Induce Sin and Mass Derange at no cost. Any Derangement selected must be one that is present on your character sheet.

Legendary, NPC Only

Q: MASTER OF DREAMS (SELF)

Cost:	1 Quintessence	Call:	"Daze", "Mass Daze", and "Dreamshape"
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For the next 10 minutes, you gain and may use Daze, Mass Daze, and Dreamshape at no cost.

Legendary, NPC Only

Q: MASTER OF HELL (SELF)

Cost:	1 Virtue and <X> Quintessence	Call:	"Bind Demon"
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You must be at ST camp to activate this power, as both you and a Demon enter the game.

You summon a Demon from hell and create a temporary body for it, as if it has used Possession on you. The demon's power is determined by the Quintessence spent. It must follow your commands to the letter but may subvert or tempt you.

If you become Incapacitated, have no Quintessence, or go OOG, the Demon breaks free for 10 minutes, after which it is pulled back to hell and goes OOG.

Note that this is the only way a Demon may be summoned outside of a summoning circle without being directly by its reliquary. Your body counts as its reliquary for the purposes of not being re-banished unless you are Dead.

Legendary, NPC Only

Q: MASTER OF ILLUSION (SELF)

Cost:	1 Quintessence	Call:	"Mass Monsters" and "Mass Horrid Reality <description>"
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For the next 10 minutes, you gain and may use Mass Monsters and Mass Horrid Reality at no cost.

Legendary, NPC Only

Q: OUT OF TOUCH (SELF)

Cost:	1 Quintessence	Call:	"Cloak" and "No Effect"
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For the next 10 minutes, you gain and may use Cloak at no cost. During these 10 minutes, while Cloaked, you are immune to melee attacks.

Legendary, NPC Only

Q: PERFECT BODY (SELF)

Cost:	1 Quintessence	Call:	"No Effect"
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For the next 10 minutes, you gain a Regeneration Rate of either 3 or your current Quintessence, whichever is higher.

Additionally, during these 10 minutes, you can regenerate without concentrating, and are immune to damage calls.

Legendary, NPC Only

Q: RATIONALIZE (SELF)

Cost:	1 Quintessence	Call:	"Mass Status Disable" and "No Effect"
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For the next 10 minutes, you gain and may use Mass Status Disable at no cost.

Additionally, during these 10 minutes, you are immune to packet powers.

Legendary, NPC Only

Q: RAW POWER (SELF)

Cost: 1 Quintessence Call: "<Damage>"

For the next 10 minutes, your boffer and packet damage becomes either 6 or twice your current Quintessence, whichever is higher.

Legendary, NPC Only

Q: REFORM (SELF)

Cost: 1 Quintessence Call: "Reform"

Spend 60 seconds totally still. You may be Cloaked or in either Realm.

Go OOG for at least 4 hours. When you return, your current and Maximum Health are fully restored.

Legendary, NPC Only

Q: RIGHT HAND OF GOD (SELF)

Cost: 1 Quintessence Call: "Mass Entrancement" and "Unresistable Absolution"

For the next 10 minutes, you gain and may use Majesty and Unresistable Absolution at no cost.

Legendary, NPC Only

Q: SECRET IDENTITY (SELF)

Cost: 1 Quintessence Call: None

You must be at ST camp to activate this power.

Create a second character sheet that is a non-Mage Human, Shifter, Vampire or Wraith. Switch character sheets and garb / appearance, playing with the new character sheet as if it is your own. You may only use the powers, skills, and merits of this new sheet, and must respond to Sensory powers as if this new sheet were your character.

You must be at ST camp to deactivate this power and use your original character sheet once more.

Legendary, NPC Only

Q: SPRING'S BOUNTY (SELF)

Cost: 1 Quintessence Call: "Fabricate Armor 10"

For the next 10 minutes, you gain and may use Fabricate Armor at no cost, creating 10 armor points instead of 4.

Additionally, for these 10 minutes, you can spend any amount of Energy to instantly heal the same amount of Aggravated damage.

Legendary, NPC Only

Q: SUMMER'S FURY (SELF)

Cost: 1 Quintessence Call: "Fire <Damage>"

Double your current Maximum Health and fully restore your Current Health. For the next 10 minutes, add the Fire <type> to all damage attacks.

After these 10 minutes, your Maximum Health returns to normal (and your Current Health drops to the maximum if it now exceeds your maximum).

Legendary, NPC Only

Q: TOUCH OF DEATH (SELF)

Cost: 1 Quintessence Call: "Agg <Damage>"

For the next 10 minutes, add the Agg <Type> to all damage attacks. Additionally, during these 10 minutes, your packet powers have no cost..

Legendary, NPC Only

Q: UNCHAINED (SELF)

Cost: 1 Quintessence Call: "No Effect"

You may end any Mental, Status, and / or Touch effect(s) on yourself. For the next 10 minutes, you are immune to all Mental, Status, and Touch powers.

Legendary, NPC Only

Q: UNDYING (OTHER)

Cost:	2 Virtue and 1 Quintessence	Call:	None
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You may use the Zombi Ritual (Rare, Vampire) without any casting time or components.

Additionally, if you are Dead or Dying, you may spend 2 Virtue and 1 Quintessence to go OOG. You may then return at the edge of game with 1 Health and 1 Energy.

Legendary, NPC Only

Q: VOICE OF MALFEAS (SELF)

Cost:	1 Quintessence	Call:	"Tainted Induce Sin <Sin>" and "Mass Subjugate"
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For the next 10 minutes, you gain and may use Tainted Induce Sin and Mass Subjugate at no cost.

Legendary, NPC Only

Q: WINTER'S TOUCH (SELF)

Cost:	1 Quintessence	Call:	"Unresistable Brittle Bones" and "Ice 4"
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For the next 10 minutes, you gain and may use Unresistable Brittle Bones and Ranged 4 <Ice> at no cost.

R

READ / WRITE INFERNAL TEXT (SELF) C3

Cost:	3 Energy	Call:	None
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Receive one Infernal Text tag at Check-In (without paying this power's cost).

You may attach the Infernal Text tag to a paper after writing or drawing on it and paying the cost. The Derangement selected must be one present on your character sheet.

You are also immune to the effects of any document with an Infernal Text tag.

Legendary, NPC Only

RESTORE ESSENCE (TOUCH)

Cost:	5 Energy	Call:	"Restore Essence"
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If the target's current Energy type is Essence, they regain Energy up to their maximum.

Legendary, NPC Only

RITUAL MASTER (PASSIVE)

Cost:	None	Call:	None
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If you have Rituals 3, you may cast Legendary Potency rituals that you meet the other casting requirements for.

S

<TYPE> SCORCHED (PASSIVE) C1

Cost:	None	Call:	None
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You take Aggravated damage from the specified <type>. If another source causes you to take Aggravated damage from that <type> or if you cannot take Aggravated damage, double the damage you take from all attacks of that <type> (you still only lose 1 Maximum Health from such attacks).

You also take Exposure damage from contact with the specified <type>, as normal. If the <type> is <Light>, you do not take Exposure damage from <Light> — instead, you gain Sunsickness from sun exposure. <Light> damage still causes you to take Aggravated damage as normal.

SENSE FACTION (SENSORY) C1

Cost:	None	Call:	"Sense Faction"
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Stare at the target for 10 seconds. They must answer OOG with their Faction.

SENSE FAE OATH (SENSORY) C2

Cost: None Call: "Sense Fae Oath"

Stare at the target for 10 seconds. After the sig call, ask one or both of: "Do you have any Fae Oaths or bargains?" or "Have you broken any Fae Oaths or bargains this weekend?". The target must answer OOG truthfully. If you had any Fae Oaths or bargains with the target, you may quickly clarify OOG whether they have been broken.

*NPC Only***SENSE PATRON (SENSORY)** C3

Cost: None Call: "Sense Patron"

Stare at the target for 10 seconds. They must answer OOG with their Patron, or "No Effect" if they do not have one.

SENSE POWER (SENSORY) C1

Cost: 1 Energy Call: "Sense Power <Power>"

Stare at the target for 10 seconds. They must answer OOG "yes" or "no" if the stated power is listed on their character sheet. Powers gained through Mimic or Magical items are not powers on the character's sheet.

*Legendary, NPC Only***SENSE <SUBFACTION> (SENSORY)**

Cost: None Call: "Sense <subfaction>"

Stare at the target for 10 seconds. They must answer OOG with their requested subfaction, or "No Effect" if they do not have such a subfaction. The subfaction will be specified in the power source.

EXAMPLES

Sense Auspice, Sense Changing Breed, Sense Claimed Type, Sense Clan, Sense Fae Court, Sense Fellowship, Sense Guild, Sense Legion, Sense Spectre

*NPC Only***SENSE TRIBE (SENSORY)** C3

Cost: None Call: "Sense Tribe"

Stare at the target for 10 seconds. They must answer OOG with their Tribe if they are Garou or Garou Kinfolk; with their changing breed if they are Fera or Fera Kinfolk; or "Ronin" if they are Ronin. All other characters respond "No Effect".

SENSE TORMENT (SENSORY) C1

Cost: None Call: "Sense Torment"

Stare at the target for 10 seconds. They must answer OOG their current Torment rating. Targets without a Torment rating call "No Effect".

SENSE VIRTUE (SENSORY) C1

Cost: None Call: "Sense Virtue"

Stare at the target for 10 seconds. They must answer OOG their current Virtue rating. This does not tell you what type of Virtue they have, only the numeric value.

*Legendary, NPC Only***SHARED MEMORY (PASSIVE)**

Cost: None Call: None

Your character knowledge is shared with all other spirits of the same kind, even if you die.

SHIFT REALM (SELF) C3

Cost: None Call: None

Spend 60 Uninterrupted seconds concentrating. Travel from the Realm to the Umbra or from the Umbra to the Realm.

NPC Only, Fae Only

SHOW / HIDE MEIN (SELF) C3

Cost: None Call: None

Put on or take off masks, prosthetics, and other optional costuming representing your Mein. You shift into or out of your Mein form.

NPC Only

SHUNT (TOUCH) C3

Cost: 1 Energy Call: "Breach Shunt"

The target falls from the Realm into the Umbra or from the Umbra into the Realm. You must be able to provide the target a white headband to force them into the Umbra.

STRENGTH (PASSIVE) C2

Cost: None Call: None

You gain Augment 1. Different sources of Augment stack with one another.

T

NPC Only, Spirit Only

TEACH TREE <POWER TREE> (PASSIVE) C1

Cost: None Call: None

You may teach the appropriate Power Tree to characters of the appropriate Faction. You must have at least one power from said Tree. All other rules around Teaching and Learning are normal.

EXAMPLE: A Spirit with Teach Tree <Order of Hermes> cannot teach a Ghoul or an Old Faith Sorcerer, but could teach a Sorcerer who has no Fellowship.

TOUGH FORM (MASK) C2

Cost: None Call: "Resist"

You may put on a mask determined by this power's source. While wearing any transformation mask you may resist Status attacks for 1 Energy.

Note: this power was removed from PC trees in 2023. It's kept as an ST power in case it appears on any items that are still in use. It is recommended to not be placed on future items.

V

VIGOR (PASSIVE) C1

Cost: None Call: None

Your Regeneration Rate is increased by 1.

W

WYRM'S HERALD (PASSIVE) C3

Cost: None Call: "No Effect"

You are immune to the Subjugate and Sanctuary powers.

